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ISKCON Law

*The 2018 ISKCON Law Book Update, Extended with GBC Resolutions Through
2026*

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This document reproduces the 2018 *ISKCON Law Book* update (found by Pitambara dasa) verbatim, chapters 1–24 plus Appendices, and adds every published GBC resolution from the 2019 Annual General Meeting through 2026 under the book's own matching chapter/section, clearly marked "ADDED". It has not been reviewed, edited, or authorised by the Governing Body Commission or ISKCON's Law Department. Nothing here should be relied on as a statement of current ISKCON law.

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Chapter/section numbers follow the 2018 book's own numbering exactly (never renumbered). Back-matter appendix numbers (Appendices 1-4) are a separate numbering scope from the main chapters and may repeat small numbers already used by a chapter (e.g. both a chapter and an appendix have their own, unrelated "2.3") -- always distinguished by context/heading in the text. Two entries marked "(dup. no.)" are places where the 2018 source ITSELF reuses a section number for a second, different passage -- flagged, never renumbered; see Methodology in the companion HTML edition for the full explanation.

Preface

This volume marks the revival of a resolution that directs the GBC to publish an annual up-to-date corpus of the Society's laws. It is also a significant step on the way to the drafting of a constitution for ISKCON, which Srila Prabhupada asked the GBC to put together in the early seventies. Finally, this volume will serve the GBC, ISKCON Leaders and all devotees as a useful source book of information in the practical affairs of executing devotional service within our institution. It is the hope of the GBC Body that the Vaisnavas in Srila Prabhupada's great movement will be satisfied with this compilation of ISKCON Law.

There may be laws that are obsolete, redundant, contradictory or poorly composed. And there are undoubtedly areas that our laws do not cover sufficiently. But in general, these laws are well thought out, each one representing many hours of deliberation on the part of many of the most experienced devotees in ISKCON. To get us from this corpus to a constitution, the help of all interested devotees throughout the movement is welcome.

-H.H. Suhotra Swami (GBC 2nd Vice Chairman 1997-98)

1 International Society for Krishna Consciousness

1.1 Definition

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON) is the spiritual institution founded by His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada in July 1966 as a continuation of the *Brahma-Madhva-Gaudiya sampradaya*. ISKCON was personally directed by its Founder-Acarya Srila Prabhupada until his departure on November 14, 1977. According to Srila Prabhupada's will, ISKCON continued thereafter under the ultimate managing authority of the Governing Body Commission (GBC).

Accordingly, ISKCON is that institution founded by Srila Prabhupada and originally directed by him, which continues to be directed after his departure by the GBC.

1.2 Principles: The Seven Purposes of ISKCON

1. To systematically propagate spiritual knowledge to society at large and to educate all peoples in the techniques of spiritual life in order to check the imbalance of values in life, and to achieve real unity and peace in the world.
2. To propagate consciousness of Krsna as it is revealed in the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.
3. To bring the members of the Society together with each other and nearer to Krsna, the prime entity, and thus develop the idea within the members and humanity at large that each soul is part and parcel of the quality of Godhead (Krsna).
4. To teach and encourage the *sankirtana* movement of congregational chanting of the holy name of God as revealed in the teachings of Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu.
5. To erect for the members, and for society at large, a holy place of transcendental pastimes, dedicated to the Personality of Krsna.
6. To bring the members closer together for the purpose of teaching a simpler and more natural way of life.
7. With a view towards achieving the aforementioned purposes, to publish and distribute periodicals, magazines, books, and other writings.

ADDED · 2019

307.4 · Ban of 'One Time Use' Plastic (2019)

[Guideline]

(Proposed by Hrdaya Caitanya Das, sponsored by him and Devamrita Swami)

Whereas plastic is often used once-off and then thrown away;

Whereas the lifetime of plastic varies from 50 years to more than 1000 years;

Whereas plastic contaminates mother earth and her inhabitants;

Whereas many ISKCON temples use plastic and foam cups, plates, spoons, water bottles, maha-prasadam packages, plastic bags, etc., once-off and then discard them despite there being biodegradable alternatives;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada states that first you become conscious and then you become Krishna conscious;

Whereas there is an increasing awareness in the general public about such issues and ISKCON should set a proper example:

Resolved:

That ISKCON centres and members are strongly encouraged to not use single-use plastic.

GBC Resolution 307.4 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

307.04 • ISKCON's statement on race (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas ISKCON needs to reinforce its position on race;

RESOLVED:

That ISKCON's global Governing Body Commission (GBC) issues the following as ISKCON's official position statement on race:

In this time of global strife, tension, and polarization, the insights expressed in the Bhagavad Gita, a timeless wisdom text, irrevocably establish the spiritual equality of all beings. Such equality fosters tolerance, understanding, deep compassion, and unity in diversity. Moreover, Sri Isopanisad says, "He who systematically sees everything in relation to the Supreme Lord, who sees all living entities as His parts and parcels, and who sees the Supreme Lord within everything never hates anything or any being." In this way, all living beings are souls, children of God, brothers and sisters in God's all-embracing family.

In the Gaudiya Vaishnava tradition, of which the International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON) is a present-day branch, inclusiveness has been taught by generations of teachers, including Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu (1486-1534), the pioneer of a great social and religious movement that began five centuries ago in India. Despite forceful opposition, Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu, who is understood by the tradition to be Lord Krishna (God) Himself, opened his movement to everyone.

In turn, His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, (1896–1977), ISKCON's Founder-Acharya, travelled the world to establish ISKCON and spread the message of bhakti, or unconditional love of God, and to teach that spiritually we are all equal. Hence, Sri Caitanya's vision of equality and inclusiveness underpins ISKCON's worldview.

Srila Prabhupada tirelessly proclaimed the physical body to be like an outward dress and the spirit soul to be the real person. He taught that material differences were external and superficial. What matters is the person, not the dress — the soul, not the body. On the spiritual plane of the soul, equality is true and absolute. In this way, his teachings pivoted on spirit, not matter. They went far

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beyond the considerations of body, mind, intellect, and false ego to culminate in pure devotion and service to God, which only begins in earnest when our sense of who we are is firmly removed from any bodily, psychological, or intellectual designation.

Through his prolific writings, lectures, and organizational designs, Srila Prabhupada tirelessly endeavored to assist everyone in rekindling this vision and their natural love and in refining the kindness, integrity, and happiness that ensue. He placed love and compassion at the center of his personal dealings, and he exemplified these divine qualities in the way he inspired and directed the communities and organizations he founded. He taught that traits such as sex, race, and social class are ultimately irrelevant. His efforts were heroic; his accomplishments profound.

Clearly, such a sublime, spiritual vision warmly embraces all communities and races. Indeed, ISKCON, or the Hare Krishna movement, is committed to this vision and therefore invites everyone to participate and share fellowship in service to God, take responsibility, and hold positions of spiritual leadership.

Thus, the Hare Krishna movement stands against any form of racial bigotry and discrimination and condemns any behavior that is derogatory, demeaning, and racially insensitive. Instead, it encourages racial harmony and spiritual equality, as did Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu and Srila

Prabhupada. We are committed to creating an environment in which everyone feels valued and is educated to manifest a culture of universal peace, understanding, respect, tolerance, friendliness, and forgiveness. Furthermore, we remain committed to intervening, wherever and whenever necessary within ISKCON, to stop any wrongdoing that opposes such values.

Let us all acknowledge our shared spirituality, transcend racial differences and divides, and together live up to aspirations worthy of our ultimate connectedness with every living being, and with God.

GBC Resolution 307.04 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on September 1, 2021)

ADDED · 2025

307.04 · A Concise Statement of Gaudiya Vaisnava siddhanta for the (2025)

[Position paper]

International Society for Kṛṣṇa Consciousness position paper — 2025

Whereas every successful sampradaya, from ancient times to the present, has some form of concise statement to encapsulate its siddhanta;

Whereas a concise statement of siddhanta for ISKCON would help establish the philosophical unity of our movement, allowing for diversity of practical application;

Whereas our acaryas, such as Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura, have provided some such statements, but for ISKCON it would be more appropriate to base such statements on Srila Prabhupada's books as his teachings are our primary source of evidence and philosophical understanding

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC approves the position paper “A Concise Statement of Gaudiya Vaisnava Siddhanta for the International Society for Kṛṣṇa Consciousness.

The GBC especially thanks HH Bhakti-vijnana Goswami and HH Badrinarayan Swami for their efforts in producing this paper.

GBC Resolution 307.04 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed November 27, 2024

New material since 2018 — placement to be confirmed

ADDED · 2019

301.7 · Letter of Appreciation to Tamohara Das (2019)

[Vote of thanks]

Dear Tamohara Prabhu,

Please accept our humble obeisances. All glories to Srila Prabhupada.

We hereby accept your letter of resignation with immense gratitude for your service to the GBC Body.

Beginning with your contributions to developing and maintaining the Child Protection Office as its

director, you have steadily accepted your service as a leader in ISKCON with integrity and dedication.

Your educational background, your insights, and your focus on serving the devotees of Srila Prabhupada's ISKCON have brought so much benefit to our society. In addition, your balance of understanding and compassion along with firm adherence to Srila Prabhupada's instructions were particularly highlighted during your tenure as the GBC Chairman.

Although we regret that we will no longer have your association on the GBC Body, we pray that you

will continue with great success in your many services to Srila Prabhupada for years to come.

On behalf of the GBC Body, we respectfully offer you the title of GBC Emeritus with gratitude for your

dedicated service to Srila Prabhupada and his International Society for Krishna Consciousness.

Thank you very much.

Hare Krsna,

Your servants,

Madhu Sevita Das

Bhaktivaibhava Swami

Ramai Swami

(GBC Executive Committee, on behalf of the GBC Body)

GBC Resolution 301.7 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

301.7 · Letter of Appreciation to Sivarama Swami (2019)

[Vote of thanks]

Dear Sivarama Maharaja,

Please accept our humble obeisances. All glories to Srila Prabhupada.

It is impossible to put into words your contributions to the GBC Body in over three decades of service.

We have leaders who are expert managers and we have leaders who are deeply immersed in Krsna consciousness, thus bringing another sort of expertise to management. You, however, are that very rare Vaisnava who is a brilliant manager yet deeply Krsna conscious, committed to your service in Srila Prabhupada's mission yet conscious of the needs of others, philosophically astute, yet humorous and lighthearted.

There is scarcely a committee or project that has not benefitted from your input. And whenever a new

topic arises, yours is often the first input we seek out.

It is an understatement to say that a vacancy will be felt on the GBC Body in light of your retirement.

We pray that after taking time to focus on recuperating your health, you will consider giving us your

association again on the GBC Body.

Thank you very much, Maharaja, for your association, wisdom, friendship, and dedication.

Hare Krsna,

Your servants,

Madhu Sevita Das

Bhaktivaibhava Swami

Ramai Swami

(GBC Executive Committee, on behalf of the GBC Body)

GBC Resolution 301.7 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

301.7 · Letter of Appreciation to Guru Gauranga Das (2019)

Dear Guru Gauranga Prabhu,

Please accept our humble obeisances. All glories to Srila Prabhupada.

On behalf of the GBC Body, we respectfully offer you the title of GBC Emeritus with gratitude and

appreciation for your years of contributions and services to ISKCON and dedication to Srila Prabhupada.

You pioneered Krishna consciousness and laid the foundation for ISKCON's future growth in Switzerland in 1971, later establishing ISKCON as a legally recognized Swiss Church foundation. Thereafter, you organized Srila Prabhupada's official reception by the Government of Geneva and, in

1978, organized the first public Rathayatra in a major European city outside the UK.

Later, you successfully resisted defamatory remarks (libel) made by the Catholic Church against the

Hare Krishna movement in Switzerland, and thereby defended the position of ISKCON as a bona fide

spiritual organization.

You were appointed to the GBC Body in 1986, and served as the first GBC Minister of Justice.

During

your tenure, you established ISKCON's first Conflict Resolution Procedures (CRP).

Recently, you worked tirelessly to lead the legal team that successfully sued to prevent the sale of the

Sri Sri Radha-Govinda Temple in New York and restored it to its rightful place in ISKCON.

We thank you very much for your past and present services that have brought much benefit and protection to our society.

Your servants,

Madhu Sevita Das

Bhaktivaibhava Swami

Ramai Swami

(GBC Executive Committee, on behalf of the GBC Body)

GBC Resolution 301.7 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

304.2 · Sale of the Gaura Mandala Temple, Rome (2019)

[Action order]

(Proposed by Harikirtan Das and sponsored by Madhu Sevita Das and Hrdaya Caitanya Das)

Whereas there have been 20 years of litigation for the purpose of recovering the Gaura Mandala Property from a splinter group;

Whereas there is an executive court order that allows ISKCON to take possession of the above-mentioned property;

Whereas Sri Panca Tattva is kept in a most condemnable situation, and there are two very valid alternatives for Their worship and care;

Whereas there is an opportunity to acquire a better and safer place for the preaching in the Rome area:

Resolved:

The GBC body gives permission to the Rome Temple President and the local GBC, in conjunction with the Deity Ministry, to sell the Gaura Mandala property when the courts allow, buy a new temple

property for Rome, and relocate the Panca Tattva to a more suitable environment.

This is provisional on the Property Trustees providing a signed approval giving reasons for the sale to

the ISKCON Property Office.

GBC Resolution 304.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

306.2 · Ratification of the Mayapur Executive Board (MEB) (2019)

[Action order]

(Proposed and Sponsored by Anuttama Das)

Resolved:

The Governing Body Commission recognizes the following GBC members as GBC Representatives

for the Mayapur Project. They are also authorized as the GBC representatives serving on the Mayapur Executive Board (MEB):

Jayapataka Swami

Gopal Krsna Goswami

Bhakti Charu Swami

Bhakti Purusottama Swami

Anuttama Das

Hrdaya Caitanya Das

GBC Executive Chairman (ex-officio)

The GBC also recognizes the three ISKCON India Bureau members serving on the MEB. As of March 12, 2019 they are:

Basu Ghosh Das

Devakinandan Das

Dayaram Das

GBC Resolution 306.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

306.2 · GBC-ISKCON India Bureau Mayapur Agreement (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

The GBC seeks to establish a legally-binding agreement between the GBC and the ISKCON India Bureau regarding the management and ownership of the Mayapur Project, including the Temple of Vedic Planetarium.

The GBC directs the Mayapur Executive Board, with the assistance of other senior leaders of their choice, to dialogue with the Bureau to achieve this legally-binding agreement with regular reporting starting at the 2019 Midterm General Meeting.

GBC Resolution 306.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2020

301.03 · Policy guidelines for understanding and managing domestic abuse in (2020)

ISKCON — 2020

Guideline

Whereas Srila Prabhupada instructed his devotees to be of exemplary behavior at all times

Whereas Grhastha-asrama is meant to be an asrama of peaceful coexistence and spiritual progress for

both husband and wife

Whereas Srila Prabhupada took special care to engage, facilitate and protect his women disciples

Whereas our sastra directs all devotees to protect the brahmanas, the elderly, children, women and cows

Whereas sometimes Vaisnava husbands in ISKCON communities use sastric references or bring in outside

non-Gaudiya Vaisnava cultural norms and use those to justify physical or emotional abuse of their spouse

Whereas spousal abuse also harms children and the community at large

RESOLVED:

That the ISKCON GBC accepts the GBC Statement Against Domestic Abuse and the Guidelines contained

therein that give guidance to devotees and also provide resources to leaders and managers who are called

upon to deal with domestic abuse in their communities.

[Footnotes to resolution]

ISKCON North America instituted a Domestic Abuse Policy in 2019. This has been well received. A

modified policy for International ISKCON is available.

GBC_Stmt_Domestic_Abuse_2020.pdf

Domestic_Abuse_Appendix_2020_Intl.pdf

5

GBC Resolution 301.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

301.06 • GBC decision concerning Ananda Caitanya dasa's appeal (2020)

Action order

Whereas Ananda Caitanya dasa (BCAIS), formerly Bhakti Swarupa Caitanya Swami, was found to have

committed serious transgressions of the sannyasa order

Whereas the Sannyasa Committee, considering the evidence in this regard, decided to divest him of his

sannyasa title

Whereas Ananda Caitanya dasa subsequently appealed this decision

Whereas the GBC appointed a subcommittee consisting of Giriraja Swami, Krsna Kesava dasa, and Radha

dasi (MG) to look into this matter further

Whereas the subcommittee has submitted its recommendations to the GBC Body

RESOLVED:

That Ananda Caitanya dasa is directed to comply with the following:

1. Regular close association and careful mentoring by senior devotees. Such help should be specific in assisting Ananda Caitanya dasa to value the reputation of Srila Prabhupada, ISKCON, the sannyasa order, and the devotee community. He has indicated that Niranjana Swami and Bhakti Caitanya Swami know him and could be effective mentors.
2. Sannyasa status suspended for a minimum of four years. This suspension would run from the date of the original decision, meaning that Ananda Caitanya dasa has served one year of suspension thus far. At the end of the four-year period, his status should be reviewed by the Sannyasa Committee. If he is not ready for reinstatement, the Sannyasa Committee may extend the suspension after consideration of feedback from Ananda Caitanya dasa's mentors.
3. Limited preaching opportunities. After a period of one year from the adoption of these recommendations, Ananda Caitanya dasa could be given the opportunity to preach at small home gatherings. If this opportunity is granted to him, we recommend that he be required to obtain the permission of local and regional leaders in the area (after disclosing the terms of the decision against him). In addition, he should be chaperoned by a mature and reliable Vaisnava during any travel or preaching. At the end of four years from the date of the original decision, his mentors can assess whether he is ready to preach on a wider scale.
4. Five-year ban on leadership positions. This was part of the original decision and we believe it is appropriate. This five-year period would begin from the date of the original decision. The general standard used by both the Child Protection Office and the North American Leader Misconduct Committee is that giving Srimad-Bhagavatam class, giving the Sunday Feast or other public lectures, or leading kirtana are leadership positions.
5. Further restrictions possible. It should be made clear to Ananda Caitanya dasa that this remedial program of rectification is an opportunity for him to restore trust and to be reinstated as a recognized ISKCON sannyasi. If he breaches the conditions of probation, then his probationary period should be extended or he should receive further restrictions, including perhaps permanent removal of sannyasa status.

This GBC decision is based on two primary considerations. First, rectification and reintegration are

important goals of any system of correction in ISKCON. Ananda Caitanya dasa's offenses do not warrant

his being excluded from ISKCON. Thus, we must be concerned with reforming him.

Further, a five-year period of prohibition with no mentoring or assessment means that we will have no assurance that Ananda Caitanya dasa has rectified those tendencies that led to this situation. A shorter period of restrictions with careful mentoring and monitoring is more likely to achieve good results.

GBC Resolution 301.06 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

303.03 · Enhancing the culture of reading Srila Prabhupada's books globally (2020)

via Srila Prabhupada's book reading week — 2020

Action Order

Whereas there is evidence that ISKCON devotees, including leaders, often face challenges in regularly

reading Srila Prabhupada's books

Whereas at the 2017 edition of the SGGS it was also felt there should be a worldwide effort to increase

reading of Srila Prabhupada's books

Whereas Srila Prabhupada had many times emphasized the importance of his books and requested the

leaders of ISKCON to read his books and train others to systematically study his books

Whereas Srila Prabhupada often made statements such as, "I am very glad to know that you are reading

our literatures and you are very thoughtful about them", and "In my books the philosophy of Krishna

Consciousness is explained fully so if there is anything which you do not understand, then you simply have

to read again and again"

Whereas Srila Prabhupada cautioned his followers to daily employ their intelligence, by reading, discussing

and preaching to others, in order to keep our minds and actions pure

Whereas there is the need to bequeath to future generations of ISKCON a culture of diligently reading Srila

Prabhupada's books, so as to prevent speculations and concoctions

Whereas by reading Srila Prabhupada's books regularly, present and future generations can gain Srila

Prabhupada's divine association

RESOLVED:

The week leading up to Srila Prabhupada's arrival in America be declared "Srila Prabhupada's Book

Reading Week." This year this falls between September 3 and 9.

- During this week ISKCON centers are encouraged to highlight the importance of reading Srila Prabhupada's books in all lectures, addresses and discussions.
- During this week ISKCON leaders are encouraged to inspire devotees under their care to read Srila

Prabhupada's books by organizing orientation sessions and seminars on how and why to read Srila Prabhupada's books regularly and systematically.

- New programs may be introduced that will encourage and allow congregation devotees to take up

the reading of Srila Prabhupada's books enthusiastically.

GBC Resolution 303.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

303.03 · Dates for 2022 GBC Annual General Meeting — 2021 (2020)

Whereas the Srimad-Bhagavatam, Sri Caitanya-caritamṛta or Bhagavad-gita class is a sacred time dedicated to reading, discussing and deepening our understanding of our scriptures

Whereas the advertising of one's own devotional products during or at the end of giving the Srimad-

Bhagavatam, Sri Caitanya-caritamṛta or Bhagavad-gita class is in poor taste

Whereas it has been observed over the last few years, when tuning into many online classes around the

world, that this practice is gathering pace and risks becoming the norm

Whereas speakers who wish to promote their own devotional products, should, ahead of time, arrange with

the relevant authority to inform the devotees where—after class—their book, CD or USB stick etc., will be

available for purchase

RESOLVED:

No books, paraphernalia or any other products will be allowed to be advertised, promoted, or sold from or

near the speaker's asana before, during, or after the class

All ISKCON temples and centers will thus ensure that when speaking from the speaker's asana, speakers

will not use the speaker's asana or nearby as a platform for the promotion, advertising or sale of any books,

paraphernalia or other products including their own.

The only exceptions to this law are the books and recordings of Srila Prabhupada.

GBC Resolution 303.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

303.03 · Cooking with ghee (2020)

Guideline

Whereas Srila Prabhupada personally instructed and taught his disciples to prepare prasadam using ghee

Whereas most of our ISKCON temples are using oils instead of ghee for cooking, mainly due to economic reasons

Whereas Srila Prabhupada stated:

“Anna, ghṛta, dadhi and dugdha are food grains, ghee, yogurt and milk. Actually, these are the basis

of all food. Vegetables and fruits are subsidiary... We should understand that in order to prepare nutritious food, we require only grains, ghee, yogurt and milk. We cannot offer anything else to the

Deity. The Vaiṣṇava, the perfect human being, does not accept anything not offered to the Deity.” (Purport Cc Madhya 4.93)

Whereas Srila Prabhupada stated:

“There should be abundant prasadam for whoever comes all day long. The kitchen should go on. So see there is sufficient stock of rice, atta, ghee, etc. The life members should be especially cared for and invited.” (Letter to Gurudas July 1, 1974 Melbourne)

Whereas Srila Prabhupada stated:

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“From the very beginning I was asking to open restaurant and farm. Produce ghee in the farm and send to the restaurant, and make nice samosā, kachorī preparation, and there will be no scarcity of money. And if you organize in this way, your whole country will be transferred into Kṛṣṇa conscious

country. Whole country.” (Room Conversation -- May 4, 1976, Honolulu)

Whereas Srila Prabhupada personally made multiple arrangements for providing ghee at various ISKCON

temples

Whereas Srila Prabhupada stated:

“No society can improve in transcendental knowledge without the guidance of such first-class men,

and no brain can assimilate the subtle form of knowledge without fine brain tissues. For such important brain tissues we require a sufficient quantity of milk and milk preparations.” (Light of the

Bhagavata 27)

Whereas Srila Prabhupada made statements stressing ghee as an unavoidable essential in the diet for

development of necessary intellect

RESOLVED:

All ISKCON Temples are encouraged to use ghee in their cooking.

GBC Resolution 303.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

306.02 · Mayapur Festival declaration: Section A — Statement of commitment (2020)

— 2020

Statement

Whereas Srila Prabhupada showed by his own personal example the importance of the Mayapur Festival

by attending every year—being the first one to arrive and the last one to depart

Whereas Srila Prabhupada encouraged devotees to participate in the Mayapur Festival

Whereas Srila Prabhupada expects his GBC to be “Acarya-like” and set an example

Whereas ISKCON Mayapur is our world headquarters, and the home of the Temple of the Vedic Planetarium (TOVP). Thus, an ideal location is provided here for the GBC to associate with other ISKCON

devotees by engaging in the five principal limbs of bhakti together

Whereas by performing devotional activities together in Sri Dham Mayapur, we shall create a universal

impact. It was none other than Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakur who said that, “. . . just by the performance of

Navadvipa Mandala Parikrama the world can be liberated”

Whereas the mood and action of the current leaders will send a message to future generations of leaders

Whereas the Mayapur Festival is an opportunity to foster love, trust, and friendship. The family that prays

together, stays together

Whereas a source of frustration for some devotees is to travel to Mayapur and not be able to associate with

the leaders, due to our leaders being too busy during the GBC meetings, and their rapid departure from

Mayapur after the meetings

Whereas if the Mayapur Festival is not well attended by our leaders, this will be a big loss for our society

RESOLVED:

9

That the GBC Body makes the following statement:

“The GBC Body is committed to a healthy and wholesome Mayapur Festival. To achieve this end, we

commit to supporting this festival through our personal participation, as well as encouraging our fellow

Vaisnavas to participate.”

GBC Resolution 306.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

306.02 · Mayapur Festival declaration: Section B — SGGS involvement (2020)

Action order

Whereas apart from the GBC members, other leaders of our society's participation in the Mayapur Festival

will have a great impact

RESOLVED:

That the GBC Body hereby requests the organizers of the SGGS to bring the following item onto their

coming agenda for 2021:

"Mayapur Festival: Maximizing participation of GBCs, Srila Prabhupada's Disciples, Gurus, and Sannyasis."

GBC Resolution 306.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2021

301.03 · Code of ethical behavior (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas Srila Prabhupada wished his followers to exhibit exemplary ethical behavior;

Whereas the GBC Body seeks to encourage ISKCON devotees in such behavior;

Whereas since 1975 the GBC has created meaningful ethical guidelines;

Whereas there is a need of consolidating these guidelines into a concise document,

RESOLVED:

That the ISKCON GBC accepts the Code of Ethical Behaviour and the guidelines contained therein as a

living document that gives guidance to devotees and provide resources to leaders and managers who are

called upon to deal with issues regarding ethical behaviour.

GBC Resolution 301.03 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on August 16, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

301.04 · Reinstatement of Keshava Swami (2021)

[Statement]

ISKCON

RESOLVED:

Keshava Swami is hereby reinstated as an ISKCON sannyasi in good standing. His preaching and service

area is limited to Latin America. He may be invited by local leaders to speak at their temples in India.

GBC Resolution 301.04 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on October 20, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

301.05 · Excommunication of Raya Nitai dasa aka Ryan DePue from ISKCON (2021)

[Statement]

ISKCON

worldwide — 2021

Whereas Raya Nitai dasa promotes Nazism, homophobia, racism, white supremacy and misogyny on various websites, Facebook pages and published materials.

Whereas Raya Nitai claims that Srila Prabhupada promoted the above in his teachings.

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Whereas Raya Nitai's offensive materials misrepresent Srila Prabhupada, misrepresents ISKCON to the public and offends devotees with his rhetoric.

Whereas Raya Nitai has been told by the North American Council to stop misrepresenting ISKCON and

Srila Prabhupada but refuses to do so. He claims he is not ISKCON and is truly representing Srila Prabhupada's teachings.

Whereas many devotees are offended and upset by his actions and are demanding that the GBC make a strong statement to protect ISKCON's reputation and the integrity of Srila Prabhupada and his teachings.

RESOLVED:

Raya Nitai dasa has been excommunicated as a member of ISKCON and is not representing ISKCON or

Srila Prabhupada with his offensive propaganda. ISKCON does not support Nazism, white supremacy or racism by its practices or teachings

[Footnotes to resolution]

North American Council has communicated with Raya Nitai dasa, demanded that he stop misrepresenting

ISKCON and Srila Prabhupada and effectively banned him from visiting temples or attending any ISKCON

events. He continues his damaging activities and in fact has escalated in his on-line forums.

A GBC Body resolution will reinforce the restrictions (world-wide ban from visiting any ISKCON centre or attending any ISKCON event).

A GBC resolution will create a public statement that can be used in counter negative publicity and devotee complaints about his activities.

GBC Resolution 301.05 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on April 7, 2021)

ADDED • 2021

301.06 • GBC decision concerning Ananda Caitanya dasa's appeal (2021)

[Administrative order]

Whereas Ananda Caitanya dasa (BCAIS) and the lady with whom he had a relationship confessed that,

while he was a sannyasi, they engaged in illicit sex on a number of occasions;

Whereas Ananda Caitanya dasa, on numerous occasions, even during interviews in a formal investigation

into his actions, lied concerning the allegations of his deviations as a sannyasi;

Whereas Ananda Caitanya dasa committed numerous offenses against those conducting the investigation

into his actions;

Whereas Ananda Caitanya dasa violated the terms of his probation as given in GBC resolution (301.6 of 2020)

RESOLVED:

Two committees will be formed to monitor Ananda Caitanya dasa.

The first committee, an International committee, will be comprised of Bhakti Vijnana Goswami, Bhakti

Caitanya Swami, Caitanya Candra Carana dasa, and Acyutatma dasa. This Committee will monitor Ananda

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Caitanya dasa's general behavior and his adherence to the GBC's decision and restrictions resulting from his deviations.

The second committee, a Local committee, will be comprised of the Lithuanian national leadership headed

by Dhruvananda dasa. This committee will monitor Ananda Caitanya dasa's services and adherence to the GBC resolution in Lithuania.

Ananda Caitanya dasa will remain in Lithuania under the supervision of the local leadership for a period of

two years effective from the date of this resolution. Under their guidance and supervision, he will be

encouraged to serve in whatever capacity they see as appropriate. In Lithuania, during the next two years

effective from the date of this resolution, Ananda Caitanya dasa will not be permitted to give classes,

neither in person nor online nor lead kirtans in any ISKCON temple, ISKCON centre, and/or ISKCON

related organisations and/or congregations in Lithuania.

Ananda Caitanya dasa will be encouraged to serve senior devotees around the world in some non-public

setting, such as translating their lectures off-line.

The Lithuanian leadership will give a semi-annual report and recommendations concerning Ananda

Caitanya dasa to the International committee.

After two years, effective from the date of this resolution, the International and Local committees will decide

on which restrictions in Lithuania, which include, but are not limited to, preaching and leading kirtans will

continued to be imposed on Ananda Caitanya dasa.

It is suggested that the local authorities consider obtaining professional counseling to help Ananda Caitanya dasa.

GBC Resolution 301.06 of 2020, which dealt with the possible future reinstatement of Ananda Caitanya

dasa as an ISKCON sannyasi, is hereby rescinded.

Outside of Lithuania, Ananda Caitanya dasa, for an indefinite period of time, effective from the date of this

resolution, is not allowed to give classes, lead kirtans, either in person and/or online, or take any leadership

position in any ISKCON temple, ISKCON centre, and/or ISKCON related organisations and/or congregations worldwide.

The international committee can, after a period of 3 years, effective from the date of this resolution, submit

a request to the GBC that resolution be modified or rescinded.

When wearing dhoti and kurta Ananda Caitanya dasa must not dress in saffron.

Any violations by Ananda Caitanya dasa of any or all of the above restrictions will result in further

disciplinary measures being imposed upon him.

GBC Resolution 301.06 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on April 2, 2021)

303.03 • Eco-theology and Three Tiers of Eco-Guidelines (2021)

[Guideline]

temples

Whereas Srila Prabhupada's Sixth Purpose for ISKCON is to teach a "simpler more natural way of life;"

Whereas the ISKCON Environmental Initiative (IEI) has produced a document "The Eco-theology of Our

Tradition" delineating the importance of environmental awareness and appropriate behaviors for Gaudiya

Vaishnavas and the followers of Srila Prabhupada;

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Whereas ISKCON communities both urban or rural should be exemplary in upholding the principles of

sattvic lifestyles in all areas, including in their vision, teaching, and management;

Whereas ISKCON communities lack specific guidelines for practical steps to undertake regarding respect

and care for the natural environment;

Whereas the ISKCON Global Duty Officer for the Environment, the ISKCON Environmental Initiative (IEI),

and ISKCON Communications Ministry have developed appropriate guidelines in three tiers, or levels of

application, for temple communities and members;

Whereas such guidelines have been reviewed and endorsed by leading members and managers of ISKCON who are concerned and knowledgeable in these issues;

Whereas care of the earth is an essential issue facing society-at-large, and there is a significant role for

ISKCON to play in demonstrating care for Lord Krishna's creation;

Whereas ISKCON communities, members, and the world in general will benefit from the GBC endorsing

such guidelines and encouraging their application within ISKCON.

RESOLVED:

The document "Three Tiers of Environmental Practices" as presented by the ISKCON Environmental

Initiative, the ISKCON Global Duty Officer of the Environment, and the ISKCON Communications Ministry,

and with the endorsement of other global ISKCON leaders and scholars, is hereby adopted as an Official

Guideline for all ISKCON Temples and Communities. The GBC strongly encourages all ISKCON temples,

communities, and projects, and wherever possible individual devotees, to apply the principles and guidelines in their daily lives and practices. (It is understood that these guidelines may be updated, every 3-

5 years, at the discretion of the GDO of the Environment, the ISKCON Communications Ministry, and the ISKCON Environmental Initiative.)

Furthermore, the document “Eco-theology of Our Tradition” is recognized by the GBC as providing valuable insights on the Gaudiya Vaishnava philosophy regarding the need for ISKCON devotees and leaders to strive to live in harmony with the natural environment, and to respect the natural world as the property and energy of the Supreme Lord.

[Footnotes to resolution]

Recognizing the document “Eco-theology of Our Tradition” carries no cost.

Adopting the Three Tiers of Environmental Practices as Guidelines may have some initial costs, but will have a positive short and long term economic impact on local communities.

1. Most Tier One guidelines, such as composting and recycling, will incur no costs. Some guidelines, such as minimizing waste of food and energy will immediately save money. Some items, such as stopping the use of environmentally harmful garden products and only using biodegradable plates, cups, and flatware may incur initial costs but are likely to inspire donors to cover those costs.
2. Some Tier Two guidelines will immediately save money, such as growing more food in temple gardens. Other items, such as purchasing energy efficient machines and automobiles, will require upfront costs that will be recovered over time, and save money in the long run.

GBC Resolution 303.03 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on April 10, 2021)

ADDED • 2022

301.05 • Status of Anirdesya Vapu dasa (formerly known as Bhaktividya Purna (2022)

[Governing law]

ISKCON

Swami) — 2022

Whereas an October 28 2022 CPO decision determined that Anirdesya Vapu dasa, previously known as

Bhaktividya Purna Swami, had engaged in the sexual abuse, sexual harassment, and psychological abuse of a child

Whereas it was also confirmed that he had engaged in sexual acts with at least one adult woman over an extended period of time

Whereas a further investigation by the Guru Services Committee has confirmed the same

Whereas such behaviors are in gross violation of Vaisnava codes of conduct, especially for someone who

is trusted to give spiritual guidance as a leader and a guru. They go against the very principles of care for

the vulnerable which should guide our every action and thought

Whereas in February 2007 Anirdesya Vapu dasa was restricted from accepting disciples via GBC Resolution 312/B which was based upon a CPO decision from September 2000

Whereas it has been established that Anirdesya Vapu dasa violated that prohibition and initiated devotees after that date

Whereas based on the 2022 CPO decision, and the new information about the extent of Anirdesya Vapu

dasa's abuses that it revealed, and his other violations, the GBC Guru Services Committee has determined

that Anirdesya Vapu dasa is unqualified to serve as either a diksa-guru or siksa-guru (initiating disciples, or offering spiritual instruction)

Whereas the GBC Sannyasa Committee has suspended Anirdesya Vapu dasa's sannyasa status, and that

is likely to be made permanent in the near future.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC affirms that Anirdesya Vapu dasa is, for the duration of his life prohibited from:

Accepting disciples in ISKCON; and

Serving as a siksa-guru in ISKCON; and

Giving any form of spiritual guidance or instruction, including leading or contributing to any classes,

meetings, or seminars of any kind, at any ISKCON temple, or affiliated program, festival, venue, or

online forum.

Furthermore, regarding those devotees who accepted initiation from Anirdesya Vapu dasa:

If such an initiation was before February 2007, those devotees are advised to seek spiritual guidance from senior devotees in ISKCON and to continue serving within ISKCON as they have been doing. They continue to be initiated devotees in ISKCON, in the line of Srila Prabhupada, with

the full privileges and responsibilities thereof. Yet, if any of those devotees chooses to seek reinitiation from a guru in good standing in ISKCON, either now or in the future, they are welcomed

and encouraged to do so. In such a circumstance, devotees should seek further guidance from their local ISKCON authorities and GBC.

If such an initiation occurred after February 2007, the date that Anirdesya Vapu dasa was prohibited from initiating, those devotees are strongly advised to seek initiation from an ISKCON guru in good standing, as their current initiation status has no standing in ISKCON.

The GBC EC will reach out to ISKCON devotees worldwide, and especially those impacted by Anirdesya

Vapu dasa's abuse and other actions to share this information and to offer them appropriate spiritual support.

GBC Resolution 301.05 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on December 14, 2022)

ADDED • 2022

301.06 • GBC Decision regarding Lokanath Swami (2022)

[Statement]

Whereas in 1990 a devotee invited Lokanath Swami to stay with his family for several days while recovering from a serious injury. The host also “requested Lokanath Swami to train and impart Indian culture to his youngest daughter, who was eleven and a half years old at the time” (the “minor”)

Whereas the minor alleged to ISKCON’s Governing Body Commission (“GBC Body” or “GBC”) three years

later that Lokanath Swami had touched her inappropriately during his stay in the minor’s home

Whereas the GBC took these allegations seriously and immediately launched an investigation, which

included reaching out to the minor and her family. The investigation also included a review by independent

mental health experts. The GBC also imposed certain restrictions on Lokanath Swami

Whereas the minor (then an adult) raised the issue again in 2010, 20 years after the original event(s). The

GBC then reopened the matter and imposed additional restrictions on Lokanath Swami

Whereas there was recently discussion about reopening the Lokanath Swami matter for a third time

Whereas the GBC appointed a Review Panel whose work resulted in the Review Panel Report of the

Lokanath Swami Matter (“the Report”)

Whereas the GBC found the Review Panel’s in-depth and professional Report to be helpful and insightful

Whereas the Review Panel members, unanimously agreed that:

The allegations concerning Lokanath Swami had been fully investigated in both 1993 and again in

2010-2011

These investigations were adequately documented

Lokanath Swami substantially complied with the restrictions imposed on him

The Lokanath Swami matter be referred back to the GBC to act on the Review Panel’s recommendations

Whereas the GBC has adopted the resolution “GBC non-intervention in the functioning of its deputed

agencies — 2022”, requiring that henceforth any plausible claim of abuse or misconduct be directly referred

to the appropriate ISKCON agency rather than to the GBC Body

Based on ISKCON’s ecclesiastical principles and practices as well as the Report,

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC Body endorses the Review Panel’s recommendation that the Lokanath Swami matter, already

twice adjudicated, not be reopened for further proceedings as no new relevant facts pertaining to this matter have come to light, as of the date hereof.

The GBC Body reaffirms its existing policy that an ISKCON Regional Governing Body (“RGB”) or similar body has the right to restrict any devotee from visiting and preaching in their region(s), such as has already been done in North America.

Lokanath Swami shall not initiate disciples, in person or virtually, in any region or area where he has not been welcomed by the relevant RGB or similar body of area leaders. In the case of rare exceptions that may be proposed to the RGB (or similar body), the GBC Executive Committee (“EC”) will assist in reaching an agreeable outcome.

This present Resolution is based on and limited to the facts described herein.

GBC Resolution 301.06 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on July 20, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

305.01 · Improving the Review Process of Editorial Revisions Undertaken by (2022)

[Statement]

(BBT)

the BBT — 2022

Whereas an Editorial Review Panel (ERP) was set up by the BBT, in conjunction with the GBC, in 2019 for

the purpose of reviewing the editorial revisions made by the BBT editors

Whereas a part of the resolution states that “If there is a dispute between the ERP and the BBT Editorial

Board, or for that matter among ERP members themselves about a specific revision, the Global BBT

Trustees/Directors will be the final arbiter.”

Whereas the BBT, although responsible, feels that input from the GBC is essential in making any determination about disputes as described, and has requested a set of protocols to deal with this situation.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Upon the recommendation of the BBT-GBC Relations Committee the following process is adopted by the

GBC Body:

Including, but not limited to, final decisions on the few cases (five cases in the Introduction and 1st

Chapter of Bhagavad-gita) where the ERP and the BBT Editorial Board cannot come to a consensus, that a committee comprising three qualified BBT members and three qualified GBC members be formed to be the final arbiter in the case of any dispute between the ERP and the BBT Editorial Board. The three qualified BBT members will be chosen by the BBT Trustees, and the three qualified GBC members will be chosen by the GBC body. Once those six members are chosen, at their first meeting they will discuss and agree on a seventh member and all decisions will

require five of the seven members to vote in favor for it to be ratified.

Footnote:

The GBC have chosen Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Prahladananda Swami and Tapan Misra dasa as their

three members to serve on this committee.

GBC Resolution 305.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on March 30, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

305.05 · Statement of appreciation of the Bhaktivedanta Research Center (2022)

[Vote of thanks]

Center

Whereas proper preservation of the rare precious writings including manuscripts, journals and books of our

previous acaryas such as the personal library collection of HDG Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura and HDG Srila

Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura Prabhupada hosted at the Bhaktivedanta Research Center (BRC) is

critical and hence all decisions about their preservation need to be under the purview of the GBC body

Whereas wider utilization of writings of previous acaryas is required and a recognition by GBC will help

spread the message amongst the devotee community in general, and amongst scholars (both from the

devotee and academic community) in particular, about the unique services provided by BRC in collecting,

preserving, researching and teaching in collaboration with reputed universities and scholars worldwide the

writings of our previous acaryas

Whereas recognition of the BRC will inspire devotees to spend more time with shastra and appreciate the

austerities the previous acaryas have undergone to preserve these literatures.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC body appreciates the work of the Bhaktivedanta Research Center as a library, research center

and academic institute serving ISKCON globally.

[Note: Additional footnotes and documentation supporting this resolution can be found here]

GBC Resolution 305.05 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on GEM on July 14, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

305.06 · Sarasvata Gaudiya Vaisnava Association (2022)

[Statement]

Association

Whereas Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura instructed his disciples to work together

Whereas to reunite the Sarasvata Gaudiya family as a primary objective, Srila Prabhupada established the

Bhaktivedanta Swami Charity Trust (BSCT) on the 5th of November 1977, comprised of ISKCON and

Gaudiya Math members

Whereas in or around 1980, the BSCT, subsequently formed the Sarasvata Gaudiya Vaishnava Association (SGVA) with the blessings of the then present god-brothers of Srila Prabhupada, such as Srila

Bhakti Pramod Puri Maharaja, Srila Bhakti Vaibhava Puri Maharaja, and others

Whereas ISKCON Sri Mayapur has consistently established cordial relations with many neighbouring

Gaudiya Maths and international leaders alike over the past fifty years or more

Whereas many of them have shown interest in becoming part of the SGVA

Whereas under the circumstances, it is prudent to formalize a legal constitution of the SGVA.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. The GBC agrees in principle to join the formally incorporated SGVA.
2. Jayapataka Swami, Bhakti Purusottama Swami and Bhadra Balarama dasa are assigned to draft a constitution for the SVGA in consultation with the various stakeholders.
3. When the constitution is ready, the GBC Body will review it.
4. After reviewing the SGVA constitution the GBC will decide on its participation/membership.
5. If the GBC decides to join the formal SGVA it will assign representatives to attend meetings.

GBC Resolution 305.06 · 2022 · Online AGM, (passed via GEM on June 19, 2022)

ADDED · 2023

301.05 · Narahari dasa's Suspension as an Initiating Guru in ISKCON (2023)

[Statement]

Whereas considering that the concerns raised by the Hawaii temple board about Narahari prabhu's activities and their opinion that he should not be allowed to resume giving initiations, and considering that

Narahari dasa continues to make aspiring disciples despite the GBC's and the North American RGB's

decision that he should not do so

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Narahari dasa's suspension as an initiating guru is continued until February 20, 2025. His suspension will

not automatically be lifted, but further considered based on his performance.

During the time of his continued suspension Narahari dasa will continue to follow all the restrictions given to

him by the North American RGB as well as any agreement he works out with the Hawaii temple board

which should include the board's clear expectations of his service, relationships and behavior. Any agreement worked out with the Hawaii board should also be sent the Guru Services Committee and the

North American RGB.

Also, during his suspension, Narahari dasa will not canvas, promise initiation or give initiation to anyone

anywhere in the world, including the aspiring disciples that he presently has. He will also inform those who

are now aspiring for initiation that he was not and is not now authorized to accept aspiring disciples.

The North American RGB and the Guru Services Committee will work together to reach any future

decisions concerning Narahari dasa's suspension.

GBC Resolution 301.05 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed October 19, 2023

ADDED · 2025

301.01 · Puspa-samadhis in ISKCON (2025)

[Governing law]

Whereas a clear resolution is required regarding the establishment of puspa-samadhis to avoid conflicting final instructions;

Whereas with the passage of time, the departure of senior Vaisnavas is becoming more prevalent, creating an urgency for a concise statement

Therefore, it is resolved that:

No puspa-samadhis will be erected for any member of ISKCON in the future, effective March 19, 2025. Any

senior Vaisnava whose followers choose to erect a samadhi may erect only one samadhi in total after

receiving the approval of the GBC Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee.

Every ISKCON guru shall include this instruction in their will.

GBC Resolution 301.01 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed March 19, 2025

ADDED · 2025

301.07 · Narahari dasa's Suspension as an Initiating Guru in ISKCON — 2024 (2025)

[Statement]

Whereas the GBC Body suspended Narahari dasa from giving initiations in 2023;

Whereas that suspension order expires on February 19, 2025;

Whereas Narahari dasa has definitely been repeatedly reminded about this suspension order;

Whereas Narahari dasa has chosen to ignore this order;

Whereas Narahari dasa's initiations have violated several ISKCON laws

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. Initiations by Narahari dasa (ACBSP) after February 20, 2020, are not recognized in ISKCON.
2. Narahari dasa's suspension as a initiating guru within ISKCON will continue indefinitely until he resolves the previously-mentioned issues to the agreement of the Guru Services Committee and the GBC Body.
3. Narahari dasa's and his "disciples'" association with any ISKCON temple will be left up to the local authorities and the local GBC.

GBC Resolution 301.07 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed July 24, 2024

302.05 • Encouraging the establishment and maintenance of ISKCON temple (2025)

[Guideline]

asramas — 2025

Whereas Srila Prabhupada established and built ISKCON upon the strength of temples with vibrant

asramas;

Whereas many if not most ISKCON temples in the West and elsewhere have minimized or closed their

asramas in the course of evolving toward congregational development;

Whereas the current need for finding qualified devotees to take leadership roles in ISKCON can be largely

met by providing asrama training and experience for more young devotees

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC encourages all ISKCON temples who currently do not have active resident asramas to deliberately and diligently establish or re-establish them according to the following best practices:

1. Though resident asramas may sometimes accommodate older devotees, in general, temples shall

provide asrama accommodation for young people newly taking up Krishna consciousness as a training ground for their future lives as devotees. At the same time, the contributions and needs of older devotees, who have dedicated years of their lives to Srila Prabhupada's movement, are deeply valued and respected. Temples may also offer facilities to support and integrate older devotees into the community. To welcome and nurture newcomers, we must provide protected asrama space for them, while also honoring and accommodating the senior devotees who have laid the foundation for this spiritual movement. This balanced approach ensures that both older and younger devotees are cared for and encouraged in their spiritual journeys.

2. Resident asrama schedules should be manageable and moderate so that students have sufficient time for a balanced life of sadhana, seva, recreation and rest.

3. Initial seva assignments may include menial tasks, but in time leaders should seek to provide asrama students in varieties of experiences including training in kirtana, instruments, public speaking and management tasks.

4. Resident asramas should have dedicated leaders who understand the sensitivity of training new students and whose only service is the well-being of new students.

5. Except in parts of the world where women's asramas are culturally unacceptable, resident asramas

should provide separate but equal facility for men and women, as per Srila Prabhupada's instruction.

6. In addition to equal asrama facility, where culturally appropriate, aspiring Vaisnavis should be given

equal opportunity and encouragement for worship, preaching and service.

7. Courses in Bhakti Sastri and the ISKCON Disciples Course should be provided for asrama students.

8. As nearly all new devotees marry, grhastha training should be part of the curriculum, even for those who are interested in pursuing renunciation.

GBC Resolution 302.05 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

307.09 · Honoring the sacred birthplace of Bhaktivinoda Thakura (2025)

[Statement]

Thakura

Whereas Birnagar is the birthplace of Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura, and it holds significant historical and spiritual importance for devotees;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada expressed his deep desire to develop Birnagar to broadcast the glories of Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura, the eminent Acarya of this Gaudiya Sampradaya, to the world;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada had a profound desire to honor Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura by developing his birthplace in Birnagar into a significant center for spiritual education and pilgrimage;

Whereas the Birnagar project is one of the most important projects for every Gaudiya Vaisnava, especially for our movement;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada requested the Bhaktivinoda Gosthi (the Managing Committee of the Birnagar Dvadasa Temple), Srila Lalita Prasada Thakura, to permit us to render this service. Unfortunately, however, he and the committee did not accept the proposal;

Whereas even after 52 years we have not been successful, as the Bhaktivinoda Gosthi still does not agree to our proposal for developing the Janma-sthana;

Whereas through the Bhaktivedanta Swami Charity Trust some renovations and construction work for the Birnagar Dvadasa Siva Mandir were carried out. The Birnagar Bhaktivinoda Gosthi is willing to accept the construction but is not ready to grant us any sevaiteiship. If they do not provide sevaiteiship, they will be unable to maintain a large temple on their property after its construction;

Whereas the Bhaktivinoda Gosthi is not ready to give us the land, either on lease or through any other arrangement as of now;

Whereas, as per the desire of Srila Prabhupada, ISKCON should establish a magnificent temple for Bhaktivinoda Thakura, along with a display of his life history, his writings, an educational center, parks and gardens, guesthouses, an asrama, and more;

Whereas ISKCON should purchase land in Birnagar next to Bhaktivinoda Thakura's birthplace and develop a memorial and temple for the great Acarya Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura;

Whereas, since this is a big project, it should be directly supported and managed by ISKCON
Therefore, it is resolved that:

To fulfill Srila Prabhupada's desire and instruction to establish a temple at the birthplace of Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura, the GBC will actively support the Birnagar Project Committee in this important initiative.

The plan includes developing a magnificent temple and other facilities envisioned by Srila Prabhupada near the birthplace on land free from lease restrictions. A 4.5-acre plot, located just 300 meters from the current temple, is available, and the committee is working on acquiring it. Simultaneously, the committee will continue efforts to negotiate with the management of the Birnagar Dvadasa Temple to secure sevaiteiship of the existing birthplace temple.

The GBC empowers the committee to raise awareness within the devotee community about the spiritual significance of this project, inspiring devotees to actively participate in its service and contribute to its successful development.

Any fundraising efforts must be approved in advance in writing by local and regional ISKCON leadership.

GBC Resolution 307.09 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2026

301.08 · Acknowledging the ISKCON Constitution Drafting Committee (2026)

[Vote of thanks]

Whereas the GBC wishes to officially acknowledge the team that diligently worked to bring the ISKCON

Constitution to completion

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC offers its gratitude and appreciation to the ISKCON Constitution Project Team—Anuttama dasa

(ACBSP), Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Devasri Radhika devi dasi (BCS), Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Pancharatna dasa (ACBSP), and Vrinda devi dasi (GKG).

The GBC also wishes to extend its gratitude and appreciation to other devotees that, at different stages and

in various degrees, have participated in the ISKCON Constitution project—Akruranath dasa (ACBSP),

Bhaktarupa dasa (ACBSP), Bhakti Gauravani Goswami (ACBSP), Bhaktimarga Swami (ACBSP), Dvarakadhisa dasa, Gopika Radhika devi dasi (JPS), Hridaya Caitanya dasa (SDG), Kaisori devi dasi

(SDG), Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS), Praghosa dasa (SDG), Parivadi dasa, Praharana devi dasi (ACBSP),

Prema Bhakti dasa (TKG), Shalagram dasa (TKG), and Sesa dasa (ACBSP).

The GBC also thanks the many other devotees who, throughout the years, offered feedback and suggestions.

GBC Resolution 301.08 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 7, 2026

ADDED • 2026

301.09 • Notice of Censure of Kamalesh Krishna dasa, Lilasuka devi dasi and (2026)

[Statement]

Daksina devi dasi —2026

Resolved that:

The GBC issues the following letter of censure:

Dear Kamalesh Krishna Prabhu,

Please accept our humble obeisances. All glories to Srila Prabhupada.

This letter records the formal censure adopted by the Governing Body Commission (GBC) in respect of yourself for non-compliance with GBC Resolution 450.03, passed on 21 February 2025.

As you are aware, the GBC approved an Enhanced Child Protection Model on 3 January 2025. Shortly thereafter, the newly established GBC Standing Committee — Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC)—formally requested the handover of website and email credentials as early as 11 January 2025, followed by additional requests for key documentation. Multiple emails were sent

inviting you to attend a meeting to facilitate a structured transition, but no agreement was received,

and the meeting never took place.

Subsequently, a Resolution 450.03 issued on 21 February 2025 required that the Minister of Justice

serve as transitional ICPO Director and specifically asked for a comprehensive handover to be conducted by you, Kamalesh Krishna dasa, as the outgoing ICPO Director by the 1st of March 2025.

The resolution referred to the handover, inter alia, the transfer of case file notes, status reports, incomplete case materials, investigator and panelist contact information, and all relevant databases and records necessary to ensure continuity of safeguarding oversight. The resolution is clear and binding.

The required comprehensive handover has, as of 9th February 2026 being the date of the issuing of this censure, not occurred.

Over the past year, the matter was addressed with you via CPOC, ISKCON's General Counsel and the GBC Executive Committee. Additionally, a GBC EC File Note was issued in June 2025. When compliance was still not forthcoming, the GBC EC issued a final letter of demand dated 24 November 2025 to you and Lilasuka devi dasi. A response was submitted by yourself on the final day of the deadline, 15 December 2025, wherein you changed your stance from not having the files/access to the files to an assertion that legal restrictions prevented transfer, a concern that had never previously been raised and that, if valid, could have been addressed at the time the handover was required.

As a result thereof an external legal opinion was sought by the GBC's General Counsel which determined that you, as the former ICPO Director acted under GBC authority as an agent of ISKCON, that the records constitute ISKCON proprietary information, and that refusal to transfer them to the GBC's authorized representative is not legally justified.

This conclusion reflects not only the legal position, but also the most basic standards of institutional

common sense and leadership accountability. Your continued withholding of these records for

almost one year has impeded the implementation of the GBC-approved child protection framework and has disrupted continuity of oversight in a safeguarding context.

Daksina devi dasi who had resigned as the UK CPO director, continued to upload case files on behalf of your defunct office and serve in the North American CPO during Lilasuka devi dasi's medical leave period, having full access to all file data. Notably, Lilasuka devi dasi and Daksina devi dasi, who were fully aware of the transference directive and had the means to facilitate it, likewise failed and/or refused to act.

These failures reveal not isolated mistakes, but a systemic lack of stewardship, supervision, and commitment to institutional continuity. This reflects a chain of defiance and accountability lapses at the highest level as compliance with duly adopted GBC resolutions is an essential obligation of service within ISKCON, while the transfer of institutional records during authorized transitions is necessary to maintain continuity, accountability, and the protection of those served.

Accordingly, the GBC formally censures:

You, Kamalesh Krishna dasa, for failure to execute the comprehensive handover mandated by Resolution 450.03 and failure to exercise basic foresight and leadership.

Lilasuka devi dasi and Daksina devi dasi, for facilitating or supporting the continued withholding of CPO files and databases, in circumstances where transference could have been facilitated by them. It is to be noted that after the November 2025 demand, Lilasuka devi dasi transferred only seven case files to ISKCON's General Counsel. These seven files relate only to open North American cases. She continues to retain possession of all remaining ISKCON Child Protection files, both hard and soft copies.

The GBC regards this non-compliance as a serious failure in the discharge of institutional responsibility and considers it a severe case of incompetence and negligence. Such conduct is inconsistent with the standards expected of those entrusted with governance and safeguarding responsibilities, and is incompatible with any role requiring trust, accountability, and prudent judgment. Given the fact that you had a fiduciary responsibility—timing, delegation, and inherited arrangements do not excuse the absence of decisive leadership at a critical transition point as delegation of tasks does not equal delegation of responsibility. Safeguarding documentations represent the core operational responsibility of the office, and securing its orderly transfer should have been an intentional, proactive act of stewardship. The situation reflects not merely an administrative oversight, but a concerning lack of foresight, ownership, and leadership judgment at the close of your mandate.

Accordingly, your conduct, particularly your non-compliance with a duly adopted GBC resolution, reflects a serious departure from the standards of cooperation and accountability expected of those entrusted with the protection of children and holding office in ISKCON. This has resulted in a loss of institutional confidence and raises serious concerns regarding suitability for future engagement in any office or position within ISKCON involving leadership, governance authority, oversight functions, institutional records, or child protection responsibilities.

On behalf of the GBC Body,

Your servants,

Govardhana Das

Tapana Misra Das

Madhu Sevita Das,

(GBC Executive Committee)

GBC Resolution 301.09 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 9, 2026

303.04 · Sale of the ISKCON Wellington property — 2025 (2026)

[Action order]

Whereas the GBC Executors Property Oversight Committee (GEPOC) recommends approving the sale of

the Wellington, NZ, temple based on use of all net sale proceeds for purchasing a new, larger, code-

compliant temple building, for the following reasons:

1. The current Wellington, NZ temple was ordered closed for public assembly unless it is renovated to

meet building codes and specifically handicap accessibility. That would entail rebuilding or adding

handicap accessible bathrooms. Currently the temple cannot be used for public worship, kirtan, classes or serving prasadam to devotees and guests.

2. If such renovations were performed, then the local authorities could apply for zoning for public assembly, etc.

3. If such renovations were to be planned, it was felt by local GBC and the temple president that the

entire building should be raised to avoid the regular flooding that occurs during heavy rains.

4. The local GBC and temple president feel that even if such costly renovation work were performed,

the temple doesn't allow for growth, or even for safe parking.

5. The local GBC and temple president have identified an alternate building in Petone (20 miles away)

which is for sale, which is code compliant with adequate parking, currently used for commercial offices. If purchased, a renovation can be performed to create a large temple room suitable for the deities and suitable to accommodate a growing devotee and life member community.

6. The temple president has raised and banked in an ISKCON account almost \$700,000 NZD for the

purchase. The sale proceeds from the current Wellington site would bring in sufficient additional funds to complete the purchase, albeit with a larger mortgage than currently exists on the Wellington temple property.

7. The current deities are relatively small Gaura Nitai deities, which can be safely moved. The ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry has stated no objection to the move, based on obtaining Hutt City

Council zoning for temple/public assembly.

Whereas based on the above reasons, GEPOC has no objection to the proposed sale for the stated purpose

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC hereby approves of the sale of the ISKCON Wellington property as presented.

GBC Resolution 303.04 · 2026 · Online General Meeting, passed June 2, 2025

ADDED · 2026

306.02 · Mayapur Review — 2025 (2026)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The GBC authorizes the GBC Executive Committee (EC) and General Counsel (GC) to oversee the

Review into Sridham Mayapur's management and to provide updates on the progress of the Review on a

quarterly basis until its completion, with the first update on or before December 2025

GBC Resolution 306.02 · 2026 · Online General Meeting, passed June 25, 2025

ADDED · 2026

307.03 · ISKCON Constitution ratified — 2025 (2026)

[Action order]

Whereas in October 2006 the GBC had resolved that one of the priorities for the future health of ISKCON

was to have a constitution.

Whereas the members of the Drafting Committee, through various drafts, have produced a version that the

GBC accepted and ratified.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The following linked document is hereby acknowledged as the official Constitution of the International

Society for Krishna Consciousness.

GBC Resolution 307.03 · 2026 · Online General Meeting, passed April 16, 2025

2 Srila Prabhupada, the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON

2.1 Definition

To fulfill the previous acarya's desire for a united worldwide preaching organization to expand Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu's mission, Srila Prabhupada founded the International Society for Krishna Consciousness as a distinct branch of the *Brahma-Madhva-Gaudiya-Vaisnava-sampradaya*. Therefore he is the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON.

His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada is the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON. This means that he is ISKCON's link with the *Brahma-Madhva-Gaudiya sampradaya*, that his writings, oral teachings, and exemplary actions remain the permanent and irreplaceable basis for all subsequent teachings and activities of ISKCON. He is and will remain always the instructing spiritual master of all devotees in ISKCON. (Law Revision committee 9.6.90)

2.2 Principles

2.2.1 The Significance of Srila Prabhupada to ISKCON

1. Srila Prabhupada is the foundational *siksa-guru* for all ISKCON devotees because he has realized and presented the teachings of the previous *acaryas* of the *Brahma-Madhva-Gaudiya-sampradaya* appropriately for the modern age.
2. Srila Prabhupada's instructions are the essential teachings for every ISKCON devotee.
3. Srila Prabhupada's books are the embodiment of his teachings and should be accepted as the standard by all future generations of ISKCON.
4. Srila Prabhupada should be worshipped daily by every ISKCON member.
5. Every ISKCON spiritual master is responsible to guide his disciples to follow Srila Prabhupada's instructions.
6. As Founder-Acarya, Srila Prabhupada gave directions for management, principles of cooperation, and other practical guidelines which form the basis and inspiration for ISKCON's policies.
7. Srila Prabhupada established the Governing Body Commission to execute his will, following the order of the previous *acaryas*.(94)

2.2.2 Recognition of Srila Prabhupada's Position as the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON

The position of Srila Prabhupada as Founder-Acarya shall be recognized in ISKCON through the use of the titles "Founder-Acarya," "Founder," and "Prabhupada," and through the establishment of shrines in places of Srila Prabhupada's pastimes, memorials and plaques to his memory.

2.3 Regulations

2.3.1 Use of Title

1. The titles "Founder-Acarya," "Founder," and "Prabhupada" can be used only in reference to His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada. Srila Prabhupada's full name shall be displayed along with his titles "Founder-Acarya" and "Prabhupada" on all printed materials, signs, letterheads, and in connection with all ISKCON projects.(83)

2. The title "Prabhupada" should be included on all printed materials, signs, etc. and only be used for Srila Prabhupada.(83)

3. All ISKCON publications such as books, magazines, newsletters, leaflets, fliers, invitations, etc., should clearly display the full name and titles of Srila Prabhupada including Founder-Acarya, Prabhupada, and His Divine Grace, for example:

"His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada,

Founder-Acarya of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness".(96)

2.3.2 Shrines and Memorials

1. Places of Srila Prabhupada's pastimes shall be maintained as permanent shrines, and his paraphernalia shall be collected and preserved in memorials to him.

2. The responsibility for maintaining the worship of Srila Prabhupada shall be borne by ISKCON as a whole and distributed among the temples and initiated devotees of the Society.

3. There shall be a committee named "The Bhaktivedanta Swami Memorial Committee" whose members are appointed by the GBC. It will determine where and how Srila Prabhupada's rooms and paraphernalia shall be preserved.

Srila Prabhupada's rooms in the following places shall be maintained as permanent shrines in remembrance of his pastimes:

1. Vrndavana-dhama
2. Mayapur-dhama
3. Bombay
4. Los Angeles
5. Honolulu
6. Atlanta
7. Detroit

Srila Prabhupada's original grass hut (*Bhajana Kutira*) at Sri Mayapur shall be a Bhaktivedanta Swami memorial shrine.(81)

The *Sannyasa* Ministry and the Vrndavana Temple Management shall take joint responsibility for maintaining the worship in Srila Prabhupada's rooms at Radha-Damodara temple.(90)

2.3.2.1 Samadhi Mandirs at Sri Vrndavana-dhama and Sri Mayapur-dhama

ISKCON shall establish and perpetually maintain worship of Srila Prabhupada in his Samadhi Mandir at Sri Vrndavana-dhama and his Puspa-Samadhi Mandir at Sri Mayapur-dhama.

Temples or zones shall pledge to maintain the worship of Srila Prabhupada's Samadhi in Vrndavana according to the established system.

ADDED · 2026

100.05 · Bhaktivedanta Manor recognized as a Shrine and Memorial — 2025 (2026)

[Statement]

Whereas the ISKCON Law Book presently states:

100.2 Shrines and Memorials

1. Places of Srila Prabhupada's pastimes shall be maintained as permanent shrines, and his paraphernalia shall be collected and preserved in memorials to him.
2. The responsibility for maintaining the worship of Srila Prabhupada shall be borne by ISKCON as a whole and distributed among the temples and initiated devotees of the Society.
3. There shall be a committee named The Bhaktivedanta Swami Memorial Committee whose members are appointed by the GBC. It will determine where and how Srila Prabhupada's rooms and paraphernalia shall be preserved. Srila Prabhupada's rooms in the following places shall be maintained as permanent shrines in remembrance of his pastimes:

- Vrndavana-dhama
- Mayapura-dhama
- Bombay
- Los Angeles
- Honolulu
- Atlanta
- Detroit
- New Vrindaban

4. Srila Prabhupada's original grass hut (bhajana kutira) at Sri Mayapura shall be a Bhaktivedanta Swami memorial shrine. (1981) etc.

Whereas Srila Prabhupada was personally involved in the purchase of Bhaktivedanta Manor by George Harrison, spent quality time there from 1973 to 1977, met and conversed with many devotees and prominent people in his rooms there (conversations later published by the BBT in small books like the "Journey of Self Discovery"), and indeed made the Manor his last destination outside India.

Whereas Srila Prabhupada mentions Bhaktivedanta Manor in many letters and conversations, thus placing emphasis on the project.

Whereas Srila Prabhupada was highly pleased with Bhaktivedanta Manor and made it the European headquarters for ISKCON.

Whereas Srila Prabhupada's rooms at Bhaktivedanta Manor are one of the few remaining places that Srila Prabhupada personally resided for a considerable length of time.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Srila Prabhupada's Bhaktivedanta Manor, Watford, UK, be given official recognition as a Shrine and Memorial and included in the ISKCON Law Book 100.2 Shrines and Memorials.

GBC Resolution 100.05 · 2026 · Correspondence Vote, passed May 29, 2025

2.3.3 Plaques

1. All ISKCON temples and prominent buildings which do not already have Srila Prabhupada's name inscribed upon them, shall install plaques stating Srila Prabhupada's full name and his position as the Founder-Acarya of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness.
 2. This shall also apply to prominent buildings of the Bhaktivedanta Book Trust, Bhaktivedanta Institute and any other society founded by Srila Prabhupada or affiliated to ISKCON.
 3. The Ministry of Communications shall give a standard format and wording for these plaques upon request.
- (95)

ADDED · 2021

100.03 · Celebration of Srila Prabhupada's 125th Anniversary Vyasa Puja (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Srila Prabhupada is the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON,
and his teachings and example are the guide and inspiration for the entire International Society for Krishna Consciousness;

Whereas celebration of his appearance in this world is an annual event of great significance for all ISKCON devotees throughout the world;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada's Vyasa Puja Day 2021 marks the 125th year of his appearance in this world;
and

Whereas special advance events leading up to the celebration of his 2021 Vyasa Puja Anniversary were limited due to the impact of the global covid pandemic.

RESOLVED:

That, the Governing Body Commission requests all ISKCON regions, temples, and communities to highlight

and celebrate Srila Prabhupada's 125th Appearance Anniversary throughout the upcoming year, including Prabhupada's Vyasa Puja Day 2021 and ending with Vyasa Puja Day 2022.

The GBC is particularly grateful for the ideas, themes and programs generated by the Prabhupada 125th Anniversary Committee in India.

The GBC recommends that devotees around the world utilize the ideas the Committee has generated, including the official 125th Anniversary logo, as well as any other ideas and programs that may be locally initiated, to celebrate this historic year in a humble mood of gratitude and service to His Divine Grace.

GBC Resolution 100.03 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on August 18, 2021)

3 Governing Body Commission

3.1 GBC Body

3.1.1 Definition

1. The Governing Body Commission (GBC) is the ultimate managing authority of the entire International Society for Krishna Consciousness.
2. The GBC has been established by His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada to represent him in carrying out the responsibility of managing the International Society for Krishna Consciousness ISKCON of which he is the Founder-Acarya and supreme authority.

3.1.2 Principles

The GBC accepts as its life and soul, the divine instructions of His Divine Grace Srila Prabhupada and recognizes that it is completely dependent on his mercy in all respects. The GBC has no other function or purpose other than to execute the instructions so kindly given by His Divine Grace and to preserve and spread his teachings to the world in their pure form.

3.1.3 Powers

1. The GBC, as a collective body has been authorized by His Divine Grace Srila Prabhupada to make all necessary arrangements for carrying out the responsibilities of management, including but not limited to delegating authority, managing resources, setting objectives, making plans, calling for reports, evaluating results, training others, maintaining spiritual standards and defining the sphere of influence and responsibilities of the various GBC members as well as other devotees.(75)
2. The GBC may, either directly or through a deputed representative, request a report from any ISKCON member, who shall be duty-bound to cooperate with this request.(81)
3. The GBC Body may authorize one of its Commissioners to go to any GBC member to get a report from him on his activities. The GBC member must then co-operate and provide the GBC Body with his report. If a GBC member whose behavior is in question does not co-operate, the GBC Body must immediately be informed.(75)

3.1.4 Duties

3.1.4.1 Appointment of Ministers

A Minister is appointed by the GBC Body for each Statement of Mission. His prime duties are to become expert in his field and to act as a professor by establishing the curriculum of his discipline and disseminating this knowledge throughout ISKCON.

3.1.4.2 Establishing Standards of Conduct

The GBC Body is responsible for establishing the proper standards of conduct for its members and others to whom it delegates authority. If an individual to whom the GBC Body has delegated authority fails to perform his mandated duties or acts in a manner contrary to ISKCON Law or principle, then the GBC Body is responsible to correct or remove the deviant. If it is demonstrated that the GBC Body did not function in a timely manner to rectify one of its representatives, and as a result, an individual ISKCON temple or project suffers inordinately, then the GBC Body is to consider how to help the local temple or project overcome its difficulties, but the GBC Body cannot be held liable in any way.(93)

3.1.4.3 GBC Annual Donations and Pledges

For the efficient functioning of the GBC Executive Committee and GBC Communications Office, the GBC shall assess what donation amount is proportionally appropriate to meet the annual expenses of the GBC. It is necessary that contributions are promptly given. Those temples which give delayed contributions create an additional burden which they should compensate for, by giving an additional donation equivalent to the rate between 10 to 20 percent per annum for temples that do not contribute within the 30th June due date. In addition, the GBC Body reaffirms its previous resolution that if any pledged amounts remain unpaid by the beginning of the subsequent year's GBC meeting, the responsible GBC member shall be subject to censure by the GBC Body at that meeting.

3.1.4.4 Trademarks

1. The GBC Body is the ultimate authority all over the world for controlling the use of the names "ISKCON", "International Society For Krishna Consciousness", "Hare Krsna Movement" and other names related to the ISKCON Movement. It shall obtain legal authority to withdraw the right to use such names, under appropriate circumstances.(82)
2. The GBC Body is the full and final authority to rescind the right to use or operate the above mentioned names, and anyone using ISKCON names without permission shall be legally stopped from doing so.(82)

3.1.4.5 GBC Press

A publishing house shall be created under the auspices of the ISKCON GBC Body to print books produced by the ISKCON Monitors which are of interest to the management and functioning of ISKCON. This publishing house shall be called ISKCON GBC Press. Its main work will be to print books produced by the GBC Monitors, Ministers, individual GBC members, and special committees, books which are accepted by the GBC Body as useful information for the Society thereby distributing and expanding the knowledge of their various fields. The ISKCON GBC Press will be situated in Sridhama Mayapur, and will be managed under the GBC Body.

The emphasis will be on producing the titles inexpensively to make them accessible to the temples and devotees.

All books published by the GBC Press shall contain front matter clearly setting forth the authority the work holds for ISKCON, including standards and practices normative for all devotees or temples, philosophical positions answering pertinent questions for ISKCON members, useful guidelines, Ministerial and other practical training material and other categories of authority and obligations for implementation.

The Executive Committee of the GBC Body shall assign each proposed work to a Ksetra Committee or other GBC subcommittee to establish a system of conducting a final review, editing and approval of the proposed works. This committee shall also write the required front matter mentioned above.(92)

3.1.4.6 Other Regulations

1. Committees may be formed from time to time by the GBC Body as needed for certain purposes and may be disbanded by the GBC Body.(75)
2. At its annual meeting, the GBC Body shall approve goals and objectives for its Zonal Secretaries and Ministers to be accomplished during the upcoming year.(86)
3. The GBC Body shall divide the world into geographic zones, each being assigned to one or more "Zonal Secretaries" such territory, regardless of whether there is an ISKCON center there, falls into a zone.
4. Before changing a GBC Member's zone, the GBC Body must first consult with the local leaders in the zone concerned.(86) The procedures given in the GBC Rules of Order are to be followed for changing a GBC member's zone.

5. The GBC Body shall publish philosophical position papers on important topics which require clarification and direction from the GBC Body.(84)

6. A central file shall be kept on all of Srila Prabhupada's initiated devotees for purposes of public relations and for reclaiming devotees who have fallen into *maya* and for engaging devotees in Srila Prabhupada's devotional service. Other disciple records shall be centrally maintained on a zonal basis.

7. Any ISKCON Ministry, organization, individual, or project (including those legally independent of ISKCON) receiving funding from ISKCON or the BBT, including mandatory assessments, taxes, and so forth, from temples and/or zones, is required to provide financial reports clearly delineating assets, liabilities, expenditures, and income. Such reports are to be submitted to the GBC Body through its Corresponding Secretary at least forty-five days prior to the beginning of the Annual Meeting, and shall be distributed to all GBC members and made available to other concerned ISKCON officials upon request. The Corresponding Secretary shall compile a list of ISKCON Ministries, organizations, individuals, or projects to whom this Law applies, and annually notify them of their report deadline at least 60 days in advance. Anyone submitting a request to the GBC Body or ISKCON for funding should, along with their appeal, include their budget and previous financial reports for information. (90)

3.1.4.6 Global Duties & Responsibilities of the Governing Body Commission (GBC)

(duplicate number in the 2018 source)

3.1.4.6 “Global Duties & Responsibilities of the Governing Body Commission (GBC)” is a document detailing the entirety of GBC Duties and responsibilities.

3.1.5 ISKCON Mission Statements

3.1.5.1 Delineation and Publishing of Statements of Mission

The GBC shall delineate and publish ISKCON's Statements of Mission (Statements of Aims), supporting objectives, progressive goals and vital tasks as defined below:

3.1.5.1.1 Statement of Mission (ISKCON Statement of Aim)

A Statement of Mission is the ultimate goal or long-range mission of ISKCON for a specific primary area of devotional service. Statements of Mission are established and modified by the GBC Body. All members of ISKCON and leaders shall cooperate together and work to systematically achieve ISKCON's Statements of Mission.

3.1.5.1.2 Supporting Objective

In order to realize the broad Statement of Mission there are essential, integral and supporting objectives that must first be achieved. These are called the "Supporting Objectives". They are by definition more specific and detailed than the Statement of Mission. They deal with a sub-topic within a Statement of Mission. Supporting Objectives for ISKCON worldwide are established and modified by the GBC Body and by lower levels of administration for their respective areas of responsibility following the worldwide supporting objectives, but not limited to them.

3.1.5.1.3 Progressive Goals

In order to work towards progressively realizing ISKCON's Statements of Mission and Supporting Objectives, each zone (or temple) will adopt intermediary stages or goals called Progressive Goals. Unlike both Mission Statements and Supporting Objectives, Progressive Goals are time-bound, quantitative, specific, and localized. The respective authorities for each level of administration within a zone should establish and update their own Progressive Goals based on their areas of responsibility. As a general principle, one-year and five-year goals shall be set. The GBC Body for the world, and a Continental Committee for a continent, may also adopt Progressive Goals if practical.(92)

3.1.5.1.4 Vital Tasks

In order to achieve a Progressive Goal, there may be many lesser tasks that need to be achieved. These are very specific and limited in nature and are the lowest definable stage towards achieving the Statement of Mission. The respective administrative authorities shall assign tasks for the areas and leaders.

3.1.5.2 Zonal Secretary and Statements of Mission

A Zonal Secretary's duties in relation to Statements of Mission are to motivate and organize his zone's progress in each Statement of Mission area. He is also to present that progress in an Annual Report for each Statement of Mission. He is to identify one-year and five-year Progressive Goals for his zone and temples in consultation and cooperation with his Zonal Council, Regional Secretaries, and Temple Presidents, and submit the same to the respective Ministers.

3.1.5.2.1 Regional Secretary and Statements of Mission

A Regional Secretary's duties in relation to Statements of Mission shall be to assist the Zonal Secretary to motivate and organize the region's progress in each Statement of Mission area.

3.1.5.2.2 Temple President and Statements of Mission

A Temple President's duties in relation to Statements of Mission shall be to be directly responsible to realize the Statement of Mission and Progressive Goals in his temple. He is to motivate the devotees and organize his temple's progress in each Statement of Mission area. He is also to present the progress in an Annual Report for each Statement of Mission for his temple to his Zonal Secretary.

Temple Presidents shall submit annual reports to the Global Secretariat and to each GBC Member (Zonal Secretary and/or Minister) with the following information:

1. The details requested for each temple.
2. Summary of the zonal progress in relation to the specific Statement of Mission.
3. Proposals related to the Statement of Mission.
4. New or revised continental, zonal or local Progressive Goals for the Statement of Mission; including information on the progress achieved for each Statement of Mission/Aim.

The Corresponding Secretary, in conjunction with the concerned Minister, shall standardize the report forms or information so as to facilitate data entry and data reporting of annual progress of the entire ISKCON Movement. The Corresponding Secretary shall be responsible to see that informative progress reports from available data are generated by computer as far as practical.

The Temple Presidents are responsible to see that local Goshala managers send quarterly reports to the Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture. The local GBC Deputee/Deputies shall validate these reports by either personally visiting, or appointing an accountable and reliable representative to do so. (2001)

ADDED · 2022

201.02 · GBC non-intervention in the functioning of its deputed agencies (2022)

[Statement]

Whereas the GBC Body (GBC) has created various ISKCON agencies, offices and committees to which it has delegated authority to deal with abuse of minors, leadership sexual misconduct and other transgressions involving ISKCON sannyasis, gurus, leaders and members. As of the date hereof, these agencies, offices and committees are the ISKCON Child Protection Office (ICPO), the Prevention of Leadership Misconduct Office (PLMO), the ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry and the Guru Services Committee

Whereas a few of these agencies, offices and committees, such as the ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry and the Guru Services Committee contain, within their guidelines, provisions by which the GBC may be called to act as a decision-making or appellate adjudicatory body

Whereas the GBC recognizes the necessity for these agencies, offices and committees to function without the intervention of the GBC, except in instances where the Guidelines of these agencies, offices and committees provide otherwise.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Henceforth, all allegations of conduct risking or resulting in the physical or emotional harm, sexual abuse or

exploitation of a minor shall be directly and automatically referred to the ICPO; all allegations of a sexual act or behavior by an ISKCON leader with adults, or other misconduct, which are in violation of the standard of behavior for ISKCON leaders as contained in ISKCON Law as well as the Code of Ethical Behavior, directly and automatically to the PLMO; all allegations of misconduct by an ISKCON sannyasi, directly and automatically to the ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry and all allegations of misconduct by an ISKCON guru, directly and automatically to the ISKCON Guru Services Committee. Where any allegation

of misconduct falls under the jurisdiction of multiple ISKCON agencies, offices and committees, there shall

be concurrent jurisdiction of each.

Except for appointing the CPO and PLMO Directors and approving CPO and PLMO Guideline and policy objectives, the GBC Body shall refrain from intervening in the work of the various ISKCON agencies, offices

and committees described herein.

GBC Resolution 201.02 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on July 20, 2022)

3.2 Executive Committee of the GBC Body

3.2.1 Definitions

The GBC Executive Committee consists of the annually elected officers: Chairman, two Vice-Chairmen, and Secretary.

3.2.2 Duties

3.2.2.1 Executive Committee

1. With the Chairman of the GBC and the other Executive Committee members relieved of overseeing any specific area of the world, they can concentrate on global issues.

2. Every year, to meet in Mayapur and, reviewing previous reports, divide the practical workload amongst themselves for a more even distribution. This could include: correspondence, forwarding matters to appropriate persons, personally going to resolve problems which could not be resolved otherwise, follow-up, overseeing the implementation of resolutions, functioning of GBC Office, etc.
3. At the end of the year, to make a review of the previous year's workload and make suggestions for handling the work better, propose new amendments to the system, etc.
4. The yearly index of GBC resolutions and suggestions be published in proper booklet form and distributed yearly to the Society as soon as possible by the annual Secretary.(79)
5. A booklet of the ISKCON Constitution and the "Laws of ISKCON" shall be printed, with amendments added, yearly, at Sri Mayapur BBT, under the GBC Parliamentarians' supervision, and that funds shall be allotted for this. Each GBC and Temple President shall get one copy, extras for a fee.(80)
6. If an ISKCON member hears rumors of fall downs of a senior devotee like a GBC or sannyasi, rather than spread it further, he is to write to the GBC Chairman who, as one of his duties shall provide information.(77)
7. The Executive Committee shall mediate between GBC ministers and zonal secretaries if there is any conflict of interest in executing GBC directions.(86)
8. The Executive Committee is responsible to make sure that the resolutions passed by the GBC Body are carried out by ISKCON members during the year.

In addition the Chairman of the Executive Committee shall keep a written log or record of the actions the Executive Committee and its agents take during its year of office. This shall be handed over to the new Executive Committee at an explanatory briefing session so the new officers are up to date with their immediate service requirements.(96)

Delegation to Executive Committee of Power to suspend or Expel: (1999)

Whenever it deems necessary, the GBC Body may, by a two-thirds (2/3) vote, delegate to the Executive committee for a determined period of time, the power to suspend or expel from ISKCON, specifically named members, without convening a further meeting of the entire GBC Body.

GBC Body empowers the Executive Committee to re-constitute the GBC Deputies' Body on a regional basis and engage a recognized Body of Deputies in research and the work of restructuring the GBC's operations.

The GBC Body directs the GBC Executive Committee to engage its office in organizing and working with the GBC Deputies for the purposes of improving communications, record keeping and administration in ISKCON.

The GBC Body empowers the GBC Executive Committee to approve GBC Deputies. Replacing the function of the GBC Deputy Nomination Committee described in ISKCON Law 9.4.10

[Note : Law 9.4.10 is not in the existing Law Book.]

14. To have a deputy approved, the Executive Committee shall consult with a local GBC member who can verify the qualifications of the deputy candidate.

GBC Executive Committee Term of Office: (1999)

The term for the GBC Executive Committee shall be one year.

3.2.2.2 Executive Committee Continental Representatives

Every Continental Committee will select one GBC member from the continent to serve as "GBC Executive Committee Continental Representative" for the year, commencing from Gaura-purnima. For areas that do not have Continental Committees, the GBC Members from the area will meet at Mayapur and select a Continental Representative for the year.

These Representatives will be chosen for

1. North America
2. South America
3. Europe-CIS-North Africa-West Africa
4. India-Middle East-East Africa-South Africa, and
5. The Pacific Rim.

In addition, a *sannyasi* will be assigned to each area to assist.

1. To directly receive notifications of all problems referred to the Executive Committee from within his continent.
2. To send to the Chairman of the GBC a regular report every three months on all significant issues which were brought to his attention from within his area.
3. To ensure that the normal procedures for resolving a problem have been attempted (going through the Temple President, Zonal Secretary, etc.) or are not applicable.
4. To consult with the GBC Chairman and/or Executive Committee if any issue occurs that he feels he cannot or should not deal with by himself.
5. To serve as a voting member of the Executive Committee on any issues concerning only his area, and to be consulted before any decision affecting his area is taken.
6. To engage the assigned *sannyasi* and/or Candidates for GBC assigned to his continent for the year in assisting him in resolving emergencies as required.

Issues that can be passed on by the Executive Committee Continental Representative are:

- a. Those that have global consequences or consequences reaching beyond his continent;
- b. Is an emergencies on the level that he cannot comfortably deal with;
- c. Issues that intimately deal with a GBC member or ISKCON *Guru*;
- d. Issues that deal with the workings of the GBC Body.

3.2.2.3 GBC Chairman

The Chairman should himself not directly oversee any area of the world, other than his designated area of GBC responsibilities. He should work with his Executive Committee and the Executive Committee Continental Representative in the following ways:

1. Delegate appropriate issues arising from a continent to the concerned Continental Representative. Delegate issues related to a Ministry to the appropriate Minister to reply.
2. Receive, coordinate, and correspond about the regular reports sent to him by his Executive Officers and Continental Representatives, and other correspondence to the GBC Chairman.
3. Consult with a Continental Representative on any issue concerning the continent or as the Continental Representative feels necessary, and to take their vote and input on issues concerning their continent which are being considered by the Executive Committee.
4. Accept and deal with all issues passed up to him from the Continental Chairmen.
5. Follow up, after the initial notification by the past GBC Chairman, on all previously passed GBC resolutions.

6. Directly deal with issues of global consequence, or delegate to another member of the Executive Committee.
7. To discuss with other members of the Executive Committee on major issues of greater consequence, and get their help and input for resolving the problem.
8. Establish practical procedures to ensure that before matters are brought up to the Executive Committee the applicants have gone through the normal avenues for redressing the problems, to forward improperly submitted matters to appropriate persons, and to propose legislation in this regard as necessary.
9. To directly deal with emergencies requiring immediate attention due to their urgency. These shall be discussed with the Executive Committee as appropriate.
10. From time to time see that the other elected members of the Executive Committee are updated about the global issues which have surfaced and important continental issues.
11. To delegate an elected member of the Executive Committee (Vice-Chairman or Secretary) to deal with a problem which cannot be resolved by a Continental Chairman or *sannyasi* and cannot wait until the annual GBC meeting.
12. To coordinate *sannyasis* to resolve problems as required.(93)

ADDED · 2019

202.3 · GBC EC Service Description Research (2019)

[Action order]

(Proposed by the GBC EC)

A committee consisting of the Executive Secretariat, Devakinandan Das (General Counsel), and Radha Krsna Das, is hereby formed to deal with the service description of the GBC Executive Committee, with the possible timeline for the 2019 Midterm General Meeting, or latest by the 2020 Annual General Meeting.

GBC Resolution 202.3 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

3.3 GBC Standing Committees

3.3.1 Definition

A Standing Committee is a Sub-committee created by the GBC Body which continues to exist until absolved. A Standing Committee can function as part of the GBC meetings as well as outside of GBC meetings during the year. Some Standing Committees are called Ksetra Committees (see Ksetra Committee Section for details), while other Standing Committees have delegated authority in a specific assigned area.

3.3.2 Powers

Standing committees have specific powers and responsibilities assigned by the GBC. These include the power:

1. to make decisions and recommendations on matters referred to it in a prescribed manner or directly by the GBC.
2. to act on behalf of the GBC in some area(s).

3.3.3 Duties

1. To submit a written report to the GBC before the annual GBC meeting at Mayapur.(79)
2. To fulfill the Duties as prescribed for a Standing Committee under the GBC Rules of Order (See GBC Rules of Order for further information).

3.3.4 Individual Standing Committees

3.3.4.1 Ksetra Committees

3.3.4.1.1 Definition

1. The GBC has Standing Committees, known as Ksetra Committees which are comprised of the Ministers of the committee's topics, assigned GBC Members, and any other qualified devotees as the GBC deems necessary. The committees shall have a permanent chairman and permanent members.
2. The following Statements of Mission / ISKCON Statements of Aims are accepted (91-95):

Ksetra Committee 1: Essential Preaching

1. Book Publication and Distribution

To publish and distribute the books and periodicals of Srila Prabhupada and his followers in all languages and distribute them in ever-increasing numbers and with ever-increasing effectiveness, so that an ever-growing collection of Krsna conscious literature is enshrined in every household in the world.

2. Public Chanting and Festivals

To celebrate the congregational chanting of the holy name of Krsna by regularly organizing public chanting and joyous festivals in every city, town and village of the world.

3. Congregational Development

To bring to all homes in the world the continuing association of devotees and the regular practice of devotional activities.

4. Restaurants

To establish Krsna-prasadam restaurants in every city and town and make them famous all over the world so that millions eat in them every day.

5. Food for Life

To establish massive free prasadam distribution programs all over the world so that all human beings are adequately fed and nourished with Krsna-prasadam, reducing hunger as far as possible.

6. Prasadam Distribution

Ksetra Committee 2: Specialized Preaching

1. Vedic Science

To convince all people of the world of the errors of materialistic science and philosophies and to research, elucidate and teach God-centered science, based on bona fide Vedic knowledge.

2. Padayatra

To bring the congregational chanting of the Holy Name to every town and village of the world through organized Padayatra festivals.

3. Cultural Programs

To reveal Vedic culture as the universal and essential culture of all the world's peoples, and to supplant all mundane productions of literature, drama, music, and art with Krsna conscious alternatives.

4. Youth Preaching

5. College Preaching

Ksetra Committee 3: Education and Spiritual Development

1. Gurukula

To provide children with a life-long devotional foundation and to progressively train them according to their natural propensities in occupational duties of devotional service to Krsna.

2. Spiritual Standards

To establish and maintain in ISKCON and its members the high standards of Krsna conscious understanding and practices taught by Srila Prabhupada.

3. Adult Education

To convince receptive people all over the world to commit themselves to rendering devotional service, as taught by Srila Prabhupada, under the direction of a bona fide spiritual master.

4. Training New Recruits

To teach new devotees, through proper Vaisnava association and instruction, the philosophy and basic devotional practices of Krsna Consciousness.

Ksetra Committee 4: Essential ISKCON Infrastructure for Preaching

1. Finance and Accounting

To ensure that every ISKCON organization and program meets standards of excellence in handling fiscal matters.

2. Fund Raising

To establish systems and programs of fund-raising throughout the world to provide ISKCON with adequate funds to realize its goals.

3. Management and Administration

To ensure that the leadership of ISKCON is characterized by devotion to guru and Krsna, spiritual purity, compassion, integrity, commitment, consistency, competency, accountability, and to ensure that the devotees and assets of ISKCON are appropriately engaged, protected and increased.

4. Communications

To win respect for and trust in the ISKCON in all nations and among all people of the world.

Ksetra Committee 5: Holy Places and Communities

1. Deity Worship

To attract all peoples of the world to the personal service of the Lord, to engage them as devotees in that service, and train them in the principles and techniques of that service.

2. Mayapur and Vrndavana

To develop and maintain, for devotees and society, Mayapur and Vrndavana and other such holy places dedicated to the pastimes of Lord Krsna and His devotees.

3. Spiritual Communities

4. Daiva-varnasrama Development

5. Cow-Protection

6. Self-sufficiency

To reform the economic and social structure of all communities in the world by demonstrating the God-centered culture that depends on the land and the cows.

7. Temples as places of pilgrimage [tirthas]

Ksetra Committee 6: International ISKCON

1. Justice Systems
2. Legal Affairs
3. Unity of ISKCON
4. Zonal Affairs
5. Constitutional Issues

3.3.4.1.2 Regulations

1. To submit a written report to the GBC before the annual GBC meeting at Mayapur.(79)
2. To fulfill the duties as prescribed for a Standing Committee under the GBC Rules of Order (See GBC Rules of Order for further information).

3.3.4.2 Other Standing Committees

3.3.4.2.1 The Philosophical Committee

1. The Philosophical Committee is a resource available to ISKCON members.
2. Individual devotees and ISKCON entities (e.g., the GBC Body, Continental Committees, or International Temple Presidents) may approach the Philosophical Committee for the settlement of disputes on philosophical matters that arise within ISKCON. The Philosophical Committee will examine the issues and their implications, clarify what the areas of conflict are, and determine what is at stake. The Committee may then propose resolutions to the GBC Body. However, if the Philosophical Committee finds that a dispute simply concerns questions of correct practical application of philosophy, it will refer the matter to the local GBC secretary. ISKCON leaders may also request the Philosophical Committee to review publications which are perceived to be questionable.(96)
3. In addition (to its appointed members), the International GBC Chairman shall be an ex-officio member of the committee and serve as its Chairman.

3.3.4.2.2 Bhaktivedanta Memorial Committee

A Bhaktivedanta Memorial Committee shall determine where and how Prabhupada's rooms and paraphernalia shall be preserved.(78)

3.3.4.2.3 Executors Committee

Executors Committee shall see that Srila Prabhupada's will is being carried out.(78)

3.3.4.2.4 Sannyasa Committee

A standing GBC sub-committee established to deal with sannyasa matters.(96)

3.3.4.2.5 Interfaith Commission

An officially GBC-appointed Interfaith Commission with the specific purpose to present officially authorized ISKCON representatives for interreligious dialogue. These official representatives are authorized to speak on behalf of the ultimate managing authority, the GBC. This commission encourages the devotees in their taking initiative to speak on behalf of ISKCON in less official capacities.

This commission will be empowered to act as ISKCON's official voice and representation to the heads of all world religions and is empowered to engage other devotees in this service. Before publishing or issuing any major position statements, the commission will obtain the approval of the GBC Executive Officers.

The Commission will have different functions. It will act as a consultant for those who meet heads of religions; its members and their representatives will meet heads of religions; its members will appoint, assign and authorize official ISKCON representatives. Before a ISKCON representative is made official, the committee must to vote and approve him or her by majority vote. After each meeting with a major faith or its representative, the ISKCON representative will send a report to each member of the commission. These reports will be kept carefully by the commission. At the end of the year, the commission will make an official report to the GBC Body of its activity throughout the year. Among themselves, the committee members will decide how they will administrate their various functions throughout the year. If they are in doubt at any point about their decision-making, they will consult with the GBC Executive Committee officers for guidance.

The specific purpose of this commission is to present officially authorized ISKCON members to speak on behalf of the entire organization. This is our internal system for that.

Ritvik Committee (2000)

In order to protect the interests of ISKCON, the GBC Body hereby establishes the Ritvik Committee as a permanent standing committee. This committee can also appoint others at their discretion and is to include one International GBC Body member who does not have zonal responsibilities in India. The purpose of this committee is to address and make decisions regarding Ritvik related lawsuits to protect the interests of ISKCON.

3.3.4.2.6 Others

Other Standing Committees are:

1. ISKCON Board of Examinations (see Adult Education)
2. ISKCON Board of Education (see Primary and Secondary Education)
3. Sri Mayapur Vrndavana Festival Committee (see International Projects)
4. Sri Mayapur Project Development Committee (see Sri Mayapur Project)
5. Justice Committee
6. Facilitators Committee
7. Child Protection Guidelines Committee
8. Funding Committee

Nominations Committee

Guru Services Committee (2000)

Amendment 2002

3.4 GBC Geographic Area Committees

3.4.1 GBC Continental Committees

3.4.1.1 Definition

An "ISKCON Regional Governing Body" ("RGB") is a formally constituted body that performs certain managerial functions on behalf of the GBC Body for conduct of the affairs of the ISKCON society within a clearly designated contiguous geographical area, called a "Region," consisting of either a single country or a group of contiguous countries.

3.4.1.2 Duties

If the GBC Body delegates a particular function to a Regional Governing Body, then any decision of the RGB within the scope of that function is binding within the Region as if the decision had been made by the full GBC Body, but it may be overruled by majority vote of the GBC Body.

There are minimum delegated functions as well as optional delegated functions:

3.4.1.2.1 Minimum Delegated Functions:

The functions that are delegated to an RGB by the GBC Body shall include, as a minimum, the following:

1. To serve as a forum for increasing coordination of the overall preaching strategy in the Region.
2. To serve as a forum for increasing the coordination of the implementation of GBC policies, guidelines and resolutions applicable within the Region.
3. Subdivision of the Region into Divisions for the purpose of organizing Divisional Councils as described below, in consultation with all Zonal Secretaries actively functioning in the Region.
4. Making recommendations to the GBC Body, where appropriate, for GBC legislation.
5. Making recommendations to any Zonal Secretary or other ISKCON official functioning within the Region on matters concerning the affairs of the Region.
6. Appointment of Regional Ministers, Committees, etc., as it deems necessary for the conduct of its delegated functions.
7. Resolution of any conflicts within the Region that are beyond the scope of any Divisional Councils constituted within the Region. This includes handling of complaints on Regional matters referred to it by the GBC Body, the Divisional Councils, any ISKCON official or body, or from individuals.
8. Where necessary and appropriate, undertaking disciplinary action against ISKCON officials and/or other devotees serving within the Region, as allowed under ISKCON law for such a body.

3.4.1.2.2 Optional Delegated Functions

If the GBC Body so chooses it may also delegate additional functions to a particular Regional Governing Body.

3.4.1.3 Regulations

An RGB for a particular Region may be created by simple majority vote of the GBC Body, but the effect of such a resolution will be pending the completion of certain formalities as specified below, and eventual notification by the GBC Secretary. Similarly, RGB's may have their geographic areas modified, and they also may be dissolved, by simple majority vote of the GBC Body.

In considering a proposal for creation of an RGB, the GBC Body shall consider the following criteria:

- a. Are the needs of the region in question sufficiently uniform as to make amalgamation into a single region appropriate?
- b. Is the existing leadership within the region sufficiently mature to be able to assume such a delegation of responsibilities?
- c. Does the region have a track record of cooperative management, such as through the proper functioning of a Continental Committee or other informal body as described below?

Note: Bodies known as "National Councils" or "National Governing Bodies" which are managing ISKCON's affairs in a single country may be designated by the GBC Body as RGB's, or if they are not so designated then they may be Divisional Councils or informal bodies as defined in the following sections.

3.4.1.4 Approval of Rules and Regulations:

In order to be recognized as a Regional Governing Body under this law, the regional leaders must submit to the GBC Secretary the proposed Rules and Regulations for how the affairs of the RGB will be conducted. These Rules and Regulations must include, as a minimum, information on:

- a. How membership in the RGB is determined, and that there is allowance for a sufficient number of GBC Members functioning within the area to be members.
- b. How meetings are convened and conducted.
- c. Rules for the election of officers and their duties.
- d. The rights and responsibilities of the members.
- e. Procedures for reporting to the GBC Body on its actual membership and proceedings.
- f. Procedures for maintaining a record of the official proceedings of the RGB.
- g. Procedures for changing the Rules and Regulations by minimum 2/3 vote.

The GBC Secretary may also from time to time promulgate additional standards for what is to be included in the Rules and Regulations, as directed by the Executive Committee.

When the GBC Secretary is satisfied that the Rules and Regulations for the conduct of the affairs of the RGB are well formed then he or she shall issue notification to such effect and the RGB shall be considered created.

Any changes that the RGB proposes to make to its Rules and Regulations shall be submitted to the GBC Secretary for approval before they take effect.

In the functioning of an RGB, if any dispute arises among the members as to whether the Rules and Regulations are being properly followed, the GBC Secretary shall make a final determination.

Update 2010:

That all Regional Governing Bodies (RGBs), Continental Committees, and Divisional and National Councils provisionally accept and function on the principle that whenever the majority of GBC members present in their respective meetings are not in favor of a proposed resolution, the said resolution will go for more discussion until the majority of GBC members present are in agreement.

3.4.1.5 RGB Special Duties

3.4.1.5.1 Reporting Duties

All ISKCON Regional Governing Bodies, as well as Continental Committees and Divisional and National Councils where there are no RGBs, have the duty to send to the Corresponding Secretary of the GBC, at the latest one month after being passed, a copy of any resolutions they pass at their regular or extraordinary

meetings. If the resolutions are not in English, an accurate English translation should be sent. The Corresponding Secretary will evaluate those resolutions for the purpose of identifying those items that may conflict with ISKCON law.

Update 2010:

1. All ISKCON Regional Bodies (RGBs) shall establish a Regional or Continental Office of Communications. They shall appoint a Director and provide reasonable funding and facilities for the execution of that service. The appointment of Regional Director of Communications shall be made in consultation with the ISKCON Minister of Communications, and that Director shall report to both the RGB and the Minister of Communications.
2. Regional Bodies, Continental Committees, and Divisional and National Councils shall also give priority to the establishment of National Offices of Communications, with appointed National Directors and reasonable funding and facilities, for each country within that region where ISKCON has a significant presence. National Directors shall report to the National or Divisional Council of their country and to the Regional Communications Director where they exist. They should report to the Minister where the Regional Communications Director does not exist.
3. In those countries where ISKCON has multiple temples or communities, the National Bodies shall encourage and facilitate the establishment at each major temple of a Temple Communications Office with a local Communications Representative and reasonable funding and facilities. The local Communications Representative shall report to the Temple President and the National Communications Director.
4. The Minister of Communications shall assist with training and strategic coordination among Regional Directors, National and Divisional Directors and Temple Representatives of Communications to ensure expertise and progress in ISKCON communications efforts.

3.4.2 GBC Divisional Councils

3.4.2.1 Definitions

In addition to Regional Governing Bodies, which have functions clearly delegated by the GBC Body, there may continue to exist in certain regions, as required, informally constituted bodies with the function of expanding cooperative management within a geographical area. They may be called Continental Committees or other names as appropriate. They may function to resolve issues of importance to the region on a cooperative or advisory basis, to give vision and prepare strategies for advancing the objectives of Krishna consciousness, and/or to make recommendations and proposals to the GBC Body. Decisions of such Continental Committees or other such bodies should be followed in a cooperative spirit. However, for the Continental Committee's resolutions to be obligatory they must either be ratified by the GBC Annual General Meeting at Mayapur or have been specifically previously empowered in that regard by the GBC Body.

3.4.3 ISKCON Divisional Councils

3.4.3.1 Definition

An ISKCON Divisional Council is a body that performs certain managerial functions on behalf of an individual Zonal Secretary, on behalf of a group of Zonal Secretaries serving in the same general area or on behalf of a Regional Governing Body for conduct of the affairs of the ISKCON society within a clearly designated contiguous geographical area, called a "Division." The geographical area in question could be a group of small countries, a single country or a section of a single country, but it should be small enough such that all temple leaders within the area would be generally familiar with ISKCON's activities throughout the geographical area, and such that the members would be able to meet together several times per year.

3.4.3.2 Formation of Divisional Councils

Wherever there are functioning Regional Governing Bodies, these Bodies shall designate the Divisions for formation of the Divisional Councils within the Region, in consultation with the Zonal Secretaries actively functioning within the Region.

Where there is no functioning RGB, the appointed GBC Zonal Secretaries may designate specific areas as Divisions and may form Divisional Councils for these Divisions. Such designation must be done in writing, addressed to the GBC Secretary and signed by all GBC Zonal Secretaries assigned to the area in question. The GBC Secretary shall acknowledge such designations. If no such written designation has been made then any bodies constituted shall be considered as informal bodies as described under Section 3.4.2.

3.4.3.3 Divisional Council Membership

A Divisional Council shall be constituted of all Temple Presidents, all Preaching Center managers, all Regional Secretaries and all Zonal Secretaries (that wish to attend) within the region as well as resident sannyasis or other leading devotees as the council desires or as the local Zonal Secretaries recommend.

3.4.3.4 Divisional Council Functions

1. Serve as a forum for coordination of the overall preaching strategy in the Division.
2. Serve as a forum for coordination of the implementation of GBC policies, guidelines and resolutions applicable within the Division.
3. Serve as a forum for resolution of any conflicts within the Division. This includes handling of complaints on local matters referred to it by the GBC Body, the RGB, any ISKCON official or body or from individuals.
4. Making recommendations to the RGB, where appropriate, for RGB or GBC legislation.
5. Making recommendations to any Zonal Secretary or other ISKCON official functioning within the Division on matters concerning local affairs.
6. Where necessary and appropriate, undertaking disciplinary action against ISKCON officials and/or other devotees serving within the Division, as allowed under ISKCON law for such a body.

A Divisional Council may also perform other functions within the Division as specifically assigned to it by a Zonal Secretary, the RGB or the GBC Body, such as approving the opening or closing of ISKCON centers, appointing Temple officers, taking final decisions on matters of dispute, deciding on territorial matters among the various temples, making recommendations on sannyasa candidates, formally considering the nomination of candidates who reside within their area of responsibility for serving as new initiating gurus, checking into the management of the local ISKCON centers, overseeing spiritual standards, etc.

[ACTION ORDER] It is further resolved, That India is hereby approved as a Region as per the above law. GBC Members serving in India shall submit proposed Rules and Regulations for an RGB for India as per Section 3.4.1.4.

3.5 GBC Members

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

3.5.1 Definition

The expression “GBC member” exclusively indicates the full (voting) GBC members, the Acting GBCs and the Assistant GBCs; they are supported and aided by the GBC Emeriti, the GBC Candidates, the GBC Standing Committees, the Global Ministries, the Executive Secretariat, the Divisional Directors, the GBC Deputies and by any other office, committee or individual as required and approved from time to time by the GBC

3.5.2 Principles

1. A GBC Member shall practically accept as one's life and soul the mission, purpose, special projects, and will of Srila Prabhupada and accept the GBC, which is Srila Prabhupada's representative. (81)
2. The individual members of the GBC Body do not have any inherent authority but rather derive their authority from the Governing Body Commission itself and ultimately from His Divine Grace Srila Prabhupada. Their authority may be over a particular geographic area or over a particular function. Whichever area of responsibility be given to the various members, their primary responsibility is to the Society as a whole. Therefore a GBC member should not consider himself as the whole GBC, but as a member or commissioner, commissioned by the whole Governing Board.(75)
3. A GBC Member shall represent the GBC by performing the assignments allotted in accordance with GBC policy.(81)

3.5.3 Standards

3.5.3.1 Standard for Sadhana and Spiritual Practices

That a GBC Member must be an exemplary practicing devotee who follows daily *sadhana* and full morning program, demonstrably chants sixteen rounds, follows strictly the four regulative principles, regularly gives classes, and participates in temple festivals and *harinama* parties.(92)

A GBC Member must live in or near a Krsna conscious temple community so as to regularly, on a daily basis, participate in devotional activities and associate with devotees.(92)

3.5.3.2 Standard of Personal Behavior and Character

A GBC should be exemplary in all respects in his behavior and character.(92)

1. A GBC member be an "acarya" by teaching by personal example the path of Krsna consciousness in its purity.(81)
2. No GBC can knowingly or unknowingly permit his men or himself to engage in illicit, illegal activities.(78)
3. GBC members should not speak in a derogatory way of other GBC members in public.(86)

3.5.3.3 Disqualifications

No devotee who has remarried after having divorced a devotee-spouse shall serve as a member of the GBC.

Exempt from this law are devotees who become divorced against their desire by the action of their spouses, or as a consequence of their spouses' becoming committed non-devotees.

Provisionally exempt are devotees who became divorced prior to the effective date of this resolution, March 2, 1990.

3.5.4 General Duties

1. A GBC member must accept and carry out diligently and responsibly all GBC duties, including those specifically assigned.

2. No GBC member shall engage in illegal activities or allow those under his direction to do so, except under conditions where Krsna consciousness itself is locally considered an illegal activity.(78)

3.5.4.1 In Relation to the GBC Body

1. To participate in the annual GBC meeting at Sridhama Mayapur before Gaura-purnima.(81)
2. To maintain at all times the confidentiality, integrity, and sanctity of the GBC proceedings and policy.(81)
3. To serve as an officer of the GBC and as a member of the GBC Committees and to participate in GBC *istagosthis*, special meetings, etc., when duly called upon.(81)
4. To offer one's realized viewpoint to the assembly of the GBC.(81)
5. Every GBC member should support the decisions of the GBC Body. He is free to express his opinion after first clearly presenting the will of GBC Body.(86)
6. GBC member shouldn't indulge with non-GBC men in criticizing the GBC Body.

Every GBC member shall be required to submit annual reports in time to the GBC Body. A report shall be submitted in accordance with the format prescribed by the Corresponding Secretary and the Executive Committee. A member failing to submit an annual report in a timely manner shall be subject to censure by the GBC Body. Members should insure that their annual reports are submitted in time, even though they may possess an excused absence or tardiness for the annual meeting.(90)

3.5.4.2 In Relation to International Projects

If an aspect of the Sri Mayapur Development Project or any other International Project be assigned the individual GBC representative, he shall adopt those particular assignments as his personal responsibilities, no less than if they were an extension of his Zone or Ministry.

The constitution of the GBC includes, in defining the duties of the GBC members, their obligation to support Srila Prabhupada's International Priority Projects such as Sridhama Mayapur etc.(80)

3.5.4.3 In Relation to Other GBC Zonal Secretaries

No GBC member should enter into the zone of another GBC member on the plea of protecting or helping someone within that zone, without the approval of local GBC.(86)

3.5.5 Categories of GBC Members

3.5.5.1 GBC Zonal Secretaries

3.5.5.1.1 Definition

A Zonal Secretary is a member of the GBC Body appointed by the GBC Body to oversee ISKCON Temples and other ISKCON projects in a specific geographical area designated as a "zone". A Zonal Secretary has overall responsibility for the management and administration of the zone.

3.5.5.1.2 Powers

1. The GBC Zonal Secretary, whether initiating or not, is the ultimate managerial authority within his zone, as the official representative of the GBC Body.
2. A GBC member can go to a center in his zone and inspect the accounts and if any unauthorized expenditures are being made he may take appropriate action to correct it.(75)
3. The GBC recognizes that as per Srila Prabhupada's instructions, GBC men may have even "thousands of secretaries"; individual GBC men may see the need for appointing assistants who will have greater responsibility than Temple Presidents, and who may be known as Regional Secretaries, etc.(79)

3.5.5.1.3 Duties

3.5.5.1.3.1 Sadhana and Temple Programs

All GBC Zonal Secretaries are responsible to see that all devotees in their zones attend the morning and evening programs, except when they have an alternative bona fide preaching engagement in the evening.(77)

3.5.5.1.3.2 Book Distribution and Preaching

1. GBC Zonal Secretaries and all Temple Presidents shall ensure that their respective zones and temples will distribute books on *sankirtana* on a regular basis, making a sincere attempt to implement Srila Prabhupada's formula that fifty percent (50%) of our income be used for book distribution and fifty percent (50%) be used for the temple expenses. The Temple Presidents should give a minimum of twenty five percent (25 %) of income for book distribution.

2. To inspire the leaders and help to organize college preaching programs and other forms of congregational preaching and to involve the Temple Presidents and devotees in that preaching work.

3. To go out in the preaching field in each of his temples to insure proper preaching techniques are being utilized.(77)

3.5.5.1.3.3 Congregational Preaching

1. Each GBC Zonal Secretary shall allocate the responsibility for preaching to the congregation in the different geographic areas of his zone to temples or Congregational Preaching Directorates to insure maximum effectiveness in congregational preaching and development.

2. If a *nama-hatta* center upgrades to become an ISKCON temple or otherwise a temple is established in a Congregational Preaching Directorate area, then naturally the Zonal Secretary will make new arrangements to re-allocate the respective geographic responsibilities for preaching to the congregation in the affected areas. (93)

For those geographic areas which fall beyond the capacity or desire of ISKCON temples to supervise, promote, and expand the congregational preaching, the local GBC Zonal Secretary(s) and the Zonal Council (if any) can appoint a responsible devotee in good standing to be a "Director" of a "Congregational Preaching Directorate" or "Branch" of ISKCON who can lead a team of preachers to systematically cultivate, preach to, and expand the congregational preaching in a specified area.

3. To oversee that every temple maintains a program of sending a monthly letter from a devotee to his parents, if his parents are at least approachable.(77)

3.5.5.1.3.4 Recovering "Blooped" Devotees

1. Each GBC member is responsible to try to recover the devotees living in his zone who are not fully active in devotional service.(94)

2. Each GBC member shall maintain a master record of the devotees in his zone.

3.5.5.1.3.5 Oath of Loyalty by Temple Presidents

To administer and insure that their Temple Presidents sign and take the oaths as requested by Srila Prabhupada. (77)

3.5.5.1.3.6 Cooperation with the Local Leader in Preaching

To take permission from the local GBC Zonal Secretary or Temple President of another zone before sending a traveling party into their area.(77)

3.5.5.1.3.7 In Relation to Temple Presidents

To collect from each Temple President in his zone, if any, their monthly report, and verify that it contains an itemized account of income and expenditure, the preaching highlights including the number of books sold, and inventory of books.(75)

3.5.5.1.3.8 In Relation to Initiating Gurus

To submit a form annually to the Executive Committee indicating briefly the status of all approved ISKCON gurus normally residing, regularly preaching, or initiating in his zone. (The Executive Committee will assign each *guru* to a GBC member(s) for monitoring.) If any approved *guru* has: (a) taken reinitiation/shelter of a non-ISKCON *guru* or institution, (b) rejected ISKCON or Srila Prabhupada; or, (c) undergone a change of service, of *asrama*, or of living situation, which the local GBC member feels threatens to hamper the approved *guru's* ability to give guidance to or set a proper standard of conduct for disciples, then the GBC member's report shall, if possible, include a written statement from the approved *Guru* as to his intentions in regard to his disciples and his devotional service. If not possible, then it shall at least include a description of the approved *Guru's* intentions as best they can be discerned through the investigation of the GBC member. The report shall also contain any other information which would be of value to the GBC Body in determining the *guru's* status, as well as the recommendations of the local Temple Presidents, zonal councils, etc. The Executive Committee shall review the reports and take any necessary action.

3.5.5.1.3.9 Child Protection Concerns

Persons, who after an ISKCON investigation, are confirmed to be guilty of child abuse must report their status to the local Temple President upon their arrival in an ISKCON community. Also, it is the obligation of a Temple President to determine for every member joining his community, if the newcomer is a confirmed child abuser. The Temple President is then obliged to notify the local householders and GBC of the offender's presence.

The local GBC should be advised if a Temple President knowingly arranges for a confirmed child abuser to be supported by a temple, or live on temple property without first notifying the householder community as per ISKCON laws. The local GBC is to supervise the situation to be sure the Temple President follows the following GBC guidelines:

1. "In no case should a confirmed perpetrator remain in the local community unless the local ISKCON authorities obtain the written authorization of no less than three-quarter of the parents of children at the project or in the community.
2. The local government authorities and/or the ISKCON Board of Education will make the final determination of the appropriate degree of segregation. (1990-119.4)"
3. Every GBC make sure the temples presidents in his zone are made aware of this resolution and GBC guidelines.

3.5.5.1.4 Guidelines for Evaluating GBC Zonal Secretary

That if a Temple President or local Temple Council thinks that an assigned GBC Zonal Secretary is not fulfilling the responsibilities of that position, he should communicate with the GBC Executive Committee.

ISKCON Administrative Regions (2001)

The GBC Secretariat, in cooperation with the GBC Zonal Secretaries and ISKCON Continental Committees shall organize "ISKCON Regions" each consisting of approximately ten to twenty geographically contiguous ISKCON branches.

Each region shall have one GBC Deputee assigned to it who resides in the region and interfaces with the GBC Secretariat on ISKCON administrative issues. This assignment implies no administrative authority for the GBC Deputee, whose sole responsibility in this role is to communicate effectively with the Regional Temple Presidents and the GBC Secretariat.

The GBC Secretariat has drafted a list of such regions summarised below. The GBC Body provisionally accepts this list, with the understanding that their exact composition may be changed at any time by consensus of the local GBC Zonal Secretaries and the GBC Secretariat or by direction of the GBC Executive Committee.

Draft summary of ISKCON Regions: Africa (two regions), Australia (two regions), India (four regions), CIS (six regions), Europe (six regions), South America (two regions), North America (four regions).

ADDED · 2019

205.2 · Identifying More GBC Areas (2019)

[Administrative order]

(Proposed and Sponsored by the GBC Organizational Development Committee)

Whereas the GBC wishes to adopt a more rational, effective approach to the deploying of its Commissioners, as indicated in the “Directional Statement” 2015 resolution;

Whereas the first step requires identifying coherent “GBC Areas” (independently from considerations on who may be assigned there at present);

Whereas such GBC Areas should be based on criteria such as geographical contiguity, size and nature of ISKCON presence, size of the local population, potential for expansion, local culture (language, religion, etc.);

Whereas, following on from the thirteen GBC areas created at the 2018 Midterm General Meeting, the below GBC Areas fulfill the above general guidelines and characteristics

Resolved:

The following territories are accepted as “GBC Areas”:

14. Japan, South Korea and North Korea.

15. China (including Hong Kong, Macau & Taiwan) and Philippines.

16. South East Asia (including Myanmar, Thailand, Malaysia, Singapore, Brunei, Vietnam, Cambodia and Laos).

17. Oceania (Australia, New Zealand, Papua New Guinea, Fiji and the rest of Oceania), Indonesia and East Timor.

The configuration of a “GBC Area” can be modified by a simple majority vote by the GBC.

GBC Resolution 205.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

205.3 · Identifying GBC Areas (2019)

[Action order]

Whereas Resolution 306 of the Midterm General Meeting 2018, Identifying GBC Areas, stated that:

“The GBC wishes to adopt a more rational, effective approach to the deploying of its Zonal Secretaries, as indicated in the ‘307: Directional statement on GBC deployment — 2016’ resolution;

“Whereas the first step requires identifying coherent “GBC Areas” (independently from considerations on who may be assigned there at present);

“Whereas such GBC Areas should be based on criteria such as geographical contiguity, size and nature of ISKCON presence, size of the local population, potential for expansion, local culture (language, religion, etc.);

“Whereas the following GBC Areas fulfill the above general guidelines and characteristics.”

Resolved:

That the following territories are accepted as “GBC Areas”:

GBC Area One:

Belarus

Russia:

Arkhangelsk Region

Belgorod Region

Bryansk Region

Chuvash Republic

Ivanovo Region

Kaliningrad Region

Kaluga Region

Karelia, Republic of

Komi Republic

Kostroma Region

Kursk Region

Leningrad Region

Lipetsk Region

Mari El Republic

Moscow

Moscow Region

Murmansk Region

Nenets Autonomous District

Nizhny Novgorod Region

Novgorod Region

Oryol Region

Pskov Region

Ryazan Region

Saint Petersburg

Smolensk Region

Tambov Region

Tatarstan, Republic of

Tula Region

Tver Region

Vladimir Region
Vologda Region
Voronezh Region
Yaroslavl Region
GBC Area Two:
Armenia
Azerbaijan
Georgia
Kirghizstan
Kazakhstan
Moldova
Russia:
Adygea, Republic of
Astrakhan Region
Bashkortostan, Republic of (south)
Chechen Republic
Crimea, Republic of[d]
Dagestan, Republic of
Ingushetia, Republic of
Kabardino-Balkar Republic
Kalmykia, Republic of
Karachay-Cherkess Republic
Krasnodar Territory
Mordovia, Republic of
North Ossetia-Alania, Republic of
Orenburg Region
Penza Region
Rostov Region
Samara Region
Saratov Region
Sevastopol
Stavropol Territory
Ulyanovsk Region
Volgograd Region
Tajikistan
Turkmenistan
Ukraine
Uzbekistan
GBC Area Three:
Russia:
Altai Territory
Altai Republic
Bashkortostan, Republic of (North)
Chelyabinsk Region
Kemerovo Region
Khanty–Mansi Autonomous District – Yugra
Kirov Region
Kurgan Region

Novosibirsk Region
Omsk Region
Perm Territory
Sverdlovsk Region
Tomsk Region
Tyumen Region
Udmurt Republic
Yamalo-Nenets Autonomous District
GBC Area Four:
Mongolia
Russia:
Amur Region
Buryatia, Republic of
Chita region (Zabaykalsky Territory)
Chukotka Autonomous District
Evenk Autonomous District
Irkutsk Region
Jewish Autonomous Region
Kamchatka Territory
Khabarovsk Territory
Khakassia, Republic of
Krasnoyarsk Territory
Magadan Region
Primorsky Territory
Sakha (Yakutia) Republic
Sakhalin Region
Taimyr Dolgano-Nenets Autonomous
Tuva Republic

The configuration of a “GBC Area” can be modified by a simple majority vote by the GBC.

GBC Resolution 205.3 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

3.5.5.2 Candidates for GBC

3.5.5.2.1 Definition

A Candidate for GBC is an official status which is preliminary to Assistant GBC. A candidate for GBC is given the opportunity to demonstrate that he does well in his assigned area for a specified length of time, in which case the GBC would consider him as Assistant GBC for that area.(92)

3.5.5.2.2 Regulations

3.5.5.2.2.1 Appointment

1. The Governing Body Commission may, at its discretion, appoint a senior ISKCON member in good standing to be a "Candidate for GBC" to fulfill a need for additional GBC presence for a specified geographical area or Ministry. Upon successful completion of the terms of appointment, the Candidate for GBC shall be considered at the plenary GBC meeting for the post of Assistant GBC.

2. Official Candidates for GBC shall be appointed by the Governing Body Commission by a simple majority vote.

3. It shall be required that a Candidate for GBC be under the supervision of a GBC member, group of members, or committee. They shall assist the Candidate for GBC as needed, and make reports on his progress and activities to the GBC Body or a committee assigned for this purpose.

3.5.5.2.3 Duties

There shall be specific duties given to the Candidate along with the appointment, which will vary according to individual circumstances, such as the following:

1. To establish permanent ISKCON centers or develop an undeveloped or underdeveloped part of the world as an active Krsna conscious missionary.
2. To reside or remain in a particular area for a minimum total period of time or time per year.
3. To dedicate himself to preaching in a particular area or field.
4. To demonstrate his abilities and capacities successfully for a specified minimum period of time.
5. To provide an annual report to the GBC in approved format.
6. To improve deficiencies in some aspects of the person's character, attitude, knowledge, abilities, skills or behavior.

3.5.5.2.4 Powers

A Candidate for GBC is empowered by the GBC Body as deemed necessary to enable him to fulfill his duties. These powers may include:

1. Acting as an official representative of the GBC Body for the assigned area.
2. Having any or all of the general powers of a Zonal Secretary or Minister, as qualified under the "Supervision" section below.
3. Other special powers for fulfilling some special assignment or service as the GBC Body may deem appropriate.
4. Attendance at GBC plenary or committee meetings.

3.5.5.2.5 GBC Supervision

It shall be required that a Candidate for GBC be under the supervision of a GBC member, group of members, or committee. They shall assist the Candidate for GBC as needed, and make reports on his progress and activities to the GBC body or a committee assigned for this purpose.

3.5.5.3 Emeritus GBC

3.5.5.3.1 Definition

The GBC Body may award the title "Emeritus GBC" to retired GBC Members who have rendered distinguished service.

3.5.5.3.2 Role

The role of an Emeritus GBC is to:

- a. make himself available to all GBC members as a storehouse of knowledge and experience,
- b. be respected in ISKCON society as were the great sages in Vedic society,
- c. when requested, act in a non-managerial role by giving advice to the GBC member or members or GBC Deputies who have taken over his GBC responsibilities,
- d. participate in GBC meetings as a non-voting member if he should so choose,

e. as a participant in GBC meetings, be afforded all privileges offered to an ordinary GBC Member.

ADDED · 2020

203.02 · GBC Emeritus (2020)

Statement

Whereas the wording of the below ISKCON Law 3.5.5.3 “Emeritus GBC” needs improvement in clarity, composition and grammar:

3.5.5.3 Emeritus GBC

3.5.5.3.1 Definition

The GBC Body may award the title “Emeritus GBC” to retired GBC Members who have rendered distinguished service.

3.5.5.3.2 Role

The role of an Emeritus GBC is to:

- a. make himself available to all GBC members as a storehouse of knowledge and experience,
- b. be respected in ISKCON society as were the great sages in Vedic society,
- c. when requested, act in a non-managerial role by giving advice to the GBC member or members or GBC Deputies who have taken over his GBC responsibilities,
- d. participate in GBC meetings as a non-voting member if he should so choose,
- e. as a participant in GBC meetings, be afforded all privileges offered to an ordinary GBC Member.

RESOLVED:

The wording of ISKCON Law 3.5.5.3 “Emeritus GBC” shall be amended and restated as follows, and the GBC Emeritus official webpage shall be reworded accordingly:

<https://gbc.iskcon.org/>

http://gbc.iskcon.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/05/Zonal_Assignments_2020.pdf

http://gbc.iskcon.org/wp-content/uploads/2020/05/Zonal_Assignments_2020.pdf

<http://gbc.iskcon.org/gbc-emeritus/>

2

“The title of GBC Emeritus may be awarded by the GBC Body to honor a retired GBC member who has rendered distinguished service to ISKCON and the GBC Body.

“Due to their extensive experience and knowledge derived from years of service, GBC Emeriti are invited to make themselves available in a non-managerial role by offering advice to the GBC Body, GBC members and GBC Deputies.

“GBC Emeriti are welcome to participate in meetings of the GBC Body and shall be afforded all privileges offered to a regular GBC Member, except the right to vote. Upon request by a GBC Emeritus, the GBC Executive Committee may approve his or her inclusion on the online GBC Conference.”

GBC Resolution 203.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

3.5.5.4 GBC Deputies

3.5.5.4.1 Definition

In order to recruit some of the best non-GBC ISKCON members into the GBC decision making process that will help make the GBC more relevant to the needs of the Society while creating valuable training opportunities for these members, there shall be "GBC Deputies" appointed from ISKCON Leaders (Temple Presidents, Regional Secretaries, etc.) to assist the GBC Body in its global management of ISKCON in addition to their normal duties.

(2000)

Further membership in this Body shall be for 3 years and may be renewed. Members must attend the Annual Mayapur GBC Meetings.

3.5.5.4.2 Duties

1. To attend the annual GBC meetings in Sridhama Mayapur,
2. To be appointed for a term of 3 years, reappointment is permitted,
3. To be assigned to the Ksetra Committees, standing or other committees and to serve as regular voting members of the same,
4. To stay in communication during the year and continue to serve as committee members,
5. To do other things as requested by the GBC Body,
6. To review the previous year's GBC meeting minutes and report to the GBC Body on what has been achieved and is still requiring action,
7. To preview and refine proposals and cast a preliminary vote to expedite GBC voting and
8. to assist the collection of data for evaluating ISKCON performance.(97-404.1)

3.5.5.4.3 Functions

The GBC Rules of Order give details on GBC Deputy functioning.

ADDED · 2020

203.03 · Ongoing support, training and accountability for new GBCs (2020)

Statement

RESOLVED:

The GBC Organizational Development Committee is mandated to submit a proposal at the Mid-term General Meeting in October 2020 delineating systems, parameters and procedures to establish ongoing support, training and accountability of new GBCs.

GBC Resolution 203.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2026

201.03 · Confidentiality and governance strengthening within the GBC— 2025 (2026)

[Statement]

Whereas the GBC deliberates on sensitive spiritual and governance matters vital to ISKCON's integrity and future.

Whereas breaches of confidentiality can undermine trust, credibility, and unity within the Movement.

Whereas modern governance best practice requires secure communication, document management, and accountability systems.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. Google Workspace Adoption: The ESO shall implement a dedicated Google Workspace environment for the GBC by the 2026 Annual General Meeting (AGM), including secure emails, document drives, and collaboration tools.
2. Board Management Software: The ESO shall procure and implement board management software (such as Diligent, Convene, or equivalent nonprofit solution) for exclusive use by the GBC by the 2026 Annual General Meeting (AGM).
3. ESO Oversight: The ESO shall provide technical support, training, and monitoring to ensure compliance with confidentiality protocols.
4. Annual Review: The GBC shall review the effectiveness of these measures annually, with recommendations for further strengthening as needed.

GBC Resolution 201.03 · 2026 · Mid-term General Meeting, passed October 2, 2025

ADDED · 2026

201.04 · Carrying out Srila Prabhupada's Order — 2014 (2026)

[Position paper]

[Note: this paper was originally passed in 2014 but not released publicly till now due to legal considerations]

Resolved that:

The document "Carrying Out Srila Prabhupada's Order: The GBC as ISKCON's Ultimate Managing Authority" is an official GBC paper and an important presentation that traces the vision and instructions of Srila Prabhupāda in establishing the Governing Body Commission (GBC) as the ultimate managing authority of ISKCON. Drawing on key historical events, correspondence, and foundational documents, it highlights how the GBC serves as the instrument of Srila Prabhupada's will and the thread that holds ISKCON together as a unified, spiritually vibrant global society.

We encourage the ISKCON community to view and share this resource, as it deepens our collective understanding of Srila Prabhupada's vision and underscores the responsibility we share in preserving and strengthening the institution he built for the upliftment of the world.

GBC Resolution 201.04 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 20, 2014

New material since 2018 — placement to be confirmed

ADDED • 2019

204.3 • Dates For 2020 GBC Annual General Meeting (2019)

[Action order]

Feb 07 Org Dev Nityananda Trayodasi
Feb 08 Org Dev
Feb 09 Org Dev
Feb 10 Org Dev / EC
Feb 11 GBC Plenary on Org Dev Matters
Feb 12 GBC Plenary
Feb 13 GBC Plenary
Feb 14 ISKCON Leadership Sanga (ILS)
Feb 15 GBC Plenary ILS Continues
Feb 16 GBC Plenary ILS Continues
Feb 17 GBC Plenary ILS Continues
Feb 18 GBC Plenary/ILS (half day) ILS Continues
Feb 19 GBC Plenary
Feb 20 ILS ends
Feb 21 GBC Plenary
Feb 22 GBC Plenary
[https://gbc.iskcon.org/
Zonal_Assignments_2019_%20v3.pdf](https://gbc.iskcon.org/Zonal_Assignments_2019_%20v3.pdf)
[Zonal_Assignments_2019_%20v3.pdf](https://gbc.iskcon.org/Zonal_Assignments_2019_%20v3.pdf)
Feb 23-26 Kirtan Mela
Feb 27- Mar 05 Navadvipa Mandala Parikrama
March 09 Sri Gaura Purnima

GBC Resolution 204.3 • 2019 • Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED • 2019

204.4 • Mid-term General Meeting 2020 (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

That the Midterm General Meeting of the ISKCON GBC Society shall take place from October 22-28, 2020, at ISKCON Pune, India:
18 October Org Dev
19 October Org Dev
20 October Org Dev
21 October Org Dev/EC
22 October GBC Plenary on Org Dev Matters
23 October GBC Plenary on Org Dev Matters
24 October GBC Plenary on Org Dev Matters
25 October GBC Plenary on Org Dev Matters
26 October Special Topic (Rama Vijayotsava)
27 October ½ Day Special Topic & ½ Day GBC Plenary (Ekadasi)
28 October GBC Plenary (Final Day)
31 October Karttika Begins

GBC Resolution 204.4 • 2019 • Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

206.2 · Rule of Order Regarding Sponsorship of Proposals (2019)

[Rule of Order]

(Proposed by Bhaktarupa Das and sponsored by Bhanu Swami and Guru Prasad Swami)

Whereas existing ministries and standing committees often need to approach GBC members to sponsor proposals on matters within their area of responsibility and expertise, which may create a bureaucratic burden on them.

Resolved:

That duly constituted ISKCON ministries and standing committees may submit proposals for consideration by the GBC Body for matters directly within their mandate. If there is any question raised regarding whether a submitted proposal is actually within the mandate of the submitting ISKCON ministry or standing committee, then the GBC Deputies' Executive in conjunction with the GBC Executive Committee will decide.

GBC Resolution 206.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2020

204.03 · Dates for 2021 GBC Annual General Meeting (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

Feb 22 Org Dev

Feb 23 Org Dev

Feb 24 Org Dev/EC

Feb 25 Org Dev/EC Nityananda Trayodasi

Feb 26 GBC Plenary on Org Dev Matters

Feb 27 GBC Plenary

Feb 28 GBC Plenary

March 1 SGGS (Sanga of GBCs, Gurus, and Sannyasis)

March 2 SGGS

March 3 SGGS

March 4 GBC Plenary

March 5 GBC Plenary

March 6 GBC Plenary

March 7 GBC Plenary

March 8 GBC Plenary

March 9 GBC Plenary

March 12 Festival Inauguration

March 13-16 Kirtan Mela

March 17-24 Navadvipa Mandala Parikrama

March 28 Sri Gaura Purnima

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GBC Resolution 204.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

209.02 · Reviewing proposals and resolutions: Amendment of SABHA (2020)

document Section 2A — 2020

Action order

Whereas the SABHA has been created by the GBC to provide checks and balances on the GBC

Whereas currently there is no provision for the SABHA to review tabled and rejected proposals

RESOLVED:

That section 2A of the SABHA Document (Resolution 306 of the 2018 AGM) shall be amended as follows:

The GBC shall provide the SABHA with:

- a. The resolutions that passed*
- b. The tabled and rejected proposals*

By a two-thirds majority of its voting members, the SABHA can formally object to any GBC resolution and

return it to the GBC for re-evaluation. The SABHA can also request that a tabled and rejected proposal be

reconsidered by the GBC. This resolution is not retroactive.

[Footnotes to resolution]

*Other than those deemed confidential.

GBC Resolution 209.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

209.03 · SABHA membership — Approval of temporary members: Amendment (2020)

to SABHA document Section 7 — 2020

Action order

Whereas the current SABHA resolution does not provide for timely replacement of members

Whereas the SABHA can only fulfill its purpose by having a diverse composition and a minimum number of members

Whereas article #9(c) of the SABHA document lists one of the Chair's responsibilities as "overseeing the

election of members"

RESOLVED:

That the SABHA chairman and/or any appointed SABHA member may interact with the SGGS, Regional

Councils, Vaishnavi Ministry, and Youth Ministry in selecting a temporary SABHA member. A temporary

member has full rights as a regular SABHA member. By a simple majority of all its voting members, the

SABHA can approve the inclusion of temporary members. The temporary member can then be either

approved or replaced by the appropriate administrative agency.

The temporary member will act with all the responsibilities and rights of a regular member. If approved by

the respective body (SGGS, Ministry, etc.), the temporary members will become regular members.

The_SABHA_document_ratified_by_GBC_on_3_Feb__2018_2020_Updates.pdf

4

GBC Resolution 209.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

504.01 · Establishing the position of Special Duty Officer as an official position (2020)

in ISKCON Law — 2020

Administrative order

Whereas occasionally a senior devotee will be assigned a special service by the GBC Body or GBC EC in

a particular zone, city or country or serving with a specific ISKCON entity such as a Ministry. These

assignments are time limited and specific in scope

Whereas the title of Special Duty Officer (SDO) has been used in the past but was never enacted in

ISKCON Law as an official position

RESOLVED:

The position of Special Duty Officer (SDO) is established as an official ISKCON position under ISKCON

Law. Special Duty Officers may be appointed by the GBC Body or by the GBC EC as required or as

requested by Zonal GBC(s). The specific duties of the Special Duty Officer will be established by the GBC

Body or GBC EC in conjunction with the Zonal GBC(s). Special Duty Officer assignments may be modified

by the GBC Body or GBC EC during the term of service as required or as requested by Zonal GBC(s).

GBC Resolution 504.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2021

203.04 · HH Bhakti Charu Swami's Samadhi — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas HH Bhakti Charu Swami has rendered many years of exceptional service to Srila Prabhupada, Sri

Dhama Mayapur, and ISKCON;

Whereas Bhakti Charu Swami is a prominent devotee whose passing should be marked by a samadhi

structure over the place where his body is interred;

Whereas Bhakti Charu Swami departed from this world on the appearance day of Sanatana Goswami,

Guru Purnima, July 4, 2020, and his body was interred in Mayapur, 13 July 2020, therefore, there is an

urgency to finalize the samadhi structure.

RESOLVED:

HH Bhakti Charu Swami shall have a samadhi structure built over the place where his body is interred.

GBC Resolution 203.04 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

203.04 · Bhakti Charu Swami's Samadhi size exception — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas it is necessary to finalize the decision for the samadhi of Bhakti Charu Swami;

Whereas Tamal Krishna Goswami's full body samadhi in Mayapur is 2.7 metres long, (because he was put into samadhi lying down) by 1.8 metres wide, by 2.9 metres high, and this is an exceptional circumstance;

Whereas Sridhara Swami's full body samadhi in Mayapur is 1.6 metres long, by 1.7 metres wide, by 2.7 metres high;

Whereas Tatpar Swami's full body samadhi in Mayapur is 1.0 metre long, by 0.8 metre wide, by 1.6 metres high;

Whereas the standard size for samadhis in ISKCON is .9 metre (3ft) long, by .9 metre (3ft) wide maximum footprint, and 1.5 metres (4ft 11in) maximum height;

Whereas the GBC body feels it is appropriate to make an exemption to the size restriction for Bhakti Charu Swami's samadhi.

RESOLVED:

That the samadhi structure for Bhakti Charu Swami will be the same size as the samadhi of Tamal Krishna Goswami — a maximum footprint of 2.7 metres by 1.8 metres, and a maximum height of 2.9 metres.

GBC Resolution 203.04 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

203.04 · Final decision on samadhi of HH Jayapataka Swami and further (2021)

[Statement]

considerations regarding samadhis near Srila Prabhupada's puspa samadhi in Mayapur — 2021

2

Whereas after repeated attempts to get clarity on what is the right course of action regarding the samadhi

area near Srila Prabhupada's puspa samadhi, a conclusion has not been reached;

Whereas further attempts via surveys seem impractical and unwanted;

Whereas there are a significant number of undecided members, therefore it is difficult to get a clear picture

of what the GBC wants;

Whereas the survey presented to the GBC members in December 2020 regarding more samadhis in the

area near Srila Prabhupada's puspa samadhi received votes of 10 in favor, 9 against, and 9 undecided;

Whereas in 2018 there was a consensus amongst GBC members that HH Jayapataka Maharaja's samadhi

will be placed in this area.

RESOLVED:

That HH Jayapataka Swami's samadhi will be in the Mayapur Samadhi Park near Srila Prabhupada's

puspa samadhi. The samadhi will be no larger than the size of HH Tamal Krishna Goswami's samadhi.

There will be no further samadhis in the samadhi area near Srila Prabhupada's puspa samadhi until the

matter is decided by the GBC body.

GBC Resolution 203.04 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on January 6, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

203.04 · Rompada Swami's leave of absence extension (2021)

[Action Order]

The Leave of Absence of Romapada Swami is extended by a further one year, to March 2022.

GBC Resolution 203.04 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 3, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

203.04 · HH Hridayananda dasa Goswami as GBC Emeritus (2021)

[Statement]

That in recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, HH Hridayananda dasa Goswami is again

hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

GBC Resolution 203.04 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on September 22, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

204.01 · GBC Virtual and online meetings established as General Meetings, pt. (2021)

[Rule of order]

1 — 2021

3

Whereas Article VI Clause 1 of the Regulations of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission (GBC)

Society of West Bengal states that the Annual General Meeting (AGM) "shall be held during Shree Krishna

Caitanya Mahaprabhu's birth anniversary celebrations at Shree Mayapur, District Nadia, West Bengal,

India, unless extraordinary events make such a venue and timing impossible";

Whereas the GBC Executive Committee posits that the current Covid-19 global situation is such an

"extraordinary event" whereby it is not feasible for the GBC to physically conduct its AGM in Mayapur in

February-March 2021;

Whereas the above view is wholeheartedly shared by the GBC's General Counsel;

Whereas Article VI Clause 4 of the Regulations of the ISKCON GBC Society allows for a Special General

Meeting to be called if an emergency exists;

Whereas pursuant to the above, the Executive Committee hereby calls for a Special General Meeting and

will place as one of the agenda items the postponement of the 2021 Mayapur AGM;

Whereas the EC shall, in the Special General Meeting also propose that all resolutions passed and adopted from now till the next physical GBC meeting be conducted by Correspondence Vote pursuant to

GBC Resolution 418 of 2006.

This will include voting on any matters which ordinarily would have been conducted during the AGM;

Whereas the GBC EC shall also, in the Special General Meeting, propose that the GBC Virtual Conference

also become an official medium for dealing with all GBC business, including proposals and votes during the

year, regardless of the holding of an AGM or not.

RESOLVED:

That the GBC Annual General Meeting of 2021 is hereby postponed until further notice due to the current

Covid-19 global situation. All GBC business, including voting on proposals, may be conducted either via

correspondence on the GBC Discussions email conference, or online via the GBC Virtual meetings.

GBC Resolution 204.01 · 2021 · Correspondence Vote (passed on January 6, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

204.01 · GBC Virtual and online meetings established as General Meetings pt. (2021)

[Rule of order]

Whereas the GBC conducts virtual conference meetings using online platforms, along with face-to-face

plenary meetings and email correspondence voting;

Whereas proposals may be presented, voted on and made into official GBC resolutions using on-line

platforms;

Whereas the virtual meetings are attended by GBCs, Ministers, a representative from the SABHA, a

representative from the Deputies, a representative from the Executive Secretariat and others, as deemed

necessary by the GBC Executive Committee.

RESOLVED:

4

GBC virtual meetings using online systems, such as Zoom etc. are accepted as an official platform for GBC

meetings.

GBC Resolution 204.01 · 2021 · Correspondence Vote (Passed on January 6, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

204.02 · Dealing with urgent matters (2021)

[Rule of order]

Whereas giving a fair and timely hearing to a large group of concerned GBC members seeking to share

information and engage in discussion and deliberation on a matter which they deem of great importance is

not only desirable but proper.

RESOLVED:

When 33% or more of the GBC members submit a request to the Executive Committee to place a matter

on the agenda of a GBC meeting for the purpose of discussion, deliberation and/or decision-making, that

matter shall be taken up as an introductory presentation of no more than 30 minutes on a GBC meeting

agenda to be held within 30 calendar days after submission of the request.

GBC Resolution 204.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on May 14, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

204.03 · GBC Meetings: Annual General Meeting: Dates for 2022 GBC (2021)

[Action Order]

Annual General Meeting — 2021

RESOLVED:

Due to the ongoing Covid-19 crisis, the 2022 Annual General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body

Society shall be held online

GBC Resolution 204.03 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on November 24, 2021)

206.01 • Rules for voting online (2021)

[Rule of order]

Part A:

Whereas the sequential and ordered processing of proposals has been codified and can be managed easily in the GEM software;

Whereas processes usually managed in face-to-face meetings are replicated, streamlined and stored securely in the GEM;

Whereas proposal processing and voting can be readily captured and calculated online making it easy for the GBC EC, Deputies, OrgDev, SABHA and secretaries to keep track of all stages of proposal management;

Whereas comments can be quickly tabulated and incorporated into PMIs, presentations and proposals as necessary.

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RESOLVED:

That the online GBC Environment for Meetings (GEM) shall be an official system for processing proposals and resolutions for the ISKCON GBC Society (WB).

Part B: (passed during the GBC Virtual Meeting on November 24, 2021):

Whereas the rules for GBC voting via GEM need to be clarified.

RESOLVED:

1. All proposals submitted to the GBC will be processed using GEM except where the GBC EC decides a different methodology is required.
2. All proposals shall be lodged via the Proposals conference and processed by the Deputies. Any exemptions to the proposal process that may be in place for GBC- appointed committees shall apply to GEM voting as well
3. When the GBC Executive Committee decides that a proposal warrants bypassing the Deputies, due to considerations such as confidentiality or it being an emergency, etc, the proposal will be sent directly to the GBC First Review level on GEM (see Point 6 below).
4. When using GEM during in-person meetings, schedules will be determined by the Deputy EC and the GBC EC.
5. The following timeline refers to the use of GEM in a virtual setting, e.g. Zoom.
6. From the time the proposal reaches the GBC First Review stage on GEM, seven (7) days shall be allowed for discussion before Straw Voting.
7. Following this initial discussion period five (5) days will be given for Straw Voting.
8. At the conclusion of the Straw Vote the Deputy EC, or in special cases, the Corresponding Secretary, will distribute the results to all participants. If the proposal does not require editing, the Deputy EC (or Corresponding Secretary) will then announce the commencement of the GBC Final Review.

9. If editing is required, the Deputy EC (or Corresponding Secretary) Will then edit the proposal in a

maximum of three (3) days, following which The GBC Final Review will commence.

10. A period of seven (7) days will be allowed for the GBC Final Review before the Final Vote.

11. If, during the GBC Final Review, a member proposes an amendment, discussion will stop. The amendment will be discussed for up to three (3) days after which it will be voted upon. The GBC Final Review will then continue.

12. If, during the GBC Final Review, a member proposes that discussion should take place outside GEM, and this is seconded, a vote will be taken. If there is a simple majority in favor, the discussion

will then take place virtually, e.g. on Zoom. The GBC Final Review will then continue.

13. Following the GBC Final Review, seven (7) days will be allocated for the GBC Final Vote.

14. Three quarters (75%) of the eligible participants must vote for a Final Vote to be considered binding.

(Eligible participants are GBC members who are not on a Leave of Absence or are not restricted from voting for disciplinary or other reasons.)

15. Voting requirements for the various types of proposals, of either simple majority, two-thirds majority,

or three quarters majority etc, will be applied to votes as per the standard GBC Rules of Order.

16. If fewer than three quarters (75%) of the eligible participants have voted within seven (7) days, the

GBC Executive Committee will contact those who have not voted and attempt to get their votes in a

maximum of a further seven (7) days.

17. If, following that extended period, fewer than three quarters (75%) Of the eligible participants have

voted, then the vote is void. At the discretion of the Executive Committee, the proposal may be reconsidered for additional discussion and voting via GEM, virtually, e.g. Zoom, or at the next General Meeting.

18. All resolutions passed on GEM are final and binding, subject to Review by the SABHA where appropriate, and Legal Review, and do not have to be further approved at either an Annual General Meeting or a Midterm General Meeting.

6

19. The GBC Secretariat shall keep detailed records of those who have not voted within the Final

Voting period. Reasons for not voting must be submitted in writing to the Executive Committee.

GBC Resolution 206.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

206.02 · GBC resolutions and cultural sensitivity (2021)

[Statement]

proposals

Whereas ISKCON is a growing international society, with communities on six continents;

Whereas ISKCON members and communities naturally interact, and exist within, many different cultures,
languages and historical traditions;

Whereas ISKCON is composed of devotees from a wide variety of backgrounds, races, ethnicities, traditions, and cultures;

Whereas our Founder-Acarya Srila Prabhupada stressed the need to share Krishna Consciousness according to time, place, and circumstance;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada taught us the importance of unity in diversity, and the importance of cooperation;

Whereas, the Governing Body Commission acknowledges that the varieties of cultural expressions of Krishna consciousness are a strength, not a weakness, and a symbol of our global success and expansion.

RESOLVED:

1. The GBC Body may, on exceptional occasions, pass resolutions which may, due to differing cultural norms in certain parts of the world, require special attention, and thus the GBC may designate such a resolution as potentially a “culturally sensitive resolution.”
2. A Regional Governing Body (RGB), or where there is no RGB, an authorized national council with the support of their GBC, or where a national council has more than one GBC, a majority of their GBCs, may apply to the GBC Body with a request to modify a culturally sensitive resolution for their area/yatra. Such a request must include the details of the specific adjustment/s they propose to make, as well as the reasons for requesting such an adjustment/s.
3. The GBC Body will give guidelines and set out the parameters regarding what may or may not be adjusted within a culturally sensitive resolution. Any details, guidelines, parameters, timelines, etc., in regard to its exceptional status must be recorded within the resolution itself.

GBC Resolution 206.02 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on November 17, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

209.03 · Increasing the Age Limit of Youth Representatives on the SABHA (2021)

[Action order]

Membership

7

Whereas the age limit for youth representatives assigned to the SABHA is currently 30 years of age;

Whereas discussions on the SABHA often take a high degree of maturity in knowledge, experience, and perspective;

Whereas including devotees up through the age of thirty-five offers a greater number from which to choose;

Whereas the Youth Minister says, "Extending the age to 35 will be very helpful."

RESOLVED:

That GBC Resolution no.306/2018 (The SABHA — Spiritual Advisors Bhagavat Assembly) 6.l(b) (iv) be

changed from "Youth (3): Devotees below the age of thirty (30) at the time of election" to "Youth (3):

Devotees below the age of thirty-six (36) at the time of election."

GBC Resolution 209.03 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on March 30, 2021)

ADDED · 2022

204.03 · Dates for 2023 GBC Annual General Meeting (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The Annual General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

February 7-11, 2023, at ISKCON Mayapur, WB, India

GBC Resolution 204.03 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on October 5, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

206.02 · Sponsorship of Proposals: Amendment (2022)

[Rule of order]

proposals

Whereas the GBC passed the following resolution in 2019:

Change of rule regarding sponsorship of proposals — 2019

That the GBC Rules of Order be modified to state, in addition, "However, duly constituted ISKCON

ministries and standing committees may submit proposals for consideration by the GBC Body for matters directly within their mandate without the requirement of getting two GBC members as sponsors. If there is any question raised regarding whether a submitted proposal is actually within the mandate of the submitting ISKCON ministry or standing committee then the GBC Deputies' Executive in conjunction with the GBC Executive Committee will decide."

Whereas this Rule of Order applies only to Ministries and Standing Committees

Whereas it is seen in practice that the SABHA, the SAC, and other administrative entities are also submitting proposals under the auspices of this resolution.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That the Rule of Order "Change of rule regarding sponsorship of proposals — 2019" is modified to:

Duly constituted GBC administrative entities may submit proposals for consideration by the GBC Body for

matters directly within their mandate without the need for separate sponsorship by GBC members.

The following entities may submit proposals without the requirement of sponsorship by two GBC members:

ISKCON Global Ministries

GBC Standing Committees

Spiritual Advisors Bhagavat Assembly (SABHA)

ISKCON General Counsel

GBC Strategic Planning Team

BBT-GBC Relations Committee

ISKCON Central Office for Child Protection

ISKCON Property Office

Sastric Advisory Council

Prevention of Leadership Misconduct Office

GBC Executive Secretariat

GBC Deputies

Organizational Development (Org Dev)

If there is any question raised regarding whether a submitted proposal is actually within the mandate of the

submitting entity, then the GBC Deputy Executive Committee in conjunction with the GBC Executive

Committee will decide.

GBC Resolution 206.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on June 19, 2022)

207.03 • Establishing the GBC Executive Office (2022)

[Administrative Order]

Whereas the GBC Executive Committee may benefit from increased executive and administrative support to assist in supervising the various entities and initiatives connected to the GBC

Whereas the GBC can become more relevant, relatable, accessible, and effective with such an addition and would benefit from improved digital record keeping.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC Executive Office is hereby established.

The GBC Organizational Development Committee is mandated to, in close consultation with the GBC EC, gradually develop such an Office over the course of 2023, and to identify ways and means for its funding in perpetuity.

The Office, its physical features located in Sridham Mayapur, shall at least consist of an Executive Director, a Director for Ministries and Standing Committees, a Director for Core Support Functionaries and a Director of Corporate Services.

Regular progress reports will be submitted to the GBC, for additional inputs, as required.

The duties and responsibilities of the GBC Executive Office shall include, but are not limited to:

- Assisting and supporting the GBC EC.
- Following up on the implementation of GBC resolutions.
- Overseeing and facilitating the work of global Ministries, GBC Standing Committees and other Offices, under the care of the GBC EC.
- Attend to all compliance matters for the GBC West Bengal Society.
- Creating and maintaining a GBC archival system, ensuring digital filing, and archiving of all relevant documentation of all GBC-related functions; developing research capacity.
- Assisting the GBC in creating and maintaining a global diary, as well as short-term and long-term work plans.
- Creating and maintaining a digital directory of incorporated ISKCON national chapters, local centers, and other ISKCON-related entities.
- Serving as the global communications desk; standardizing and maintaining the GBC website and other GBC-related online presence.
- Participating in developing the agenda for AGM, MTGM and other GBC meetings, including:
 - Regularly conducting censuses.
 - Ensuring that the ISKCON Law Book and other policy documents remain updated.
 - Embedding capacity for audit and risk management.
- The Executive Director may attend GBC meetings as non-voting staff member.
- Being a resource and support to individual GBC members, Global Duty Officers, and Special Duty Officers.

Facilitating the process of leadership succession and the integration of the next generation.
Liaison between the GBC and the SABHA.
Facilitating the upgrading of ISKCON into a world-class organization.

The role of the GBC Executive Office is to assist the implementation of the GBC's will, vision, decisions and strategies and has no independent function beyond this mandate. The organogram is as follows:

GBC ADMINISTRATIVE AND EXECUTIVE SUPPORT

GBC Resolution 207.03 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on December 21, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

209.04 · SABHA Annual Meeting (2022)

[Statement]

meeting

Whereas SABHA is in the process of planning our annual meeting in Mayapur for 2023

Whereas according to the SABHA Foundation Document, the SABHA annual meeting is obligatory to attend for all SABHA members

Whereas all work on reviewing GBC Resolutions has been done online for the last two years and SABHA has been quite efficient in fulfilling its duties via online meetings

Whereas some SABHA members have health considerations

Whereas some SABHA members have financial considerations, and SABHA has a limited budget.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That SABHA is allowed to have an option of holding SABHA Annual Meetings in an in-person, online or mixed format decided by the majority vote by SABHA and approved by the GBC EC.

GBC Resolution 209.04 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on November 23, 2022)

209.05 • Presidents' Annual Conference – Repealed (2022)

[Statement]

Annual Conference

Whereas it is required for the smooth functioning of the GBC meetings that the Rules of Order are up-to-

date and available to all members

Whereas the Rules of Order have not been updated for many years

Whereas previously the GBC passed the following resolution which was classified as a Rule of Order:

PRESIDENTS' ANNUAL CONFERENCES

I. ANNUAL CONFERENCES

1. An Annual Conference of the temple presidents to be called the "Annual Temple Presidents' Meeting" shall be held every year at the same location as the annual GBC meeting. After the GBC has completed its agenda, the temple presidents' meeting shall be held. The regional secretaries should also attend the Presidents' Meeting.

2. At the commencement of the meeting there shall be harinama sankirtana, and immediately thereafter a passage from the works of Srila Prabhupada shall be read aloud as an invocation.

II. POWER OF ANNUAL CONFERENCES

1. The annual Presidents' Meeting shall examine the resolutions passed by the GBC during their annual meeting and pass resolutions recommending acceptance, amendment, or rejection of the GBC resolutions, all of which shall be in the form of recommendations that shall be referred back to the GBC. The GBC Body shall meet and hear the presidents' recommendations and shall pass their own resolutions which shall be final.

2. An additional meeting of the temple presidents and/or regional secretaries shall be held during or after the annual GBC meeting at Sri Mayapur in the form of istagosthi workshops where the presidents and/or the regional secretaries can informally exchange ideas on how to spread Krsna consciousness and strengthen the movement. During the general annual Presidents' Meeting the schedule for the next year's istagosthi workshop shall be finalized. As many presidents / regional secretaries as possible should attend. This is an amendment to the previous rule. [82]

III. DUTIES OF PRESIDENTS CONFERENCES

1. The former "temple presidents' meeting" will now be referred to as the "ISKCON Managers Meeting." [86]

2. That rules of order #50 from the 1986 GBC meeting be superseded to read as follows:

a. Those eligible to attend and vote in the "ISKCON Manager's Meeting" are as follows:

i. The president of any authorized temple or preaching center listed in BACK TO GODHEAD or any other official Bhaktivedanta Book Trust publication. Any center that cannot officially publish its address can get authorization from the GBC chairman). If a President cannot personally attend, he can authorize in writing a representative to attend.

ii. Regional secretaries.

- iii. At the request of the body, guests may be invited as observers to participate in the meeting.
- iv. Headmasters of Gurukulas with more than 50 students, and non- GBC global ministers. [88]
- 3. To elect the Chairman, Vice-Chairman, and Secretary of the Meeting.
- 4. To elect the Chairman, Vice-Chairman, Secretary, and Sergeant of Arms for the meeting. This is an amendment to the previous rule. [82]
- 5. To discuss the GBC resolutions and pass resolutions to recommend their acceptance, amendment, or rejection to the GBC.
- 6. To pass resolutions recommending for adopting by the GBC any new resolution not included in the GBC resolutions.
- 7. The Chairman and his functions:
 - a. The Chairman shall be elected from among the temple presidents at their annual general meeting. His term shall be the full duration of the meeting.
 - b. He shall preside over the temple presidents' meeting and shall regulate the proceedings according to the rules of order, and he shall sign the temple presidents' minutes.
- 8. The Vice-Chairman and his functions:
 - a. The Vice-Chairman shall be elected in the same manner as the Chairman.
 - b. He shall assist the Chairman in discharging his duties and in his absence shall perform the same.
- 9. The Secretary and his functions:
 - a. The Secretary shall be elected from among the temple presidents at the Annual General Meeting, his term being the duration of the meeting and the completion of his duties.
 - b. He shall keep and maintain the minutes of all proceedings of the presidents' meeting and present them to the GBC.
 - c. He shall sign the minutes along with the Chairman to verify their correctness and take signatures of all attending temple presidents at the outset of the meeting.
- 10. Voting: At the annual temple presidents' meeting all questions shall, subject to any rules or bylaws, be decided by simple majority of all those members present and voting, the voting being by show of hands. The Chairman shall cast the deciding vote. To reject any resolution of the GBC a majority of two- thirds vote of the members present at the meeting shall be required.
- 11. A GBC representative shall attend the presidents' meeting. One or more members of the GBC shall be nominated by the GBC Chairman, with the consent of the GBC members, to attend the temple presidents' meeting to answer any questions, to make "personal explanation" motions, etc., on behalf of the GBC body, and to generally render assistance to the Chairman. He shall not have voting power in the presidents' meeting.
- 12. Agenda of meeting:
 - a. The GBC resolutions and any supplementary material should be seen by the temple presidents at least one day before their meeting at Mayapura.

b. The meeting shall consider all GBC resolutions and pass its own resolutions recommending to the GBC that each GBC resolution be passed as is, amended, or rejected. After completion of this business any motions (proposals) that may have been submitted to the Chairman in writing in advance and that are signed by at least three temple presidents shall be admitted by the Chairman for discussion, taking the members' consent. All motions admitted for discussion shall be debated and put to question as per the rules of order. The Chairman shall decide the order of business for matters originating in the temple presidents' meeting.

13. Amendments, rules of debate, etc: The rules of order of the GBC regarding amendments, procedural motions, rules, debate, personal explanation, rights, and rules of order numbers IV.1.4, IV.L.3, IV.J.7, and IV.J.8 shall be followed during the temple presidents' meetings.

14. Participation in presidents' meeting:

a. Only presidents of an ISKCON temple shall be eligible to participate in the temple presidents' meeting. A list of temple presidents shall be made by the GBC secretary according to the advice of the local GBC members at least one day before the meeting takes place. Only one vote per temple shall be allowed, and if co-presidents exist at any temple they may both attend, but with only one vote between them.

b. BBT secretaries or managers or devotees in similar responsible positions who are not GBC members, on the recommendation of their BBT trustees or GBC member, shall be eligible to attend the annual temple presidents'/regional secretaries meetings at Mayapura at the Gaura Purnima Festival. [81]

15. All regional secretaries and temple presidents shall come for their own meeting at Gaura Purnima before the festival begins. [81]

16. The Sergeant at Arms shall strictly regulate admission, participation, and voting at the annual presidents' meeting to only those persons authorized to participate and vote, as well as keep order during their meetings. [82]

17. The presidents' meeting shall appoint committees on the request of the GBC or the GBC Committees to fulfill duties as assigned. [82]

18. Temple presidents at their annual meeting shall appoint committees for performing duties given by the GBC or its standing committees. [82]

19. The past year's Chairman of the temple presidents' meeting shall attend the final GBC meeting in Mayapura when the presidents' resolutions are read to the GBC body.

20. The new officers of the temple presidents' meeting shall be present when the presidents' resolutions are read to the GBC Body. [83]

Whereas the President's Annual Conference has not taken place for many years

Whereas this role has been taken on by the SABHA

Whereas the SABHA has been effective in this service.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That the resolution "President's Annual Conference" is repealed and removed from the ISKCON Law books.

GBC Resolution 209.05 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on June 19, 2022)

204.01 • Protocol for Extending Meetings (2023)

[Rule of order]

Whereas the following resolution was passed in 1987:

1. That no GBC meeting shall exceed the scheduled limits of 9:30 a.m. to 12:30 p.m. (morning session) and 3:30 p.m. to 6:30 p.m. (afternoon session), unless the members by a 2/3rds majority concur that an emergency exists. In the event of such an emergency, the maximum extension per session may be extended for 30 minutes only.

Whereas this resolution no longer serves the needs of the GBC.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Any GBC meeting may be extended by a 2/3rds majority vote. The meeting may be extended by up to 30

minutes. If a further extension is necessary, then another 2/3rd majority vote will be required.

Any meeting may be extended for a maximum of 1 hour.

Whereas the service of a GBC zonal secretary is a solemn responsibility to the ISKCON society, Śrīla

Prabhupāda and the mission of Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu.

Whereas in order to facilitate the GBC meetings more flexibility is required.

Whereas there is a need to increase the quorum to ensure that the decisions made by the GBC are indeed

the will of the majority of GBC members.

Whereas the existing rules of order state:

No business shall be transacted at any general meeting, except for the adjournment of the meeting, unless a quorum of members is present at the time when the meeting proceeds to business.

A quorum for any general meeting shall be 51% of the total number of GBC members of the Society

subsisting as such on the date of notice of the meeting.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

- The chairman must establish that a quorum is present before a meeting can begin.
- Any member can raise a point of order about an apparent lack of quorum.
- If the chair begins the meeting without a quorum present and a member is speaking on an issue, that member may not be interrupted for the purpose of stating that a quorum is not present. The chair should allow debate to continue and permit a member to raise an announcement about not having a quorum when members are not speaking.
- 60% of the voting members must be present for a quorum, to vote on a proposal for a Final Vote to be considered binding. (Voting members are GBC members who are not on a Leave of Absence or are not restricted from voting for disciplinary or other reasons.)
- In the event individual members are not able to participate in meetings onsite, the GBC EC may grant leave for the member to participate online,

- In exceptional circumstances, the GBC EC, at their discretion, may also utilize the option of blended meetings.

- Members participating online, must do so with their cameras on for their votes to be considered.

- If there is no quorum no decisions can be made other than to:

- o Adjourn the meeting.

- o Take a recess.

- o Fix the time to adjourn to.

- o Taking measures to establish a quorum.

- Discussion may continue, at the discretion of the GBC EC chair, on a particular topic but no voting is allowed.

Participation in meetings

- If a voting member misses more than three consecutive online meetings, or one onsite meeting, the

GBC EC will seek an explanation from the member to understand why they are not participating in meetings.

- Persistent absence without satisfactory explanation (to be determined by GBC EC) from meetings may result in a member being censured.

- This rule of order for quorum applies to onsite, online, and blended meetings.

Whereas nearly every resolution passed by the GBC Body has potentially significant ramifications on ISKCON and its devotees.

Whereas it is the solemn duty of the GBC Body as a whole and of each GBC member individually to make informed decisions when voting on proposed resolutions.

Whereas each GBC member is expected to assimilate relevant and often vital information contained in submitted documents, oral presentations, and deliberations prior to voting.

Whereas relevant and often vital documents are frequently not provided to GBC members sufficiently in advance of GBC meetings thereby impairing the ability of GBC members to attentively read and absorb the documentation in a timely fashion.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. Sufficient time in advance of each online GBC meeting, but in no case less than 10 (ten) days, shall

be allocated by the GBC Executive Committee to enable GBC members and Ministers to read and assimilate all documentation, in excess of (10) ten pages, provided for that meeting;

2. Prior to any presentation, discussion or deliberation regarding any agenda item, each GBC member shall certify to the GBC Body by means of a “polling sheet” whether he or she has read and assimilated the attached documents pertaining to that agenda item;
3. Only members who have certified on the "polling sheet" that they have read and assimilated the attached documents will be allowed to vote on the matter.
4. If the number of GBC members making said certification to the GBC Body is less than the number required to constitute a quorum, then such agenda item shall not be taken up at that meeting but shall be postponed to the next meeting of the GBC Body at which time the certification process set forth above shall again be required.
5. If the GBC Body votes by a two-thirds supermajority that an agenda item is urgent, the requirements of this resolution may be waived, except for the requirement set forth in Section 2 above.

GBC Resolution 204.01 · 2023 · GBC Midterm General Meeting, passed October 28, 2023

ADDED · 2023

204.03 · Dates for 2024 GBC Annual General Meeting (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The Annual General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

February 27–March 9, 2024, at ISKCON Mayapur, WB, India

GBC Resolution 204.03 · 2023 · GBC Midterm General Meeting, passed October 28, 2023

ADDED · 2023

204.05 · Dates for 2023 GBC Midterm General Meeting (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that: The Midterm General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall

be held from October 25-30, at ISKCON Pune, India

GBC Resolution 204.05 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed March 15, 2023

ADDED · 2023

204.05 · Dates for 2024 GBC Midterm General Meeting (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that: The Midterm General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall

be held from October 1-7, at ISKCON New Vrindavan, USA.

GBC Resolution 204.05 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed December 13, 2023

501.01 • Amendment to Deputies Duties (2023)

[Statement]

Whereas the Deputies for decades have given the GBC valuable service in reviewing proposals before they are presented to the GBC.

Whereas the GBC resolution “Deputies Appointment Procedures — 2005” defines the responsibilities of the GBC Deputies Committee as:

All Deputies should attend the annual GBC Meetings in Sridham Mayapur and assist the GBC Body in its deliberations. This shall include:

Meeting as a separate body to consider various proposals or topics referred to it by the GBC Executive Committee, as well as proposals from amongst its own members, and to prepare draft legislation for consideration and voting by the GBC Body; and

Participating in various subcommittees and/or attending to other duties as assigned by the Executive Committee.

All Deputies should, where possible, make themselves available to assist the GBC Executive Committee and Secretariat during the year in communicating with any ISKCON managers that an individual Deputy may be in contact with.

Whereas the Deputies have saved the GBC time by reviewing proposals sent to the GBC.

Whereas the GBC Deputies Committee has proven effective in assisting the GBC to craft relevant legislation address the needs of ISKCON.

Whereas proposals from different Ministries, Committees and Offices should be treated equally, except for exceptional circumstances.

Whereas the GBC passed the following resolution in 2021:

1. That All proposals submitted to the GBC will be processed using GEM except where the GBC EC decides a different methodology is required.
2. All proposals shall be lodged via the Proposals conference and processed by the Deputies.
3. When the GBC Executive Committee decides that a proposal warrants bypassing the Deputies, due to considerations such as confidentiality or it being an emergency, etc, the proposal will be sent directly to the GBC First Review level on GEM.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The resolution defining the responsibilities of the GBC Deputies Committee be amended to:

All Deputies should attend the annual GBC Meetings in Sridham Mayapur and assist the GBC Body in its deliberations. This shall include:

1. All proposals submitted to the GBC must first go through the Deputies for their review; exceptions to this rule may be made by a unanimous vote of the GBC EC or a majority vote of the GBC body for individual proposals.

2. The GBC Deputies Committee may also consider additional topics referred to it by the GBC Executive Committee, as well as proposals from amongst its own members, and to prepare draft legislation from these deliberations for consideration and voting by the GBC Body; and
3. Participating in various subcommittees and/or attending to other duties as assigned by the Executive Committee.
4. All Deputies should, where possible, make themselves available to assist the GBC Executive Committee and Secretariat during the year in communicating with any ISKCON managers that an individual Deputy may be in contact with.

GBC Resolution 501.01 · 2023 · GBC Annual General Meeting, passed February 10, 2023

203.04 • Reinstating the positions of Assistant GBC and Acting GBC (2024)

[Statutory Regulation]

Whereas the process to become a Global Duty Officer and Zonal Supervisor prior to entering the GBC

Nomination process is effective in training potential nominees for GBC membership.

Whereas there is a provision to circumvent the current Nominations process by a 4/5ths vote of the GBC

under emergency or special circumstances;

Whereas some GBC members have asked the Nominations Committee to build in some further flexibility

and creativity in the current nomination process during the next 5 years of extreme shift in the GBC

membership and the time needed to get quality devotees in the future GBC pipeline.

Whereas the training and engagement of Zonal Supervisors is focused on local and zonal management

and that of Global Duty Officers on specific global functions in ISKCON which do not necessary require

travelling out of the zone unless specifically outlined in the GDO project.

Whereas the training and evaluation of future GBC nominees will be strengthened by their attending and

participating in GBC meetings along with in-service training and supervision.

Whereas the removal of the preliminary intervals of Assistant and Acting GBC deprives the individual and

the group of the advantages of nominees attending and participating in GBC meetings and other GBC

group engagements, sub-committee participation etc.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The positions of Assistant GBC and Acting GBC are reinstated.

The GBC Nominations Committee will assess the qualifications of each stage and report and recommend to the GBC.

Before becoming a GBC member with voting rights, one is required to first become an Assistant GBC and

later an Acting GBC under the guidance of a GBC member. This assumes a potential nominee has completed the existing nomination process as is currently in effect.

After at least one year, or maximum two, an Assistant GBC can become an Acting GBC by a 2/3rds vote of the GBC Body.

After at least one year, or maximum two, an Acting GBC may become a Full GBC with Voting rights by a 2/3rds vote of the GBC Body.

At either stage of the process, if the candidate is not confirmed to move to the next stage within the two-year period, the candidate will be dropped from the list. During the same period the candidate may decide to opt out as well.

GBC Resolution 203.04 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 8, 2024

ADDED · 2024

204.03 · Dates for 2025 GBC Annual General Meeting (2024)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The Annual General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

February 14–23, 2025, at ISKCON Mayapur, WB, India

GBC Resolution 204.03 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 1, 2024

204.02 · Improving GBC meetings (2025)

[Statement]

Whereas the GBC Executive Committee requested the GBC Organizational Development Committee to

propose improved functioning of the GBC, which includes meetings

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC body endorses the following steps to improve their AGM meeting. These should be achieved by

the Executive Committee engaging the guidance of experienced and trained facilitators and other advisors:

1. Streamlining Agendas: The GBC meetings should focus on essential agenda items to avoid time wastage on less critical matters as decided by the GBC EC. Survey results clearly indicate dissatisfaction with current agenda choice, pre-meeting preparation, and the way discussions are carried out. Only essential issues related to GBC responsibilities should be included, with other topics dealt with appropriately.
2. Enhancing Meeting Culture: Encourage strict punctuality, adherence to the GBC code of honor, and full focus on meeting proceedings so that they don't drag on.
3. Improving Venue and Format: Develop better arrangements in Mayapur including better room layout, technological enhancements, etc.
4. Effective Meeting Processes:
 - a. Pre-meeting Preparation: Always distribute agendas in advance with clear goals for each topic. Strictly delegate all topics that are not essential for the GBC to discuss, including proposals that the Deputies are analyzing.
 - b. During Meetings: Effective time management to keep discussions on track. Appropriate use Robert's Rules of Order and appropriate use of tried and true facilitation processes guided by the GBC Code of Honor.
 - c. Post-meeting Follow-up: Effective follow-up on action items and timely and appropriate communication of resolutions.
5. Encouraging Full Participation:
 - a. Facilitator/Chairman to use standard processes to encourage full GBC participation during the meetings, such as increased group discussions.
 - b. At their discretion, the GBC EC may engage experienced, neutral facilitators to help facilitate the meetings under their direction.
 - c. Additional guidelines on meeting improvements are found in the Meeting Manual 2025 which was originally presented to the GBC in 2016.

GBC Resolution 204.02 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 16, 2025

ADDED · 2025

204.04 · Dates for 2026 GBC Annual General Meeting (2025)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The Annual General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

February 4-14, 2026, at ISKCON Mayapur, WB, India

GBC Resolution 204.04 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 22, 2025

ADDED · 2025

204.06 · Dates for 2025 GBC Midterm General Meeting (2025)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The Midterm General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

October 1-5, at Villaggio Hare Krishna, Italy

GBC Resolution 204.06 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 22, 2025

207.04 • Establishing the office of the GBC Parliamentarian (2025)

[Administrative order]

Whereas the GBC meetings must be conducted pursuant to the GBC Rules of Order;

Whereas it is in the interests of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness that matters raised in

GBC Meetings are discussed efficiently and fairly pursuant to the GBC Rules of Order to determine

appropriate actions to be taken;

Whereas members are not sufficiently conversant with the GBC Rules of Order;

Whereas the GBC Rules of Order grant the power to rule on questions of order and on the proper application of the rules to the GBC Chairman;

Whereas the GBC Rules of Order are lengthy, detailed and intended to respond to/cover all matters

associated with the conduct and procedure of GBC Meetings;

Whereas it is important for at least one attendee of the GBC meetings to be sufficiently conversant with the

GBC Rules of Order to advise the Chairman and other members about proper functioning of GBC meetings

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The office of Parliamentarian is hereby established.

That the GBC will review the function of the office of Parliamentarian five years after its establishment.

Definition

The Parliamentarian:

1. Is a non-voting participant in the GBC meetings who is an expert in interpreting and advising on the rules and procedures of all GBC Meetings, as set out in the GBC Rules of Order.
2. Participates in all GBC Meetings to which the GBC Rules of Order apply.
3. Does not make substantive points/arguments on the topics being discussed in any GBC Meeting except where such Parliamentarian is separately a Minister or any other non-GBC participant.
4. Takes an active part in GBC Meeting debates in order to ensure that they are conducted pursuant to the applicable GBC Rules of Order.
5. Is an impartial participant who maintains a good working relationship with the GBC Chairman and other members.

Powers

The role of the Parliamentarian:

1. Does not have voting rights.
2. Does not make substantive points/arguments on the topics being discussed in any GBC Meeting except where such Parliamentarian is separately a Minister or any other non-GBC officer.
3. May interject at any time during any GBC Meeting to carry out their duties.
4. Can conduct their duties outside of a GBC Meeting, including, but not limited to, advising the

Chairman and other members (as necessary) on the interpretation and/or application of the GBC Rules of Order.

5. Is a member of the GBC discussions conference.

Duties

The Parliamentarian:

1. Has a sufficient working knowledge of the GBC Rules of Order.
2. Provides to the Chairman and other members, by consultation or interjection, impartial guidance on the interpretation and application of the GBC Rules of Order.
3. Compiles an updated edition of the GBC Rules of Order and circulates this to members every two years.
4. Advises the GBC on the state of the GBC Rules of Order, including the requirement to modify, add or delete rules.
5. Advises the GBC Chairman (or presiding officer of the relevant GBC Meeting) to respond to points of order and parliamentary inquiries.
6. Maintains a good working relationship with the GBC Chairman and other members.

Selection process

The General Counsel of the GBC will nominate candidates for the office of Parliamentarian to the GBC.

The Parliamentarian is selected by a simple majority vote of the GBC.

Where a nominated candidate is not voted in by simple majority, the General Counsel will nominate another candidate.

The term of the Parliamentarian will be for 5 years or until such time the Parliamentarian resigns from the office or is deemed unfit by a two-thirds majority vote of the GBC.

There is no limit on the number of terms of office the Parliamentarian may hold.

GBC Resolution 207.04 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2026

204.04 · Dates for 2027 GBC Annual General Meeting (2026)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The Annual General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

February 21 to March 3, 2027, at ISKCON Mayapur, WB, India.

The detailed list of dates is below:

Sunday Feb 21 GBC Plenary

Monday Feb 22 GBC Plenary

Tuesday Feb 23 GBC Plenary

Wednesday Feb 24 GBC Plenary

Thursday Feb 25 ISKCON Leadership Sanga

Friday Feb 26 ISKCON Leadership Sanga

Saturday Feb 27 ISKCON Leadership Sanga

Sunday Feb 28 ISKCON Leadership Sanga

Monday Mar 01 GBC Plenary

Tuesday Mar 02 GBC Plenary

Wednesday Mar 03 Reserve Day

GBC Resolution 204.04 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

204.06 · Dates for 2026 GBC Mid-term General Meeting (2026)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The Mid-term General Meeting of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission Society shall be held from

October 19-23, at Govardhan Eco-village, India.

GBC Resolution 204.06 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

4 ISKCON Ministries

4.1 Definition

A Minister is appointed by the GBC Body for each Statement of Mission. He is an expert in the educational, regulatory, developmental, and planning aspects of his field. He acts as a professor and establishes the curriculum of his discipline and disseminates this knowledge throughout ISKCON. A Ministry is usually headed by a Minister.

A Minister shall be appointed by the GBC Body for each Statement of Mission.

4.2 General Duties

1. To oversee a Statement of Mission or specific area as assigned by the GBC Body.
2. To educate Zonal Secretaries and ISKCON Leaders how to take practical steps towards achieving the Statement of Mission and Progressive Goals.
3. To advise, assist, and promote the realization of the Statement of Mission or coordinate others to do so.
4. To monitor ISKCON's progress in relation to his Ministerial area including the progress towards the stated Mission, its Supporting Objectives, and the Progressive Goals for the world.
5. To work through the regular ISKCON administrators, and to try to further motivate them to achieve the Statement of Mission.
6. To make annual and other progress reports as necessary on the respective Statement of Mission.
7. To make observations on each Zonal Secretary's progress reports, and otherwise make special progress reports or studies in regard to a zone or other area, as required.
8. To appoint staff members, assistants, and advisers (who are experts in the field), as needed.
9. To liaise in the appointment of Continental or National coordinators with the local bodies.
10. To become expert in his field, and to act as a professor.
11. To establish the curriculum of his discipline and disseminate this knowledge throughout ISKCON.
12. To provide the GBC Body with reports on their assigned activities which shall include financial details such as assets, liabilities, expenditures, and income. Such reports are to be submitted to the GBC Corresponding Secretary at least forty-five days prior to the beginning of the annual meeting, and shall be distributed to all GBC members and made available to other concerned ISKCON officials upon request.

4.3 Guidelines

4.3.1 Preaching Vision and Goals for ISKCON in Relation to ISKCON Ministries

The following is accepted by the GBC Body as the preaching vision and goals for ISKCON.

4.3.1.1 *Goal and Strategy for Qualified Teachers*

1. Background

In order to maintain our devotees in the preaching spirit, they need to continually be utilizing their brain to its capacity and providing them with a challenging and meaningful learning experience within Krsna consciousness.

2. Goal

All ISKCON personnel who are teaching other devotees on any subject should obtain the ability and technique required to educate the students effectively.

3. Strategy

All ISKCON personnel who are teaching or intend to teach others on any subject should attend and pass the Teachers Training Course as soon as possible.

4. Action to be taken by

- a. All desirous of teaching.
- b. Teachers Training course organizers.

4.3.1.2 Goal and Strategy for Education Oriented Ministries

1. Background

The Book Distribution Minister reported great gains from his Book Distribution courses and trainers courses. It became evident that this should be the standard for all or most Ministries in ISKCON and that some more curriculums were urgently needed.

2. Goal

That every Ministry will have nicely developed curriculum and courses for imparting knowledge in their area of activity.

3. Strategy

Every Ministry shall submit the topics for which they need training courses to the Adult Education Minister who shall utilize his resources and work cooperatively to insure that high quality training manuals and courses are prepared for each Ministry. The Congregational Preaching Ministry is a top priority.

4. Action to be taken by each Minister, Ksetra Committee, Adult Education Minister and VTE.

4.3.1.3 Goal and Strategy for Seva-Oriented Ista-gosthi

1. Background

Devotees need to discuss their services amongst others doing the same or similar services in order to share their experiences and realizations. This has proved very effective in book distribution and congregational preaching.

2. Goal

To enliven devotees and provide them positive inputs about how to improve their services and to improve the spiritual bonding amongst them with Lord Krsna and devotional service in the center.

3. Strategy

The devotees engaged in the same activity in all fields should meet together and discuss their common service on a weekly basis (if not possible fortnightly or monthly). They should share their experiences, realizations, challenges and get input from others on how to overcome the difficulties. They encounter in this way, and they should improve their quality of service.

4. Action to be taken by GBC Zonal Secretaries, Temple Presidents, Department Heads, and general devotees.

4.3.1.4 Goal and Strategy for Training All Committed Devotees

1. Background

Many courses are and will increasingly be available in ISKCON.

To improve the quality, life and ability of the Temple Devotees and initiated or committed congregational devotees, training courses have proven to be highly successful.

2. Goal

That every committed devotee shall participate annually in some formal training program and obtain diplomas or certificates based on their performance.

3. Strategy

That every committed devotee should go through at least one course per year on a scheduled systematic basis.

4. Action to be taken by Temple Presidents, Congregational Preaching Directors and general devotees.

4.3.1.5 Goal and Strategy for Bhakti-sastri Implementation

1. Background

Utilizing the courses that Srila Prabhupada has given us would enliven devotees and improve their self-esteem and ability to preach Krsna consciousness. These courses should be administered from all temples, but somehow they are not easily available.

2. Goal

That temple devotees, initiated congregations, and other congregational members who desire, should become *bhakti-sastri* degree holders.

3. Strategy

To have the Education Ministry (or appropriate body) make available to all temples and GBC's, the standard materials necessary to administer *bhakti-sastri* courses and exams.

4. Action to be taken by Education Ministry and Temple Presidents.

4.3.1.6 Goal and Strategy for ISKCON Temples as Centers of Learning

1. Background

Now that the gradual orientation of the temples is changing, it is important to maintain the relevance of the temple through educating its adherents.

2. Goal

Every ISKCON temple will become a center of transcendental learning for both the residents, congregational devotees and members of the public. The temples shall provide training, degrees or diplomas, and titles for each major department of applied Krsna conscious activity.

3. Strategy # 1

The various Ministries shall identify the areas for training (as mentioned earlier) to include all applied and practical areas of training and with the Adult Education Ministry, develop course materials.

4. Strategy # 2

In addition, the great wealth of already trained personnel within ISKCON, or ISKCON alumni's who are available as resources, shall be identified. The Ministry of Education shall create a massive database of all skilled devotees in the world and identify who can become teachers in the following areas:

- a. Deity worship
- b. Cooking
- c. Congregational preaching
- d. Cow Protection
- e. Book distribution
- f. Preaching
- g. *asramas*
- h. Farming
- i. *Sastric* knowledge
- j. Fund development
- k. Temple management

5. Strategy # 3

"Baby step" courses should be established to make it more interesting and accessible for children and new congregational members.

6. Action to be taken by ISKCON temples, all Ministries and centers of learning. (97-105)

ADDED · 2022

454.02 · Preaching Vision Council: Change of Category (2022)

[Statement]

Whereas it is required for the smooth functioning of the GBC meetings that the Rules of Order are up-to-date and available to all members

Whereas the Rules of Order have not been updated for many years

Whereas in 2001 the following resolution was passed by the GBC:

Preaching Vision Council — 2001

That as part of the agenda of every Annual GBC Meeting, there shall be a Preaching Vision Council that shall plan strategies, define standards, and improve the quality of all ISKCON preaching.

Among the duties of the Council shall be:

1. Devising systems to encourage/develop the devotees' skills/abilities/proclivities through training and education,
2. Finding ways for the GBC and other leaders to facilitate preaching,
3. Discussing ways to increase the number of festivals,
4. Initiating or planning global events (like Srila Prabhupada's Centennial).

The method of implementing this shall be that every subcommittee of the GBC shall dedicate at least one full session to such work. The results of this shall then be presented in plenary for straw votes for at least one full session, then returned to each subcommittee for final work, and presented again to the plenary for final votes.

Whereas the Preaching Vision Council — 2001 was not formed and has not functioned.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That the Rule of Order "Preaching Vision Council" is recategorized as a Guideline.

GBC Resolution 454.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on July 27, 2022)

4.4 Individual ISKCON Ministries

4.4.1 Ministry of Emergencies

The Ministry of Emergencies is created to assist the Executive Committee to handle emergencies throughout the year which require personal resolution. (see GBC Rules of Order give details)

4.4.2 Ministry of Justice

4.4.2.1 Definition

The Ministry of Justice is recognized as fully authorized by the GBC to carry out the mandate described herein, given assurance of the participatory support of each GBC member which will be necessary to successfully execute the mandate described herein, and given sufficient resources to efficiently and effectively deal with grievances and complaints which arise within ISKCON.

4.4.2.2 Duties of the Minister of Justice

The Minister of Justice shall oversee the development, implementation and ongoing operation of complaint and dispute resolution mechanisms for the ISKCON community. The Minister of Justice shall be responsible for the creation of procedures and guidelines for resolution of disputes and the investigation of complaints.

4.4.2.3 Procedures for Resolution of Disputes

4.4.2.3.1 Investigation of Complaints

Devotee ombudspersons will be engaged to receive and investigate complaints. The ombudsperson will then work to achieve a satisfactory resolution of complaints through neutral analysis of the complaint presented; analysis of relevant instructions of Srila Prabhupada and the *sastras*, research of existing GBC resolutions, comparisons with procedures in other traditions (religious and secular), and the recommendation of changes in ISKCON procedures.

4.4.2.3.2 Mediation Services

Mediation involves an independent (neutral) third party who acts as a facilitator, hears both sides of the problem and helps devotees achieve a satisfactory resolution about the issues at hand. The mediator's primary function is to provide a forum where disputants can construct their own mutual agreement. Mediators work directly and in-depth with the parties in dispute and encourage discussion. No decisions are imposed by mediators but mediators do help devotees make their own decisions about what solutions will work for them.

4.4.2.3.3 Arbitration Services

Arbitration is more formal than mediation. In arbitration, the parties to a dispute select one or more neutral persons to serve as arbitrators for the dispute. As part of the arbitration, the parties usually agree in advance to accept the decision of the arbitrators as binding, although the decision may be merely a recommendation. Parties to the dispute present their case to the arbitrators in a common meeting. The arbitration proceeding may be informal or almost as formal as a legal trial, depending on the agreement of the parties.

Conflict Resolution (2001)

The GBC create a division under the Ministry of Justice for conflict resolution with responsibility to :

Be well informed about the process of conflict resolution;

Acquire and, if necessary, adapt resources on conflict resolution;

Disseminate information and guidelines on conflict resolution within ISKCON;

Provide education and training on conflict resolution;

Make their services available, when possible, to ISKCON centers and individuals;

Frame a network of devotees as conflict resolution consultants who may be able to assist, when requested, in different areas of ISKCON.

The mandate of the division is strictly to serve ISKCON centers and members when requested. Its primary function is educational with no executive mandate whatsoever.

4.4.2.4 Prevention of Development of Complaints and Disputes

4.4.2.4.1 Complaint Registry Services

The Ministry of Justice shall maintain a registry of complaints against devotees, quasi-devotees, and devotee organizations which either refuse to participate in the dispute resolution mechanisms above or who fail to abide by agreements reached. Thus the ISKCON community will have one place it can go to find out information of previous complaints against individuals or organizations. Essentially this shall serve like a Better Business Bureau.

4.4.2.4.2 Prevention Registry

Another aspect of this service shall be to maintain a registry of questionable characters who travel the ISKCON world. Such individuals may be listed with the Complaint Registry and information would be available upon request. As this service has the potential of being misused, listing and reporting will be subject to the discretion of the Minister of Justice.

4.4.2.4.3 Publishing Services

1. The Ministry of Justice will compile and disseminate information conducive to the education of the ISKCON community in respect to the above services.
2. In all instances the GBC Body will remain the ultimate authority for resolution of complaints and disputes in ISKCON, and as such shall, at its discretion, accept appeals from the processes described above.

4.4.2.4.4 Other Provisions

1. The Ministry will develop Continental Committees.
2. The above replaces the current Justice Committee in the GBC resolutions. As sections of the Ministry and procedures are developed, they shall be subject to revision by the GBC Body.
3. The Minister of Justice is to be fully acquainted with all the provisions in the Society's Memorandum of Association, Regulations and Rules of Order. He is to check all resolutions passed as being in line with these documents before they are made final. There should be legal review of all ISKCON resolutions before they are published.

4.4.3 Ministry of Communications

The ISKCON Ministry of Communications will be governed by a Board of Directors appointed by the GBC Body as its final authority.

1. Wherever the name "ISKCON Ministry of Public Affairs" exists in ISKCON legislation it shall be changed to "ISKCON Ministry of Communications" which is the current official name. The Minister of Public Affairs shall now be referred to as the Minister of Communications
2. The purposes and goals of the Ministry shall be as per the document "ISKCON Communications Charter", dated February 13, 1991 and filed with the Corresponding Secretary, or as they may be modified by the Board of Directors in the future and reported in writing to the GBC Body. (91)
3. The Board of Directors of the Ministry of Communications will meet annually in Mayapur, and additionally as necessary, to review and set policies and goals for the Ministry. (91)

4.4.4 Ministry of Finance and Management

4.4.4.1 Duties

1. To provide the Society with a description of the Ministry's present available services
2. To recruit staff for the office of the Ministry to help in:
 - a. Correspondence
 - b. Data collection and consolidation
 - c. Investigation
 - d. Treasurer function
3. To recruit assistance to provide the following services for the society at large:

- a. Business consultancy
 - b. Real estate advisory
 - c. Investment advisory
 - d. Advit and investigation advisory
 - e. Fund raising advisory
 - f. Financial systems and EDP advisory
 - g. Research department and manual development
4. To correspond with all BBT directors as well as all other international projects to ensure proper systems, propriety with objectives and policies, efficiency, reporting to all donors and directors, and audit if necessary.
5. To collect annual financial statements from each of the zones and consolidate the same for the GBC annual meeting.(86)

4.4.4.2 ISKCON Resource Manual

That the Minister of Management and Finance shall provide a manual, annually updated, detailing all resources at the disposal of ISKCON Leaders during the year and during their annual meetings.

It shall contain lists detailing

- 1. GBCs
- 2. Ministers
- 3. Standing Committees
- 4. GBC Deputies
- 5. Divisional Councils
- 6. The ISKCON Law Book
- 7. ISKCON Management Guidelines
- 8. An ISKCON Directory containing all addresses, e-mail addresses, phone and fax numbers of ISKCON Centers.

4.4.4.3 ISKCON Central Secretariat

4.4.4.3.1 Definition

The ISKCON central secretariat shall facilitate the management of ISKCON. The ICS (ISKCON Central Secretariat) is organized and managed by the Finance and Management Minister.

4.4.4.3.2 Duties

- 1. Create and maintain a database of information of all temples in the World and Minister's areas of responsibility.
- 2. Develop and implement a practical system of reporting by consulting Ministers, GBC's and Temple Presidents as to what they require, desire and are capable of providing. As far as possible, implementation shall be done through 'regional' Committees (Regional, National, Zonal or Continental as the case may be).
- 3. Develop a database that may contain statistical information of:
 - a. Temple Finances (assets & liabilities, Annual income & expenses)
 - b. Temples/Managers Contacts (addresses, phone/fax, etc.)

- c. Details of owned properties
 - d. Complete data on all transactions with Temple buildings.
 - e. Progress towards fulfilling mission statements.
 - f. Annual reports for all Ministries.
 - g. Devotee bio-data.
 - h. And any other information deemed useful
4. Present reports shall in a format useful for the individual Ministers, GBC Zonal Secretaries, Committees, and ISKCON Leaders.

Provide global status reports on ISKCON international projects. Areas which are declared as a security risk for reporting purposes may not have to report. This arrangement can be made between the local GBC and the Secretariat.(96)

Full-time Secretariat Office (2000)

A full-time Secretariat Office shall be established in Mayapur.

The office shall work directly under the Executive Committee which shall take necessary steps towards organizational improvement.

ADDED · 2023

450.03 · Establishing a Committee to Identify CPO Director (2023)

[Statement]

Resolved that: The GBC hereby forms a committee composed of the Executive Support Office, along with Navin Krishna Das, Champakalata Devi, Chaitanya Mangala Das, Govinda Lilamrita Devi, the regional CPO Directors, and the CPO advisor Anuttama Das, to identify qualified candidates for CPO directorship. The current CPO Director, Kamalesh Krishna Das, will be consulted in this process.

GBC Resolution 450.03 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed December 13, 2023

ADDED · 2024

450.01 · Child Protection Office Policy Manual Update (2024)

[Statement]

Protection Policy Manual

Resolved that:

The revised ISKCON Child Protection Office Policy and Operational Guidelines are hereby approved by the GBC.

GBC Resolution 450.01 · 2024 · Online General Meeting, passed December 13, 2023

450.03 · Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC) (2025)

[Statement]

Oversight Committee (CPOC)

Whereas the GBC recognizes that its resolution dated January 3, 2025, has met with mixed response from the Regional Governing Bodies and Regional Child Protection Offices around the world. We also recognize that the SABHA officially returned the proposal, as SABHA is empowered to do, and asked for the GBC to reconsider it

Whereas after reviewing the SABHA, RGB, and local CPO concerns, we modify our previous January 3 decision with the following additional resolution

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The Minister of Justice will serve as the transitional ICPO Director for a period of 3-9 months.

A comprehensive handover process by the current ICPO Director to the transitional ICPO Director shall be conducted. This process shall include, but is not limited to, the transfer of all case file notes, status reports, and contact information for panelists and investigators, with particular attention to incomplete case files. Additionally, all relevant databases—covering complaints, offenders, Child Protection Teams (CPTs), and panelists—must be fully transferred by the current ICPO Director to the transitional ICPO Director, to ensure continuity and oversight.

During this transitional time, the Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC) is directed to:

1. Engage in further consultation with the regional CPO directors, RGBs, and other stakeholders.
2. Implement the new enhanced approach parallel with the existing ICPO model and Guidelines using cases reported after 1 March 2025, in consultation with the transitional ICPO director and the applicable regional CPO directors, to test the enhanced model, identify problems, and further refine the model.
3. Give special consideration to issues raised regarding professional investigators; cross-jurisdictional issues; inconsistent standards, definitions and response to abuse across regions; regional case review bias; revision/update of existing CPO Policies and Guidelines; funding; etc.
4. Establish regional CPOs in areas where none exist and, where necessary, form collaborative relationships between regional CPOs as well as deploy resources where needed.
5. Provide feedback and results from the trial period to the GBC by no later than October 30, 2025, as to the readiness of the existing CPOs to implement the enhanced approach.

GBC Resolution 450.03 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 21, 2025

450.03 · Special Interim Review Panels (2026)

[Action Order]

Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC)

Whereas in the transition to the Enhanced Approach Child Protection System, some child protection matters were left unresolved, and reliable case records were never handed over or are incomplete.

Whereas the lack of case resolution coupled with the non-handover of the files has disrupted the transition framework under which the Interim Director was expected to finalize pending CPO cases including appeals.

Whereas withheld files, incomplete adjudications and unaddressed appeals cause ongoing distress for victims, accused devotees, families, and communities while continuing unresolved restrictions without closure is contrary to ISKCON's duty of care and compassion.

Whereas protecting children is an act of devotional care, requiring timely, fair, and consistent resolution.

Whereas legal consultation confirms that, in case of litigations, civil courts generally defer to a religious body's highest authority when fair and transparent internal procedures exist.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC hereby authorizes the establishment of Special Interim Review Panels (SIRPs), operating under the oversight of the Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC), to address pending child protection matters without final adjudication and/or appeals, expressly excluding all cases that have already been fully

adjudicated and where the appeal has not been lodged within the 60-day deadline from the date of the CPO decision in a particular case.

CPOC and ISKCON's Law Department will work together to identify and select qualified members for the Special Interim Review Panels.

The Special Interim Review Panels shall follow the adjudication and appeal procedures set out in the CPO Guidelines 2023. If compelling issues arise outside the scope of the CPO Guidelines 2023, the Special Interim Review Panels shall seek guidance from CPOC, which may consult the ISKCON Law Department to ensure the highest level of procedural integrity.

A Special Interim Review Panel shall issue a written, reasoned, and internally coherent determination to achieve procedural closure.

Appeals:

In the event that an appeal is permitted or required under the applicable procedures, the appeal shall be heard by a newly constituted Special Interim Review Panel composed of members who did not participate in the original adjudication.

This appellate Special Interim Review Panel shall review the matter in accordance with the CPO Guidelines

2023 and shall issue a written, reasoned, and internally coherent determination, which shall constitute the final decision within the Special Interim Review Panel process.

Upon the complete handover of all case files from the former International Child Protection Office, Special

Interim Review Panels shall not be given any further matters and shall only complete the cases that they have already commenced.

450.03 · Ownership and retrieval of historical case records (2026)

[Statement]

Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC)

Whereas the GBC established the Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC) to reform and strengthen ISKCON's child protection governance under the Enhanced Approach to Child Protection.

Whereas the GBC appointed an Interim International Child Protection Office Director for a defined transitional period, explicitly requiring the full handover of all child protection case files and records from the previous International Child Protection Office and its Director.

Whereas despite explicit GBC directives and Executive Committee file notes, a complete handover of institutional case files has not occurred, and a substantial portion of files remains in the possession of a former officeholder, which is a direct non-compliance with the GBC resolution 450.03 dated February 21, 2025:

"A comprehensive handover process by the current ICPO Director to the transitional ICPO Director shall be conducted. This process shall include, but is not limited to, the transfer of all case file notes, status reports, and contact information for panelists and investigators, with particular attention to incomplete case files. Additionally, all relevant databases—covering complaints, offenders, Child Protection Teams (CPTs), and panelists—must be fully transferred by the current ICPO Director to the transitional ICPO Director, to ensure continuity and oversight."

Whereas certain regional authorities have transferred some files from their custody, confirming that such a handover is both feasible and appropriate.

Whereas the continued retention of institutional case files by unauthorized individuals has directly obstructed the processing of appeals, impeded due process, and caused ongoing ethical, pastoral, and operational harm.

Whereas all child protection case files—physical or digital—are the sole institutional property of ISKCON, and claims of personal custodianship or generalized data-protection objections do not supersede lawful institutional governance.

Whereas the failure to secure these files exposes ISKCON, GBC, and duly appointed bodies to escalating legal, regulatory, and reputational risk, while they are unable to act without access to records.

Whereas in a written statement to the GBC EC on December 15, 2025, the former International CPO Director stated that he is not able to transfer the data due to obligations under the UK data-protection law (UK General Data Protection Regulation Law).

Whereas the ISKCON's General Counsel sought guidance from Taylor Wessing, a well-established London-based international law firm, which confirmed that, under current UK GDPR law, the case files are the property of the GBC, which determined the purposes and means of the data processing, and that the former International CPO Director has no legal standing in relation to the files, having acted solely as an agent of the GBC rather than as an owner, controller, or processor of the data, and that by restricting access to the data he is in breach of UK GDPR.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. Institutional Ownership Affirmed

The GBC formally reaffirms that all child protection case files are the exclusive property of ISKCON and must be held only by currently authorized child protection bodies.

2. Immediate Handover Required

Any individual or entity retaining such files without current authorization is hereby directed to transfer all records—complete, unaltered, and without condition—to the custody designated by CPOC. Access to the digital files is to be provided within 14 days of the adoption of this resolution. The physical files are to be provided within 45 days of the adoption of this resolution.

3. Decentralized Retrieval Authorized

In the event that there is persisting non-compliance, the GBC Body, in coordination with relevant GBC Zonal Secretaries and regional authorities, shall ensure the handover of the case files from wherever they are currently being held in the stipulated time period.

4. Legal Enforcement Permitted

The GBC authorizes ISKCON's General Counsel to arrange for the issuing of formal legal notices and, if necessary, initiate appropriate civil proceedings to secure the recovery of institutional records withheld.

5. Urgent Remedial Action

In the event of non-retrieval of the files, and in light of the emergency currently confronting ISKCON, the GBC will convene an urgent meeting with CPOC to consider proposed solutions to the practical issues resulting from the continued unavailability of the files and their operational consequences.

6. Liability Clarified

Any continued retention, alteration, or obstruction relating to ISKCON child protection files shall be deemed a serious breach of trust, with personal liability resting solely on those acting in conflict with this resolution.

7. Reporting Requirement

CPOC shall report progress on file recovery to the GBC Executive Committee within the specific timeframes mentioned above until full resolution is achieved.

GBC Resolution 450.03 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 9, 2026

4.4.4.4 ISKCON Foundation Training Centers

The ISKCON Foundation is blessed and encouraged to establish ISKCON Training Centers in different continents and shall be responsible for their direction and proper management under the guidance of the Management and Finance Ministry. They shall also arrange the required operating expenses by setting up ISKCON Foundation chapters in the local areas and engaging interested congregational members, who will be nominated by the local Temple Presidents and Zonal GBCs and will serve under their direction.

They shall work in close continuous cooperation with the respective local temples to assist the GBC Ministers and GBC Zonal Secretaries in their work of training ISKCON temple and congregational devotees by:

1. organizing seminars and courses in all Ministry areas
2. providing materials and resources for training
3. providing ongoing consultation and advice
4. employing/engaging full/part-time or volunteer staff trained by GBC Ministers and Zonal Secretaries to do the above
5. gather data and information and communicate such with the appropriate entities.

4.4.5 Ministry of Fund Development and Life Patron Membership

4.4.5.1 Duties and Purposes

1. To develop a worldwide congregation of devotees from the Indian community.
2. To inspire those devotees to regularly engage their body, mind, and wealth in the service of Lord Krsna.
3. To educate the leaders and other devotees of ISKCON to see the Indian community as our best ally and to develop training programs in how the community should be cultivated.
4. To create facilities for Indian community members to take on major responsibilities within ISKCON.
5. To provide programs to inspire the youth of the Indian community to become Krsna Conscious.
6. To encourage within ISKCON the development of purely vaisnava cultural presentations which will attract non-resident Indians by filling the cultural vacuum they experience.
7. To inspire those born in India to take up the order of Lord Caitanya to preach the message of Lord Krsna all over the world.
8. To establish and supervise administrative offices all over the world for the coordination of services for ISKCON Life Members.
9. To establish and implement international standards for ISKCON Life Membership.
10. To re-establish the International Life Membership Newsletter. (91)

4.4.6 Ministry of Health and Welfare

4.4.6.1 Duties

The Health and Welfare Ministry should produce a booklet about what AIDS is, how it is communicated, how to prevent it. This booklet should be practical and not alarmist.

ADDED · 2021

410 · Dissolution of Ministry of Health and Welfare (2021)

[Action order]

RESOLVED:

That the ISKCON Ministry of Health & Welfare is hereby dissolved.

The GBC Body expresses its gratitude for HH Prahladananda Swami's thirty years of service as the Minister of Health & Welfare.

GBC Resolution 410 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on November 24, 2021)

4.4.7 ISKCON Youth Ministry

4.4.7.1 Duties

1. To establish and maintain a Youth Ministry Office.
2. To develop a world-wide database of second generation devotee youth.
3. To develop a world-wide database of training and occupational opportunities for the second generation youth.
4. To facilitate the connection of devotees from the above two subsets.
5. To produce a bimonthly newsletter describing this ongoing training and placement.

6. To attend the Mayapur GBC meetings, and that he/she may elect one other second generation young adult to attend the meetings with him/her in his/her place with the approval of the GBC Executive Committee.(96)

4.4.7.2 Powers

The Youth Ministry can internationally

- a. access ISKCON mailing lists and audiences.
- b. establish reps. in various parts of the world [North European rep., etc.]

A period of 15-30 minutes be designated annually at a GBC Plenary Session for a report from the Youth Minister.

4.4.7.3 Youth Members

1. *Gurukula* graduates and youth who have been raised in our ISKCON family are to receive a special ISKCON Youth Membership status offering them free *prasadam* and accommodation at any ISKCON temple for one week per year per temple (provided they are respectful and follow temple rules.) Membership certificates shall be issued by the ISKCON Youth Ministry on renewable five year terms to individuals in good standing.
2. All ISKCON departments, projects, businesses, and other enterprises controlled by ISKCON members are strongly encouraged to seek out, train and employ ISKCON *Gurukula* graduates and other youth raised in ISKCON. Wherever feasible, such youth shall be given priority over others.
3. ISKCON temple *asramas* have an obligation to provide room and board to *Gurukula* graduates and other youth raised in ISKCON while they are pursuing further education and training at colleges, universities, or from our own skilled devotees. Such youth living in ISKCON *asramas* must be of good character and are expected to be respectful, follow the temple rules, and attend the morning program. Whenever possible (for example, when there is an income from parents, financial aid, etc.), they should make regular donations to the temple. ISKCON Temple Presidents shall do everything feasible to fulfill this obligation to any youth certified and approved by ISKCON Youth Ministry.(97-302)

4.4.8 Women's Ministry

4.4.8.1 Duties

The Ministry is to address the following concerns in a clear, mature, and deliberate manner:

1. Appreciating the contribution of ISKCON's female devotees.
2. Increasing understanding of the serious concerns of women in ISKCON.
3. Providing facility, communication and support for all female members of ISKCON.
4. Addressing issues of abuse and sexual impropriety in ISKCON.
5. Defining the different female devotee situations (e.g. *grhastha* women, older, renounced women, and *brahmacarinis*).

Working with temple authorities and GBCs to identify role models and encourage them to inspire and train junior Vaisnavis.

Grhastha & Community Development Ministry (1998)

Grahastha Ministry is renamed as “The Grhastha & Community Development Ministry” vide IGBCS AGM 1998 resolution.

The purpose of this Ministry is to:

Develop Grhastha Education Program and encourage establishment of guilds and chambers of commerce;

Offer and help to develop varnasrama colleges in co-ordination with the Ministry for Social Development Information.

Be a catalyst for the development of social structure of ISKCON according to Srila Parbhupada, svision.

4.4.9 Other Ministries

Ministry of Education: See Chapter 13 "Education" (page. 125)

Ministry of Records

Ministry of Congregational Development:

See Chapter 15 "Congregational Development" (page. 131)

Ministry of *Sannyasa* Services: See section on *Sannyasa*

Ministry of Vaisnava Cultural History

Ministry of Book Distribution: See Chapter 14 "Sankirtana - Book Distribution" (page. 127)

Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture (Chapter 14) (1998)

New material since 2018 — placement to be confirmed

406.2 · Milk from Protected Cows (2019)

[Guideline]

(Proposed by Hridaya Caitanya Das, sponsored by him and Devamrita Swami)

Whereas the current commercial dairy systems of the world in which the older cows, practically all

bulls, young and old, and most female calves are slaughtered is thoroughly condemned and abhorrent;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada wrote in this regard: “These greatly sinful acts are responsible for all the

troubles in present society.” (SB 1.17.3 Purport);

Whereas ISKCON is established for more than 50 years and has matured to a stage where it is possible to establish alternative supplies of “ahimsa milk” or dairy from farms where all cows and bulls

are protected for life;

Whereas ISKCON's 6th purpose is “to bring the members closer together for the purpose of teaching

a simpler and more natural way of life”;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada desired that urban ISKCON centers should be connected to rural ISKCON farming communities where devotees would produce food and milk to supply the urban centers;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada stated that we should keep the cows very happy and without fear and they will produce double quantity of milk;

Whereas several ISKCON projects have demonstrated the feasibility of supplying ahimsa milk;

Whereas ISKCON's Ministry for Agriculture and Cow Protection is prepared to support the development of ahimsa dairy;

Whereas in ISKCON many installed Deities do not get milk from slaughter-free cows;

Whereas continuing ISKCON's indirect support of the cow slaughter industry by consuming dairy from

this industry, if based solely on financial reasons, calls into question the sincerity of ISKCON's commitment to cow protection:

Resolved:

By Janmastami 2022 all ISKCON centers should develop a plan whereby all milk and milk products

— butter, ghee, yogurt etc. — offered to the deities are procured from protected cows. The centers may approach the International Ministry of Cow Protection for assistance.

GBC Resolution 406.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

406.4 · ISKCON Ministry for Cow Protection and Agriculture Standing Annual Presentation to the GBC Body (2019)

[Rule of Order]

(Proposed by Kalakantha Das, and sponsored by Praghosa Das and Hrdaya Caitanya Das)

Whereas when cow protection supports brahminical culture, then, as per the instructions of our Founder-Acarya, it will bring prosperity to ISKCON and its members;

Whereas it is often seen that in projects where cow protection and agricultural practices are below the

minimum standards allowed in ISKCON Law, it is a result of zonal and local management not knowing the standards;

Whereas GBC members and other leaders of ISKCON may not have the time to learn appropriate standards for ISKCON farms;

Whereas although the maintenance of proper standards is the responsibility of the local managers, ultimately it is the responsibility of the zonal management to make sure that the local managers are

fulfilling their responsibilities;

Whereas other primary activities of ISKCON such as book distribution and Deity worship have standing annual presentation time at the AGM, and discussion of ISKCON's 6th purpose with a focus

on cow protection and agriculture is similarly worthy of the GBC Body's attention and awareness:

Resolved:

Each year at the AGM in Mayapur, the ISKCON Ministry for Cow Protection and Agriculture will be

allocated 30 minutes at the discretion of the EC to present a report on cow protection and agriculture

in ISKCON, particularly with a focus on regional developments on standards and certificates of readiness.

GBC Resolution 406.4 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

406.4 • Cow protection Certificate of Readiness (2019)

[Governing Law]

(Proposed by Kalakantha Das, and sponsored by Niranjana Swami and Praghosa Das)

Whereas Srila Prabhupada has stated, “Progressive human civilization is based on brahminical culture, God consciousness and protection of cows.” [SB1.19.3]

Whereas according to Srila Prabhupada’s instructions a minimum standard for Cow Protection should

be maintained in ISKCON (Ratified in ISKCON Law 507 of 1999);

Whereas there are currently cows and bulls that are not being cared for properly;

Whereas it is unacceptable that ISKCON centres start cow protection programs without enough preparation or knowledge of cow protection and its connection with agriculture and the reasons for

protecting cows and bulls, which increases the burden on ISKCON, its members and the GBC body;

Whereas the ISKCON Ministry for Cow Protection and Agriculture has the capacity to assess the ability of an ISKCON centre to protect cows and understand its connection with agriculture;

Whereas cow protection initiatives are started without enough consideration for their ongoing maintenance;

Whereas there are several cow protection initiatives that are of a questionable nature:

Resolved:

In order to start a cow protection project that will be accredited within ISKCON and accepted as an

ISKCON supported project, a “Cow protection Certificate of Readiness” needs to be obtained.

The following are the requirements for obtaining such a certificate, which will allow new cow protection projects to commence their operations:

1. The GBC Minimum Cow protection Standards ISKCON Law 507(1999) needs to be read and fully understood before applying for the certificate.
2. An exam must be taken and passed. The questions in the exam will be based on the content of Law 507.
3. A well-thought-out business plan with the signature of the GBC member must be presented to the Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture.

Details regarding the content that must be addressed in the business plan are provided below in order to assist in its preparation:

Centers may not make any commitments or agreements regarding procuring and/or acquiring cows

until the “Cow Protection Certificate of Readiness” is granted. The “Certificate of Readiness” applies

only to an ISKCON registered property to which it is granted and is not a generic permanent approval.

The Certificate of Readiness is valid for up to 180 days beyond the initial scheduled acquisition date.

If the 180-day period has elapsed without the set up being completed, the center will be reassessed by the ISKCON Ministry for Cow protection and Agriculture for a new Certificate of Readiness to be

issued.

The Cow protection Certificate of Readiness will be assessed by a local representative (from the temple concerned); the local GBC, regional leadership (which may include a representative from

the National Council or RGB, etc.); and an ISKCON Cow protection and Agriculture (IMCPA) accredited representative. The GBC Executive Committee will be informed of the assessment outcome. The initial contact: The centre wanting to commence a Cow protection Program makes an application via the IMCPA's website. After receiving this application which includes a business plan signed by the local GBC, IMCPA contacts local GBC and regional authorities to assess the viability of the application by their business plan and test. If process shows the centre has made a proper analysis of requirements for Cow protection which includes agriculture and is moving in the right direction regarding the proper allocation resources, etc. for cow protection, then the first stage approval is given. This then enables the temple to make arrangements to acquire cows and commence fund-raising, etc. The second and final stage will be assessed based on the findings of a site visit by an IMCPA accredited representative, or comprehensive consultation with concerned devotees.

GBC Resolution 406.4 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

407.6 · Formal Acceptance of Deity Ministry Position Papers (2019)

[Position statement]

(Proposed by Nrsimha Kavaca Das and sponsored by Bhanu Swami and Praghosa Das)

Whereas there are different opinions on whether Srimati Radharani's feet may be shown in public and

whether the general public can participate in the bathing of temple deities on festival days;

Whereas the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry has prepared position papers establishing uniform policies on these matters:

Resolved:

The two position papers, "ISKCON Temple Abhisekas" and "Showing Radharani's Lotus Feet" are accepted as ISKCON's official position on these topics

GBC Resolution 407.6 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

413.1 · Amendment to ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services Policies Manual (2019)

[Action order]

(Proposed by Prahladananda Swami and Sponsored by him and Bhakti Caitanya Swami)

Whereas changes to the ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services' Policy Manual must be approved by

the GBC;

Whereas there is a need to clarify the appeal process concerning decisions made by the Sannyasa Standing Committee:

Resolved:

That the ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services' Policy Manual appeal process section will now read:

If the sannyasi wishes to appeal a decision, he has six months to do so. The sannyasi must first present his appeal to the GBC Executive Committee. The sannyasi's appeal must be made in writing and state all evidence and reasoning why the decision should be overturned or modified. The sannyasi should also send a copy of his appeal to the Sannyasa Standing Committee. If a majority of the GBC Executive Committee agrees, the appeal will be presented to the GBC Body. A decision concerning an appeal will be made by a majority vote of the GBC

<http://mcpa.iskcon.org/>

<http://mcpa.iskcon.org/>

<http://deityworship.com/assets/idwm-position-on-iskcon-temple-abhisekas.pdf>

<http://deityworship.com/assets/idwm-position-on-showing-radharani-s-lotus-feet.pdf>

Body. However, during any appeal, the original decision remains in effect. A sannyasi who does not abide by the decision shall be subjected to penalties according to ISKCON Law.

Grounds for appeal can be based on:

1. an error in applying the legal principles or rules for arriving at the decision (e.g., incorrect standard of proof applied) or
2. an error in fact (e.g. the facts were incorrectly understood by the decision-maker) or
3. on the grounds of procedural irregularity (e.g. inadmissible evidence such as hearsay evidence was accepted by the decision maker) or
4. severity of sentencing (as referenced in section six – Disciplinary Steps – of the Sannyasa Policy Manual.)

GBC Resolution 413.1 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

421.1 · Global Devotee Care Course Education (2019)

[Guideline]

(Proposed by Gauranga Das and sponsored by Anuttama Das and Revati Raman Das)

Whereas caring for devotees (vaisnava-seva) is one of the three cardinal principles given by Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada was himself a personification of devotee care (example, he built the Lotus

Building before the Mayapur temple to facilitate devotees);

Whereas there is benefit to ISKCON to develop devotee communities that are spiritually vibrant and

materially stable;

Whereas, often devotees leave or develop bitterness towards the movement due to inadequate devotee care:

Resolved:

That the GBC encourages all ISKCON Temples to hold the four-day Devotee Care Course entitled,

“Embedding Care in Krishna Conscious Communities” for all caregivers and administrators.

The course can be conducted in 24 hours:

spread over 8 days of 3 hours each

or two weekends of 6 hours per day

or any other permutation or combination that suits the local yatras.

GBC Resolution 421.1 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

423.3 · Calendar updates: Necessary adjustments to the observances shown on ISKCON calendars (2019)

[Statement]

(proposed by GBC Vaisnava Calendar Committee and sponsored by Bhanu Swami and Hrdaya Caitanya Das)

Whereas ISKCON Calendar calculations were originally derived from the Gaudiya Panjika published

by the Chaitanya Math in Mayapur;

Whereas it has come to the attention of the committee that there are two observances, originally taken from that source that are incorrect and need adjustment:

According to the research of the committee, the observance of "Lalita Sasti" two days before Radhastami appears to be based on the Bengali tradition of the appearance of the manifestation of Durga named "Lalita". The Gaudiya Panjika does not list appearance days for any of the sakhis of Srimati Radharani. According to Radha Krishna Ganodesa Dipika by Srila Rupa Goswami, Lalita Sakhi actually appeared twenty seven days before Radha:

tatradya lalita-devi syad astasu varyasi

priya-sakhya bhavaj jyestha sapta vimsati-vasaraih||79||

Among the eight principal sakhis, Lalita is the best. She is older than Radha by twenty-seven days.

Also, according to research, the observance of "the appearance of Radha Kund" on the astami of the dark fortnight of Kartik month is incorrect and the event should be observed on Caitra Purnima.

And whereas, ISKCON devotees, encouraged by the BBT Trustees, have recently started major book

distribution programs centered around Bhadra Purnima, and it would be appropriate to add this observance to the ISKCON calendar:

Resolved:

Therefore, the GBC Body endorses the recommendation of the GBC Vaisnava Calendar Committee

that it may proceed as follows:

1. That the observance of "Lalita Sasti" be removed from the calendar.
2. That the observance of the "Appearance of Radhakund" be shifted to Caitra Purnima.
3. That the observance of Bhadra Purnima be added to the calendar.

GBC Resolution 423.3 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

426.15 • Formal Recognition of Legal Development Committee (2019)

[Administrative order]

(proposed by Sesa Das and sponsored by him and Prahladananda Swami)

Whereas ISKCON requires common standards, policies, and procedures for managing investigations

of misconduct or abuse, in instituting corrective and rehabilitative consequences for offenders, as well

as in restorative justice for all involved when guilt is established;

Whereas ISKCON requires policies and processes to address disputes and dispute resolutions that are based on equity, impartiality, fairness, and timeliness, and these should be of such caliber that all

ISKCON entities will honor and utilize them;

Whereas internal ISKCON investigations, in principle, are based on the enforcement of ecclesiastical

standards and acceptable moral and ethical behavior of ISKCON devotees, and as such they will not

supersede any secular criminal investigations;

Whereas there is a need to encourage respectful, honest and ethical behavior among ISKCON members;

Whereas a judicial system in ISKCON should promote a feeling of confidence and well-being in its

members, it should seek to spiritually rehabilitate offenders wherever possible, and it should serve to

protect devotees from harm, restore faith and well-being in those offended, and create in the society

an environment of high spiritual integrity:

Resolved:

That the GBC Body hereby recognizes that an “ISKCON Legal Development Committee” has been

created by the ISKCON Ministry of Justice and has been delegated the following responsibilities:

1. To develop and confirm all judicial policies and procedures with the GBC Body to effectively address transgressions and misconduct of ISKCON members.
2. To develop judicial policies and procedures for effectively dealing with disputes and dispute resolution when ISKCON Resolve is unable to resolve the problem. This includes reestablishing the ISKCON Dispute Resolution Office (IDRO).
3. To create a team of trained and qualified investigators, including those who speak languages other than English, that will be available for deployment as needed.
4. To create a team of trained and qualified judges, including those who speak languages other than English, that will be available to deal with matters as needed.
5. To create training programs (online and classroom courses) for investigators and judges.
6. To set up a system to mentor new investigators and judges and to monitor performance of investigators and judges on an ongoing basis.
7. To keep confidential records of all cases in a secure environment.
8. To coordinate its efforts with the GBC Body and all ISKCON Ministries and Committees.
9. To create a website that will provide resources and information to ISKCON devotees and ISKCON entities regarding ISKCON judicial matters.

Committee Members:

Chair: Prahladananda Swami, GBC, Minister, Sannyasa Ministry
 Vice Chair: Champakalata Dasi, Attorney (South Africa) and Director of the ISKCON Office for Prevention of Leadership Misconduct
 Devakinandana Das: Attorney (Singapore), Director ISKCON Legal Office
 Hansarupa Das: Professional investigator, former Director of ISKCON Ethics, Standards and Compliance Office (Mayapur), Temple President, ISKCON Brooklyn
 Kamlesh Krishna Das: Child Protection Professional, Director, ISKCON Child Protection Office
 Praharana Dasi: Professional Social Worker (MSW), Chair, North America GBC Leader Sexual Misconduct Committee
 Radha Dasi: Attorney (USA), Vaishnavi Minister, member of North American GBC Leader Sexual Misconduct Committee
 Sesa Das: Attorney (USA); GBC, Minister, ISKCON Ministry of Justice
 Vraja Vihari Das: Dispute resolution professional, Director ISKCON Resolve
 This resolution and the committee so created do not supersede the existence, duties, policies or independent status of the ISKCON International Child Protection Office.

GBC Resolution 426.15 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

429.2 · Law Book — Sections (2019)

[Rule of order]

(Proposed by Nrsimha Kavaca Das and sponsored by Madhu Sevita Das and Praghosa Das)

Whereas the current Law Book Committee has been working to make the body of GBC resolutions

more accessible to the members of ISKCON;

Whereas this has resulted in the development of a web-based database;

Whereas in order to focus the search feature of the database the search criteria must be very specific;

Whereas the resolutions have been sorted into clearly defined categories;

Whereas the proposed sections are based on the chapters of the 1996 printed Law Book;

Whereas the following was unanimously passed by the GBC at the AGM in 2016 but not recorded:

Resolved:

All proposals and resolutions must be sorted into the following sections:

- 100 – Srila Prabhupada
- 200 – Governing Body Commission
- 300 – International Society for Krishna Consciousness
- 400 – ISKCON Ministries and Committees
- 500 – Deputies, GDOs and Zonal Supervisors
- 600 – ISKCON spiritual leadership
- 700 – Gurus and disciples
- 800 – Appointments
- 900 – Financial and legal
- 2000 – Appendices

GBC Resolution 429.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

429.2 • Law Book — Categories (2019)

[Rule of order]

(Proposed by Nrsimha Kavaca Das and Sponsored by Madhu Sevita Das and Praghosa Das)

Whereas the categories use to classify resolutions passed by the GBC have evolved over time, as can be seen by the following:

1987:

1997:

All resolutions be categorized as a rule of order, law, or provisional order at the time of passing.

That all GBC resolutions shall be categorized as one of the following:

- a. Action Order (administrative, appointment, action oriented, directive or provisional orders, plus send to or form a committee, etc. that is temporary in nature and expires on completion)
- b. GBC Rule of Order (permanent in nature)
- c. ISKCON Law (permanent in nature)
- d. ISKCON Vision and Goal (time bound) (future planning, strategies, standing objectives which push on the preaching of the Society and position papers, statements of appreciation, etc. that are permanent in nature), and
- e. Guideline (behavior or action for ISKCON).

2010:

The following terms, when used as descriptions of the intent of GBC Resolutions and included in the language of the resolution when passed by the Body, shall henceforward have the following meanings:

1. LAW: A statement of principle applicable permanently to the whole of ISKCON.
1. GUIDELINE: A statement of principle recommended to be adopted by the whole of ISKCON.

2. RULE OF ORDER: A rule governing the internal functioning of the GBC Body.

The Rules of Order as a whole also form a default set of rules for the internal functioning of other ISKCON administrative bodies, to be followed as applicable to their various circumstances, unless the other body has specifically resolved that it shall function differently.

Laws, Guidelines, and Rules of Order, in order to have the effect of Laws, Guidelines, and Rules of Order as described in these definitions, must be declared as such within the language of the resolution when passed by the GBC Body. The GBC Executive Committee shall cause updated compilations of all current Laws, Guidelines, and Rules of Order to be maintained and regularly made available to the society.

Other declarations of categories shall be optional, and the intent of a resolution shall be determined by the wording of the resolution itself and not by the category declared.

Whereas the existing categorizations of GBC resolutions have been found to be inadequate, and to some degree inappropriate, for the present functioning of the GBC;

Whereas the intent of the above resolutions – to help minimize confusion and improve the resolutions’

usability – was partly accomplished, it has been found that not all resolutions fit neatly into one of these categories, and some mis-categorizations have increased confusion rather than reducing it;

Whereas a better policy will be to let the resolution speak for itself, with optional categorization included in the resolution wording when such is deemed helpful to convey the intent of the resolution;

Whereas for those resolutions that establish enduring principles, the GBC should provide standard definitions for the category terms;

Whereas the GBC directed the current ISKCON Law Book Committee to keep as much of the work of

the previous committee as possible, and;

Whereas the following was unanimously passed by the GBC at the AGM in 2016 but not recorded.

Resolved:

The following categories must be used to define any proposal being presented to the GBC Body to describe the intent of the proposal.

This language which will be included in the final resolution shall henceforward have the following meanings:

1. Constitutional principles

Enduring principles based on Prabhupada's teachings on how ISKCON should be organized.

Enduring features of ISKCON as per Prabhupada's teachings.

2. Governing laws:

Rules governing the practical functioning of ISKCON which are globally applicable.

3. Statutory regulations:

The Memorandum and Articles of Association which govern the internal functioning of the ISKCON GBC Society West Bengal.

4. Rules of order:

Procedures for the functioning of the GBC Body.

5. Administrative guidelines:

Detailed description of the practical application of laws. Includes Administrative Orders, Action Orders, Position Papers and Statements.

a. Administrative order:

Orders by which an administrative wing or branch of ISKCON with specific functions is created. E.g. a ministry or other functional unit that has an existence beyond the scope of the individuals performing the task.

b. Action order

A directive to a specific individual or group of individuals to perform a time bound task.

c. Position statements

Considered conclusions of the Body on particular subject matters.

d. Statements

Declarations setting forth decisions of the Body.

e. Guidelines

Guidance relative to setting standards or determining a course of action.

f. Votes of thanks

Statements of appreciation or recognition of outstanding service or contributions to ISKCON.

GBC Resolution 429.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

429.2 · Law Book — One Category per Resolution (2019)

[Rule of order]

(Proposed by Nrsimha Kavaca Das and sponsored by Madhu Sevita Das and Praghosa Das)

Whereas the current Law Book Committee has been working to make the body of GBC resolutions

more accessible to the members of ISKCON;

Whereas this has resulted in the development of a web-based database;

Whereas in order to focus the search feature of the database the search criteria must be very specific;

Whereas resolutions that have more than one category are more difficult to enter and refine the search.

Resolved:

All proposals shall only include one category as defined in the above resolution “Lawbook — Categories — 2019.”

For proposal concepts that require more than one category, e.g. “Action order,” “ISKCON law,” etc.,

each section requiring its own category must be presented as a separate proposal.

GBC Resolution 429.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

429.2 • Law Book — Guru Name Abbreviations (2019)

[Rule of order]

(Proposed by Nrsimha Kavaca Das and sponsored by Madhu Sevita Das and Praghosa Das)

Whereas as ISKCON expands and an ever-increasing number of devotees get initiated it is common

that many devotees have the same name;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada has stated that the identity of a person can be understood by who their father is;

Whereas there is a need to be able to clearly identify which devotee(s) a resolution is referring to;

Whereas such identification will assist the search feature of the Law Book Database;

Whereas such a list is already in existence and has been used by the PAMHO email service for many

years:

Resolved:

Any devotees referred to in any proposal to the GBC will be identified by adding the abbreviation of

their spiritual master's name after their initiated name.

The Guru Services Committee is directed to maintain this list and generate abbreviations for new initiating spiritual masters.

The following list is accepted as the standardized list of abbreviations for all past and current ISKCON

gurus:

A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada (ACBSP)

Atmanivedana Swami (AVS)

Bhakti Bhrnga Govinda Swami (BBGS)

Bhakti Bhusana Swami (BBS)

Bhakti Caitanya Swami (BCAIS)

Bhakti Charu Swami (BCS)

Bhakti Dhira Damodara Swami (BDDS)

Bhagavan Das (BGD)

Bhavananda Das (BG)

Bhakti Gaurava Narayana Swami (BGNS)

Bhakti Gauravani Goswami (BGVG)

Bhurijana Das (BJD)

Bir Krishna Das Goswami (BKG)

Bhaktimarga Swami (BMS)

Bhakti Raghava Swami (BRS)

Bhakti Svarupa Damodara Swami (BSDS)

Bhakti Sundar Goswami (BSG)

Bhakti Tirtha Swami (BTS)

Bhakti Vijnana Goswami (BVG)

Bhakti Vikasa Swami (BVKS)

Bhakti Vaidurya Madhava Swami (BVMD)

Bhakti Visrambha Madhava Swami (BVMS)

Bhakti Vrajendranandana Swami (BVNS)

Bhaktividya Purna Swami (BVPS)

Bhaktivaibhava Swami (BVS)

Bhaktivyasa Tirtha Swami (BVTS)
Bhakti Vighna Vinasa Narasimha Swami (BVVNS)
Caitanya Candra Caran Das (CCCD)
Caitanya Candra Das (CCD)
Caru Das (CD)
Candra Mukha Swami (CMKS)
Candramauli Swami (CMS)
Devamrita Swami (DAS)
Dhanurdhara Swami (DDS)
Danavir Goswami (DG)
Druktakarma Das (DKD)
Dhanvantari Swami (DVS)
Gunagrahi Das Goswami (GDG)
Giridhari Swami (GDS)
Gour Govinda Swami (GGS)
Gopal Krishna Goswami (GKG)
Gopaswami Das (GSD)
Guru Prasad Swami (GPS)
Giriraja Swami (GRS)
Ganapati Swami (GS)
Hrdayananda Das Goswami (HDG)
Harikesa Das (HKS)
Hanumatpresaka Swami (HPS)
Indradyumna Swami (IDS)
Isvara Swami (IS)
Jayadvaita Swami (JAS)
Jagadish Das (JDG)
Janananda Goswami (JG)
Jivananda Das (JND)
Jayapataka Swami (JPS)
Kesava Bharati Das Goswami (KBG)
Kavicandra Swami (KCS)
Krsna Das Swami (KDS)
Kalakantha Das (KKD)
Kadamba Kanana Swami (KKS)
Kripamoya Das (KMD)
Kratu Das (KRD)
Krishna Kshetra Swami (KRKS)
Lokanath Swami (LOK)
Matsya Avatara Das (MAD)
Mahaman Das (MMD)
Mahatma Das (MD)
Mukunda Goswami (MG)
Manonatha Das (MND)
Madhusevita Das (MSD)
Mahavisnu Goswami (MVG)
Mahavishnu Swami (MVS)
Niranjana Swami (NRS)

Navayogendra Swami (NYS)
Prahladananda Swami (PAS)
Purnacandra Goswami (PCD)
Paramananda Das (PD)
Prithu Das (PDA)
Param Gati Das (PGS)
Partha Sarathi Das Goswami (PSDG)
Purusatraya Swami (PTS)
Prabhavisnu Das (PVS)
Radha Govinda Swami (RGS)
Radhanath Swami (RNS)
Romapada Swami (RPS)
Rohini Suta Das (RSD)
Rtadhvaja Swami (RTS)
Ravindra Svarupa Das
Samik Rsi Das
(RVSD)
(SRD)
Sankarshan Das (SDA)
Satyadeva Das (SDD)
Satsvarupa Das Goswami (SDG)
Sridhar Swami (SDHS)
Suresvara Das (SED)
Smita Krsna Swami (SKS)
Sacinandana Swami (SNS)
Somaka Swami (SOS)
Sivarama Swami (SRS)
Suhotra Swami (SS)
Subhag Swami (SSM)
Tamal Krishna Goswami (TKG)
Trivikrama Swami (TVS)
Virabahu Das (VBD)
Vipramukhya Swami (VMS)
Varsana Swami (VS)
Vaisesika Das (VSD)
Vegavan Das (VVD)
Vedavyasapriya Swami (VVPS)

GBC Resolution 429.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

429.2 · Law Book — Content Layout (2019)

[Rule of order]

(Proposed by Nrsimha Kavaca Das and Sponsored by Madhu Sevita Das and Praghosa Das)

Whereas entering data into the Law Book Database is very time consuming and will be greatly simplified if the content and structure of proposals and resolutions match the database data entry fields;

Whereas there are many resolutions that have titles that do not assist the user in understanding the content of the resolution, such as in 2001 a proposal was submitted named, “Show cause notice”. The proposal was actually informing the GBC that a show cause notice relating to Adridharan Das was pending before the high court. This is not apparent from the title.

Whereas crafting ISKCON legislation is often a very detailed and time-consuming task and if ISKCON’s legislators have sufficient information on hand they will gain a deeper understanding of the

thought process and background that led to such resolutions being drafted and passed;

Resolved:

All proposals and resolutions must include the following data fields in the order as listed below:

Section

Title

Year

Meeting

Category

Presentation of proposal

Resolution

Tags

Published

Amendment

Proposed by

Sponsored by

Footnotes to resolution

Explanatory notes:

Section — according to “Sections used to sort resolutions — 2019”

Title must also include the year it was passed. This will facilitate finding relevant resolutions.

Year — year resolution passed

Presentation of proposal — where applicable, all proposals should include.

Resolution

Tags — this will enable search feature.

Published — is this resolution to be published or unpublished.

Amendment — is this an amendment to another resolution. Identify other resolution.

Proposed by — name of proposer(s)

Sponsored by — name of sponsors

Footnotes to resolution — any footnotes to resolution

GBC Resolution 429.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

434.3 · Sastric Advisory Council's Pati-guru Paper (2019)

[Statement]

(Proposed and Sponsored by the SAC)

Resolved:

That the GBC accepts the conclusion and recommendation as found on page 38 of the SAC's Pati-guru paper.

GBC Resolution 434.3 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

437.1 · Charter Model Statement (2019)

[Statement]

Resolved:

That the GBC approves the general direction of the 'Charter Model' approach and authorizes and encourages the GBC Organizational Development Committee to conduct pilot efforts in the fields of:

1. Preliminary communication and consultation with relevant and receptive constituencies
2. Funding for the initial phase

as well as to continue conducting legal feasibility studies.

The committee shall formally report their observations and experiences at the 2020 GBC Midterm General Meeting

GBC Resolution 437.1 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

407.02 • Amendment to Certificate of Readiness—Appeal process (2020)

Governing law

Whereas ISKCON Governing Law 407.02, “Regulation of Deity installations — 2012” does not include any

information directing centers how to appeal decisions by the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry

Whereas ISKCON centers have the right to appeal a decision

Whereas ISKCON centers should understand the process for appealing a decision

And whereas there is already an existing appeal process in ISKCON Law

RESOLVED:

ISKCON law 407.02, “Regulation of Deity installations — 2012” for commencing worship of Deities in

ISKCON is amended to include the following:

Any ISKCON center that has applied to the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry for a Certificate of Readiness to commence worship of deities, but their application has not been successful, may appeal

the decision via the following process:

1. Communicate to the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry that they are not satisfied with the decision.

<http://deityworship.com/>

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2. IDWM will then offer a written explanation of the decision.

3. If the center is still not satisfied with the outcome of that communication then they have the option to follow the appeals process established by GBC resolution 604.2, Appeal of Decisions to GBC Executive Committee 2005.

The full revised law is below:

Any ISKCON center wishing to install any deities for public temple worship or commence the worship of

any deity in an ISKCON center must first receive a “Certificate of Readiness for Worship” for the said

deities.

Centers may procure deities and begin promoting planned temple openings or additions to existing worship

once they have successfully completed the first stage of the approval process. Centers shall not commit to

and/or publicly advertise final dates for commencement of worship until they receive a “Certificate of

Readiness for Worship.”

This “Certificate of Readiness for Worship” applies only to the deities for which it is granted and is not a

generic permanent approval.

The initial contact: The center wishing to commence the worship of deities makes an application via the

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry’s website, Deityworship.com. After receiving this application, the IDWM

contacts the local GBC and regional authorities to assess the viability of the application. If this consultation

shows the center has made a proper analysis of the requirements to worship deities and are

moving in the right direction regarding allocation, resources, etc. to the worship of the deities then the first stage approval is granted. This then enables the temple to make arrangements to acquire deities and commence fund-raising, etc.

The second and final stage will be assessed based on the findings of a site visit by an IDWM representative, or comprehensive consultation with concerned devotees.

The readiness for worship will be assessed by a local representative (from the temple concerned); the local

GBC, regional leadership (which may include a representative from the National Council or RGB, etc.); and

an ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry representative. The GBC Executive Committee will be informed of the assessment outcome.

For any applications for deities apart from those given by Srila Prabhupada, i.e. Radha-Kṛṣṇa; Jagannātha,

Baladeva, Subhadrā; and Gaura-Nitai (or Panca-tattva) and salagram silas, the IDWM requires executive input.

Therefore, for any application that includes Kṛṣṇa-Balarama or Sita Rama Lakshman Hanuman, the IDWM

will consult with the GBC Executive Committee for approval.

Any deities apart from the aforementioned must be approved by the GBC Body before the IDWM can issue

a Certificate of Readiness for installing deities.

This Certificate of Readiness is valid for up to 180 days beyond the initial scheduled installation date. If the

180-day period has elapsed without the installation being completed, the temple will be reassessed by the

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry for a new Certificate of Readiness to be issued.

Any ISKCON center that has applied to the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry for a Certificate of Readiness

to commence worship of Deities, but their application has not been successful, may appeal the decision via

the following process:

1. Communicate to the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry that they are not satisfied with the decision.

2. IDWM will then offer a written explanation of the decision.

3. If the center is still not satisfied with the outcome of that communication then they have the option to

follow the appeals process established by GBC resolution 604.2, Appeal of Decisions to GBC Executive Committee 2005.

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GBC Resolution 407.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

411.01 · Upgrading World Holy Name Committee to ISKCON Harinama (2020)

Sankirtana Ministry — 2020

Administrative Order

Whereas harinama-sankirtana is the yuga-dharma and a core practice of all ISKCON devotees

Whereas other important ISKCON practices are supported by Ministries, including:

- Ministry of Book Distribution
- Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture
- ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry

Whereas a Harinama Sankirtana Ministry would be of benefit to the society through contributions including,

but not limited to:

- Education and training
- Establishing standards
- Production of publications
- Website
- Improved coordination of ISKCON's annual World Holy Name Festival

Whereas the GBC Standing Committee, World Holy Name Committee, has been effectively functioning

since 2007 to celebrate the World Holy Name Festival and is willing to expand its mandate to function as a

Ministry

Whereas the World Holy Name Committee desires to add additional members to facilitate functioning as a

Ministry

RESOLVED:

That the World Holy Name Committee is hereby reconstituted as the ISKCON Harinama Sankirtana

Ministry.

The Ministry may be expanded to add additional members. The service description of the individual

members will be decided by the Ministry.

The Minister shall be Lokanath Swami.

<http://worldholynama.org/>

<http://worldholynama.org/>

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GBC Resolution 411.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

423.03 · In-depth study of variations in second initiation policies (2020)

Action order

Whereas different initiating gurus in ISKCON have established different policies regarding when second

initiation may be offered to an ISKCON member. Some offer second initiation quite readily to all, regardless

of the service they are performing in the society, and others offer second initiation readily only to those who

are expected to be engaged in worship of ISKCON temple deities, and very few others

Whereas the Board of Examinations has established a standard for admission of a candidate for a Bhaktivedanta degree program whereby second initiation is a prerequisite for enrolment, and it will soon be

publishing a revised standard for this degree that removes this prerequisite, but adds the requirement that

the candidate must be second-initiated in order to actually receive a Bhaktivedanta degree

Whereas this lack of uniformity in second initiation policies of ISKCON's initiating gurus may be the source

of unnecessary conflict and confusion

Whereas some ISKCON gurus have changed Srila Prabhupada's requirements for second initiation

RESOLVED:

That the Guru Services Committee is directed to arrange for an in-depth study of the varying policies for

second initiation and present their recommendations to the GBC at the 2021 AGM.

GBC Resolution 423.03 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

431.02 · Interim guidelines for the Prevention of Leader Misconduct Office (2020)

Misconduct (PLM Office)

Action order

Whereas in 2018 it was resolved that The ISKCON International Office for the Prevention of Leader

Misconduct (PLM Office) be established as a permanent ISKCON organizational entity subject to review by

the GBC Body (as with other Offices and Ministries)

Whereas one of the immediate goals of The PLM Office was to draft a document of ISKCON International

Policies and Procedures for (a) preventing Leader Sexual Misconduct, (b) responding to complaints, and (c)

conducting investigations

Whereas the GBC body acknowledges the urgent need for such guidelines to be implemented in order to

facilitate the functions of the Office

RESOLVED:

(i) Until the final PLM Office Guidelines are adopted, the PLM Office Director shall have the authority

to accept complaints on a case-by-case basis at his or her discretion. Such complaints shall be handled using the protocols contained in the PLM Office working document.

(ii) The Director of the PLM Office will submit to the GBC Executive Committee the Policy and Procedure Guidelines for consideration by the 2020 GBC Mid-term General Meeting.

PLM_WORKING_DOCUMENT.pdf

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(iii) The GBC Executive Committee is authorized to, in its discretion, at any time prior to or at the 2020

Mid-term General Meeting, adopt the Policy and Procedure Guidelines as it sees fit and such revised guidelines will then be the official Policy and Procedure Guidelines of the PLM Office.

[Footnotes to resolution]

The GBC spent considerable time discussing the guidelines for the PLM Office, but some details remained

to be worked out. Therefore, the GBC authorized to Executive Committee to adopt final policies with minor

adjustments, on its behalf. If approved by the Executive Committee, those shall be distributed to the GBC

members and made publicly known to the ISKCON society.

GBC Resolution 431.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

409.01 • Mood of worship (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas deity worship is an essential element of the process of bhakti and the development of a sadhaka;

Whereas it is intrinsic to a devotee's development in bhakti, and when engaged in deity worship, that a devotee follows the proper rules and regulations governing the worship and understand and follow the appropriate mood of worship;

Whereas devotees who have not attained the platform of spontaneous attachment in devotional service render devotional service under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master according to the regulative principles mentioned in the revealed scriptures;

Whereas Lord Caitanya explained the mood of worship to Sanatana Goswami as awe and reverence:

sadhu-sanga, nama-kirtana, bhagavata-sravana
mathura-vasa, sri-murtira sraddhaya sevana

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One should associate with devotees, chant the holy name of the Lord, hear Srimad-Bhagavatam, reside at Mathura and worship the Deity with faith and veneration. CC Madhya 22.128

Whereas Srila Prabhupada in his books and other writings, has established the mood of worship for ISKCON temples, most notably in SB 4.24.45-46:

Generally the worship of the Lord begins with the worship of Narayana, or Visnu, whereas the worship of Lord Krsna and Radha is most confidential. Lord Narayana is worshipable by the pancaratrika-vidhi, or regulative principles, whereas Lord Krsna is worshipable by the bhagavata-vidhi. No one can worship the Lord in the bhagavata-vidhi without going through the regulations of the pancaratrika-vidhi. Actually, neophyte devotees worship the Lord according to the pancaratrika-vidhi, or the regulative principles enjoined in the Narada Pancaratra. Radha-Krsna cannot be approached by the neophyte devotees; therefore temple worship according to regulative principles is offered to Laksmi-Narayana. Although there may be a Radha-Krsna vigraha, or form, the worship of the neophyte devotees is acceptable as Laksmi-Narayana worship. Worship according to the pancaratrika-vidhi is called vidhi-marga, and worship according to the bhagavata-vidhi principles is called raga-marga. The principles of raga-marga are especially meant for devotees who are elevated to the Vrndavana platform.

Whereas Srila Prabhupada has explained: The greatest danger to our movement will come when we manufacture and create our own process for worshipping the deities. Letter Jan. 4, 1973;

Whereas deity worship is not a forum for free expression where devotees are able to offer service according to their own idea, but it must be offered according to the direction of guru, sadhu, and sastra;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada established specific standards of deity worship in ISKCON with the mood of awe and reverence being the most central to these standards;

Whereas in recent years we have noticed a steady drift away from this mood of worship established by Srila Prabhupada;

Whereas it is apparent in various temples that this mood of worship is not being followed or has not been understood.

RESOLVED:

The GBC reaffirms that the mood of worship established by Srila Prabhupada, which is to be followed in all ISKCON centres, is the mood of awe and reverence.

All worship conducted in ISKCON centres, both regular daily worship and occasional worship (such as festivals), must be conducted according to this standard.

All ISKCON leaders are required to ensure that devotees and centres under their care understand and implement worship according to these standards.

As such, all practices that demonstrate a different mood of worship are not approved and must be actively discouraged by leaders at all levels. This includes but is not limited to:

- Devotees' conduct in the presence of the deities
- The way devotees interact with the deities
- The manner in which devotees dress the deities, and
- The different aspects of daily and festival services

GBC Resolution 409.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on April 17, 2021)

440.01 • Establishing the Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee [VMSC] (2021)

[Administrative order]

Establishing the committee

Whereas the GBC affirms there is a need to have standard policy on the establishment of Vaisnava memorials and who is eligible for what type of memorial;

Whereas the GBC deems this is a task that should be overseen by a committee and therefore, at the 2008

AGM, passed the following Resolution:

That the standing Commemoration Committee is established with the mandate as follows:

1. To research and establish a standard set of guidelines documenting the process for correctly honoring departed Vaisnavas.
 2. To maintain records of departed ISKCON Vaisnavas and a summary of their services for the society.
 3. To determine the application of the guidelines in individual cases.
 4. To decide which of the departed disciples of Srila Prabhupada will be interred in full, given a puspam samadhi, or honored with a plaque in the Mayapur Garden of Inspiration.
- Praghosa dasa (convenor), Bhakti Caru Swami, Bhakti Purusottama Swami, and Mahamaya devi dasi are assigned to the standing committee.

Whereas this committee was never active;

Whereas the committee's focus is to establish guidelines for, and approval for Vaisnavas who may be remembered in memorial parks, Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee (VMSC), is a more appropriate name;

Whereas, as the devotee population ages, an increasing number of devotees are passing away and the need to establish a universal policy for Vaisnava memorials is ever more pressing.

RESOLVED:

That the GBC re-establishes the Commemoration Standing Committee and renames it the Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee. The mandate or scope of the Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee will be as follows:

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1. To research and establish a standard, global policy for appropriately honoring departed devotees.

Such a policy will take into account, and reflect the global diversity of ISKCON, and shall duly respect the contribution of Vaisnavas as well as Vaisnavis.

2. To proactively reach out to all sannyasis, gurus, GBCs and other senior devotees to establish what they want done with their bodies or remains after their passing away, either by obtaining a copy of their will and testament, or by their own written statement, and:

- a. Establish and maintain a list of devotees who are eligible for samadhi, either full body or other;
 - b. Decide how departed devotees will be honored;
 - c. Determine what standard size of memorial is appropriate for all departed devotees;
 - d. Identify exceptional cases and refer them to the GBC body.
3. To communicate with regional bodies and temples, looking for recommendations for candidates for samadhi.
4. To maintain records of departed devotees and a summary of their services for ISKCON, and to make this information readily available to the members of ISKCON, through a website, and/or other suitable means.

GBC Resolution 440.01 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on May 19, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

440.02 · Types Of Memorials For Departed Vaisnavas — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Regulations

Whereas of the 27 GBC members who voted on this topic, 23 members voted for a plaque, a structure, or both.

RESOLVED:

That Vaiṣṇavas being recognized in the Memorial Park may have one of the following:

1. A plaque established on the Remembrance Wall
2. A small ash samadhi (a plinth with their name on it)
3. A small puspa samadhi (a plinth with their name on it)
4. A full body samadhi with a samadhi structure

GBC Resolution 440.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

440.02 · Samadhis for Sannyasis — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Regulations

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Whereas the GBC Samadhi Committee has presented evidence that sannyasis are generally buried;

Whereas it is not essential that a ‘samadhi structure’ be erected over the body of a departed sannyasi.

Instead a tulasi plant or a tree could be planted over their body;

Whereas of the 21 GBC members that voted on the question “Should Sannyasis automatically get a vapu samadhi?” 16 voted against;

Whereas of the 45 sannyasis that responded to a SABHA survey on samadhis, 22 said they did not want their bodies put in samadhi;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada said ‘Anyone who is in full Krishna Consciousness and is dedicating his life for Krishna is already a sannyasi even if he is a married man.’

RESOLVED:

That although sannyasis are usually buried, it is not essential this must be done nor is it essential that a samadhi structure be erected for every sannyasi.

GBC Resolution 440.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

440.02 · Location of Vaiṣṇava Memorial Park in Sri Mayapur Dhama — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Regulations

Whereas a number of GBC members expressed reservations about establishing future memorials in the

location next to Srila Prabhupada's Puspa Samadhi in Sridham Mayapur.

Whereas there is a need to have a memorial park for Vaisnavas in Mayapur.

RESOLVED:

That the general location for future samadhis for the majority of devotees shall be near the Jagannath

Mandir in Simantadvipa.

At this location devotees may be honored in the following ways:

Their full body is placed in the ground, with either a samadhi structure, a plinth with a plaque, or a tree above;

Puspa or ash samadhis, with either a samadhi structure, a plinth with a plaque, or a tree above;

A memorial wall or other structure for memorial plaques;

A kiosk where devotees visiting the memorial park may learn about departed ISKCON devotees.

GBC Resolution 440.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

440.02 · Vaiṣṇava memorial wall in Sri Mayapur Dham — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Regulations

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Whereas an important element of Vaiṣṇava memorials is a memorial wall with plaques where visiting devotees may remember departed ISKCON devotees and reflect on their service to Lord Kṛṣṇa, Srīla Prabhupada, and the guru parampara;

Whereas the GBC body agreed there should be a memorial wall in Sri Mayapur Dham;

Whereas the GBC body expressed their desire not to overdevelop the area next to Srīla Prabhupada's puspā-samādhi in Sri Mayapur Dham;

Whereas there are other suitable locations where a memorial wall may be located.

RESOLVED:

That there may be more than one memorial wall in Mayapur. The first memorial wall will be located on the inside wall of the ground floor or first floor of Srīla Prabhupada's puspā-samādhi, to be finalised in discussion with Mayapur Management. A second Memorial Wall could be located at the Jagannath Mandir Vaiṣṇava Memorial Park as required.

Wherever memorial walls are located there will also be a kiosk where visiting devotees can access information about the departed ISKCON devotees.

GBC Resolution 440.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

440.02 · Worship at Vaiṣṇava samadhis — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

Regulations

Whereas at present there is daily worship going on at Srila Prabhupada's Puspa Samadhi;

Whereas the worship at other existing samadhis is going on at different levels depending on the disciples of
the devotee(s) involved;

Whereas of the 21 GBC members that voted in the survey, 13 GBC members opted for no daily worship at
the individual samadhis;

Whereas ISKCON Law 701.05, "Guru Worship Standards —2009" amends ISKCON Law 6.4.8.1.3 to the
following:

D. In order to focus more fully on Srila Prabhupada and every devotee's special relationship with him, an ISKCON siksa or diksa guru may accept public guru puja (arati and/or foot bathing) in person once a year on ISKCON property on his or her Vyasa-puja.

RESOLVED:

1. No daily worship, either individual or collective, is required to be offered to any Vaiṣṇava in any

Vaiṣṇava Memorial Park in Mayapur. However, individuals may occasionally offer incense, flowers,
or prasadam remnants.

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2. A modest ceremony honoring a departed Vaiṣṇava may be organized on the appearance and disappearance days of the departed Vaisnava. This function may include offering bhoga, arati, puspanjali, glorification of the departed Vaiṣṇava, and a feast.

3. In accordance with existing ISKCON Law there will be no murti (deity) of any departed Vaiṣṇava.

There may be a photo of the departed Vaiṣṇava and where applicable a pair of shoes or other similar paraphernalia.

4. This resolution is retroactive and applies to all existing samadhis located anywhere on ISKCON land
in Mayapur.

GBC Resolution 440.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

440.02 · GBC direction to Mayapur leadership regarding further samadhi area (2021)

[Statement]

in Mayapur — 2021

RESOLVED:

That, the GBC hereby directs the Mayapur leadership to identify land near the Jagannath Mandir that can be used as a second location for samadhis, and to make whatever preliminary, minimum arrangements are required.

GBC Resolution 440.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

451.02 · Policies and procedures for the PLM office (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas in 2018 it was resolved that the ISKCON International Office for the Prevention of Leader

Misconduct (PLM Office) be established as a permanent ISKCON organizational entity subject to annual

review by the GBC Body (as with other Offices and Ministries);

Whereas the immediate goal of the PLM Office was to draft a document of ISKCON International Policies and Procedures.

RESOLVED:

The document entitled International Policy and Procedure Guidelines is hereby adopted as ISKCON's official policies on:

- (a) preventing Leader Sexual Misconduct
- (b) responding to complaints and
- (c) conducting investigations into allegations of sexual misconduct by leaders in ISKCON and resultant disciplinary proceedings.

GBC Resolution 451.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 31, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

453.03 · Sastric Advisory Council's Hermeneutic Foundation Document — 2020 (2021)

[Statement]

RESOLVED:

The GBC acknowledges the SAC Hermeneutic Foundation Document as the basis for starting hermeneutic

training in ISKCON and acknowledges the SAC Hermeneutic Supplementary Materials as a useful guide to

the Foundation Document. Others may produce their own guides to the Foundation Document.

The SAC has produced a level one training course based on these materials that may be of value to

ISKCON members.

GBC Resolution 453.03 · 2021 · AGM 2020 (passed on February 17, 2020, not published then by oversight)

ADDED · 2022

406.01 · Amendment to the Minimum Cow Protection Standards: IMCPA (2022)

[Statement]

Consultation Team — 2022

Whereas the Minimum Cow Protection Standards established by the ISKCON Ministry for Cow Protection and Agriculture (IMCPA) in 1999 allows for amendments

Whereas the Standards are intended to guide and regulate practices of cow protection and regenerative agriculture in ISKCON

Whereas the IMCPA has identified amendments to the current law that will help in educating stakeholders and resolving issues.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That the name and functioning of the IMCPA Investigation Team (IT) referred to in the current Minimum Cow Protection and Agricultural Standards will be changed to the IMCPA Consultation Team (CT) as shown below:

XV. CONSULTATION TEAM (CT)

Recommended

1. Selection of CT

The Ministry will collect a worldwide list of representatives and consultants to act as a resource pool.

Such devotees will be knowledgeable of the standards and have agricultural experience. From this list, the Ministry will select an appropriate CT.

2. Travel

To defray travel expenses, representatives who live closest and have knowledge about the problem in question will be chosen first. Centers receiving the consultants are requested to provide travel expenses. A fund can eventually be set up to help with travel expenses.

3. Membership of CT

The IMCPA CT should consist of 2 or more devotees not involved in the management of the program being attended and a professional suited to the situation selected by the CT. The professional should not be currently employed by the farm receiving the consultancy.

4. Duties of CT

The CT will arrange for group meetings and individual interviews with the stakeholders concerned and is responsible for the compilation of reports are given to all GBC concerned (Local Commissioner, Global Secretary, and Cow Protection Ministry).

GBC Resolution 406.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on October 7, 2022)

406.01 • Amendment to law 406.01 Cow Protection Certificate of Readiness (2022)

[Governing law]

Whereas to ascertain which projects need to apply for a certificate of readiness, all ISKCON farms and

goshalas must be registered in the ISKCON Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture (IMCPA) directory

Whereas the certificate of readiness is a tool to assist with the long-term sustainability of each cow protection project

Whereas all the major ISKCON farms and goshalas are registered in the directory

Whereas there are still some projects not registered with the directory.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

ISKCON law 406.01 is amended with the following inclusion:

All ISKCON farms and goshalas must be registered in the IMCPA directory. Any project not registered in the directory by the 30th of March 2023, will have to submit a certificate of readiness to be registered in the directory.

Existing farms need to be registered with the IMCPA if they are managed by ISKCON even if they are in the name of a Trust or other entity. The Zonal Supervisors and Zonal Secretaries are responsible to see that all goshalas and farms are duly registered.

Footnote:

Current law with amendment inserted:

In order to start a cow protection project that will be accredited within ISKCON and accepted as an

ISKCON supported project, a “Cow protection Certificate of Readiness” needs to be obtained.

All ISKCON farms and goshalas must be registered in the IMCPA directory. Any project not registered in the directory by the 30th of March 2023, will have to submit a certificate of readiness before registration in the directory.

Existing farms need to be registered with the IMCPA if they are managed by ISKCON even if they are in the name of a Trust or other entity. The Zonal Supervisors and Zonal Secretaries are responsible to see that all goshalas and farms are duly registered.

The following are the requirements for obtaining such a certificate, which will allow new cow protection projects to commence their operations:

The GBC Minimum cow protection standards “ISKCON law 507 (Care for cows — 1999)” needs to be read and fully understood before applying for the certificate.

An exam must be taken and passed. The questions in the exam will be based on the content of Law 507.

A well-thought-out business plan with the signature of the GBC member must be presented to the Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture.

Details regarding the content that must be addressed in the business plan are provided below in order to assist in its preparation.

Centers may not make any commitments or agreements regarding procuring and/or acquiring cows until the “Cow Protection Certificate of Readiness” is granted. The “Certificate of Readiness” applies only to an ISKCON registered property to which it is granted and is not a generic permanent approval.

The Certificate of Readiness is valid for up to 180 days beyond the initial scheduled acquisition date. If the 180-day period has elapsed without the set up being completed, the center will be reassessed by the ISKCON Ministry for Cow protection and Agriculture for a new Certificate of Readiness to be issued.

The Cow protection Certificate of Readiness will be assessed by a local representative (from the temple concerned); the local GBC, regional leadership (which may include a representative from the National Council or RGB, etc.); and an ISKCON Cow protection and Agriculture (IMCPA) accredited representative.

The GBC Executive Committee will be informed of the assessment outcome.

The initial contact:

The centre wanting to commence a cow protection program makes an application via IMCPA’s website.

After receiving this application which includes a business plan signed by the local GBC, IMCPA contacts local GBC and regional authorities to assess the viability of the application by their business plan and test.

If process shows the centre has made a proper analysis of requirements for cow protection which includes agriculture and is moving in the right direction regarding the proper allocation resources, etc. for cow protection, then the first stage approval is given. This then enables the temple to make arrangements to acquire cows and commence fund-raising, etc.

The second and final stage will be assessed based on the findings of a site visit by an IMCPA accredited representative, or comprehensive consultation with concerned devotees.

GBC Resolution 406.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on October 30, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

406.02 · Renaming “Minimum Cow Protection Standards” (2022)

[Statement]

Protection and Agricultural Standards

Whereas in 1999 the GBC ratified the document entitled “Minimum cow protection standards”

Whereas the addition of agricultural standards requires a change of title.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The document referenced in “Care for Cows — 1999” entitled “Minimum cow protection standards” will be

renamed “Minimum cow protection and agricultural standards.”

GBC Resolution 406.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on August 18, 2022)

ADDED • 2022

406.02 • Amendment to Minimum Cow Protection Standards: Pesticides, GMOs, (2022)

[Governing Law]

protection and agricultural standards
and fertilizers — 2022

Whereas scholars agree that “diverse pesticides directly or indirectly pollute the air, water, soil, and overall ecosystem which cause a serious health hazard for living beings.” (Sharma et al., 2019)

Whereas the WHO (World Health Organization) and FAO (Food and Agriculture Organization) affirm that the harmful side-effects of pesticides are becoming increasingly clear. (Global situation of pesticide management in agriculture and public health, 2021)

Whereas WHO classifies pesticides as carcinogenic (can cause cancer), and neurotoxic (can cause damage to the brain). (Food safety: Pesticide residue, 2021)

Whereas in places where more than 80 percent of the land is used for industrial agriculture, water tables are dropping quickly

Whereas Srila Prabhupada spoke profusely on the harm such ugra-karmic technologies bring to the planet, the environment, public health, the economy, and to human civilization

Whereas Minimum Cow protection standards referenced in ISKCON Law “Care for Cows — 1999,” Section

1, VIII, recommends that “any property (land and cows) belonging to the deity should be protected by environmentally sound conservation practices designed with the long-term fertility and preservation of the soil in mind” but does not specify the agricultural standards to accomplish this

Whereas ISKCON has established the minimal cow protection standards but has not yet devised the standards for agriculture.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The following agricultural standards will be added to the Minimum Cow Protection and Agricultural Standards.

The use of:

1. Synthetic pesticides
 2. Genetically modified organisms (GMOs)
 3. Synthetic fertilizers
- will not be allowed in ISKCON projects.

A project may continue to use synthetic fertilizers, at most until 2025, under the condition that they present a short-term transition plan towards regenerative agriculture.

Regenerative agriculture and agroecology practices are recommended. Organic Agriculture practices are allowed.

Glossary:

GMO: An organism produced through genetic modification.

Agricultural Biotechnology Glossary <https://www.usda.gov/topics/biotechnology/biotechnology-glossary>

Regenerative Agriculture: A holistic, principles-based approach to farming. It seeks to strengthen soil fertility, community, and water-sources resilience. Such systems include biodynamics, permaculture design, rotational grazing, biomimicry, agroforestry, syntropic farming, etc. Adapted

from (Newton et al., 2020) <https://doi.org/10.3389/fsufs.2020.577723>

Organic agriculture: Agriculture that focuses on production without the use of synthetic inputs and does not allow the use of transgenic organisms.

Agricultural Biotechnology Glossary <https://www.usda.gov/topics/biotechnology/biotechnology-glossary>

GBC Resolution 406.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on August 18, 2022)

406.02 • Training and Engagement of Oxen (2022)

[Guideline]

Whereas according to ISKCON's Minimum Cow Protection and Agricultural Standards, section 2, IX an

ISKCON project is not allowed to acquire and breed milking cows if they don't have a well-defined plan to engage their oxen

Whereas the bull is the emblem of moral principles (SB 1.16.18 purport)

Whereas Lord Caitanya presented that the bull is our father because he helps with food production (CC Adi 17.153)

Whereas working oxen can multitask, provide service of many utilities. They can not only plough land, but also transport pilgrims, guests, community members, and loads. In many places, they also grind spices and grains

Whereas Padayatras offer natural engagement to the oxen and the spreading the holy names

Whereas there are ox-training teachers and courses, within and outside of ISKCON

Whereas most people have a connection with cows through dairy consumption, but very few have any connection with working oxen

Whereas bulls represent 50% of the demographic of bovines to be cared for

Whereas many nations are indicating a need to reduce fossil fuel usage

Whereas Srila Prabhupada writes:

"So, take more land and engage them in agriculture, plowing by the bulls instead of a tractor.

Bulls

can be engaged in plowing and transporting. Nice bullock carts village to village for preaching.

Make

the farm the center and go ten miles this side, ten miles that side, ten miles this side, etc., with four bullock carts. Sell books and preach and live peacefully on the farm. People used to engage the bull

for this purpose. So there was no problem with which way to utilize them. First of all, this artificial

way should be stopped, and the bulls should be engaged in plowing and transporting and smashing the grains. To avoid machinery, petrol, machine oil, by nature's way."

(Letter to Balavanta, Bombay 3 January 1977)

Therefore, it is resolved that:

All National Bodies and Regional Bodies that have cow protection projects should establish regular training

and engagement of oxen, e.g., Padayatra parades, transportation, ploughing, etc. by Janmastami 2025.

[NOTE: The above updated resolutions and full standards of the Cow Protection and Agriculture Ministry

can be viewed here: [Minimum Cow and Agriculture Standards](#)

GBC Resolution 406.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on July 20, 2022)

407.01 • Mood of worship—Darsanas (2022)

[Governing law]

Whereas in 2021 the GBC made the following statement:

That the GBC reaffirms the mood of worship established by Srila Prabhupada, which is to be followed in all ISKCON centers, is the mood of awe and reverence.

All worship conducted in ISKCON centers, both regular daily worship and occasional worship (such as festivals), must be conducted according to this standard.

All ISKCON leaders are required to ensure that devotees and centers under their care understand and implement worship according to these standards.

As such all practices that demonstrate a different mood of worship are not approved and must be actively discouraged by leaders at all levels. This includes but is not limited to:

1. Devotee's conduct in the presence of the deities.
2. The way devotees interact with the deities.
3. The manner in which devotees dress the deities, and
4. The different aspects of daily and festival services.

Whereas this resolution reaffirms Srila Prabhupada's stated requirement of the mood of worship for ISKCON centers as awe and reverence

Whereas it is necessary to define what this mood of worship looks like in the various aspects of deity worship, so devotees understand proper standards

Whereas changing the appearance of deities conflicts with Srila Prabhupada's stated mood of worship

Whereas every festival brings newer and more creative modifications to the appearance of the deities in some ISKCON centers

Whereas according to Srila Prabhupada's statement in *Adi-lila* 14.50, devotees should not divert their attention to the worship of demigods.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

When observing festivals and dressing for daily darsana, the physical appearance of the deity must not be modified. This includes, but is not limited to:

1. Covering the deities' faces with masks, or otherwise obscuring the normal appearance or darsana.
2. Adding limbs to the deities, such as arms, legs, feet, etc.
3. Modifying the appearance of the deities' eyes, either changing the colour or the direction they are looking.
4. Dressing the deities as demigods

When temples have an interest in depicting pastimes of the Lord and His associates this may be achieved via the use of dioramas, pictures, drama, and other means.

GBC Resolution 407.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on June 8, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

407.06 · Deity worship and eclipses (2022)

[Position papers]

Whereas there are different opinions on whether deity worship should continue during eclipses

Whereas there are different opinions on what devotees should do to observe the occasion of a solar or lunar eclipse

Whereas the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry has prepared a position paper establishing a uniform policy on this matter.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The position paper, Deity worship and eclipses, is accepted as ISKCON's official position on this topic.

GBC Resolution 407.06 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on October 14, 2022)

408.01 • GBC Inquiry regarding Child Abuse at Sridham Mayapur and (2022)

[Action order]

Vrndavana — 2022

Whereas it has been brought to the attention of the GBC Body that there were lapses in the implementation

of sufficient child protection measures in the ISKCON Mayapur and Vrndavana Schools

Whereas it is imperative to first identify, by way of an inquiry, the causes of such a lapse in the current

governance and system setup for child protection and, subsequently, to put in place measures to avert

such lapses from being repeated in the ISKCON Mayapur and Vrndavana schools

Whereas such an inquiry shall not preclude the formation or functioning of other committees with respect to

improving child protection within ISKCON.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC conducts an inquiry to identify the lapses in the implementation of child protection measures at

ISKCON Mayapur and Vrndavana schools, details of which are set out below as follows:

1. Scope of enquiry

a. This inquiry will be limited to ISKCON schools with specific focus on examining their current organisational structures and legal frameworks required for child protection and to assess the current risks in respect of the same.

b. Identify the root causes of governance shortcomings in the ISKCON Mayapur Gurukula by interviewing relevant members of the CPO, GBC Zonal Secretaries, Mayapur temple leadership, the current school leadership, and any other parties that may have been connected, directly or indirectly, to the ISKCON Mayapur Gurukula, review the documentation that governs the relationship between these entities and similarly review the governance arrangements and documentation for ISKCON Vrndavana Gurukula.

c. Ascertain whether the governance shortcomings identified above are likely to be replicated across other ISKCON school settings; this will likely include wider interviews and documentation review.

d. Review the structural and legal relationship between the different layers of ISKCON with governance of schools and the CPO.

e. Ancillary to the above review will be the Inquiry's access to and study of the CPO Guidelines as they relate to scope as outlined in items a–d above.

2. Desired Outcomes

a. Phase one shall entail collating the findings of the Inquiry and making specific written recommendations to the GBC Body in order to remedy the identified shortcomings and areas of improvement for implementation by relevant bodies; and

b. Phase two will be supporting implementation of the adopted recommendations of the Inquiry.

c. Identifying qualified resources who could help implement the approved recommendations.

d. Commissioning mandatory annual child protection audits for every school. These audits should be carried out by professionals (with no conflict of interest) and their reports should be made public.

3. Proposed team

- a. Individuals with extensive school safeguarding and inspection experience will be appointed at the discretion of the inquiry coordinator; The team members shall be independent from ISKCON management and have no conflict of interest.
- b. The Avanti Schools' legal advisors are available for consultation where necessary.
- c. Other volunteers for management, communication, and administration to support this process will be recruited as needed.
- d. Navina Krishna dasa will coordinate the inquiry.

4. Funding

Navina Krishna dasa has kindly agreed to raise the funding for the following:

- a. Team consultation fees
- b. Legal consultation fees.

5. Timeline

First phase report is to be presented to the GBC Body within 8 weeks after whatever preliminary information is requested by the team is provided to them.

6. Action items

Upon approval of the GBC Body, the following actions need to be completed:

- a. The GBC directs its secretary, and the CPO Director to assist in this endeavor and provide the information timely as requested by the inquiry team.
- b. By and before 30th December 2022, GBC members on the India Bureau, headed by Gopal Krishna Goswami, procure the India Bureau's formal resolution and commitment to support the completion of this inquiry.
- c. By and before 2nd January 2023, GBC Zonal secretaries (Jayapataka Swami, Gopal Krishna Goswami, Bhakti Purushottama Swami, Hrdaya Caitanya dasa and Anuttama dasa) and Indian Bureau representatives (Devakinandan dasa, Basu Ghosh dasa and Dayaram dasa) with authority over Mayapur must procure the Mayapur Executive Board (MEB) formal resolution and commitment to support the completion of this inquiry.
- d. MEB resolution should include assigning a dedicated co-director to arrange and assure cooperation from the Mayapur management structure for the timely completion of the inquiry.
- e. The co-director should procure by 15th January 2023 the preliminary information stated below so that the formal inquiry can ensue.
- f. By and before 8th January 2023, GBC Zonal secretaries, and Indian Bureau representatives with authority over Vrndavana must procure the Vrndavana Executive Board (VEB) formal resolution and commitment to support the completion of this inquiry.
- g. VEB resolution should include assigning the temple president to arrange and assure cooperation from the Vrndavana management structure for the timely completion of the inquiry.
- h. The temple president should procure by 31st January 2023 the preliminary information stated below so that the formal inquiry can ensue.

7. Preliminary information

- a. Provide a copy of all resolutions passed by the GBC body and local management with respect to child protection at these schools.
- b. The existing CPO guidelines that needed to be adhered to at these centers.
- c. Provide a copy of any scheme of delegation or legal or financial arrangement that connects

- the schools to ISKCON. This could be property leases, MOUs, management agreements, governing articles, and so on.
- d. Provide a copy of the child protection, health and safety, whistleblowing, complaints, grievance policies that the school has adopted.
 - e. Provide a list of the names and contact details of the governors of the school and principal/head teacher.
 - f. Provide a copy of any scheme of delegation or legal framework that sets out the relationship between the international CPO to the GBC body.
 - g. Provide a copy of any scheme of delegation or legal framework that that sets out the relationship between the local CPT to the GBC body and to the international CPO.
 - h. Who owns the land and buildings upon which the school operates?
 - i. What is the legal entity that owns the school? Please provide the governing documents for this entity (articles of association and memorandum, trust document etc.).
 - j. What is the legal entity that operates the school? (If different from the owner). Please provide the governing documents for this entity (articles of association and memorandum, trust document etc.).
- [Note: This report has been completed and is currently being reviewed by the GBC]

GBC Resolution 408.01 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meetings (passed on December 14, 2022)

430.01 • Committees and Subcommittees: Change of Category (2022)

[Statement]

Whereas it is required for the smooth functioning of the GBC meetings that the Rules of Order are up to

date and available to all members

Whereas the Rules of Order have not been updated for many years

Whereas the following has been established as a rule of order:

COMMITTEES AND SUBCOMMITTEES

The GBC Body may establish committees with such powers as appropriate.

I. POWERS OF COMMITTEE

1. A committee may have the power:

a To make decisions on matters as may be recommended by the GBC.

b To act on behalf of the GBC in some areas as fixed by the GBC.

c To submit reports or recommendations to the GBC as directed.

II. WORKING OF COMMITTEES

1. The officers should be appointed by the GBC Body.

2. The committee shall elect its Chairman, Vice-Chairman, and Secretary if any of them is not appointed by the GBC.

3. The office bearers shall perform their duties within the limits defined by the GBC and shall remain answerable to the parent body.

III. APPOINTMENT OF SUBCOMMITTEES

4. A committee may appoint a subcommittee to deal with some specific branch of the work insofar as the committee has not been barred from delegating its powers. The following shall apply:

a The powers delegated to the subcommittee can be revoked or rescinded at any time by the committee.

b The subcommittee must report to the committee.

c The subcommittee ceases to function as soon as the purpose for which it is created is accomplished.

IV. POWERS AND DUTIES OF SUBCOMMITTEES

1. A subcommittee's powers and duties shall be clearly stated by the appointing body, paying special attention to the following:

a. Power to recommend or advise

b. Power to act, spend, etc.

c. Frequency of meetings

d. Source of funds, if applicable

V. COMMITTEE REPORT

1. Each standing committee's Chairman shall submit a written report to the GBC Body at the outset of the yearly meeting as to the work, program, and participation of the committee during the previous year.

Whereas a rule of order is defined as: “Procedures for the functioning of the GBC Body”

Whereas an Administrative Order is defined as: “Orders by which an administrative wing or branch of

ISKCON with specific functions is created. A ministry or other functional unit that has an existence beyond

the scope of the individuals performing the task”

Whereas this resolution is not a Rule of Order, but an Administrative Order.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The resolution “Committees and sub-committees” is re-categorized as an Administrative order.

GBC Resolution 430.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on May 15, 2022)

441.02 · Amendment to the worship at Vaiṣṇava samadhis (2022)

[Governing law]

Whereas in December 2020 the GBC passed the resolution “Worship at Vaisnava samadhis — 2020”

which states:

1. There will be no daily worship required, either individually or collectively, offered to any Vaisnava in any Vaisnava Memorial Park in Mayapur. However, individuals may occasionally offer incense, flowers or prasadam remnants.

2. A modest ceremony honoring a departed Vaisnava may be organized on the appearance and disappearance days of the departed Vaisnava. This function may include offering bhoga, arati, puspanjali, glorification of the departed Vaisnava and a feast.

3. In accordance with existing ISKCON Law there will be no murti (deity) of any departed Vaisnava.

There may be a photo of the departed Vaisnava and where applicable a pair of shoes or other similar paraphernalia.

4. This resolution is retroactive and applies to all existing samadhis located anywhere on ISKCON land in Mayapur.

Whereas the Vaishnava Memorial Standing Committee (VMSC) proposes that such a resolution is applicable everywhere.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The resolution “Worship at Vaiṣṇava samadhis — 2020” in regard to the worship at Vaiṣṇava samadhis is

applicable worldwide and is amended to read:

1. No daily worship, either individual or collective, is required to be offered to any Vaisnava in any

Vaisnava Memorial. Still, individuals may offer incense, flowers or prasadam remnants.

2. A modest ceremony honoring a departed Vaisnava may be organized on the appearance and disappearance days of the departed Vaisnava. This function may include offering bhoga, arati, puspanjali, glorification of the departed Vaisnava and a feast. This ceremony must be significantly less elaborate than the worship offered to Srila Prabhupada at that ISKCON center.

3. ISKCON assumes no responsibility for the worship, now or in the future.

4. In accordance with existing ISKCON Law there will be no murti (deity) of any departed Vaisnava

established or worshipped on ISKCON property. There may be a photo of the departed Vaisnava and where applicable a pair of shoes or other paraphernalia.

5. This resolution is retroactive and applies to all existing samadhis located on ISKCON property anywhere in the world. Any ISKCON center with an existing deity (as of 28 March 2022) of a departed Vaishnava may apply for exemption via the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry website and

this request will be forwarded to the GBC body for consideration.

GBC Resolution 441.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on March 28, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

442.01 · Reorganization of the ISKCON Global Property Office and Property (2022)

[Statement]

Structure

Protection Governance — 2022

Whereas an Unpublished Resolution of 2019 stated:

"The GBC appoints a committee of Govardhana Das and Tapan Misra das, in consultation with the

EC and General Counsel, to reorganize the ISKCON Property Office bringing it up to the required standard, with all that that entails. All previous resolutions and appointments in regard the ISKCON

Property Office are hereby superseded."

Whereas this task has now been completed.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The "Organizational Schematic" attached hereto, as presented by Govardhana dasa and Tapan Misra

dasa pursuant to the above GBC Resolution is hereby approved by the GBC Body.

GBC Resolution 442.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on April 13, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

442.02 · Nominations to the GBC Executors Property Oversight Committee (2022)

[Action order]

Membership

(GEPOC) — 2022

Whereas the GBC approved the GEPOC structure on 13 April 2022, at the 2022 AGM

Whereas the GEPOC is a permanent committee (GBC Standing Committee) reporting directly to the GBC

Body

Whereas the GBC Body has authorized a total number of 8 GEPOC members (mirroring the 8 Executors

handpicked by Srila Prabhupada in his Will), but only 5 members have been approved by the GBC Body,

as of the present date

Whereas Giriraja Swami has since resigned and opted to serve as an advisor only

Whereas Ramesvara dasa (ACBSP) is an original executor handpicked by Srila Prabhupada and has been

serving the GEPOC with great dedication and skill as a GEPOC consultant

Whereas Nrsimhananda dasa (ACBSP) has been serving the GEPOC with great dedication and skill as an

invited guest

Whereas the GEPOC is unable to discharge its oversight duties properly without a full complement of

members

Whereas the GEPOC unreservedly recommends Ramesvara dasa (ACBSP) and Nrsimhananda dasa

(ACBSP) to become full GEPOC members.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC Body approves Ramesvara dasa (ACBSP) and Nrsimhananda dasa (ACBSP) as full GEPOC

members until the AGM of 2025.

The chair of the GEPOC will be appointed from amongst its members.

GBC Resolution 442.02 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on October 19, 2022)

ADDED · 2023

407.02 · Installing Laksmi-Nrsimha and Balaji in Guntur (2023)

[Statement]

Whereas ISKCON Guntur, India, has applied to install deities of Laksmi-Nrsimha and Balaji.

Whereas ISKCON Law “Regulation of installations — 2017” states:

For any applications for deities apart from those given by Srila Prabhupada, i.e., Radha-Krsna; Jagannatha, Baladeva, Subhadra; Gaura-Nitai (or Panca-tattva); and salagram silas; the IDWM requires executive input. Therefore, for any application that includes Krsna-Balarama or Sita Rama

Laksmana Hanumana, the IDWM will consult with the GBC Executive Committee for approval.

Any

deities, apart from the aforementioned, must be approved by the GBC Body before the IDWM can issue a Certificate of Readiness for installing deities.

Whereas in 2011 ISKCON Guntur was gifted land with the condition of installing deities of Nrsimhadeva and Balaji.

Whereas ISKCON Guntur installed deities of Jagannatha, Baladeva, and Subhadra and Radha-Krishna in

2014 under the direction of ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry’s India representatives.

Whereas the donor is pressuring the temple to install Laksmi-Nrsimha and Balaji as he feels his business is

suffering because he has not fulfilled his promise to the Lord.

Whereas ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry has expressed concerns about ISKCON submitting to the

pressure of a donor to install deities.

Whereas, understanding the difficulty faced by ISKCON Guntur in this situation and, after communicating

with the India Bureau and their indicating that they would like this installation to go ahead, ISKCON Deity

Worship Ministry is reluctantly willing to support the installation of these deities.

Whereas, ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry’s India representatives have assessed ISKCON Guntur as

having all the necessary brahmanas and other facilities and resources to care for the deities of Laksmi-

Nrsimha and Balaji.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry is hereby given permission to issue a Certificate of Readiness to ISKCON

Guntur for the deities of Laksmi-Nrsimha and Balaji.

GBC Resolution 407.02 · 2023 · GBC Midterm General Meeting, passed October 28, 2023

ADDED · 2023

445.22 · Appointment of the five GBC members to the joint ISKCON Bureau– GBC Relationship Committee (2023)

[Statement]

Committee

Whereas the ISKCON India Bureau (IB) has requested further consultation and dialogue on Vaishnavi

Diksha Guru (VDG) and Guru Tattva.

Whereas the GBC resolved on 24 October 2022 to engage in further dialogue with the IB.

Whereas the IB has nominated Bhanu Swami, Devakinandan dasa (Convenor), Rasaraja dasa, Bhakti

Vinoda Swami and Shreejeeva dasa as the members of the IB Committee.

Whereas the GBC Committee will as a first duty, seek to create an enabling environment for a productive dialogue.

Whereas the GBC Committee will draw on the extensive research done, call upon GBC members, engage

with the Vaishnavi Ministry, and with any other party, grouping or person that will advance its efforts to find

a speedy resolution; and

Whereas the GBC should finalize the 5 GBC members to the joint committee.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. Guru Prasad Swami, Dina Sharana devi dasi, Gauranga dasa (RNS), Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS) and Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) are appointed as members to the joint ISKCON Bureau (IB)-GBC relationship committee; and

2. The Committee will provide quarterly updates to the GBC body.

GBC Resolution 445.22 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed January 18, 2023

ADDED · 2023

453.03 · Brahma-gayatri Mantra in ISKCON – Varnashrama, Bhakti, Principle or (2023)

[Governing law]

Detail — 2023

Whereas the GBC Body has been informed that there are instances within ISKCON where systems of initiation have been instituted that differ significantly from the system followed by Śrīla Prabhupāda in terms of the eligibility of a devotee for initiation, as well as the vows taken, and the mantras given at the time of initiation.

And whereas at the request of the GBC Body, its Sastric Advisory Council (SAC) has extensively researched the matter and presented a paper in their advisory capacity.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. Initiates' vows at first initiation shall be, as Śrīla Prabhupāda required, to chant a minimum of sixteen rounds daily of the maha-mantra:

Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare
Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare

as well as giving up intoxication, illicit sex, gambling and the eating of meat, fish, and eggs.

2. Initiating gurus at second initiation shall give the specific seven mantras that Śrīla Prabhupāda gave to all initiates at what we call brahminical initiation or second initiation, and direct them to chant them three times a day at three sandhyas (morning, mid-day, and evening).

3. Gurus and those who recommend initiation candidates shall not make any distinction of birth, nationality, race, ethnicity, previous saṁskāra, marital status, gender, or classifications within the varṇas (such as occupational livelihood) as to who would be eligible to take those vows and receive those mantras in full at first and second initiation.

4. At the time of initiation, gurus should say, "As a member of ISKCON under the guidance and leadership of the GBC Body, I give you initiation in the guru Parampara."

Initiates must then take only the vows that Srila Prabhupada gave. Gurus may request, or instruct, disciples to accept additional voluntary individual commitments, such as chanting extra rounds on Ekadasi, or remaining loyal to ISKCON. However, such should be in the form of instructions or guidelines and should not be included as an initiation requirement or vow.

[Footnotes to resolution]

The GBC is hereby publishing the Sastric Advisory Council paper entitled "Brahma-gayatri Mantra in ISKCON -- Varnashrama, Bhakti, Principle or Detail?"

GBC Resolution 453.03 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed June 28, 2023

ADDED · 2024

406.02 · Leasing of Cows Suspended (2024)

[Governing law]

Minimum Cow Protection and Agricultural Standards

Whereas currently according to the current Minimum Cow Protection Standards for ISKCON, section 2.IX.4

“Permitted”:

4. Leasing Cows. Arrangements for leasing cows to others is permitted if it can contribute to the overall

goal of cow protection, and if the lessee is legally bound to abide by all Cow Protection Standards, ISKCON GBC Law 507 Minimum Cow Protection Standards 14 including, but not limited to, arrangements made for lifetime protection of both cow and calf.

Whereas the Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture believes the above is not currently in the best

interests of cow protection.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The above Cow Protection standard 2.IX.4 “Permitted”, allowing the leasing of cows, is suspended until

further notice. Exceptional requests to lease cows, calves, bulls, or oxen must be submitted to the regional

representative of the Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture for approval.

GBC Resolution 406.02 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

450.03 • ICPO Year Plan 2024-25 (2024)

[Action Order]

Whereas upon completion of the discussions held on 1st and 3rd March 2024 between Kamalesh Krishna

dasa, ICPO Director, and the GBC Body, Kamalesh Krishna dasa acknowledged shortcomings on his part,

and the GBC recognized the need for increased support of the International Child Protection Office, and

upon Kamalesh Krishna dasa's request to have certainty on his continued role in the ICPO.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. For 2024-2025, the GBC has increased the ICPO's budget to USD 54,000.
2. Kamalesh Krishna dasa is reappointed to serve as the ICPO Director for a period of one (1) year,
until March 1, 2025.
3. An interim Oversight Committee, as deemed necessary by the CPO Review and Working Committees, shall be appointed by the GBC.
 - a. The primary and ongoing role of this Committee is to ensure CPO policies and procedures are properly followed now and into the future.
 - b. The Oversight Committee shall not participate in any adjudications and/or investigations.
 - c. The Oversight Committee will report to the GBC EC.
4. During the upcoming year the following will be priorities for the ICPO:
 - a. The ICPO Director, is to prioritize the finalization of any pending cases, particularly those in Bangladesh and Mayapur during this year. The GBC will assist in any way it can upon request.
 - b. The ICPO shall work forthwith with the Bharat CPO to create a shared list of review panel members (including several from India) that can be drawn from for any India cases. The ICPO will work with Regional CPOs, including the Bharat CPO, in a way to share information for future functioning.
 - c. The ICPO Director shall support and permit Regional CPOs to establish their own review panels in their respective regions comprising of trained and qualified members.
 - d. All new review panel members are to undergo the foundational adjudication training provided by the Justice Ministry and supplemented by the ICPO.
 - e. The ICPO Director shall provide detailed quarterly updates on the caseload and progress reports in a format to be jointly agreed upon between himself and the Oversight Committee.
 - f. The ICPO Director shall provide the Oversight Committee with a detailed annual account of CPO expenses and an annual budget request.
 - g. The ICPO Director undertakes to ensure that he will render his fullest cooperation to the Oversight Committee in respect of sharing information and documents as and when necessary, as determined by the Oversight Committee.

The Oversight Committee shall monitor progress in these areas and offer its assistance where needed.

5. A Co-Director may be appointed by the GBC during this year to serve in the ICPO. This will be done in consultation with Kamalesh Krishna dasa.

6. During 2024, the GBC will be considering a restructuring of the ICPO, and its processes based on a review from the Executive Secretariat Office (ESO), as well as the policies adopted from the 2023 Child Protection Review Committee and Working Group. The ICPO Director is directed to serve as an advisor to those processes.

GBC Resolution 450.03 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

407.01 • Teaching deity worship in ISKCON (2025)

[Governing law]

Whereas in 1996 the GBC established the following mandate for Ministers:

To establish the curriculum of his discipline and disseminate this knowledge throughout ISKCON.

Whereas for the sake of comparison, in 1997 the GBC passed the following resolution:

THAT the five-day seminar course established by the Global Book Distribution Minister is accepted

as the official training course for all ISKCON book distributors.

This course is to be taken by all:

1. New regular book distributors within the first twelve months of their book
2. distributing career, and
3. Regular book distributors by Gaura Purnima 1998, and
4. Part time book distributors are encouraged to take this course.

The Global Book Distribution Minister is responsible to supervise the standard and content of the Book Distribution Graduate Course, promote it and ensure the requirements of this resolution are met.

Whereas since 1999 the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry (IDWM) has been actively developing and

presenting its curriculum globally and regularly presents courses in countries around the world;

Whereas 25+ years' experience training devotees has shown us how to present curriculum in a way to

avoid an elitist pujari mentality, and also how to guide devotees to have a balanced approach to setting

realistic, sustainable standards of worship for ISKCON centers;

Whereas ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry is the GBC's mandated agent for this discipline, and therefore the

most well positioned instrument to present authoritative teachings pertaining to deity worship within

ISKCON;

Whereas ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry now has more than 20 different courses on a wide range of deity

worship topics and topics related to deity worship;

Whereas when teaching a specific subject it is important that all facilitators address the same learning

objectives and present the same information, thus avoiding confusion amongst learners, and within

ISKCON;

Whereas a systematic curriculum, that is aligned with the GBC given mandate of IDWM, will enable

consistent standards of worship throughout ISKCON;

Whereas irregular presentations on deity worship are becoming more prevalent in ISKCON. Some of these

presentations even invalidate the teachings of our founder-acarya;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada stated:

The greatest danger to our movement will come when we manufacture and create our own process for worshipping the deities. ...follow it just to the exact standard as I have given you, that's all.–

Letter

to: Dhruvananda -- Bombay 4 January, 1973

You should only do what I tell you and show you in regard to deity worship, and never make anything up or copy something you see somewhere else. – Personal instruction to Nanda Kumar dasa

Whereas Srila Prabhupāda also explains:

So we have to accept religious principles from the leaders of the sampradāyas. Otherwise it is useless. Sampradāya-vihīnā ye mantrās te viphalā matāḥ [Padma Purāṇa]: "If you do not accept mantra initiation from the disciplic succession of the sampradāya, then it will be useless.... So people are manufacturing religion without any reference to these authorities. – Śrīmad-Bhagavatam

6.1.34-39. December 19, 1970, Surat

Whereas in order to establish and disseminate a curriculum, Ministries need to regulate the curriculum and

who is teaching the curriculum

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. All courses relating to deity worship in its entirety presented in ISKCON must be approved by ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry. This includes and is not limited to courses on the following topics:

Temple deity worship

Home deity worship

Deity installations

Samskaras

Observing festivals

2. Only devotees who are mandated by ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry may present or teach courses

on deity worship and deity worship related matters. Devotees who are authorised by IDWM to teach

deity worship will have appropriate teaching qualifications and be graduates from an IDWM approved course on the topic they are teaching. IDWM may also from time to time approve devotees to teach various topics without them having to complete an IDWM approved course.

3. All IDWM approved courses must offer IDWM approved certificates.

GBC Resolution 407.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2025

407.01 · Moving large deities (2025)

[Governing law]

Preamble: The question occasionally arises as to whether or not it is acceptable to move large marble

deities. In certain circumstances deities may be moved, but this cannot be done whimsically. The deities

can only be moved for the right reasons. As explained by Srila Prabhupada, to move the deities for profit, or

to get a prestigious building is not the correct motive. Sometimes it may happen that moving deities is

unavoidable, in situations where natural disaster is threatening the deity, or to protect the deity from harm.

Sometimes it may also be necessary to move deities when an ISKCON center cannot care for the deities.

However, the general principle is that large deities should never be moved once the worship has begun.

This proposal addresses this question.

Whereas Srila Prabhupada was generally strongly opposed to the moving of deities, as the following

excerpt demonstrates:

It is not very good policy to move the deities once they have been installed. – Letter to Karandhara,

GBC Resolution 407.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

407.03 · Observing festivals on the day of the correct tithi (2025)

[Guideline]

Whereas it has been reported that at some ISKCON centers, major festivals are sometimes observed on

days and times that are convenient for the congregation to attend and not observed on the days specified

for the observance in the Vaishnava Calendar;

Whereas while encouraging the congregation to participate in temple celebrations is certainly important,

observing these occasions on the designated day and time is most auspicious and recommended for all

devotees. The full-time practicing devotees and others who are able to attend the temple on those most

auspicious days and times to participate in the observance should as far as possible be facilitated to do so;

And whereas Srila Prabhupada emphasized observing festivals according to the designated days and

times as practiced in our sampradaya

Therefore, it is resolved that:

All ISKCON centres are encouraged to:

1. Observe all major festivals on their actual dates;
2. Once such an observance is held, additional observances of the same nature may also be held on subsequent days and times more convenient for the congregational devotees to attend to keep them inspired in devotional service. Additional observances may be simple or elaborate, depending on the need.
3. Devotees are encouraged to fast on those actual dates according to Srila Prabhupada's instructions and GBC guidelines

The following is the list of festivals with their observance timings that are to be considered as major

festivals as per the above rule:

Sri Gaur Purnima (Evening)

Sri Rama Navami (Noon)

Sri Nrsimha Caturdasi (Evening)

Sri Balaram Purnima (Noon)

Sri Krishna Janmastami (Midnight)

Srila Prabhupada's Appearance Day (Noon)

Sri Radhastami (Noon)

Srila Prabhupada's Disappearance Day (Noon)

Sri Nityananda Trayodasi (Noon)

GBC Resolution 407.03 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

411.02 • Temple kirtana guidelines (2025)

[Guideline]

Whereas there is a need in ISKCON for clarity in temple room kirtana guidelines.

Therefore it is resolved that:

The GBC approves the Temple Kirtana Guidelines as appended below. It shall be a living document that may be amended as required by the ISKCON Kirtana Ministry, provided such amendments are first circulated on the GBC email conference, and no objections are received within thirty days.

Temple Kirtana Guidelines

Based on the teachings of His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada Founder-Acharya of

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)

Preamble: Devotees are encouraged to chant wholeheartedly in all temple kirtanas. Managers should do

their best to implement these standards for the pleasure of Srila Prabhupada and the Vaisnavas. Participants are encouraged to follow these guidelines under the guidance of the local ISKCON management team in a mood of loving cooperation.

Golden Guidelines:

1. Always consider, “Is this kirtana pleasing to Srila Prabhupada?”
2. The most important sound in the kirtana is the congregational chanting, which the instruments should never overpower.
3. Kirtana should be attractive, welcoming, and inclusive.

Kirtana Leaders

1. Preferably, ISKCON initiated devotees in good standing, chanting at least 16 daily rounds and following the four regulative principles. Or, if not initiated, at least following the four regulative principles, accept Srila Prabhupada’s teachings and regularly chanting japa.
2. Appearance: Preferably clean and simple dress, face shaven, with Gaudiya Vaisnava tilaka. For men, dhoti, kurta, and chaddar are encouraged. For women, saris or gopi dress and shawl are encouraged. Shorts and other revealing clothes are discouraged.

Mantras

1. During temple arati kirtanas, first chant Srila Prabhupada’s Pranam Mantras, Panca Tattva Maha Mantra(s), and then the Hare Krishna Maha Mantra, which should be the primary mantra in every kirtana.
2. Chant the Nrsimha Prayers after each arati.
3. The following may occasionally be sung:
4. Bhajans, mantras from BBT songbooks, and songs from Gaudiya Vaisnava Acharyas.
5. Govinda Jaya Jaya Gopala Jaya Jaya
6. haraye namah krsna yadavaya namah / gopala govinda rama sri-madhusudana
7. Jaya Sacinandana
8. Nitai Gouranga
9. Jaya Prabhupada
10. The chanting of Srimati Radharani’s holy names in isolation from Krishna may be chanted for a few minutes on Radhastami.

11. It is recommended that no words or syllables be added or subtracted.
12. Kirtana leaders should avoid breaking up the response chanting from the congregation according to material designations ie: Male/Female.
13. Breaking the mantra into smaller parts is not encouraged.
14. The chanting should be done first by the leader and then by the congregation. While the leader is chanting, interjections by the congregation of “Chaitanya!”, “Nityananda!”, “Hare Hare!”, etc, are not encouraged.
15. Chanting the deities’ names towards the end of the arati kirtana is optional, as they may be glorified during the Prema Dhvani prayers.
16. Prema Dhvani mantras should be recited at the end of the arati kirtana.

Mangala Arati

1. During Mangala arati, the “morning melody” should be sung.

Instruments

1. The instruments should support the chanting and never overpower the sound of the chanting. Chanting should always be heard.
2. Instrument players should learn the art of playing the instruments both loudly and powerfully as well as softly and sweetly.
3. Mridanga players should aspire to play authentic beats according to parampara. Modern adaptations derived from modern dance music, etc., should be avoided.
4. During the kirtanas and the arati, the following instruments should be played: mridanga and kartalas. Whompers and gong may also be played.
5. The arati kirtana ends with the chanting of the Prema Dhvani mantras.
6. Additional instruments (harmonium, etc.) may be added after the arati kirtanas with the approval of the local management team.
7. While devotees are encouraged to practice the musical instruments to play them nicely for the pleasure of the deities, the temple room is not an appropriate venue. Practicing should be done outside the temple room.
8. The sound of the mridanga should not be eclipsed by other instruments. Therefore, various drums and other instruments that drown out the sound of the mridangas and the chanting are not encouraged.
9. Health considerations of overly loud drums are essential considerations as some devotees develop migraines and even permanent ear damage.

Singing

1. Alap is a classical Hindustani musical technique in which the mantra is lengthened, and additional ornaments are added. This technique was not utilized in ISKCON kirtana during Srila Prabhupada’s physical presence. Alap is not generally appropriate during Arati kirtanas. Other than arati kirtanas,

it may be permitted with the approval of the local management.

2. For those with the capacity, “Rama” should be pronounced as spelled, not “Ramo.”
3. Everyone, including instrument players, should also sing in response, as the congregational chanting is the essence of kirtana.

Sound Systems

4. The sound system should be set at a modest volume. Louder is not better. 85 dBA is a reasonable amount.
5. Refer to GBC Resolution of 2014: 313: Sound Systems Guideline:
<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1tAiBDMTinpnKf9jWVqer0prTequqp-M7eaBHZtANZ5s/edit?usp=sharing>
6. Only one microphone is recommended to be used during kirtanas.
7. All electronic gadgets should be in silent mode or connected to headphones for personal listening.

Dancing

1. Dancing should be graceful, in a traditional Gaudiya Vaishnava style. Approved dances include, but are not limited to, the Swami Step, forward and back, and jumping.
2. Participants should always endeavor to face the deity.

Dancing Safely

1. Dancing should not endanger the physical safety of the participants.
2. Lifting devotees into the air can cause injuries and may not be an appropriate mood.
3. Spinning around should be done with care.

Deities

1. Deities carried into the temple by congregational devotees should be treated with respect and care according to the principles set by the Deity Worship Ministry. They should not be rocked, jumped up and down, or spun around in circles.

GBC Resolution 411.02 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 22, 2025

ADDED · 2025

411.02 · Temple kirtana guidelines infographic (2025)

[Statement]

Whereas the mandate of the ISKCON Kirtana Ministry includes implementing kirtana guidelines. Whereas an effective means to communicate those Temple Kirtana guidelines includes posting an infographic in or near ISKCON temple rooms

Therefore, it is resolved that:

ISKCON Kirtana Ministry will make the Temple Kirtana Guidelines available as an infographic on its website

and circulate the link on the Leadership Discussions email conference by August 1, 2025.

ISKCON centers are encouraged to print and post the Temple Kirtana Guidelines in or near ISKCON

temple rooms by September 1, 2025.

GBC Resolution 411.02 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

414.01 • Sannyasa assessment and approval: amendments (2025)

[Governing law]

Whereas resolution 57/1988 states:

"That a brahmachari be considered for sannyasa only if he has actually strictly followed his vows for

at least ten years and is at least forty years old. In exceptional cases, a man may be awarded sannyasa before the age of forty by a 2/3 majority vote of the GBC Body. To take sannyasa at the age of 50, one must have been on a waiting list for two years; at 45, three years; at 40, four years, and at 35, five years".

Whereas the methods of evaluating candidates, expectations of them, means of training, and assessment

of readiness to take sannyasa, is evolving as per the experience of the Sannyasa Ministry;

Whereas conflicts may be avoided by modifying the current system;

Whereas by modifying the current system, time and energy may be saved at the GBC level;

Whereas by including accomplishments in the process, candidates may be inspired to offer more valuable

service to Srila Prabhupada's mission

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Resolution 57/1988 be replaced by:

The following is the official policy of the Sannyasa Ministry:

1. The Sannyasa Ministry will evaluate the qualities and accomplishments of applicants and thus determine whether a devotee can become a "potential candidate" to possibly become a "sannyasa candidate" to take sannyasa.

Such qualities may include but are not limited to:

- Cooperation with authorities.
- Demonstrates a practical understanding of the concept of "Unity in Diversity".
- Ability to present Krsna consciousness to different levels of people and devotees and effectively increase others' level of commitment to Krsna consciousness.
- Demonstrating exemplary sadhana
- Having a clear grasp of the philosophy and mission of Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu as presented by Srila Prabhupada.
- Ability and sincerity to practice what one preaches.
 - Ability to communicate effectively with all levels of devotees and authorities.

Accomplishments may include but are not limited to:

- Demonstrating an ability to create a preaching field, expand it and maintain it without much outside assistance, thereby exhibiting self-reliance.
- Creating an atmosphere of cooperation between devotees on all levels of Krsna consciousness.
- Leading a balanced life of health, preaching, sadhana, and relationships with devotees.

2. A candidate in order to be eligible to take sannyasa must be at least 40 years old.

3. The minimum number of years each devotee will be confirmed as a "potential sannyasa candidate"

is one year.

4. When a potential candidate is found to be qualified, they may become a sannyasa candidate for one year.

5. After that one year, the sannyasa candidate may be recommended to take sannyasa.

Procedure:

1. The Team for Assessing Sannyasa Candidates (TASC) committee accepts applications for sannyasa once annually.

2. Upon acceptance, applicants have their supporting documents reviewed by secretaries to ensure compliance with Sannyasa Ministry guidelines.

3. A Pre-Submit process begins by the application secretary wherein the Sannyasa Ministry receives

feedback from the various devotees the candidate has mentioned as references in the application.

4. TASC evaluates the candidate based on the feedback received from various devotees and also the

TASC requests the candidate to give class on a verse, which is also heard by the TASC members.

5. TASC members then discuss whether to accept him as a potential candidate or whether further evidence of eligibility is required.

6. Once accepted as a potential sannyasa candidate the candidate has his duties and training prescribed by the TASC, according to Sannyasa Ministry guidelines.

7. The TASC submits a yearly list of all newly accepted potential sannyasa candidates to the Sannyasa Standing Committee.

8. Potential sannyasa candidates fulfill all duties and assignments outlined by the TASC, TSCS (Team for Serving Candidates of Sannyasa), and the Sannyasa Mission committee for a minimum of one year.

9. At the end of each year, their training period is reviewed and, if necessary, renewed as deemed necessary by the TASC, following Sannyasa Ministry guidelines for sufficient improvement.

10. The TASC reviews the performance of potential sannyasa candidates, providing feedback for improvement to them, based on the feedback received from their recommending GBC, Guru, sannyasa mentors, and prospective sannyasa gurus, travel reports, mission reports, and Sannaysa college, etc.

11. Failure to comply with TASC guidance incurs a warning, followed by a second warning, and eventual removal from the list of potential sannyasa candidates.

12. The Sannyasa Standing Committee reserves the right to remove a potential candidate at any time, based on TASC advice or their own simple majority decision.

13. When the TASC is satisfied with overall progress of the potential sannyasa candidate he is then

proposed to be accepted as a candidate to the Sannyasa Standing Committee, which then votes by a 2/3 majority.

14. A list of sannyasa candidates is presented to the GBC at the next AGM for their vote, with a minimum recommended waiting period of one year.

15. The GBC has the authority to waive or extend the waiting period by a simple majority vote.

GBC Resolution 414.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2025

436.04 · Acceptance of the Guru Services Committee policy manual (2025)

[Statement]

Whereas ISKCON Law does not at present contain a comprehensive statement on the handling of complaints against ISKCON gurus;

Whereas the Guru Services Committee has drafted a Guru Services Policy Manual and has submitted it for approval on December 8, 2022

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That the Guru Services Policy Manual as attached is approved as the methodology for dealing with complaints against ISKCON gurus by the Guru Services Committee.

GBC Resolution 436.04 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2025

441.02 · Memorial wall for departed Srila Prabhupada disciples in Mayapur (2025)

[Governing law]

Whereas with the passing of time, and devotees aging and leaving their bodies it is essential that a Vaisnava Memorial policy is established for ISKCON as soon as possible;

Whereas even though there have been GBC mandates to study and establish a standard policy for honoring departed Vaisnavas and to determine the type of memorial suitable for departed Vaisnavas, till

now there is no consolidated policy or clear direction from the GBC to the ISKCON community;

Whereas it should be noted that in general, cremation is the norm for Vaiṣṇavas

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC directs the Mayapur management to arrange for a memorial wall to honor departed disciples of

His Divine Grace A.C Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada.

Any Srila Prabhupada disciple will be eligible to be remembered on these Memorial Walls with a plaque.

The plaque will have the name of the departed devotee, the date (at least the year) they were initiated by

Śrīla Prabhupada, and the date of their departure (at least the year) from this world. The Mayapur management is directed to fund this memorial wall.

GBC Resolution 441.02 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2025

441.03 · Memorial walls for departed devotees in ISKCON centers around the (2025)

[Guideline]

world — 2025

Whereas with the passing of time, and devotees aging and leaving their bodies it is essential that a Vaisnava Memorial policy is established for ISKCON as soon as possible;

Whereas even though there have been GBC mandates to study and establish a standard policy for honoring departed Vaisnavas and to determine the type of memorial suitable for departed Vaisnavas, till

now there is no consolidated policy or clear direction from the GBC to the ISKCON community;

Whereas it should be noted that in general, cremation is the norm for Vaiṣṇavas

Therefore, it is resolved that:

ISKCON centers (where the property is owned by ISKCON) are encouraged, at their discretion, to allocate

space for a memorial wall to commemorate departed devotees who have honorably served in those temples.

Each of these devotees will be honored by a plaque placed on the memorial wall. The plaque should have

the name of the departed devotee, the date (at least the year) when and if they were initiated, the date (at

least the year) of their departure from this world and may have a picture. The respective management of

each temple is requested to fund this memorial wall.

GBC Resolution 441.03 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

442.01 · Mandate of the GBC Executors and Property Oversight Committee (2025)

[Governing law]

(GEPOC) – 2025

Whereas the GBC, acting on concerns raised amongst its members, reviewed the mandate of the GBC

Executors Property and Oversight Committee (GEPOC) and, particularly, its Schedule of Authority, which

was established in a 2022 GBC resolution to revitalize property protection in ISKCON;

Whereas the Schedule of Authority, which defines the GEPOC’s role in ISKCON property protection,

currently empowers the GEPOC to approve the sale of properties outside of India without seeking approval

from the GBC;

Whereas it is imperative that the GBC, as ISKCON’s ultimate managing authority, possesses the power to

approve or reject the proposed mortgage, borrowing against, sale, transfer, encumbrance, disposal, or

alienation of ISKCON properties outside of India.

(Note that Srila Prabhupada’s Will explicitly specifies “...mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, transferred, or

in any way encumbered, disposed of, or alienated...” in respect of ISKCON properties.)

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The Schedule of Authority in respect of the sale, purchase, or mortgage of any ISKCON properties outside

India is hereby updated and amended as follows:

(a) The ISKCON Global Property Office (IGPO), which reports solely to the GEPOC, its direct oversight

authority, shall bring a proposal for any potential mortgage, borrowing against, sale, transfer, encumbrance,

disposal, or alienation of ISKCON properties to the GEPOC for review.

(b) The GEPOC shall process and review the IGPO’s report on the potential mortgage, borrowing against,

sale, transfer, encumbrance, disposal, or alienation of such a property and present its recommendations in

a report to the GBC for its approval or disapproval.

(c) For the avoidance of any doubt, the IGPO and GEPOC shall not process any purchases of ISKCON

properties.

GBC Resolution 442.01 · 2025 · AGM, passed February 23, 2025

443.01 · Establishing the Succession Committee (2025)

[Administrative order]

Whereas succession planning is a need throughout ISKCON leadership, including but not limited to the GBC;

Whereas in order for the GBC to have qualified new members, succession planning on all levels of leadership is needed;

Whereas the GBC discussed issues of succession at the 2023 Midterm General Meeting in Pune;

Whereas a written Succession Protocol will ensure smooth changeovers and be a precedent and reference manual for successive generational changes at all levels of ISKCON leadership;

Whereas the GBC Organizational Development Committee was tasked to propose a Succession and Transition strategy that detailed a step-by-step process, including options for retention of skills and revised roles;

Whereas this was for the GBC, but there is wisdom in broadening this strategy to other levels of ISKCON leadership;

Whereas a survey of the GBC showed that at least 11 GBC Members intend to retire within 5 years;

Whereas succession planning must be seen as a journey and not an event;

Whereas the appointment of a Succession Committee is a necessary response to mitigate against the consequences of poor succession planning;

Whereas even the best strategy can fail if an organization doesn't have a group of leaders with the right capabilities at the various levels

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. The Succession Committee referred to in the minutes originally in 2014 is approved as a GBC Standing Committee to assist development at all levels of senior leadership.
2. The initial membership of the Succession Committee shall comprise of Caitanya Avatari dasa and Gauranga dasa (co-convenors), Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Rasa Krida Parayana dasa, Dina Sharana devi dasi, Devakinandan dasa (Juhu) and Aniruddha dasa.
3. The membership may be expanded to include additional representatives as tasks are further delineated.

The Committee's mandate is to serve in an advisory role to:

1. Share best practices with the ISKCON Society for recognizing, recruiting and preparing ISKCON devotees for leadership positions.

2. Share mechanisms for the smooth transition of leadership.
3. Develop effective processes to guide outgoing leaders in offering all the positive forms of support to their successor.
4. Provide materials for detailed exit interviews and the use of that data for ongoing improvement.
5. Offer systems to help train, support, and provide orientation to newly appointed ISKCON leaders.
6. Work in cooperation with the GBC Nominations Committee which is specifically involved in the work of nominating candidates for the GBC.

GBC Resolution 443.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 16, 2025

451.01 • Establishing the ISKCON global crisis response team (IGCRT) (2025)

[Administrative order]

the team

Whereas ISKCON is a global organization with temples, installed Deities, congregational and temple

resident devotees, projects and programs, and other assets, in almost every country of the world;

Whereas unforeseen events and crises may include natural events such as fire, flood, and earthquakes;

leadership issues, including moral and ethical violations; technology failures; breakdown of financial

systems; legal or regulatory issues; political upheavals; and more;

Whereas crises can, and have, threatened ISKCON's financial sustainability, organizational integrity, global

reputation, and can lead to the loss of faith of devotees;

Whereas ISKCON management teams alone may not have the skills or expertise to prepare for and

respond to such crises, nor the ability to address "smoldering crises" (See Addendum One);

Whereas crises need to be handled by teams established in advance by ISKCON leadership at the global

GBC and the RGB/zonal/regional levels, and as appropriate, local levels;

Whereas depending on their locale, impact and severity, crises should be managed by local, regional or

global teams provided they are properly trained and coordinated;

Whereas unpredictable or unexpected events, especially, often require an immediate response by a dedicated, trained and coordinated leadership team;

Whereas ISKCON needs a comprehensive system to both prepare for, and respond to, all types of crises;

Whereas a crisis response system, beginning at the global level, needs to be a sufficiently resourced, multi-

disciplinary team that is pre-emptive in its approach, and empowered to be responsive as needed;

Whereas a sub-committee of the Organizational Development Committee (composed of the GBC Legal

Counsel, the ISKCON Communications Minister, a thrice-serving former GBC Executive Chairman, and the

former GBC Executive Office Chairperson) have studied this issue in depth and offered their analysis

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. An ISKCON Global Crisis Response Team (IGCRT) is hereby formed. The IGCRT will serve under

the authority of the GBC Body.

2. Its members shall consist of:

a. Standing Members:

i. GBC Executive Committee Chair, or another GBC EC member designated annually

- ii. Director GBC Executive Secretariat Office
- iii. Global Communications Minister
- iv. Executive Secretariat Office (ESO) Communications Director
- v. Crisis Officer
- vi. Administrative Assistant

b. Ad hoc Members

- i. GBC General Counsel (GGC)
- ii. Expert consultants, engaged as needed to address a particular crisis

3. Regional Governing Bodies (RGB) and other regional, national, and zonal governing bodies will be

strongly advised to establish Regional Crisis Response Teams within two years of the passage of this resolution, following a similar format, including that the GBC Member who oversees that Zone/Area must be on the Crisis Response Team, as well as the Legal Advisor or Director, the Communications Director, and other experts as available. It is recommended that individual temples

establish Local Crisis Response Teams as appropriate, with a similar structure, ie., they must include the local Temple President, Legal Advisor or Director, Communications Director, and other crisis experts as available.

4. Depending on the severity and geographical impact of any crisis, a crisis shall be addressed by the

Global, Zonal or Regional Crisis Response Team, or Local Crisis Response Team. When clarity is needed on jurisdiction of response, the decisions of the IGCRT take precedence.

5. The Crisis Officer shall be nominated by the ESO Director and appointed by majority vote of the IGCRT members annually. The initial Crisis Officer will be Madhavi-Gopi dd, of the UK.

6. The ESO Director will coordinate and support the work of the Global and Regional Crisis Response

Teams as required.

(To read the entire description, [click here](#))

GBC Resolution 451.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 16, 2025

407.02 · Worshipping Laksmi-Nrsimha and Prahlada Maharaja in North (2026)

[Statement]

Atlanta, USA — 2025

Whereas a group of ISKCON devotees residing in North Atlanta has established a temple and now seeks to have it officially recognized and affiliated as an ISKCON temple under the jurisdiction and guidance of the GBC.

Whereas the North American Regional Governing Body (NA RGB) hereby proposes to formally accept the North Atlanta center into the International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON).

Whereas the NA RGB has determined that, as a prerequisite for the North Atlanta center to be formally recognized as an ISKCON temple, its deity worship standards must first receive approval from the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry (IDWM).

Whereas NA RGB has formally requested the IDWM to conduct a review of the deity worship at the North Atlanta center and to submit a report of its findings to the NA RGB.

Whereas the North Atlanta center has submitted a formal application for the worship for deities of: Gaura-Nitai (large & small), Laksmi-Nrsimhadeva and Prahlada Maharaja (large & small), two (2) Salagrama-silas, Srila Prabhupada (large & small) and small deities of the guru parampara.

Whereas the North Atlanta center established these deities May 6th, 2023 and has been consistently worshipping Them since that time.

Whereas ISKCON Law “Regulation of installations — 2017” states:

For any applications for deities apart from those given by Srila Prabhupada, i.e., Radha-Krsna; Jagannatha, Baladeva, Subhadra; Gaura-Nitai (or Panca-tattva); and salagrama silas; the IDWM requires executive input. Therefore, for any application that includes Krsna-Balarama or Sita Rama Laksmi Hanuman, the IDWM will consult with the GBC Executive Committee for approval. Any deities, apart from the aforementioned, must be approved by the GBC Body before the IDWM can issue a Certificate of Readiness for installing deities.

Whereas it was the intention of the IDWM in proposing this law that the aforementioned ISKCON regulation shall apply not only to the commencement of worship of new deities within an ISKCON center, but also in instances where a non-ISKCON center or temple with existing deities seeks to become affiliated as an ISKCON center.

Whereas the purpose of this resolution is to evaluate a center's ability to properly maintain the worship and care for the deities, ensuring that their worship does not become an undue burden on the Society in the future.

Whereas the Zonal GBC for Southeast (Zone 3) North America, Bir Krishna Goswami, has expressed his support for the North Atlanta center becoming an official ISKCON center and for the continued worship of the aforementioned deities.

Whereas the North American representatives of IDWM have evaluated the North Atlanta center for the availability of qualified brahmanas, as well as other required facilities and resources.

Whereas recognizing the importance of integrating the North Atlanta center into the broader ISKCON

community, and after consulting with Balabhadra Bhattacharya dasa, the Regional Director, and Shyam

Behari dasa, the Temple President of the North Atlanta center—who have expressed their dedication and

commitment to consistently guide and support the local community, as well as their willingness to fully

implement all recommendations issued by the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry in a structured and time-

bound manner—IDWM is ready to approve the deity worship at the North Atlanta center.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry is hereby authorized to issue a Certificate of Readiness to the North

Atlanta center for the worship of Lakshmi-Nrsimhadeva and Prahlada Maharaja (both large and small).

GBC Resolution 407.02 · 2026 · Correspondence Vote, passed May 29, 2025

ADDED · 2026

407.02 · Installing Lalita-Visakha Deities in Gurugram — 2025 (2026)

[Action order]

Whereas ISKCON Gurugram Sector 45 has requested permission to install 42-inch marble deities of Lalita-

Visakha on 5 November 2025 along with deities of Radha-Krsna.

Whereas ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry requires GBC permission to offer approval for Lalita-Visakha deities.

Whereas ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry's India representatives have assessed ISKCON Gurugram

Sector 45 as having all the necessary brahmanas and other facilities to care for the deities of Radha-Krsna

Lalita-Visakha.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry is hereby granted permission to issue a Certificate of Readiness to

ISKCON Gurugram - sector 45 for the 42-inch marble deities of Lalita-Visakha.

GBC Resolution 407.02 · 2026 · Correspondence Voting, passed February 4, 2026

444.02 • GBC Succession Committee Facilitation Team members — 2025 (2026)

[Statement]

Whereas succession at all levels of leadership is a critical need for ISKCON's long-term stability.

Whereas the GBC Body has already recognized the urgency of establishing structured and seamless

transitions, particularly at the GBC level.

Whereas without a clear, systematic approach, ISKCON risks leadership vacuums, confusion, and weakened organizational strength.

Whereas at the 2025 AGM, the GBC created a Succession Committee to draft an actionable framework.

Whereas after global consultation with National Councils, the Committee established a GBC Succession

Facilitation Committee to:

- Coordinate structured communication between GBC, National Councils, and zones
- Identify, assess, and recommend qualified succession candidates
- Assist zones in transition planning
- Provide accountability and regular reporting to the GBC Body.

Whereas this proposal formalizes the membership of the Facilitation Team (zone-wise) and establishes a

timeline for all GBC members to participate in the process. By January 31, 2026, each GBC member will

have begun succession discussions with the Facilitation Team and begin exploring potential names with

the Facilitation Team. A comprehensive progress update will be presented at the 2026 AGM in Mayapur.

Whereas this action ensures ISKCON's global governance remains strong, stable, and faithful to Srila

Prabhupada's vision.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC Body approves the following devotees as members of the GBC Succession Facilitation Team for

their respective zones, to be reconfirmed annually at the GBC AGM:

- Africa: Umapati dasa (GKG) & Harideva dasa (BCAIS)
- Arab League & Islamic Countries: Srivallabha dasa (JPS), Aniruddha Gopal dasa (JPS), Vrajaprana dasa (JPS)
- Latin America: Paramatma dasa (SDG), Prema Rupa Madhava dasa (JPS) & Devakinandan dasa (Brazil) (HPS)
- Europe: Krishna Premarupa dasa (BSDS) Parabhakti dasa (RNS)
- Russia & Central Asia: Aprameyatma dasa (SRS), Adi Gopinath dasa (GKG)
- Asia: Southeast Asia – Sri Narayan dasa (GKG), Raghunandana dasa (MVG)
- Oceania & Indonesia: Aniruddha dasa (BJD) & Krishna Chandra dasa (BKG)
- North America: Srutisagara dasa (KKD) & Govind Priya devi dasi (RNS)
- Indian Subcontinent:
 - o North – Rishikumar dasa (GKG) & Sundar Gopal dasa (GKG)

- o West – Mukund Madhava dasa (BSDS)
- o East – BV Bhagavata Swami (JPS)
- o South – Narayana Chaitanya dasa (JPS)

GBC Resolution 444.02 · 2026 · Mid-term General Meeting, passed October 4, 2025

ADDED · 2026

444.02 · GBC Members submitting names of successors to succession (2026)

[Statement]

committee — 2025

Resolved that:

All GBC members who have not yet identified their proposed candidates to succeed them shall work with the Facilitation Team of their particular zone and whenever feasible submit potential names to the Succession Committee Co-Convenors (Gauranga dasa & Caitanya Avatari dasa).

The progress of the Succession Committee work in terms of the potential GBC Nominees' names and status will be reviewed annually at the AGM and MGM.

GBC Resolution 444.02 · 2026 · Mid-term General Meeting, passed October 4, 2025

ADDED · 2026

446.01 · Establishing the Drafting Committee of the ISKCON Constitution (2026)

[Administrative order]

Resolved that:

Having completed the compilation of the text of the ISKCON Constitution, the ISKCON Constitution Project

Team are hereby formally accepted as the “Drafting Committee of the ISKCON Constitution.”

The Drafting Committee shall remain available to the GBC and the rest of ISKCON as a reference and

resource for questions of interpretation of the letter, spirit, and application of the Constitution.

GBC Resolution 446.01 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 7, 2026

ADDED · 2026

447.23 · ISKCON 60th and Srila Prabhupada Tirobhava 50th Anniversary Global (2026)

[Administrative Order]

Committee — 2025

Whereas observance of both ISKCON's 60th Anniversary in 2026 and the 50th Anniversary of Srila Prabhupada's Tirobhava in 2027 offer outstanding opportunities for deepening ISKCON members' connection with our Founder-Acarya A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada and expanding Srila Prabhupada's ISKCON mission.

Whereas there is a need for international leadership, support and coordination to maximize the success of ISKCON's efforts for these observances.

Whereas the close succession of these events warrants a combined approach and a unified effort.

Whereas devotees, temples and zones should be encouraged and supported to plan and prepare this year, 2025, for these observances.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The 60-50 Commemoration Global Committee is created.

Its initial members shall include Anuttama dasa (Co-Chair, ISKCON Minister for Communications), Pancharatna dasa (Co-Chair, GBC SPT), and Parijata devi dasi (GBC Executive Support Office — ESO, Director - Communications), They shall add additional members as required.

The GBC, Regional Governing Bodies, ISKCON Ministries, Temples, and other ISKCON communities and projects are encouraged to develop national, regional and local committees for planning and conducting multiple programs and events. The Global Committee shall develop and provide support including appropriate graphics, themes and event and program ideas and guidelines

GBC Resolution 447.23 · 2026 · Mid-term General Meeting, passed October 5, 2025

5 ISKCON Spiritual Leadership

5.1 Definition

The following shall be considered to be ISKCON Leaders: All members of the GBC, initiating gurus, Ministers, *Sannyasis*, Regional Secretaries, Temple Presidents, Temple Vice-presidents, Members of a Temple's Board of Directors, Project Leaders (for Projects such as ISCOWP, BI, etc.), and other ISKCON Leaders.

5.2 Standards of Behavior

5.2.1 Spiritual Practices

All ISKCON Leaders must visibly chant sixteen rounds a day, follow the four regulative principles, and religiously attend the daily morning program in the temple, as prescribed by Srila Prabhupada.

5.2.2 Active Assistance to the GBC Body

ISKCON Leaders, and other senior members of the Society, shall be responsible to actively assist the GBC in maintaining and enhancing the spiritual standard of ISKCON, expanding the dynamic preaching of ISKCON, and preserving Srila Prabhupada's mood and instructions.(82)

5.2.3 Leadership Positions

1. If a devotee occupying an important position in ISKCON leaves the Society, returns, leaves again, etc., he is always welcome to return, but he cannot immediately take up the same position (such as *sannyasa*).⁽⁷⁸⁾
2. All leaders in ISKCON should clearly present the letter and spirit of the Society's rules and policies to those under their authority, and must clearly qualify any differing viewpoint as their own personal opinion.

5.2.4 Financial Dealings

That ISKCON has a moral obligation to Srila Prabhupada, as well as a legal right to pursue deviant managers who encumber ISKCON entities with liabilities stemming from unauthorized acts. If ISKCON representatives cannot convince deviant managers to accept personal liability through reason and argument, or through the ISKCON Judicial System, they have the right to pursue them through the competent courts.

5.2.5 Disqualifications

No devotee who has remarried after having divorced a devotee-spouse shall serve as a member of the Governing Body Commission or as a Temple President.

Exempt from this law are devotees who become divorced against their desire by the action of their spouses, or as a consequence of their spouses' becoming committed non-devotees. Provisionally exempt are devotees who divorced prior to March 2, 1990.⁽⁹²⁾

Update 2010: (this is not categorized as ISKCON Law)

Henceforward, a devotee shall not be approved to serve as a GBC Member, RGB Member, Regional Secretary, Zonal Secretary, Project Director, other Officer of an International ISKCON project, or Temple President of any ISKCON center, if, as determined by the appointing authority, within the ten years preceding the appointment he or she:

- a. Seriously deviated from the standard initiation vows; or
- b. Whether within the ISKCON society or not, was responsible for a financial impropriety that put significant

funds or other assets at risk; or, who risked legal consequences through the improper handling of funds and assets under his or her control; or, whose unauthorized actions caused a loss of significant funds; or
c. Engaged in serious criminal activity according to the law of the land; or
d. Otherwise engaged in an act of moral turpitude, as defined in the ecclesiastical discretion of the GBC, and/or the law of the jurisdiction in which the devotee candidate resides.

While screening candidates for such positions, appointing authorities, whether individual officials or groups, must make all reasonable efforts to ensure that the above principles are upheld. Such efforts must include seeking from the candidates full disclosures of any activities they have been involved in during the previous ten years that could be considered as falling within the clauses above as well as references of good character from friends, employers, supervisors, associates, and others who are personally familiar with the character of the devotee candidate, as the situation may require (e.g. working in close proximity with children, etc.).

5.3 Duties

5.3.1 Regarding Preaching

1. Wherever we have powerful leaders-whether GBC members, *gurus*, *sannyasis*, or Temple Presidents-they ought to impress upon their followers that book distribution and making new devotees to go out on book distribution are ISKCON's main work. (See p. 147 for more information.)
2. That the leaders of ISKCON, as followers of Srila Prabhupada, ought to see and promote book distribution as our most effective means of preaching. (See p. 147 for more information.)
3. That the leaders of ISKCON, as followers of Srila Prabhupada, ought to see the duty of training and facilitating congregational members as their primarily function, in order to fulfill the order of Lord Caitanya: "Therefore I order every man within this universe to accept this Krsna consciousness movement and distribute it everywhere." (96) (See p. 151 for more information.)
4. Wherever we have powerful leaders-whether GBC members, *gurus*, *sannyasis*, or Temple Presidents-they ought to impress upon their followers that everyone must be brought into the congregation and empowered to preach Krsna consciousness purely. (96) (See p. 151 for more information.)

5.3.2 Correcting Spiritual Deficiencies in Temples

It is the responsibility of the President, Regional Secretary, or GBC to correct any spiritual deficiencies in the temple program. Any alleged deficiency in a temple's program is not in itself sufficient grounds to justify or order a devotee to abandon one's prescribed duty.

5.4 Regulations

5.4.1 Legal Affairs

The GBC directs the officers and managers of all ISKCON corporations to make all necessary and prudent arrangements to defend the corporations and their properties from legal liabilities. Failure to make such arrangements shall be sufficient ground for removal of the officers, Regional Secretaries or GBC Zonal Secretaries.

5.4.2 Oath of Loyalty

An annual oath of allegiance shall be made and signed by each ISKCON Leader in the prescribed manner. (75)

5.4.2.1 *Statement of Oath*

The oath shall be as follows:

1. To accept His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada as the Founder-Acarya and Supreme Authority of ISKCON. To follow his teachings, instructions and directions.
2. To accept the Governing Body Commission of ISKCON as the ultimate managing authority of ISKCON as directed in Srila Prabhupada's last will and testament.
3. To abide by the Society's spiritual rules, namely no illicit sex, no intoxication, no gambling, no meat-eating and chant a minimum of sixteen rounds of *maha-mantra japa* every day. To follow the principles set forth in Srila Prabhupada's books.
4. To accept that all ISKCON's funds, assets and properties under my control or direction, including anything ISKCON may have acquired under my direction, is the sole property of ISKCON and in the event of my death, resignation or other relinquishment of all ISKCON responsibilities, all these shall accrue solely to ISKCON and at all times I shall have no claim on them whatsoever.
5. To be guided by the spiritual directions of ISKCON's management, to cooperate with the local GBC representative, and to fulfill my duties in a serving spirit never intentionally acting against ISKCON's interests.
6. I will maintain the spiritual programs, standards, and teachings established by Srila Prabhupada in the projects and with the devotees placed in my care. I further agree not to involve the Society or those devotees placed under my care in any activities contrary to the above mentioned principles.(96)

5.4.2.2 *Procedure for Taking Oaths*

All ISKCON Leaders shall complete the approved ISKCON Oath of Loyalty in the following manner:

1. A signed oath certified by the appropriate legal authority prescribed for giving testimony of a declaration (Notary Public, Judicial Magistrate, Commissioner of Oaths, etc.) in the location shall be deposited with the GBC Society Secretary. This written oath shall be renewed once in five years or whenever there is a change in their position of responsibilities.
2. The GBC's shall make the above oath orally, in a group, before the Deities in Sridhama Mayapur during the course of their annual meetings.
3. Every Temple President, Regional Secretary, Temple Officer, etc. shall take the oath orally before the Deities of the Temple every year. The oath shall be administered by a local GBC Zonal Secretary. (Optionally the oath may be taken at ISKCON Sridhama Mayapur during the Gaura-purnima Festival period).
4. Other leaders not covered above shall also make an annual oral declaration of the oath before an ISKCON Deity administered by the GBC authority or liaison assigned.

This resolution shall override and replace all previous legislation on oaths for ISKCON leaders. This doesn't replace the additional oath that ISKCON gurus must also take.(95)

The existing Oath of Loyalty Law is amended to read as follows: (1998)

The GBC Secretary shall review annually the listing of all GBCs, Temple Managers, Gurus, and Property Trustees and insure that a notarized, signed, ISKCON Oath of Allegiance is on file for that devotee.

The Oath of Allegiance and a list of names of those devotees who have not submitted a notarized, signed Oath of Allegiance shall be sent to the GBC and other com.conferences and addresses. They are to return the Oath duly signed and notarized, to the GBC Office in Mayapur prior to ISKCON's registration date.

Failure of ISKCON Leaders to submit a notarized oath in the required time shall earn an automatic censure. Continued failure to comply by the following GBC Meeting shall put the devotee on automatic probation and possible suspension.

All ISKCON Leaders and any members present shall orally take the Oath of Allegiance on the IKSCON Registration day before Srila Prabhupada and the Deities as a loving offering to His Divine Grace Srila Prabhupada.

5.4.2.3 Oath Required for Leadership Eligibility

1. No member of the GBC or any Regional Secretary or Temple President shall be eligible to vote in the GBC meeting or Temple President's meeting respectively unless their oath of allegiance to ISKCON has been duly submitted to the proper GBC authority. Once done, this needs to be renewed as provided for above.(81)

2. The archive and record of all oaths submitted to the GBC shall be maintained by the GBC Society Secretary who shall also annually provide a list to the Executive Committee of ISKCON Leaders for whom Oaths of Loyalty have been received and the list of delinquent Leaders for enforcement.(80)

5.5 Discipline and Conduct of ISKCON Leaders

Definition of Local ISKCON Official (Replacement 2007)

The specific titles borne by ISKCON officials may possibly include "President", "Vice-President", "Treasurer", "Temple Management Council Member", "Project Director", "Congregational Preaching Director", etc. (Sections concerning tenure and discipline of Regional Secretaries, Gurus and GBC members are to be included in different sections.)

5.5.1 Leave of Absence

An ISKCON Official may be granted a leave of absence at his/her request for any of the following reasons;

1. Acute and unremitting health problem(s).
2. Compelling personal reasons.

The official seeking a leave of absence shall clearly explain in writing to his/her GBC Zonal Secretary(s) or Divisional Council the specific reasons for his/her request. A leave of absence shall not be granted for a period in excess of one year, although it may be extended.

5.5.2 Resignation

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

An ISKCON Official may tender his/her resignation to their GBC Zonal Secretary(s) or Divisional Council at any time. A resignation should be submitted in writing with reasons and an effective date from which the resignation shall stand.

Resignations may be partial in nature, wherein only a portion of the responsibilities held is relinquished, such as when an official agrees to the appointment of a co-official to share the duties of office.

Disciplining Authority

There should ideally be no change of Presidents or ISKCON Leaders. If there are any difficulties there should first be an attempt to resolve it by careful mediation.

An ISKCON Official may be disciplined by any of the following;

A two-thirds majority of a Regional Governing Body or Divisional or National Council.

Three GBCs, which must include the GBC(s) of that area, or

A majority vote of the GBC Body

Depending on the severity of any improper activity, corrective steps may consist of informal discussions, written warnings or censures, or formal disciplinary measures such as placing the offending official on probation, suspension of the official's authority, or removal of the official from the position.

The reason(s) for and the process and standards of rectification, if any, must be given in writing to the official under discipline. The disciplining body or persons must ensure that the details are entered into the relevant resolutions of the disciplining body. In the case of three GBC's, the details shall be recorded by the GBC Secretariat.

Reasons for Discipline

An ISKCON Official may be disciplined for the following indiscretions;

Misconduct and Indiscipline

1. Willful violation of GBC resolutions.
2. Vilification of ISKCON or the GBC Body.
3. Misconduct in office (physical assault except in self-defense, improper relationships with opposite sex, improper sexual behavior, abusive behavior to devotees, improper dealings with external society, and so on.)
4. Habitually or knowingly making false charges and accusations or other consistent *vaisnava-aparadhas*.
5. Serious interference in the *guru* and disciple relationship.
6. Duplicitous or untruthful dealings (giving false promises to devotees, lying to spiritual authorities, and other serious prevarication).

Improper Discharge and Neglect of Duty,

Misuse of Funds and Gross Mismanagement.

1. Consistent unexcused absences at Divisional Council meetings.
2. Consistent failure to submit prescribed monthly reports.
3. Consistent interference in the guru-disciple relationship or consistent disregard of the devotees' requirement to accept a spiritual master and serve him.
4. Consistent or serious economic mismanagement of such a nature that it endangers the temple or preaching mission.
5. Serious degradation of temple standards (deity worship, cleanliness and kitchen standards, devotee morale, preaching, temple economy, etc.)
6. Failing to make all necessary and prudent arrangements to defend their corporations and properties from legal liabilities.

Spiritual Discrepancy

1. Failure to follow strictly the rules and regulations as described in Srila Prabhupada's books.
2. Philosophical deviation.
3. Consistently irregular attendance at the temple morning program without bona fide cause.
4. Failure to follow any of the four regulative principles or to regularly chant sixteen rounds of *japa*.

5.5.3 Censure

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

Censure is to be understood as a reprimand aimed at reformation of an official and prevention of further offending acts. It is the warning voice of pending probation or removal.

When ordering the censure, the disciplining authority must clearly spell out in writing to the disciplined official the specific actions that were irresponsible, inappropriate, or in violation of ISKCON law and why they were judged so.

5.5.4 Probation

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

Probation is an opportunity for disciplined officials to redress themselves and regain their status as ISKCON Officials in good standing.

When ordering the probation, the disciplining authority must clearly spell out in writing to the disciplined official:

the specific actions that were irresponsible, inappropriate, or in violation of ISKCON law and why they were judged so

the specific program of rectification

the specific curtailment of powers, if any

the specific prerequisites for restoration, if any

the time period of the probation, which shall be no longer than six months.

After the period of probation, the disciplining authority must decide as per one of the following:

that the official is rectified and that any restrictions imposed for the term of probation are rescinded; or

that further probation under the same or modified conditions is required to complete the rectification process; or

that the official has not been rectified and that the official be removed from the position.

5.5.5 Suspension

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

In the case where there is substantial reason to believe that an ISKCON official has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON law to the extent that continuation of the official in the particular position will be injurious to the properties, good name, physical assets or other resources of the society, then an official should be suspended from that position.

Suspension is to separate the official from their office so that a thorough investigation of allegations may be conducted and the suitability of the official to continue in their position is determined.

The disciplining body must conduct an immediate investigation so as to minimize disruption at the respective ISKCON centre or project. After completion of the investigation, the body shall make a determination as to the truth of the allegations and the future course of action. They may order as per one of the following:

the suspension shall be revoked and the official shall be restored to the original position; or

there shall be a probationary period with a program of rectification as described under probation above, with or without restoration of authority during the period of probation; or

it is not expected that the official can be rectified within a reasonable period of time and he or she shall be permanently removed from the position.

If an ISKCON official is under suspension he may not vote as a member of any ISKCON management body.

Removal

Under normal circumstances, an ISKCON Official will be removed from his/her position only after being put on probation and consequently unable to rectify his/her situation.

However, in urgent situations, an ISKCON Official may be removed in case of the following:

Any violation of either ISKCON, local or national laws which endangers ISKCON's stability and security locally, nationally or internationally and which cannot wait for the usual process of probation and removal.

Severe spiritual, philosophical or moral deviation.

Rebellion against the authority of Srila Prabhupada, the GBC Body or other regional, national or local ISKCON authorities.

Incompetent management over an extended period of time, giving rise to an emergency situation.

Appeals

If an ISKCON Official is disciplined by three GBCs or a National or Divisional Council, he/she shall have the right of appeal to the Regional Governing Body (if one exists in the area) or the GBC Body (if there is no Regional Governing Body in the area). If he/she is disciplined by a Regional Governing Body, he/she shall have the right of appeal to the GBC Body. Any disciplinary action taken against an ISKCON Official by any of the above-mentioned entities shall stand unless and until it is overruled by a higher body.

5.5.6 Removal

Under normal circumstances, an ISKCON Leader will be removed from his position only after being suspended and unable to rectify his situation. There should ideally be no change of Presidents or ISKCON Leaders. If there are any difficulties they should be resolved by careful mediation. However, in urgent situations, an ISKCON Leader may be removed by

Three GBC's, which must include the GBC(s) of that area, or

A two-thirds majority of a Regional Governing Body or Divisional or National Council.

The reasons for any disciplinary action must be given in writing to the disciplined leader by the disciplining body or persons, who may define a situation as urgent when it involves any of the following:

Any violation of either ISKCON, local or national laws which endangers ISKCON's stability and security locally, nationally or internationally and which cannot wait for the usual process of suspension and removal.

Severe spiritual, philosophical or moral deviation.

Rebellion against the authority of Srila Prabhupada, the GBC Body or other regional, national or local ISKCON authorities.

Incompetent management over an extended period of time, giving rise to an emergency situation.

5.5.7 Appeal

If an ISKCON Leader is disciplined by a National or Divisional Council, he shall have the right of appeal to the Regional Governing Body (if one exists in the area) or the GBC Body (if there is no Regional Governing Body in the area). If he is disciplined by three GBC's or a Regional Governing Body he shall have the right of appeal to the GBC Body. Any disciplinary action taken against an ISKCON Leader by any of the above-mentioned entities shall stand unless and until it is overruled by a higher body.

5.6 Standards and Duties of Spiritual Leaders

5.6.1 Regional Secretaries

5.6.1.1 Definition

The GBC recognizes that as per Srila Prabhupada's instructions, GBC members may have even "thousands of secretaries"; individual GBC members may see the need for appointing assistants who will have greater responsibility than Temple Presidents, and who may be known as Regional Secretaries. (79)

5.6.1.2 Regional Secretary's Duties

5.6.1.2.1 In relation to Zonal Secretary

A Regional Secretary's duties in relation to Statements of Mission shall be to assist the Zonal Secretary to motivate and organize the region's progress in each Statement of Mission area.

5.6.1.2.2 In relation to Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival

That all Regional Secretaries and Temple Presidents will be responsible for setting up their zonal exhibition booths at the annual Mayapur festival. This will be followed up by the Secretary of the Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival Committee.(82)

5.6.2 Presidents of Temples and Preaching Centers

5.6.2.1 Appointment of Temple President

The GBC Zonal Secretary/s shall be the authority to appoint or approve a new Temple President to fill in a vacancy of the post in an existing temple or in a newly established temple. If the candidate is holding such a position for the first time then he shall be appointed only as an acting Temple President for a trial period of one year. A preaching center shall not have the post of a President but shall have the post of a Manager. In all such appointments the Zonal Secretary shall give due considerations to the recommendations of the Divisional Council.

5.6.2.2 Standards of Personal Behavior

5.6.2.2.1 Spiritual Standards

1. A Temple President must be an initiated devotee who follows daily sadhana and full morning program, demonstrably chants sixteen rounds, follows strictly the four regulative principles, studies Srila Prabhupada's books, regularly gives classes, and participates in temple festivals and harinama parties.
2. A Temple President must live in or near enough to a Krsna conscious temple community to regularly, on a daily basis, participate in devotional activities and associate with devotees.
3. A Temple President should be exemplary in all respects in his behavior and character.
4. A Temple President must accept the authority of the GBC Body and the GBC Zonal Secretary and maintain the proper service attitude to senior devotees especially GBC members, initiating spiritual masters and sannyasis.

5. The Temple President should avoid intimate dealings with the opposite sex.

5.6.2.2.2 Standards of Service

A Temple President must fit into one of the following categories:

1. *Sannyasis, brahmacari(ni)s, vanaprasthas*, and brahminical *grhasthas* (living in facilities provided by ISKCON) who are fully maintained by ISKCON who are to be fully engaged in devotional service with all their time and energy.
2. *Grhasthas* who dedicate the major part of their time and energies to their ISKCON duties. They need, however, to earn a minimum amount of income for family obligations that are not defrayed by ISKCON. They are exempted from the fifty percent(50%) donation rule.
3. *Grhasthas* who choose to engage in full-time occupation outside of ISKCON must follow the fifty percent(50%) donation rule, and all of their non-occupational time should also be engaged in devotional service, sacrificing a major portion given in voluntary service to ISKCON.

There is nothing wrong with a householder managing a temple so long as he does not utilize the facilities of the temple for his own personal sense gratification. Certainly the president may get his basic requirements for living and eating fulfilled through the temple, and he may also have his own place to live outside. However, he should not exploit the temple for his own sense gratification. A Temple President must be careful not to take more than what would be allotted to any other householder who is working full time for the temple. For example, he should not have specially prepared opulent meals when the temple devotees are eating austere. In fact, he should eat with the devotees.

5.6.2.3 Principles

5.6.2.3.1 Desirable Qualities of an Ideal Temple President

1. Must be a competent and committed manager who is honest, and trustworthy. Can manage, organize, and conduct meetings.
2. Has a service attitude, respects all devotees and is able to work with others.
3. Can communicate well and is able to motivate and inspire people.
4. Cares for people.
5. Must be expert in his or her area of service or possess a willingness to learn.

A Temple President must be diligent in assuring spiritual standards are maintained within the Temple and its *asramas*.

5.6.2.4 Powers

In the case of some disagreement regarding practical policy or practical philosophy, a traveling party leader, *sannyasi* or non-local GBC member must respect the integrity of the president's authority over his temple. He must defer to the president's position and can initiate change only via the local GBC member.

5.6.2.5 Duties to

5.6.2.5.1 The Temple Deities, Srila Prabhupada, the GBC Body and the Initiating Spiritual Masters

1. Ensure that nobody preaches a philosophy contradictory to the teachings of Srila Prabhupada.
2. Maintain the worship of the temple Deities.
3. Conduct an active and effective missionary campaign to spread Krsna consciousness in the temple's geographical jurisdiction.

4. Oversee and supervise spiritual standards for practicing members and temple programs.

5.6.2.5.2 The GBC Body

1. Implement policies and directions set by Divisional Council and the GBC Body.
2. The Temple President is duty bound to follow all ISKCON Laws and directives without exception.
3. The Temple President's responsibility is to see that the spiritual and administrative standards of ISKCON are maintained.
4. A Temple President's duties in relation to Statements of Mission shall be to be directly responsible to realize the Statement of Mission and Progressive Goals in his temple. He is to motivate the devotees and organize his temple's progress in each Statement of Mission area. He is also to present the progress in an Annual Report for each Statement of Mission for his temple to his Zonal Secretary.

5.6.2.5.3 Administrative Bodies under the GBC

1. Consult with the GBC representative or Divisional Council for all significant matters.
2. Attend all Divisional Council meetings.
3. Attend continental training seminars and Continental Committee meetings.
4. Attend annual International Managers' Meeting in Mayapur. If they desire to do so, Temple Presidents may come early to the annual Mayapur meeting, for their own meetings and association.(77)
5. Establish a communication link with the appropriate GBC Ministries.
6. Temple Presidents shall submit annual reports to the Global Secretariat.

5.6.2.5.4 The Local GBC Member

1. The Temple President should cooperate with the GBC representative(s) assigned to his Temple, consult them on important issues and consider their advice. The GBC representatives are not meant to involve themselves in the day to day management of a temple. However they are responsible for seeing that the ISKCON standards are maintained within all aspects of the Society's activities. When the President is given advice or instructions as to how to maintain or improve these standards, then such instructions are to be followed by the Temple Presidents.
2. The Temple President shall provide monthly financial report and other prescribed reports to the GBC representative and other ISKCON bodies as required. The financial report should contain an itemized account of income and expenditure, the number of books sold, and an inventory of books. A GBC member can go to the center and see and correct any unbonafide expenditure.
3. That if an individual GBC member acts blatantly against the policy of the GBC, the Chairman and Secretary of the GBC Body must be informed immediately of the discrepancy by a temple officer.(81)

5.6.2.5.5 Initiating Spiritual Masters

The Temple President shall take into account any specific suggestions offered by the spiritual masters in regard to guiding their disciples and assigning services. The Temple President shall make the final decision on the services of the devotees based on considerations of effective management of the community.

5.6.2.5.6 Temple Resident Devotees

5.6.2.5.6.1 Sadhana and Temple Programs

Presidents of temples and preaching centers shall see that all devotees in their zones attend the morning and evening programs, except when they have an alternative bona fide preaching engagement in the evening.(77)

5.6.2.5.6.2 Engagement

1. The Temple President shall engage devotees according to their qualifications, propensities and capabilities with a goal to provide a satisfying service which encourages a loving sacrifice to Krsna.
2. Assign each devotee with satisfactory and well-planned service.
3. Provide opportunities for devotees to expand responsibilities, initiate activities, attend to personal matters, and voice suggestions or grievances.
4. The Temple President and Department Heads shall provide adequate training for each devotee assigned to a temple service and strive to maximize the devotee's potential through further training and personal development. They shall maintain an open and supportive climate among the temple staff, inviting suggestions and explaining grievance channels.

5.6.2.5.6.3 Care

1. He should inspire, nurture and guide the devotees of the community in their devotional service.
2. The Temple President shall give due consideration to the potentials, strengths and weaknesses (both material and spiritual) and overall maturity of the devotees. His mood is as servant of the community members.
3. The Temple President shall meet with each resident member when they join the temple and at least quarterly to ensure they are effectively engaged in their service and are progressing in their spiritual life. Thus the personal and spiritual career needs of the devotee can be monitored.
4. Provide all residents space and facilities to rest, to store and secure belongings, to maintain the body, and to study. They shall also provide sufficient quantity of good quality prasadam.
5. To ensure all dependent devotees are provided with adequate health care and health insurance except in those countries where health insurance is provided by state authorities.

5.6.2.5.6.4 Guru-Disciple Relationships

1. Must encourage all devotees to establish a relationship with an ISKCON guru.
2. Must not canvas for a particular guru.
3. Must not undermine or interfere with the relationship of any bona fide ISKCON guru and his disciple.
4. Must preach to temple devotees who are disciples of various gurus to cooperate together in Srila Prabhupada's family.
5. If conflicts arise with a particular guru then the GBC Zonal Secretary(s) should be immediately informed so that he may rectify the situation on his level.
6. Since in ISKCON it is not always possible for the gurus to directly manage and engage their disciples in devotional service, the Temple President engages all the disciples of all spiritual masters in their day to day devotional service to guru and Krsna by allocating appropriate services to the devotees for the pleasure of their respective spiritual masters and Srila Prabhupada.

5.6.2.5.6.5 Evaluation of all Initiated Devotees

It is recommended the Temple President and Department Heads perform a quarterly appraisal of all initiated devotees in their community which can then be used to measure performance and build strategies for improvement. This document can then be shared with the spiritual masters who can also offer their guidance and insights.

5.6.2.5.6.6 Following Local Laws

The Temple President should ensure that all local, state and national laws are abided by all temple and community members. He should also ensure that the devotees are following ISKCON diligently. Update 2009: For disciplinary measures, please go to 8.4

5.6.2.5.7 Congregational Devotees

5.6.2.5.7.1 Facilitating the Preaching of the Congregational Devotees

Temple Presidents and ISKCON Leaders shall encourage and facilitate the important preaching role of non-resident devotees as they introduce Krsna consciousness to their neighbors and business or work associates. The non-resident devotees should get respectful treatment, encouragement and *prasadam*.

5.6.2.5.8 Guests and Life Patron Members

ISKCON Leaders shall provide approved guests with adequate room and *prasadam* arrangements as well as attentive training in Krsna consciousness.

Registered ISKCON Life Patron Members and their immediate family members may stay for up to three days in ISKCON *asramas* free of charge. Life Patron Members must show a current ISKCON membership card or passport. The Temple President or Temple Secretary shall record Life Patron Members' names, addresses, and membership numbers upon the members' arrival.

In the event that the temple cannot provide acceptable *asrama* space, the Temple President shall attempt to accommodate the Life Patron Members in alternative facilities, such as a *grhastha's* residence.

5.6.2.5.9 The Opposite Gender

It is impossible for a Temple President to avoid some dealings with the opposite gender. In so doing the following guidelines should be adhered to in order to avoid compromising spiritual standards.

A Male Temple President should:

1. Always see all women as mother except one's wife.
2. Never be alone with a woman except one's wife.
3. Avoid intimate dealings with women.
4. Appoint a senior woman to deal with all women's affairs

A female Temple President should:

1. See all men as son except her husband.
2. Never be alone with a man except one's husband.
3. Avoid intimate dealings with men.
4. As far as possible appoint a senior man to deal with men's affairs.
5. In certain conditions it may be prudent for a female president to have her husband deal with the men, or for a male president to have his wife deal with the women.

5.6.2.5.10 Dealings With His Own Family Affairs (If Grihastha)

There is nothing wrong with a householder managing a temple so long as he does not utilize the facilities of the temple for his own personal sense gratification. Certainly the president may get his basic requirements for living and eating fulfilled through the temple, and he may also have his own place to live outside. However, he should not exploit the temple for his own sense gratification. A temple president must be careful not to take more than what would be allotted to any other householder who is working full time for the temple. For

example, he should not have specially prepared opulent meals when the temple devotees are eating austere. In fact he should eat with the devotees. Neither should he use temple funds to buy himself a nice vehicle while the other devotees are walking or taking the bus. He should take what is needed to expand his service, but not for expanding his sense gratification.

5.6.2.5.11 *The Local Community*

Develop and uphold ISKCON's good reputation in the local community.

5.6.2.5.12 *"Blooped" Devotees*

1. A complete central file be kept on all devotees for purpose of public relations and/or reclaiming "blooped" devotees and the presidents of the temples be allowed to contact the parents of a devotee in his area.(77)
2. The names of the devotees who have left the movement shall be recorded in the local temple's official Society minutes, and duly notarized.(80)

5.6.2.5.13 *Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival*

That all Regional Secretaries and Temple Presidents will be responsible for setting up their zonal exhibition booths at the annual Mayapur festival. This will be followed up by the Secretary of the Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival Committee.(82)

5.6.2.6 *Regulations*

5.6.2.6.1 *Financial Management*

In financial management the Temple President should always keep in mind that money should be spent cautiously and not be wasted and the temple should always be kept out of debt. The temple's funds should always be seen as belonging to Lord Krsna and Srila Prabhupada. Certainly, they should never be thought of as being one's own.

The Following Principles Should always be Adhered to:

1. Financial records should be properly maintained.
2. Accurate and meaningful financial statements should be prepared.
3. Budgets should be prepared to avoid and anticipate financial problems.
4. Funds should be properly banked and where not possible very securely kept.
5. As a principle a minimum of two signatories should sign on all temple bank accounts.(77)
6. Government statutes, income tax regulations for recognized non-profit organizations, and all regulations for book keeping shall be complied with.
7. Temple funds shall be invested in book distribution, *prasadam* distribution and other preaching activities as well as property purchases and recurring expenditures which support temple programs. They shall not be advanced, loaned or invested in speculative enterprises or personal projects. A ceiling should be set for discretionary funds.
8. Neither should the Temple President use temple funds to buy himself a nice vehicle while the other devotees are walking or taking the bus. He should take what is needed to expand his service, but not for expanding his sense gratification.
9. Investments of large sums of money (as determined by the local Zonal Secretary or GBC Divisional Council) should be approved by the local GBC Zonal Secretary, GBC Divisional Council and local Temple Board. If investments are made in fixed deposits such accounts should as far as possible have multiple signatories at least two of which can sign.

10. The Temple President should direct the Treasurer, and as far as possible have little to do with the direct handling of temple funds. The Temple President and the Treasurer, and if desired other officers, shall create the temple budget. The Treasurer should carefully handle the finances according to the approved budget under the directions of the Temple President and see to the proper maintenance of the accounts. The Temple President shall sign on accounts. Srila Prabhupada wanted the character and behavior of the Temple Presidents to be above suspicion.

11. Except in unavoidable cases, the Temple President or his/her spouse should not be the Treasurer.

12. The Temple President has to ensure compliance to fiscal and legal requirements.(96)

13. The Temple President shall ensure that his temple shall distribute books on sankirtana on a regular basis, making a sincere attempt to implement Srila Prabhupada's formula that fifty percent(50%) of the temple's income be used for book distribution and fifty percent(50%) be used for the temple expenses. The Temple Presidents should give a minimum of twenty five(25%) of income for book distribution.

14. There was a discussion in Srila Prabhupada's presence of temple accounting. He said accounting is a simple matter of accurate record of income and expenditure. He said temple books should not be private or confidential in the sense that any sums of money should go unrecorded. He stressed we should not keep large sums of money in bank accounts but should collect and spend.(75)

5.6.2.6.1.1 *Receiving Restricted Donations*

That as far as possible, donations to ISKCON should be accepted without any conditions. However, donations ("Restricted Donations") may also be accepted with limited conditions. ISKCON Leaders must use donations with conditions in accordance with the agreed terms.(93)

5.6.2.6.1.1.1 *Acceptable Conditions*

Acceptable Conditions are those which:

1. define a general category or use, such as deity worship, education, construction, etc.
2. define a specific geographic location or project, or
3. give the donor a modest amount of recognition.

5.6.2.6.1.1.2 *Unacceptable Conditions*

Unacceptable conditions are those which:

1. give some right to the donor to reclaim part or all of the donation in the future. All donations become ISKCON's inviolable property without any possibility of alienation,
2. are vague or ambiguous, and thus risk future disputes over interpretation,
3. in other ways risk future litigation or disputes, or which could harm ISKCON's reputation, or
4. compromise ISKCON's right or ability to manage its assets in accordance with Srila Prabhupada's instructions and ISKCON law.

5.6.2.6.2 *Management and Administration*

By careful planning, the Temple Presidents are to

1. learn to invest most of their time in activities that are developmental such as teaching, preaching, studying, and planning, rather than reactive engagements of crisis management, emergency counseling, creating patchwork solutions, etc.,
2. participate in the organization's strategic planning to develop and carry out Temple policies and to provide an annual budget and current written strategic action plan for the temple,

3. regularly review and improve the strategic plan as required to ensure the strategies are current, effective and efficient,
4. motivate the devotees and organize the temple's progress in each area of the strategic plan,
5. conduct temple community *ista-gosthis* regularly to communicate temple policies, progress and strategies and thereby foster cooperation and participation amongst the devotees,
6. facilitate and organize Department Heads into an effective management team,
7. ensure quality of service and behavior of Department Heads, and
8. train assistant(s) to work with quality and continue without interruption.

5.6.2.6.3 Book Distribution

All Temple Presidents should pledge to participate more directly in any *sankirtana* and book distribution activities, either by going out themselves once a week or by organising marathons or *maha-book* distribution efforts or by any other means they are capable of. (78)

ADDED · 2019

605.1 · GBC College for Leadership Development Trustees (2019)

[Action order]

(Proposed and Sponsored by the GBC Organizational Development Committee)

The following devotees are voted on as Trustees for the GBC College for Leadership Development:

Gopal Krishna Goswami

Bhakti Charu Swami

Rupanuga Das (BCS)

Devakinandan Das (MVG)

Gauranga Das (RNS)

Bal Govinda Das (RNS)

Kaunteya Das (JPS)

GBC Resolution 605.1 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

601.03 • Execution of wills and advanced medical directives (2022)

[Governing law]

Whereas the members of the GBC, ISKCON initiating spiritual masters, sannyasis and authorized officer bearers (collectively known as “ISKCON Leaders”) are naturally passing from this world, and these leaders

may hold, own or control, personally or otherwise, through their agents, ISKCON and/or ISKCON related assets as well as wield significant influence over their disciples (as in the case of initiating spiritual masters)

Whereas ISKCON leaders may, as time goes, also suffer from mental and/or physical incapacity, rendering them unfit, in their lifetime, to make key decisions relating to their personal and managerial affairs as well as property and finance related matters

Whereas many ISKCON leaders, who hold or own ISKCON and/or ISKCON related assets do not have Wills and/or Advanced Medical Directives (‘AMDs’) making clear their intention that the ISKCON assets they hold or own shall remain the property of ISKCON after their demise or during their lifetime if and when

they are mentally and/or physically incapacitated

Whereas neglecting to provide clear directions as described above can create confusion and conflict in the absence of a legally recognized Will or AMD

Whereas the ISKCON Oath of Loyalty directs all ISKCON leaders to accept that:

“...All ISKCON's funds, assets and properties under my control or direction, including anything ISKCON may have acquired under my direction, is the sole property of ISKCON and in the event of my death, resignation, or other relinquishment of all ISKCON responsibilities, all these shall accrue solely to ISKCON and at all times I shall have no claim on them whatsoever...”;

Whereas monies or properties gained by way of personal bequeathment from family members or loved ones, who originally acquired these monies and properties from non-ISKCON sources and/or without utilising the ISKCON name are not included.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The members of the GBC, ISKCON initiating spiritual masters, sannyasis and authorized officer bearers (collectively known as “ISKCON Leaders”) shall complete the Wills Information Form (‘the Form’) approved

by the GBC and submit it to the ISKCON Law Department for its review within a period of three (3) months

from the date of receipt of the Form. In this connection, the ISKCON Law Department will, upon request, provide assistance to any ISKCON Leader to complete the Form.

After receiving notification from the Law Department of its review of the Form, the ISKCON Leaders shall

be responsible for executing their Wills and Advance Medical Directives (‘AMDs’) within a period of six (6)

months from the date of notification and submit a copy of the Will and AMD to the ISKCON Law Department.

The ISKCON Leader is responsible for executing and completing his/her Will and AMD according to the information submitted and the recommendations given in the Form. In the event an ISKCON leader is unable to hire a lawyer or agency to draft the Will and/or AMD, the ISKCON Law Department will assist, as far as practically possible, to refer a lawyer to help draft the Will and AMD for the ISKCON leader.

The ISKCON Law Department will store the Forms and copies of the Wills and AMDs in a confidential and secure database.

All ISKCON Leaders who, prior to this Resolution, have executed their Wills and/or AMDs, shall notify the ISKCON Law Department and forward copies of their Wills and/or AMDs to the ISKCON Law Department for its records and review. The ISKCON Law Department may, upon study of these executed Wills and/or AMDs, request the ISKCON Leaders to amend or re-do their Wills and AMDs if they are not aligned with the requirements as set out in the Form. Such amendment or execution of a fresh Will and AMD shall be completed and submitted within a period of six (6) months from the date of the said request.

All ISKCON leaders shall provide necessary updates to the ISKCON Law Department, if any changes are made to the Wills and AMDs that they will execute or have executed.

In the event of non-compliance of the entirety or any section of this Resolution by an ISKCON Leader, that

ISKCON Leader shall be given a reminder by the ISKCON Law Department requesting compliance within

one (1) month of the reminder being received. If the ISKCON Leader fails to comply within one (1) month of

receipt of the said reminder, non-compliance of the entirety or any section of this Resolution will trigger the

following:

1. Suspension of GBC members' voting rights at the GBC meetings
2. Suspension of ISKCON initiating spiritual masters' right to give initiations; and
3. Suspension of ISKCON sannyasis from:
 - a. having any managerial authority in ISKCON and
 - b. giving discourses of any kind, either in person or online (including through any form of social media platforms).

GBC Resolution 601.03 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on November 23, 2022)

New material since 2018 — placement to be confirmed

ADDED · 2023

604.01 · Formation and Recognition of the North American Governing Body (2023)

[Administrative order]

— 2023

Whereas the GBC body has encouraged the establishment of continental committees (GBC Resolution

404/2002. Regional and Continental Governing Bodies)

Whereas North America has been designated as a 'Region' with 5 'Zones' encompassing the United States and Canada

Whereas the North American GBC members and other leaders have been functioning as a continental governance group prior to the 2002 resolution but have not formally applied for recognition as an RGB.

Whereas the North American Council has been working on a framework for the past 12 months, including soliciting and receiving feedback from GBC members active in North America, legal counsel, senior leaders, and temple presidents.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC accepts the application of the North American Council, including the accompanying Rules and Regulations, and officially recognizes the North American Regional Governing Body.

GBC Resolution 604.01 · 2023 · GBC Annual General Meeting, passed February 11, 2023

ADDED · 2025

604.01 · Formation and Recognition of the Russian RGB — 2024 (2025)

[Administrative order]

Whereas the GBC body has encouraged the establishment of continental committees (GBC Resolution

404/2002. Regional and Continental Governing Bodies);

Whereas Russia has been designated as a 'Region' in the Area GBC Model containing three spheres;

Whereas the Russian GBC members and other leaders have been functioning as a continental governance

group, but had not previously applied for recognition as an Regional Governing Body;

Whereas the Russian National Council (officially known as the Governing Council of the Center of Societies

for Krishna Consciousness in Russia) has been working on a framework for creating an RGB

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC accepts the application of the Russian National Council, including the accompanying Rules and

Regulations and officially recognizes the Russian Regional Governing Body.

GBC Resolution 604.01 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed August 7, 2024

604.01 • Formation and Recognition of the African RGB — 2024 (2025)

[Administrative order]

Whereas the leaders of ISKCON Africa (Southern Africa, East Africa & West Africa) have recognized the need to establish a Regional Governing Body (RGB);

Whereas the ARGB would be the prime contact with the GBC and the GBC Executive Committee (EC), thus improving communication and efficiency;

Whereas there is a need for increasing coordination of the overall preaching strategy in the African region, including book distribution, coordination of visiting devotees and preachers in the region, coordination of training and development of preachers and leaders (in person and online), increasing the coordination of

the implementation of the ISKCON Governing Body Commission (GBC) policies, guidelines, resolutions applicable for Africa, child protection and investigation and other synergistic functions;

Whereas the ARGB wishes to make recommendations to the GBC Body, where appropriate, for GBC legislation;

Whereas making recommendations to any GBC Zonal Secretary (GBC member) or other ISKCON official functioning within Africa on matters concerning the affairs of ISKCON in that region creates a stronger sense of purpose;

Whereas the ARGB will convene Committees, etc., as it deems necessary for the conduct of the African RGB's responsibilities (including but not exclusively for the vetting and approval for sannyasi candidates, guru nominations, Zonal Supervisors) to ensure succession and talent development;

Whereas the ARGB can assist in resolving any conflicts within Africa that are beyond the scope of a single

African country/zone. This includes handling of complaints on regional matters referred to it by the GBC

Body, Zonal Councils, any ISKCON official or body, or from individuals. And where necessary and

appropriate, undertaking disciplinary action against ISKCON officials and/or other members serving

in Africa, as allowed under ISKCON law for such a body;

Whereas the creation of an ARGB allows for the ease of planning the preaching, facilitation and even cross

border assistance to develop the preaching;

Whereas the establishment of the ARGB fits into the model being developed for the global management of
ISKCON

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC approves the formation of the Regional Governing Body for Africa along with its accompanying

Rules and Regulations.

GBC Resolution 604.01 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed September 4, 2024

6 Discipleship in ISKCON

6.1 The Process for Accepting a Spiritual Master

Srila Prabhupada spoke and wrote consistently both on the vital importance of accepting a bona fide guru for one's assured progress in spiritual life as well as on qualifications essential for a devotee to serve as spiritual master, such as:

tasmad gurum prapadyeta jijnasuh sreya uttamam

sabde pare ca nisnatam brahmany upasamasrayam

"Any person who is seriously desirous of achieving real happiness must seek out a bona fide spiritual master and take shelter of him by initiation. The qualification of a spiritual master is that he must have realized the conclusion of the scriptures by deliberation and arguments and thus be able to convince others of these conclusions. Such great personalities, who have taken complete shelter of the Supreme Godhead, leaving aside all material considerations, are to be understood as bona fide spiritual masters." (SB 11.3.21 quoted in SB 4.29.55 purport)

and

"The expert spiritual master knows well how to engage his disciple's energy in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, and thus he engages a devotee in a specific devotional service according to his special tendency. A devotee must have only one initiating spiritual master because in the scriptures acceptance of more than one is always forbidden. There is no limit, however, to the number of instructing spiritual masters one may accept. Generally a spiritual master who constantly instructs a disciple in spiritual science becomes his initiating spiritual master later on." (CC Adi 1.35 purport.)

Having developed some faith in the process of Krishna consciousness and prior to accepting a devotee as his or her spiritual master, a person should have scrutinized Srila Prabhupada's teachings on this essential topic in the association of ISKCON devotees and, when available, have taken the ISKCON Disciple Course.

According to the instructions of Srila Prabhupada and the previous acaryas, a person who has developed some faith in the process of Krishna consciousness, should further strengthen it by associating with one or more devotees and hearing from them about devotional service. Such devotees of varying levels of realization and maturity in Krishna consciousness give knowledge about devotional service. One or more of these may come to be a source of substantial instruction vital for one's ongoing progress, along with providing an inspiring personal example and a shelter for that person, thereby becoming his or her instructing spiritual master(s).

By regular association with, and service to, such instructing spiritual masters, the spiritual aspirant may develop a particularly strong reciprocal connection with one of the *siksa-gurus*, who demonstrates both willingness and practical ability for the ongoing guidance of the spiritual aspirant. After testing this connection for an extended period of time by further association, inquiries, and service, the candidate may desire to solidify that relationship by taking initiation from this *siksa-guru*.

He or she should then approach the local ISKCON authorities for further guidance as to accepting this devotee as one's *diksa-guru*.

6.2.1 First (Harinama) Initiation

6.2.1.1 Qualifications for First Initiation

6.2.1.1.1 One Year Preparatory Period

In order to receive first initiation one must have been engaged favorably in devotional service, strictly following the four regulative principles and chanting sixteen rounds a day, for at least one year without interruption.

6.2.1.1.2 First Six-month Period

During the first six months of following the four regulative principles and chanting sixteen rounds daily, a new devotee who is aspiring for initiation should not commit himself to a particular initiating guru. Rather, he should chant Srila Prabhupada's *pranama-mantra* and worship him as Founder-Acarya of ISKCON and as his *siksa-guru*.

6.2.1.1.3 Second Six-month Period

After successfully completing the first six-month preparatory period, and after passing the required examination, the candidate may choose his future *diksa-guru*. Receiving permission from that guru, and notifying the local Temple President, the candidate should take shelter and begin to worship that guru as his own spiritual master and chant his *pranama-mantra*. Actual initiation may take place only after a minimum six-month period from the date shelter was taken and the local Temple President notified.

6.2.1.1.4 Devotees Residing Within Temple Communities

In addition to satisfying the above requirements, devotees residing in temple communities must, during the one-year preparatory period, regularly attend the full morning program.

6.2.1.1.5 Devotees Residing Outside of Temple Communities

Devotees who do not live in a temple community and who cannot come daily to the temple programs may be initiated provided they have regular morning programs at home or attend regular morning programs at the Nama-hatta center.

6.2.1.1.6 Pass Examination

Before a devotee can be permitted to formally take shelter of a particular ISKCON spiritual master and be subsequently recommended for initiation, he or she must demonstrate a basic understanding of Srila Prabhupada's teachings by answering an oral or written test administered by the Temple President or other recommending authority. The questions to be answered are:

1. What are the qualifications of a bona fide spiritual master?
2. Why are you convinced to follow the orders of the spiritual master in this life, and even life after life?
3. Why does one worship the spiritual master like God?
4. Do you believe the spiritual master speaks the Absolute Truth? If so, why?
5. Under what circumstances should the spiritual master be rejected?
6. What are the qualifications and responsibilities of a disciple?
7. What is the unique position of Srila Prabhupada in ISKCON?
8. Why do you accept Lord Krsna as the Supreme Personality of Godhead?
9. Why do we follow the four regulative principles?
10. Why do we chant Hare Krsna?
11. What is the position of the GBC Body?
12. Explain the difference between the body and the self.
13. What is ISKCON, and why should one remain in ISKCON?

14. Have you read the paper “Harmonizing ISKCON’s Lines of Authority”?
15. What have you understood as the most important points of the “Harmonizing ISKCON’s Lines of Authority” paper?
16. Have you read GBC Resolution 303/2013: “GBC Statement on the Position of Srila Prabhupada?”

6.2.1.2 *Change of Prospective Guru*

Sometimes a candidate for initiation who had formally accepted shelter from one spiritual master as a prospective initiating guru may subsequently decide to change to another. Such a candidate must communicate this change to the former prospective spiritual master, new prospective spiritual master, and local Temple President. The candidate must also remain fixed under the shelter of the newly proposed initiating guru for six continuous months prior to receiving initiation, starting from the time of newly accepting formal shelter.

6.2.1.3 *Procedure of Formal Recommendation*

This formal recommendation process is not intended to replace or overshadow the (more important) need for other regular contact among the various ISKCON devotees guiding the candidate and his prospective spiritual master regarding the spiritual progress of the candidate. Furthermore, the prospective spiritual master is under no obligation to initiate a devotee because a proper recommendation has been given.

6.2.1.3.1 *Guru Receives Recommendation in Writing*

Before a candidate can receive first initiation, his prospective guru must receive a formal written recommendation from the appropriate ISKCON spiritual authority, as determined by the candidate's situation.

6.2.1.3.2 *Contents of Recommendation*

The recommendation of the recommending ISKCON authority must certify that the candidate has fulfilled the qualifications for initiation to the best of his understanding. The recommending authority must specifically attest that the candidate has been engaged in favorable devotional service, has chanted sixteen rounds of *japa* daily, has adhered to the four regulative principles, and has regularly attended a morning program, all for the previous twelve months.

The recommender must also attest that the candidate is sufficiently knowledgeable in the philosophy of Krsna consciousness and in the structure and purpose of ISKCON to have passed the prescribed examination, and that he has accepted shelter of the guru for at least six months.

6.2.1.3.3 *Recommender Contacts Previous Authorities*

If the candidate has not been serving continuously within the jurisdiction of the recommending ISKCON authority for the previous twelve months, then the recommender must still satisfy himself with the activities of the candidate for the full twelve-month period by contacting other ISKCON authorities with knowledge of the candidate's activities during the balance time.

6.2.1.3.4 *Devotees Residing In Temple Communities*

Before a candidate can receive first initiation, the guru must receive a written recommendation from the Temple President under whom the candidate is currently serving.

If the Temple President is also the prospective initiating guru, then the following special procedures must be observed: Either the local GBC shall write the recommendation himself, or he shall establish a local Board of Initiations, which does not include the prospective guru as a member, to review the qualifications of the candidates. The chairman of this Board of Initiations may then prepare the necessary written recommendations. In the extreme case that the local GBC, Temple President, and prospective guru are all the same person, the GBC Executive Committee shall establish the appropriate procedures to be followed.

6.2.1.3.5 Devotees Residing Away from Temple Communities

Qualified candidates for initiation who reside away from temple communities may be recommended for initiation (in the manner prescribed above) by one of the following spiritual authorities (excluding the prospective initiating guru) who knows them well: a local GBC, the nearest Temple President, the local Regional Secretary, the concerned Congregational Preaching Director, or an ISKCON *sannyasi* who is regularly preaching in that area.

If a prospective disciple requests initiation from an ISKCON initiating guru, but lives in such an isolated place that none of the spiritual authorities listed above can recommend him/her for initiation, then the guru is required to inform the National Council or the RGB body of the situation and receive their permission to go through all the applicable rules for initiation as the recommending authority. In the absence of such a national/regional body, such permission should be received from the Chairperson of the GBC Guru Services Committee who will then monitor that all applicable rules regarding initiation are followed.

A spiritual master who fails to follow this resolution will be reprimanded as per GBC rules.

6.2.1.4 Vows of Disciple

All new initiates must take the following vows at the time of initiation:

1. To chant a minimum of sixteen rounds daily without fail
2. To strictly follow the four regulative principles of no meat eating, no illicit sex, no intoxication, no gambling
3. To accept the order of the spiritual master as one's life and soul
4. To accept discipleship into the Brahma-Madhva-Gaudiya-sampradaya through the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON and to remain faithful to their order and teachings
5. To remain faithful to Srila Prabhupada's order by maintaining loyalty to ISKCON and its ultimate managing authority, the GBC

6.2.2 Second, or Brahminical, Initiation

6.2.2.1 Qualification for Second Initiation

6.2.2.1.1 One-year Wait Between First and Second Initiation

To be qualified to receive second initiation, a first-initiated devotee must have been steadily engaged in favorable devotional service, chanting sixteen rounds a day without fail, and strictly following the four regulative principles for a period of at least one year from the time of receiving first initiation. In addition, the candidate must have regularly attended a morning program, whether in a temple, preaching center, Nama-hatta center, or at home.

6.2.2.1.2 Two-year Wait for Those Who Fall Severely

A devotee who, after receiving first initiation, falls severely from the spiritual standard by neglecting or forsaking his initiation vows in a serious way or by rejecting the association of ISKCON devotees for a prolonged time, shall, after he returns to normal practice, be required to wait for at least two years before being given second initiation.

6.2.2.1.3 Examination Option of Initiating Guru

It is the responsibility of the initiating guru to determine the fitness of his disciple for brahminical initiation. To help do this, he may require his disciple to pass a suitable examination.

6.2.2.2 Procedure for Formal Recommendation

6.2.2.2.1 Guru Receives Recommendation in Writing

The guru of a candidate for second initiation must receive a written recommendation from the appropriate ISKCON authority. The appropriate authority is determined in the same manner as described above for first initiation.

6.2.2.2.2 Contents of Letter of Recommendation

The recommending authority must certify that the candidate has fulfilled the qualifications for second initiation to the best of his understanding. The recommending authority must specifically attest that:

1. the candidate has been steadily engaged in favorable devotional service, has chanted sixteen rounds of *japa* daily, adhered to the four regulative principles, and regularly attended a morning program, all for the previous twelve months (having received first initiation more than twelve months before) and
2. the candidate has either not fallen severely since first initiation or has been in good standing for at least two years since returning to normal practice.

6.2.2.2.3 Recommender Contacts Previous Authorities

As in the case of a recommendation for first initiation, if the candidate has not been serving continuously within the jurisdiction of the recommending ISKCON authority for the previous twelve months, then the recommender must still satisfy himself with the activities of the candidate for the full twelve-month period by contacting other ISKCON authorities who have knowledge of the candidate's activities during the balance time.

6.2.2.3 Restoration of Brahminical Status

If an initiated brahmana falls severely from the spiritual standard by neglecting or forsaking his initiation vows in a serious way or by rejecting the regular association of devotees for a prolonged time, and then later returns to the spiritual standard, the following procedure is to be observed:

1. The devotee should not wear a sacred thread, chant *gayatri-mantra*, or serve the Deity until he has strictly followed and practiced devotional service for a period of no less than six months.
2. He may put on the sacred thread, resume chanting *gayatri*, and serve the Deity only after he proves himself fit in the judgment of his spiritual master and local spiritual authority.
3. If, in the judgment of his spiritual master, the deviation was exceptionally severe or prolonged, the spiritual master may again give the disciple *gayatri-mantra*. If the spiritual master is beyond mortal vision, the local GBC representative shall decide the proper course of action.

6.2.4 Initiation Only from Approved Gurus

Devotees who live or serve in ISKCON may take initiation only from ISKCON gurus.

6.2.4.1 Violators

6.2.4.1.1 First Initiation Outside

ISKCON members who in violation of ISKCON law take initiation from gurus not in ISKCON shall not be permitted to serve within ISKCON. If the non-ISKCON guru has an institution or *asrama* outside ISKCON, then according to standard etiquette, his disciples should serve within the institution of their guru and should not serve within ISKCON. (This rule does not apply to persons who were already initiated before they became ISKCON members.)

6.2.4.1.2 Other Initiations Outside

Anyone initiated in ISKCON who has taken any further initiation, or reinitiation, from a non-ISKCON guru must renounce their initiation from the non-ISKCON guru in order to work within ISKCON. Their ISKCON spiritual master (or if their spiritual master is beyond mortal vision, the local GBC) shall decide the proper procedure for reinstating them in ISKCON, including the need for taking any further initiation.

6.2.4.2 Prior Initiation by Non-Bona Fide Gurus

Persons who have taken initiation from non-bona fide gurus before becoming members of ISKCON should follow the injunction of Srila Jiva Gosvami that such a useless guru, a family priest acting as guru, should be given up, and that the proper, bona fide guru should be accepted.

6.2.5 Srila Prabhupada's Disciple by First Initiation

A devotee who has received first initiation from Srila Prabhupada has become Srila Prabhupada's disciple. By accepting second initiation from a Godbrother after Srila Prabhupada's disappearance, the disciple further confirms his relationship with Srila Prabhupada and also becomes a disciple of that initiating Godbrother. The second initiation strengthens, not diminishes, one's standing as Srila Prabhupada's disciple. A disciple should always respect a worthy Godbrother from whom he has received second initiation. What such a devotee and the second-initiating guru expect from one another in their relationship shall arise from their own mutual understanding.

6.2.6 Reinitiation

A devotee whose guru has fallen and who seeks re-initiation must observe the following requirements:

1. a six-month period of formally taking shelter
2. a formal letter of recommendation from the appropriate local authority
3. acceptance by the initiating guru

6.3 Guidelines

6.3.1 Unauthorized "Initiation" Ceremonies

In cases where the formal guru-disciple relationship has not been properly sanctioned by procedures given in ISKCON Law, no ISKCON member shall engage in giving any of the elements of the initiation ceremony, such as:

giving a devotional name

giving sanctified chanting beads or neck beads

participating in some ceremony or ritual of commitment, in any number or combination, to other devotees in ISKCON or its congregations with the stated or unstated purpose or effect of creating the resemblance of a formal guru-disciple relationship

When such unauthorized activities have already taken place:

- a. all participants should be informed that no initiation has taken place, nor any binding pledge leading towards initiation
- b. The junior devotee in the transaction should seek to establish a relationship with an initiating guru in whom he can place full faith
- c. All devotees must cease using any names given, if any

7 ISKCON Spiritual Masters (Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)

(Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)

7.1 Principles

7.1.1 Srila Prabhupada's Desire for Continuing the Disciplic Succession

The GBC approves of the paper entitled "On My Order Understood" which establishes as ISKCON law the final *siddhanta* on Srila Prabhupada's desire for continuing the disciplic succession after the departure of His Divine Grace.

7.1.2 Srila Prabhupada's Siksa Position (2000)

A duly initiated disciple in ISKCON can accept Srila Prabhupada, the Founder-Acarya of ISKCON, as his principle Siksa-guru. During his devotional life, he may experience that he derives more spiritual inspiration from Srila Prabhupada's books and vani, than from his own diksa-guru.

7.1.3 Srila Prabhupada's Absolute Position (2000)

Any attempt to minimize the position or teachings of His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, the Founder-Acarya of the International Society for Krsna Consciousness, will not be tolerated in any way by the leadership of ISKCON. This is an absolute and inviolable principle.

Any member of ISKCON involved in such criticism shall be immediately dealt with by the appropriate measures according to ISKCON LAW 1996/607.4.A.1 "Offenses against Founder-Acarya and Guru Parampara" which states; "A person guilty of denouncing, openly blaspheming, or publicly abandoning loyalty to the Acarya, the previous acaryas in the disciplic succession, or Lord Krsna, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, incurs automatic dissociation from ISKCON, the right to revoke being reserved to the local Governing Body Commissioner. If the offending person holds a position of spiritual authority, the right to revoke the dissociation is reserved to the Governing Body Commission. If the seriousness of the offence warrants a more severe reaction, other measures may be brought to bear, including dismissal from authority, disqualification for initiating and ex-communication."

The GBC Zonal Secretaries and / or the local leaders must implement ISKCON Law when they perceive a transgression of this principle. If they fail to do so, the GBC Executive Committee shall directly take measures to rectify the situation and may censure or suspend (probate or remove) local leaders for not taking appropriate measures.

7.2 Qualifications of Gurus in ISKCON

7.2.1 Mandatory Qualifications

The following are the minimum qualifications necessary to be approved as a *diksa-guru* in ISKCON.

2014 updates:

1. has been twice-initiated for at least ten years
2. has been requested to initiate by the candidate's own *diksa-guru*, if physically present
3. is in good standing in ISKCON
4. has good sadhana, including chanting a minimum of sixteen rounds daily and following the four regulative principles

5. has shown consistent adherence to the principles of one's asrama in terms of:
 - (a) acceptable Vaisnava behavior (sadacara)
 - (b) engagement in Srila Prabhupada's mission
6. has substantial knowledge and realization of sastra, including a Bhakti-sastri degree
7. preaches according to Srila Prabhupada's teachings
8. works cooperatively with local authorities
9. recognizes the GBC body as the ultimate managing authority in ISKCON, supports the GBC system, and follows the GBC
10. has no loyalties that compete with or compromise the candidate's loyalty to Srila Prabhupada, to his teachings, and to ISKCON
11. must have attended the ISKCON Guru Seminar conducted by the Guru Services Committee
12. should be willing to participate in the Guru Retreat by the Guru Services Committee

7.2.2 Discretionary Qualifications

1. Spiritual degrees – Bhakti Sastri, Bhakti Vaibhava, and Bhaktivedanta (when available) – shall be a strongly recommended qualification for being granted no objection status to serve as a guru in ISKCON.
2. Should be nothing in his character, conduct, or circumstances to give rise to doubt about his ability to follow the code of conduct for gurus.
3. Should not be involved in any abnormal personal situation. An example of such a situation would be a disrupted or anomalous family life which could distract a guru from his guru duties or otherwise prove a disturbance to him or his followers.
4. Should always be responsible, conscientious, and honorable in ordinary dealings.

702.02 • Regulations for commencing the service of diksa-guru in ISKCON – part B — 2014: amendment (2022)

[Governing law]

Whereas Resolution 702.02: Regulations for commencing the service of diksa-guru in ISKCON — 2014 states in part that:

4. Three GBC Requests for Further Review:

During the six months from the date of submission of the candidate’s application to the GBC, members of the GBC who question the suitability of the candidate as per the qualifications in ISKCON Law “Procedure for commencing the service of Diksa-guru” (1b) may file written statements with the GBC Corresponding Secretary requesting further review”.

Whereas the six-month period allotted for GBC members to submit their requests for further review of a diksa-guru candidate was originally instituted by Resolution 95 of AGM 1989 with the following rationale:

That before officially objecting to any guru candidate’s recommendation, a GBC member should contact in writing the guru candidate and the chairman of the ten-man committee for clarification. If unsatisfied with the reply, or if not receiving a reply within a reasonable period of time, the GBC member may then officially object. To give enough time for exchange of correspondence, the period allowed to lodge all objections shall be extended to six months” [when regular mail was the only means of official correspondence]

Whereas modern communication technologies that emerged since 1989 provide for much faster and more efficient correspondence mandated by the above resolutions “Procedure for commencing the service of Diksa-guru” (1b) and 95/1989, making the six-month period initially allowed for filing requests for further review unnecessarily long

Whereas with the increase in number of local diksa-guru nominations endorsed by Local Area Committees (that already necessarily include all local Zonal Secretaries), any period of time past two weeks, however extended, will unlikely furnish any essential information.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

(1) ISKCON Law 7.02.02 “Procedure for commencing the service of Diksa-guru” is amended as follows:

4. Three GBC Requests for Further Review

During three months from the date of submission of the candidate’s application to the GBC, members of the GBC who question the suitability of the candidate as per the qualifications in ISKCON Law 7.2 may file written statements with the GBC Corresponding Secretary requesting further review.

a. Absence of Three Requests for Further Review

If the GBC Corresponding Secretary has not received at least three requests for further review by the end of the three-month period, the GBC Corresponding Secretary shall so inform the Chairman of the recommending Council. Then the candidate, after taking the prescribed vows, may commence the service of diksa-guru in ISKCON.

b. Requests for Further Review

If the Corresponding Secretary receives at least three requests for further review by the end of the three-month period, and if the rationales are deemed legitimate by the GBC Executive Committee per ISKCON Law 7.2 “Qualifications of Gurus in ISKCON”, then the GBC Executive Committee will communicate the reasons for the review requests to the Chairman of the Local Area Council that nominated the candidate and ask for the Local Area Council’s response.

The above applies if a single request for further review provides sufficient doubt about the candidate’s good standing as a devotee [rest of 7.4.1.4.2 is unchanged]

This amendment applies retroactively to the diksa-guru candidacies currently under the GBC review.

GBC Resolution 702.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on April 24, 2022)

701.03 • Educational Program for those who serve as Diksa- and Siksa-gurus (2021)

[Statement]

in ISKCON — 2021

Whereas Srila Prabhupada repeatedly called upon his disciples and followers to qualify themselves as spiritual masters to propagate Lord Caitanya's mission worldwide;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada also wanted the spiritual masters to be qualified, which requires training based on his teachings;

Whereas Srila Prabhupada made giving and receiving sikṣa the primary function of ISKCON, and whereas we as his followers should endeavor to enhance and improve this function;

Whereas developing such a systematic guru training program can easily avail itself of existing educational initiatives.

Whereas the rapid international growth of ISKCON necessitates a proportionate increase in the number of competent spiritual masters.

Whereas this initiative follows in the footsteps of a number of GBC resolutions seeking to address this requirement.

RESOLVED:

That the Governing Body Commission of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness accepts and supports the following principles for preparing devotees to act in the role of gurus:

All devotees, especially after taking second initiation, are encouraged to undergo systematic training to become qualified to act as spiritual preceptors.

The program shall include but not be limited to:

- demonstrating sastric knowledge (including but not limited to Bhagavad-gita, Nectar of Devotion, Srimad-Bhagavatam and Caitanya-caritamṛta);
- learning about Srila Prabhupada's biography and position;
- assimilating the proper codes of personal behavior (Vaiṣṇava sad-acara);
- training on balancing life's priorities and obligations;
- how to serve harmoniously within ISKCON;
- relevant ISKCON legislation;

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- emphasis on loyalty to Srila Prabhupada, ISKCON and the GBC;
- instruction on how to guide and counsel siksa- and diksa-disciples;
- personal mentorship of candidates; and
- considerations for regional variations.

To facilitate participation and completion, the training program shall be self-paced and include a blend of online and in-person training.

The Guru Services Committee, the GBC College for Leadership Development and the ISKCON Board of Examinations, shall collaborate in drafting and defining the curriculum, which shall be submitted to the GBC

for approval before implementation. The curriculum shall include ongoing training and support for those serving as siksa- and diksa-gurus.

After an interim period — the length and parameters of which shall be defined separately — such a training program shall become a mandatory prerequisite for commencing the service of an initiating spiritual master.

GBC Resolution 701.03 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on July 19, 2021)

702.01 • Interim Training Program for ISKCON Diksa-gurus (2022)

[Governing law]

Whereas the GBC encourages senior devotees who are already providing spiritual shelter and guidance to consider beginning serving as initiating spiritual masters.

Whereas the GBC has stressed the need to increase the number of ISKCON initiating spiritual masters who will train and accept disciples.

Whereas ISKCON leadership is responsible to ensure that devotees serving as diksa-gurus have the necessary qualifications as presented by Srila Prabhupada.

Whereas the Guru Services Committee, the GBC College for Leadership Development and the ISKCON Board of Examinations have developed an interim training and assessment program.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The interim training and assessment program (Phase I) outlined in the appendix below shall be a mandatory requirement to commence the service of diksa-guru in ISKCON until the full program (Phase II)

to prepare diksa-gurus is available and approved by the GBC. [For any help or questions regarding translation to other languages, please consult the secretary of the Guru Services Committee at: gopika.radhika.devidasi@gmail.com]

Completing this training, which can be taken entirely online, is in addition to the existing requirements such

as the Local Area Council endorsement.

Enrolment in the training may take place after the Local Area Council gives their approval for a candidate to serve as a diksa-guru.

APPENDIX

Overview of the Interim Program

Knowledge Requirements

1. Bhakti-sastri degree. Candidates who don't have it can directly take the ISKCON Board of Examinations (BOEX) exam without taking a course.
2. Writing four essays of between 600 and 1,000 words each on given topics from Srimad-Bhagavatam & Sri Caitanya-caritamrta.
3. Briefly answering a total of 20 thought-provoking questions (in written, audio or video format) on:
 - a. Philosophical aspects
 - b. Application & lifestyle topics
 - c. Institutional aspects
 - d. Controversial issues
4. Reading (or affirming that they have read) at least the one-volume, abridged biography of Srila Prabhupada and "Srila Prabhupada — The Founder-Acarya of ISKCON"; then writing two essays (of 600-words minimum) — or recording an audio or video speech of minimum 10 minutes each on:
 - a. "Srila Prabhupada's position as the Founder-Acarya at present and in the future."
 - b. "The role of ISKCON gurus in connection with the Founder-Acarya."
 - c. Watching two videos by HH Bhakti Charu Swami: "Four Maxims for ISKCON" and "The Importance of the Institution."

- d. Reading the "UMA Paper" and answering related questions.
 - e. Studying a compilation of ISKCON laws regarding the service of ISKCON diksa-gurus and answering multiple-choice questions.
5. Taking the "Spiritual Leadership Course"
6. Studying a compilation of guidelines (not covered directly in ISKCON law) on institutional ethics, diksa-guru etiquette, dealing with disciples and aspiring disciples, etc.

Personal Information, Character & Competencies

Answering questionnaires covering aspects such as asrama situation, mentorship relations, devotional history, health, educational background, finances, etc.

1. Candidates will submit:
 - a. A list of articles/books they have written — if any.
 - b. Links to lectures/seminars they gave.
 - c. Links to their Internet presence (websites, social media, etc.)
2. Candidates will be encouraged to establish mentorship relations, ideally with existing diksa-gurus.
3. Candidates shall formally commit to participate in whatever ongoing training and association the GBC shall mandate for diksa-gurus.

Resources

1. Candidates will receive information on:
 - a. Educational and other resources available in ISKCON
 - b. Suggested additional sastric and other reference materials
 - c. Tools — such as databases — used by existing ISKCON gurus

GBC Resolution 702.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on October 22, 2022)

7.3 Eligibility of Devotee to Be Guru in ISKCON

7.3.1 All Devotee's Initiations From ISKCON Gurus

1. No devotee shall be eligible to become a *diksa* or *siksa-guru* in ISKCON unless he has received all of his initiations from ISKCON-approved *gurus* in good standing.
2. A devotee initiated by a bona fide Gaudiya Vaisnava *guru* before joining ISKCON may be considered as a special case by the GBC body.

7.3.2 No One Can Give Diksa While Guru is Present

(Amendment 2002)

As taught by Srila Prabhupada, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of one's diksa-guru will be upheld in ISKCON. However, Srila Prabhupada and historical precedents also teach us that disciples may sometimes initiate in the physical presence of their diksa gurus. If a diksa guru desires for this to happen, he can direct his disciple to go through the normal GBC procedure for initiating.

701.2 · Conditions for Second-generation Diksa-gurus (2019)

[Governing law]

Whereas ISKCON Law 7.3.2 now reads:

“As taught by Srila Prabhupada, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of one's diksa-guru will be upheld in ISKCON. However, Srila Prabhupada and historical precedents also teach us that disciples may sometimes initiate in the physical presence of their diksa-gurus, if so directed by them. In such a case, the disciple should go through the normal procedure for commencing the service of diksa-guru (7.4.1).”

http://gbc.iskcon.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/Pati-guru_April_2019_SAC2.pdf

http://gbc.iskcon.org/wp-content/uploads/2019/04/Pati-guru_April_2019_SAC2.pdf

Resolved:

ISKCON Law 7.3.2 is amended to read as follows:

As taught by Srila Prabhupada, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of one's diksa-guru will be upheld in ISKCON. However historical precedents also teach us that disciples may sometimes, in exceptional cases, initiate in the physical presence of their diksa-gurus.

The GBC clarifies that an individual devotee taking up the service of diksa-guru in the physical presence of their guru may be allowed as an exception when the following conditions are met. The Guru Services Committee will confirm that the candidate for becoming a second generation guru has met all these conditions:

Mandatory Conditions:

1. The candidate must have been practicing Krishna consciousness for not less than 25 years
2. The candidate's diksa-guru has affirmed in writing to the GBC Body that he agrees the candidate is suitable for this service and that he gives his blessings
3. A letter of approval for the candidate to take up the role of diksa-guru has been received from the Regional Council, or if none exists, the National Council, Area Council or, if none of the above exists, the GBC member of that area where the candidate primarily serves or resides.
4. All standard procedures for commencing the service of diksa-guru according to ISKCON law, including required training and other conditions, as well as additional appropriate training from diksa- and/or siksa- gurus, have been met.
5. Final acceptance of the candidate to begin initiating is affirmed by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the GBC Body.

Additional Mandatory Condition (may be waived by a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the GBC Body):

The candidate's own diksa-guru has to retire completely from accepting disciples, or agree to immediately retire upon acceptance of the candidate to accept his own disciples.

Factors to be considered by the GBC in determining if a waiver may be approved:

The area in which the candidate will initiate has a substantial number of devotees wanting initiation, and a shortage of gurus to do this service.

Language barriers necessitate gurus who speak the local language in a specific area(s).

The currently initiating guru is overburdened with responsibilities.

The currently initiating guru is experiencing serious health problems.

Optional conditions that may be applied in an individual case, per a $\frac{3}{4}$ vote of the GBC:

When the candidate takes up the service of diksa-guru he will only be able initiate in a specific area(s).

The number of disciples the new diksa-guru may initiate can be limited by the GBC.

The GBC Guru Services Committee shall develop a more detailed process to implement the above resolution. This process will come for final review by the GBC Body.

GBC Resolution 701.2 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

701.02 · Initiating in the presence of one's guru: Amendment (2021)

[Governing law]

Whereas there is a need to increase the number of diksa gurus in ISKCON which will necessarily include:

- 1) requesting and training qualified second generation devotees whose diksa-gurus are no longer physically with us (or in good standing), to take up the service of diksa-guru immediately
- 2) requesting present diksa-gurus to identify, train, and empower qualified disciples to accept the service of offering diksa initiation, even while they are still present.

Whereas it can be clearly observed that whenever Srila Prabhupada spoke about disciples not initiating in the presence of their guru he always referred to it as etiquette.

Whereas on 2 December, 1975 Srila Prabhupada wrote to Tusta Krishna Swami and used the phrase "law of disciplic succession" in the following manner: "Keep trained up very rigidly and then you are bona fide Guru, and you can accept disciples on the same principle. But as a matter of etiquette it is the custom that during the lifetime of your Spiritual master you bring the prospective disciples to him, and in his absence or disappearance you can accept disciples without any limitation. This is the law of disciplic succession".

Whereas even in the one letter where he used the phrase "law of disciplic succession", it is important to observe that he continued to use the same term etiquette while referring to disciples not initiating in the presence of their guru.

Whereas considering Srila Prabhupada's consistent and overwhelming use of the phrase "etiquette" without exception including the letter where he wrote about the "law of disciplic succession", the said letter should be seen in the same context of etiquette rather than something distinct.

Whereas we have precedents in our parampara like Srila Syamananda Pandita who authorised his disciple Sri Rasikananda Prabhu to accept disciples in his physical presence but did not stop initiating himself. Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura was also requested to initiate in the presence of his guru(s) and Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura gave initiation even while Vipina-Bihari Goswami and Jagannatha dasa Babaji were present.

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Whereas Srila Prabhupada was present with us for only a brief period of twelve years. It was natural that in such a short span of twelve years he was insistent about the etiquette of his disciples not initiating in his physical presence.

Whereas the current situation is vastly different from the 12 years of Srila Prabhupada's physical presence with us, borne by the fact that some disciples of presently initiating gurus have been in the movement for more than 40 years.

Whereas if a guru were to recommend such long serving disciples to start initiating, then it should be accepted as applying a precedent from our parampara according to time, place, and circumstances.

Whereas to facilitate devotees to serve as diksa-gurus while their own gurus are physically present, is currently a bureaucratic and time-consuming process due to the 2019 amendment of GBC Law 7.3.2.

RESOLVED:

That ISKCON Law 7.3.2 reverts to its previous formulation thus:

“As taught by Srila Prabhupada, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of one’s diksa-guru will be upheld in ISKCON. However, Srila Prabhupada and historical precedents also teach us that disciples may sometimes initiate in the physical presence of their diksa-gurus, if so directed by them. In such a case, the disciple should go through the normal procedure for commencing the service of diksa-guru (7.4.1).”

[Footnotes to resolution]

The 2019 amendment being repealed by this resolution is as follows:

GBC Resolution 701.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on June 8, 2021)

702.02 • Initiating in the Presence of One's Diksa-guru (2024)

[Governing Law]

Premise:

Although the nomenclature of the proposal is "Initiating in the presence of one's Diksa Guru", the proposers are of the opinion that the essence of it, namely: a) Keeping the centrality of the Founder-Acarya in the lives of the future generations of both gurus and disciples, b) Having gurus with an appropriate level of training, advancement, maturity and being of high character, and c) Maintaining the unity of the movement by having gurus and disciples remaining loyal and obedient to ISKCON and the GBC Body, will be fundamental in any resolution dealing with the guru-disciple relationship.

The present proposal is a revisitation of the 2019 Resolution that took a lot of time and energy and was passed near-unanimously by the GBC Body; (this Resolution was then abruptly replaced during COVID through GEM without much discussion by an earlier one that is now current). This revised edition of the 2019 Resolution we are now proposing is more focused on training, less restrictive, and actually consistent with Srila Prabhupada's instructions and exemplary actions.

Whereas the replacement of the 2019 Resolution with an earlier one had taken place through an insufficient GEM discussion, so much so that many GBC Members hadn't realized that a change had taken place,

Whereas ISKCON Law 7.3.2 now reads:

"As taught by Srila Prabhupada, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of one's diksa-guru will be upheld in ISKCON. However, Srila Prabhupada and historical precedents also teach us that disciples may sometimes initiate in the physical presence of their diksa-gurus, if so directed by them. In such a case, the disciple should go through the normal procedure for commencing the service of diksa-guru."

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The 2019 Governing Law "Conditions for second-generation Diksa-gurus" be reintroduced in a modified form as follows:

ISKCON Law 7.3.2 is amended to read as follows:

As taught by Srila Prabhupada, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of one's diksa-guru will be upheld in ISKCON. However historical precedents also teach us that disciples may sometimes, in exceptional cases, initiate in the physical presence of their diksa-gurus.

The GBC clarifies that an individual devotee taking up the service of diksa-guru in the physical presence of their guru may be allowed as an exception when the following conditions are met. The Guru Services Committee will confirm that the candidate for becoming a next generation guru has met all these conditions:

Mandatory Conditions:

1. The candidate must have been initiated for at least 25 years.
2. The candidate's diksa-guru has affirmed in writing to the GBC Body that he agrees the candidate is suitable for this service and that he gives his blessings.
3. A letter of approval for the candidate to take up the role of diksa-guru has been received from the Regional Council, or if none exists, the National Council, Area Council or, if none of the above exists, the GBC member of that area where the candidate primarily serves or resides.

4. All standard procedures for commencing the service of diksa-guru according to ISKCON law, including required training and other conditions as outlined and codified by the Guru Service Committee, as well as additional appropriate training from diksa- and/or siksa- gurus, have been met.

5. Final acceptance of the candidate to begin initiating is affirmed by a 2/3 vote of the GBC Body.

Additional Mandatory Condition

(may be waived by a 2/3 vote of the GBC Body):

- The candidate's own diksa-guru should retire completely from accepting disciples or agrees to immediately retire upon the guru's disciple accepting his own disciples. This is true especially if the currently initiating guru is overburdened with responsibilities and/or is experiencing serious health problems.

Factors to be considered by the GBC in determining if a waiver may be approved:

- The area in which the candidate will initiate has a substantial number of devotees wanting initiation, and a shortage of gurus to do this service.
- Language barriers necessitate gurus who speak the local language in specified areas.

Optional conditions that may be applied in an individual case, per a 2/3 vote of the GBC:

- When the candidate takes up the service of diksa-guru he will only be able initiate in a specific area(s).
- The number of disciples the new diksa-guru may initiate can be limited by the GBC.

The responsibility of ensuring that all conditions for next generation diksa-gurus as listed above rests with the respective Local Area Councils nominating such candidates and confirmed by the Guru Services Committee.

GBC Resolution 702.02 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

7.3.3 Requirement for Consent of Mantra Guru

Devotees who have received first initiation from Srila Prabhupada and second initiation from one of Srila Prabhupada's disciples may, with the written consent of the *mantra guru*, be accepted as candidates for initiating spiritual master like any of Srila Prabhupada's other disciples.

7.4 Regulations

7.4.1 Procedure for Authorizing Diksa and Siksa-Gurus

A devotee may serve as *diksa-guru* in ISKCON after completing the following procedure:

7.4.1.1 Endorsement by an Area Council

When the Zonal Secretaries for a local area, in consultation with the local leadership, conclude that a particular devotee, through preaching in that area, has been providing substantial guidance and shelter to devotees, they may convene a Local Area Council to consider nominating this devotee for serving as a *diksa-guru*. The Council must give a three-fourths majority vote in support of the candidate to serve as *diksa-guru*.

In addition to the Local Area Council, Regional Governing Bodies may, at their discretion, have additional oversight for candidates in their area of responsibility.

7.4.1.1.1 Composition of Council

The Council must consist of the local Zonal Secretaries and at least ten other devotees from the local area who are familiar with the candidate. It must include all Regional Secretaries, Temple Presidents, and resident *sannyasis* in the area. The Council members should elect a Chairman from among themselves.

7.4.1.1.2 Principles of Evaluation

The Council shall evaluate the candidate according to the qualifications for guru given by Srila Prabhupada in his oral and written teachings and by the GBC Body, by confirming, to the best of their ability, that the candidate possesses the qualifications as listed under 7.2.1 above.

Each member of the Area Council shall fill out the Guru Qualifications Checklist and return it to be compiled by the Area Council Chairman.

7.4.1.1.3 Council Integrity Maintained

Once the council has been formed to evaluate a particular candidate, it cannot be reconstituted except to replace a member who has left his position as a local ISKCON Leader, or who has resigned from the council, or who has become spiritually unfit.

7.4.1.1.4 Communication of Objection

If the candidate for serving as *diksa-guru* is not supported by the Local Area Council, the Chairman of the Local Area Council shall inform the candidate and aspiring disciples, if any, of this decision in writing.

7.4.1.2 Provision for "No Objection" Letters

If the candidate for serving as *diksa-guru* has been active for less than five years in the area making the nomination, the nominating Local Area Council shall obtain "no objection" letters from the Zonal Secretaries and Temple President(s) of the other area(s) the candidate was active in during the five years previous to the candidacy.

Additionally, the Local Area Council shall formally consult the leadership of every area outside the jurisdiction of the nominating Local Area Council in which the candidate spends significant time before deciding on the candidacy.

7.4.1.3 Names Sent to All GBC Members

7.4.1.3.1 Letter of Nomination to GBC Corresponding Secretary

If the candidacy receives support from the Local Area Council, the Chairman of the Council shall send a letter to the GBC Corresponding Secretary that includes the following:

1. A description of how the candidate conforms to the GBC standards and guidelines for guru
2. A complete history of the devotional service of the candidate, including the dates and places of his engagements
3. A list of the nominating Local Area Council members along with their service, tenure, vote, and rationale

7.4.1.3.2 Corresponding Secretary Verifies and Distributes

After verifying that the candidate has been properly nominated, the Corresponding Secretary shall send the candidate's name to all members of the GBC.

7.4.1.4 Three GBC Objections Veto Candidate

During the six months from the date of submission of the candidate's application to the GBC, members of the GBC who question the suitability of the candidate as per the qualifications in ISKCON Law 7.2, may file written statements with the GBC Corresponding Secretary requesting further review.

7.4.1.4.1 Absence of Three Requests for Further Review

If the GBC Corresponding Secretary has not received at least three requests for further review by the end of the six month period, the GBC Corresponding Secretary shall so inform the Chairman of the recommending Council. Then the candidate, after taking the prescribed vows, may commence the service of a *diksa-guru* in ISKCON.

7.4.1.4.2 Requests for Further Review

If the Corresponding Secretary receives at least three requests for further review by the end of the six month period, and if the rationales are deemed legitimate by the GBC Executive Committee per ISKCON Law 7.4.1.1.4, then the GBC Executive Committee will communicate the reasons for the review requests to the Chairman of the Local Area Council that nominated the candidate and ask for the Local Area Council's response.

The same applies if even a single request for further review provides sufficient doubt about the candidate's good standing as a devotee.

If the GBC Executive Committee, in consultation with the GBC members requesting the review, as necessary, is able to resolve the said concerns with the Local Area Council, then the candidate, after taking the prescribed vows, may commence the service of a *diksa-guru* in ISKCON.

If the GBC Executive Committee, in consultation with the GBC members requesting the review, as necessary, is unable to resolve the said concerns with the Local Area Council, then the candidate shall be reviewed by the GBC Body at its next Annual General Meeting. If the candidacy receives a simple majority vote, then the candidate, after taking the prescribed vows, may commence the service of a *diksa-guru* in ISKCON.

7.4.1.4.3 Local Area Council Presenting at the Annual General Meeting

The Local Area Council has the option of making a presentation to the GBC Body before its final vote on the candidacy, preferably by sending a delegation of one or two members to address the Body. The candidate may also make a presentation to the Body, preferably by personal appearance.

7.4.1.4.4 Further Direction to Candidate

If the GBC chooses to not support the candidacy, then the Guru Services Committee shall provide direction to the candidate, which might include recommendations on how the candidate can come to the standard to serve as a *diksa-guru* in the future.

7.4.1.4.5 Corresponding Secretary Monitors and Informs

The Corresponding Secretary shall monitor this procedure and keep all the concerned parties informed as needed

7.4.2 Vows of Guru

If a Local Area Council does not support a *diksa-guru* candidate, the case may be appealed by any interested party to the relevant Regional Governing Body, if existing in the area. If the Regional Governing Body decides that the candidate has met the mandatory qualifications and eligibility requirements for serving as *diksa-guru* per ISKCON Law 7.4.1.1.4, then the Regional Governing Body may, at their discretion, decide to support the candidate. After notifying the Local Area Council, the Chairman of the Regional Governing Body shall then send a letter of nomination to the GBC Corresponding Secretary accompanied by the decision of the Local Area Council so the process may continue with the Regional Governing Body acting as the nominating body instead of the Local Area Council.

If there is no Regional Governing Body, the case can be appealed directly to the GBC Body. (Any proposal to the GBC Body must be sponsored by a GBC member.)

7.4.3 Standards of Conduct for Gurus in ISKCON

A devotee who has been allowed to commence the service of a *diksa-guru* in ISKCON must publicly take the following vows in a ceremony before Srila Prabhupada's *vyasasana*. A signed copy of the vows must be filed with the GBC Corresponding Secretary:

1. My personal mission as guru in ISKCON shall be the same as the mission of Srila Prabhupada: to flood the world with transcendental literature like *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and, as Srila Prabhupada said, to "do as I am doing" in establishing ISKCON all over the world.
2. I recognize the GBC as the ultimate managing authority in ISKCON. I support the GBC system and will follow the GBC as Srila Prabhupada desired.
3. I recognize that a bona fide guru is first of all a bona fide disciple, and that in all my actions I shall remain surrendered to Srila Prabhupada's orders and the orders of his authorized representatives.
4. As Srila Prabhupada ordered his followers to serve within ISKCON under the GBC, I acknowledge that for me to represent Srila Prabhupada in my service as a guru in *parampara* "under his order," I can do so only as a member of ISKCON. If I leave ISKCON I shall no longer act as guru.
5. As a spiritual master, I shall always set a Krsna conscious standard for all devotees by my behavior, which shall be strictly regulated and exemplary at all times. As a public representative of ISKCON, I must always conform with ISKCON policies and never act in any way to weaken or jeopardize ISKCON's world-wide mission. I shall not act in a way to diminish any person's faith in Krsna consciousness.
6. I shall scrupulously study and review all aspiring disciples, and grant initiation only to qualified devotees so as to preserve the seriousness and sanctity of initiation. I shall only accept as disciples candidates who are qualified according to the standards and procedures established by ISKCON law.
7. I shall give my disciples directions and examples in strict conformity with those of Srila Prabhupada. I shall teach all my disciples that they are part of ISKCON.

7.4.4 Monitoring of Gurus by the GBC

7.4.4.1 Annual Reports

1. Must always set the highest example for all devotees.
2. Must guide disciples to follow Srila Prabhupada's instructions.
3. Must protect and nourish the faith of all ISKCON devotees in their gurus, in Srila Prabhupada, and in Sri Krsna.
4. Must encourage newcomers' faith in ISKCON and protect the faith of existing members.
5. Must not give initiation until the process as detailed in 7.4.1 has been fully completed.
6. Must not canvass for disciples.
7. Must allow all uninitiated devotees full freedom to exercise their right to accept initiation from the guru of their choice.
8. Must allow uninitiated devotees who have preliminarily taken shelter of him the full freedom to change their minds on their choice of initiating guru.
9. Since the guru-*daksina* received by an ISKCON guru is the property of ISKCON, it must be used for the benefit of the Krsna consciousness movement. All guru-*daksina* must be kept in a special account, preferably an ISKCON account, with at least two signatures, and accurate account records must be kept.

7.4.4.2 Emergency Reports

1. Must respect the GBC as Srila Prabhupada's chosen successor as the ultimate managing authority of ISKCON and maintain a respectful serving attitude towards the GBC.
2. As a guru in *parampara* from Srila Prabhupada, he must follow Srila Prabhupada in order to work in ISKCON. Therefore, he must accept the GBC Body as his authority and follow the directives of the GBC.
3. Must submit to any disciplinary sanctions imposed by the GBC Body, including not initiating new disciples.

7.4.4.3 Standards in Relation to GBC Zonal Secretaries

1. Must act under the supervision of and in coordination with GBC Zonal Secretaries.
2. Must not change residence without consulting the local GBC Zonal Secretary beforehand, since such a move may affect the temples and devotees.
3. Must disclose financial records to the GBC Zonal Secretary if the need arises.

7.4.4.4 Standards in Relation to ISKCON Spiritual Authorities

"ISKCON spiritual authority" refers to Temple Presidents, Regional Secretaries, local GBC Zonal Secretaries, and those of similar stature.

1. Must be accountable to the local ISKCON authorities for his actions.
2. Must cooperate with local ISKCON authorities.
3. Must not initiate any devotee who has not received proper recommendation from the appropriate ISKCON spiritual authority.
4. Must instruct disciples and other devotees to cooperate with ISKCON authorities.
5. Must avoid confrontation with ISKCON authorities and settle any misunderstandings amicably.
6. Must not undermine ISKCON authorities in any way.
7. Must not direct disciples to make changes in service or *asrama* without first securing the consent of the disciple's local authority.
8. Must act according to his position of service in ISKCON and not merely his position as guru.

7.4.4.5 Standards in Relation to a Temple

1. Must work and preach for the interest of the temple.
2. Must coordinate any ceremonies or special programs with the temple schedule.
3. Must surrender the engagement in devotional service of his disciples who live in an ISKCON temple to the temple management.
4. Must not transfer disciples from a temple without permission of the Temple President. A guru may, however, request a disciple to leave a particular temple, without obtaining the president's consent, when the guru considers it a matter of "spiritual life and death" for the disciple, as for example, being regularly exposed to direct blasphemy of his guru, or being unable to follow the four regulative principles. In this case the guru must consult with the local GBC Zonal Secretary.

7.4.5 Sanctioning of Gurus by the GBC

7.4.5.1 Warning (or Censure)

Each GBC member must submit a form annually to the Executive Committee indicating briefly the status of all ISKCON gurus normally residing, regularly preaching, or initiating in his zone. (The Executive Committee will assign a GBC member(s) for monitoring each guru.)

7.4.5.2 Probation

If any guru has:

1. taken reinitiation/shelter of a non-ISKCON guru or institution;
2. rejected ISKCON or Srila Prabhupada; or
3. undergone a change of service, of *asrama*, or of living situation, which the local GBC member feels threatens to hamper the guru's ability to give guidance or to set a proper standard of conduct for disciples, then the GBC member shall submit an emergency report to the Executive Committee. If possible, this report shall include a written statement from the guru in question as to his intentions in regard to his disciples and his devotional service.

If not possible, then the report shall at least include a description of the guru's intentions as best they can be discerned through the investigation of the GBC member.

The report shall also contain any other information which would be of value to the GBC Body in determining the guru's status, as well as the recommendations of the local Temple Presidents, zonal councils, etc.

The Executive Committee shall review the emergency reports and take any necessary action.

7.4.6 Discipline of Devotees Serving as *Diksa-gurus*

Resignation If a devotee previously serving as an initiating guru in ISKCON is no longer able to provide spiritual guidance to his/her existing disciples and therefore resigns, he/she is required to notify the GBC Executive Committee. If the resignation is accepted, the initiating guru is required to notify his/her disciples in writing. The GBC Executive Committee or GBC Body shall then give direction to the disciples and ISKCON members in general, as deemed appropriate.

The former initiating guru's name shall then be removed from the list of initiating gurus.

Reasons for Discipline

If it is deemed that the continuation of a devotee's serving as an initiating guru in ISKCON is likely to disturb the peaceful conduct of the affairs of ISKCON, this service may be restricted or rescinded. Activities creating such a disturbance are to be defined and determined at the ecclesiastical discretion of the GBC and may include, but are not limited to:

Misconduct and Failure to Follow Religious Principles or Higher Spiritual Authority

1. Wilful violation of GBC resolutions, in particular, but not limited to, deviating from ISKCON's procedural requirements, such as canvassing for disciples, or not obtaining permission from local authorities before initiating someone, or being neglectful in the standard spiritual practices.
2. Vilification of ISKCON or the GBC Body.
3. Misconduct, such as physical assault, except in self-defense, improper relationships with the opposite sex, improper sexual behavior, abusive behavior to devotees, improper dealings with external society, etc.
4. Habitually or knowingly making false charges and accusations or other vaisnava-aparadhas.

5. Disregard of the devotees' need to accept and receive guidance and shelter from spiritual guides of their choice.
6. Duplicitous or untruthful dealings, such as giving false promises to devotees, lying, or other serious prevarications.
7. Having taken re-initiation/shelter of a non-ISKCON guru or institution.
8. Having rejected ISKCON or Srila Prabhupada.
9. Having undergone a change of service, of asrama, or of living situation, which threatens the initiating guru's ability to give guidance or set a proper standard of personal conduct.

Improper Discharge and Neglect of Duty

1. Misuse of Funds.
2. Consistent failure to submit required reports.

Spiritual Discrepancy

1. Failure to follow strictly the rules and regulations as described in Srila Prabhupada's books.
2. Philosophical deviation.
3. Failure to regularly attend the temple morning program without a bona fide or good cause.
4. Failure to follow any of the four regulative principles or to regularly chant sixteen rounds of japa.

Depending on the severity of any activity deemed improper, corrective steps may consist of informal discussions, written warnings or censures, or measures such as placing the devotee on probation, suspension of giving initiation, rescinding of giving initiation, or any other measures deemed appropriate to the situation by the GBC. **Disciplining Authority** A devotee serving as an initiating guru in ISKCON may be censured by any of the following:

A simple majority vote of the GBC Body.

The GBC Executive Committee.

A simple majority vote of a Regional Governing Body.

A simple majority vote of a Divisional or National Council.

Where there is no Regional Governing Body or Divisional or National Council, three GBC's, which must include the GBC(s) of that area.

In the case of probation, suspension or rescinding of the privilege to initiate, a *diksa-guru* in ISKCON may be disciplined by the following:

A simple majority vote of the GBC Body. The GBC Body shall then delegate a committee to perform the necessary follow-up actions.

The GBC Executive Committee.

The disciplining body or officials must ensure that all details of the disciplinary action are placed on record with the GBC Secretary and, if applicable, entered into the relevant resolutions of the disciplining body. Nothing in this law section shall be deemed to limit the ability of any Regional Governing Body, Divisional Council, National Council, or other local authority to withhold permission for a devotee serving as *diksa-guru* in ISKCON from conducting initiation ceremonies within their jurisdiction. **Censure** Censure is a reprimand aimed at reformation of the devotee and prevention of further offending acts. It is preliminary step that may lead to probation or rescindment. Censure may serve as a precedent to other forms of religious discipline.

When imposing censure, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person the specific basis of the censure, including the actions that were irresponsible, inappropriate, or in violation of ISKCON Law and the grounds thereof. **Probation** Probation is an opportunity for a devotee to rectify and regain his or her status as an ISKCON initiating guru in good standing. Probation does not mean that the service of initiating has been withdrawn, but it may include a partial curtailment. When ordering the probation, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person:

the specific actions that were irresponsible, inappropriate, or in violation of ISKCON Law and the basis thereof.

the specific program of rectification.

the specific partial curtailment of the privilege to initiate, if any.

the specific prerequisites for restoration, if any.

the time period of the probation, which shall be no longer than one year.

After the period of probation, the disciplining authority must decide one of the following:

The devotee is rectified and is no longer on probation.

A determination of further probation under the same or modified conditions is required to complete the rectification process.

The devotee has not been rectified and the privilege to initiate should be suspended or rescinded.

Suspension Pending Investigation Where there is substantial reason to believe that an ISKCON *diksa-guru* has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON Law such that continuation of the privilege to initiate is likely to damage the good name, reputation, or other resources of Srila Prabhupada or the society, or if there are serious allegations of impropriety requiring investigation, then the devotee's privilege to initiate should be suspended pending investigation. Suspension pending investigation is to separate the devotee from his or her role as initiating guru so that a thorough investigation of allegations may be conducted and the advisability of continuing to serve as *diksa-guru* is determined. The disciplining body must conduct an immediate investigation so as to minimize any disruptions. After completion of the investigation, the body shall make a determination and decide the future course of action. They may order one of the following:

The suspension shall be revoked and the privilege to initiate restored.

There shall be a probationary period with a program of rectification as described under probation above.

It is not expected that the devotee can be rectified within a reasonable period of time and the privilege to initiate shall be suspended or rescinded as per the terms given below.

There shall be no public worship of a devotee whose privilege to initiate is under suspension pending investigation by the ecclesiastical action of the GBC.

Suspension When there has been a determination that a *diksa-guru* has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON Law such that the privilege to initiate is likely to damage the good name, reputation, or other resources of Srila Prabhupada and the society, but there is possibility that eventually the devotee may be rectified, then the devotee's privilege to initiate should be suspended. When suspension is imposed, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person:

the specific transgression or misconduct causing the suspension and the grounds thereof

the specific requirements for reinstatement

Such suspension of the privilege to initiate is not limited by a period of time and shall remain in effect until specifically withdrawn by the disciplining or any higher authority. There shall be no public worship of a devotee whose privilege to initiate has been suspended by the ecclesiastical action of the GBC.

Rescindment

When there has been a determination that a *diksa-guru* has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON Law such that the privilege to initiate is likely to damage the good name, reputation, or other resources of Srila Prabhupada and the society, and there is little or no possibility that the devotee may eventually be rectified, then the devotee's privilege to initiate shall be rescinded. When the privilege to initiate has been rescinded, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person the grounds or reasons thereof. There shall be no public worship of a devotee whose privilege to initiate has been rescinded by the ecclesiastical action of the GBC.

Appeals

If an ISKCON initiating guru is disciplined by a National or Divisional Council, he/she shall have the right of appeal to the Regional Governing Body (if one exists in the area) or the GBC Body (if there is no Regional Governing Body in the area).

If he/she is disciplined by three GBC members he/she shall have the right of appeal to the GBC Executive Committee or the GBC Body. If he/she is disciplined by a Regional Governing Body he/she shall have the right of appeal to the GBC Body. If he/she is disciplined by the GBC Executive Committee he/she shall have the right of appeal to the GBC Body.

Any disciplinary action taken against an ISKCON initiating guru by any of the abovementioned entities shall stand unless and until it is overruled by a higher ecclesiastical body, up to and including the GBC.

7.4.7 Renunciation of Guru Responsibilities

7.4.7.1 "Zonal-Acarya" System

No guru should declare himself or allow himself to be declared an "*acarya*" or "present *acarya*" for ISKCON or for a geographical area of ISKCON. There should be no use of the word "*acarya*" as a title of office.

7.4.7.2 "Posthumous Ritvik" Doctrine

"The doctrine that Srila Prabhupada desired to continue to act as *diksa-guru* after his departure from this world and did not desire any of his disciples to give *diksa* in succession after him is a dangerous philosophical deviation. Ritvikism directly goes against the principle of parampara itself (of successive *diksa* and *siksa-gurus*), which sustains the pure teachings and practices of Krsna consciousness. This principle has been established by Krsna and is upheld by all *acaryas*. Indeed, it is accepted by all followers of Vedic culture. Ritvikism is thus an extreme deviation. It is utterly erroneous to espouse it, deluding and misguiding to teach it, and blasphemous to attribute it to Srila Prabhupada. No one, who espouses, teaches, supports in any way, or practices ritvikism can be a member in good standing of ISKCON.

7.4.7.3 Enforcement of ISKCON Law regarding Ritvikism

1. The GBC Body unequivocally rejects in principle any proposals that Ritvikism be in some manner or another accommodated or tolerated within ISKCON.

2. The GBC Body hereby makes known its strong determination to enforce ISKCON Law in the matter of Ritvikism and it enjoins upon all its members and other official bodies, officers, and other authorities in ISKCON such as Regional Governing Boards, Regional Secretaries, GBC Ministers, Sannyasis, Initiating Gurus, Temple presidents, and Temple Officers, the responsibility to take every appropriate action, according to ISKCON Law to enforce the prohibition against Ritvikism in ISKCON.

3. A. The GBC Body declares that to espouse or preach Ritvikism includes the following censurable offenses under the provisions of ISKCON Law: (8.4.1.3)

- Conscious and serious philosophical deviation from Srila Prabhupada's preachings and
- Wilful violation of GBC Body resolutions.

B. Further the GBC Body hereby rules that in relation to the espousal of Ritvikism these offenses are of a sufficiently serious nature as to warrant immediate imposition of the penalty of probation, including, its attendant program for rectification.

C. Further, the GBC Body hereby empowers the Executive Committee for the year 1999-2000 to place any ISKCON member who espouses Ritvikism on probation, and in consultation with that member's immediate local authority, or local GBC Member, to establish a specific program of rectification as provided in ISKCON Law 8.4.2.2.

7.4.8 Worship and Etiquette

7.4.8.1 Ceremonies

7.4.8.1.1 Guru-puja

As it is enjoined in scripture that a devotee must honour his spiritual master, ISKCON members shall be trained to place their faith, trust, allegiance first and foremost in the Founder-acarya who is the pre-eminent siksa guru for every member of ISKCON. Srila Prabhupada is to be worshipped through his words, his murti, his picture, and his devotees. Disciples of ISKCON *diksa-gurus*, other than Srila Prabhupada, may worship their gurus according to the guidelines of ISKCON Laws and in keeping with the spirit of the abovementioned standards for guru worship in ISKCON.

7.4.8.1.2 Vyasa-puja

ISKCON members shall celebrate Srila Prabhupada's vyasa-puja ceremony as the pre-eminent vyasa-puja ceremony in ISKCON. All ISKCON members are requested to write an annual vyasa-puja offering to Srila Prabhupada. Vyasa-puja for ISKCON gurus other than Srila Prabhupada should only be observed on one day a year. This celebration may be held in the temple room. ISKCON

members conducting vyasa-puja ceremonies for ISKCON siksa and diksa gurus shall observe them in a modest way, significantly less elaborate in duration and cost than Srila Prabhupada's vyasa-puja. In general, devotees shall observe these vyasa-puja celebrations in their own locales. In ISKCON, only Srila Prabhupada's vyasa-puja books shall be published.

7.4.8.1.3 Standards of Guru Worship in ISKCON

a. ISKCON devotees shall instruct new members to take shelter of Srila Prabhupada and receive guidance, training and assistance from those who are practically and directly instructing them in Krsna consciousness. ISKCON members shall not compel or coerce new members to accept any particular siksa or *diksa-guru* or to take diksa initiation at any particular point in time. New members shall choose when and from whom they wish to request initiation, however, for a minimum of six months of strict sadhana, they must focus their attention on Srila Prabhupada as Founder-Acarya and their *siksa-guru*. After having established a solid relationship with His Divine Graces' vani, they may accept an ISKCON guru and after a subsequent minimum of six months, accept Vaisnava-diksa.

b. After chanting the pranama-mantra of their diksa (or siksa) guru, all grand disciples and future generations should chant at least the first of Srila Prabhupada's pranama-mantra while offering obeisances as a means of respecting the Founder-acarya.

- c. In order to offer appropriate respect to Srila Prabhupada as Founder-acarya and pre-eminent spiritual master of ISKCON, it is considered an essential devotional practice for all ISKCON devotees, to observe or perform Srila Prabhupada's guru-puja daily, either in an ISKCON temple, or if not possible, in one's home.
- d. With an aim to focus more fully on Srila Prabhupada and every devotee's special relationship with him, and to correct any imbalance in application between the respect offered to *siksa-gurus*, *diksa-gurus* and other senior or vaisnavas contributing to a devotee's spiritual progress, an ISKCON siksa or diksa guru may accept public guru-puja (arati and/or foot-bathing) in person once a year on ISKCON property as Vyasa-puja.
- e. Events welcoming Vaisnavas, including siksa and diksa gurus to ISKCON temples should be modest (for example, limited to presentation of garland(s) and accompanying kirtana.)
- f. ISKCON Leaders shall teach that Srila Prabhupada's books and teachings are the foundation of the spiritual lives of all ISKCON members. Therefore, all ISKCON members shall consider it their compulsory duty to study Srila Prabhupada's books. Hearing from other devotee's books and teachings is secondary and supplemental and should not be done at the expense of hearing regularly from Srila Prabhupada.
- g. Temple Presidents and Project Leaders are fully responsible for engaging the devotees in their charge. Gurus must first consult with a Temple President before talking to his disciples about changing their service.
- h. Gurus shall minimize the number of devotees engaged in their personal service and in their travelling entourage. Gurus shall not personally engage single members of the opposite sex or married members of the opposite sex without their spouse, in direct personal service and should never be alone or in a solitary place with them as ordained by *sastra*.
- i. Guru-daksina and other donations offered to *siksa-* and *diksa-gurus* are the property of ISKCON.
- j. At the time of *diksa* initiation, all disciples will be further instructed by their initiating guru that Srila Prabhupada is their pre-eminent *siksa-guru* as ISKCON's Founder-Acarya, ever present in his books and teachings. Thus they have a recognized *siksa* link to Srila Prabhupada.

7.4.8.1.4 Times for Guru Worship

All festivals, events, commemorative occasions, etc. that are in honor of present ISKCON gurus and that are observed in the main worship area of ISKCON institutions, are to be held at times other than those normally set aside for regular worship, such as the morning program and the Sunday feast.

7.4.8.2 Restricted Titles

No one in ISKCON will be addressed publicly with honorific title "His Divine Grace", nor be addressed either publicly or privately, the honorifics ending in "pada" or "deva". Disciples may address their ISKCON diksa or siksa gurus as "Gurudeva" or "Guru Maharaja".

7.4.8.3 Photograph on Altar

ISKCON devotees shall offer arati and bhoga to Lord Krsna through both their diksa or siksa guru and Srila Prabhupada as their pre-eminent *siksa-guru*. A temple pujari shall keep a smaller picture of his diksa guru on the arati tray or table instead of on the altar and remove it after the arati. Subsequent generations of devotees shall continue in the same manner of respecting both their own diksa or siksa guru and Srila Prabhupada.

ISKCON Temple resident Members may keep the photographs of ISKCON diksa or siksa gurus privately in their asrama quarters but are not to display them publicly on ISKCON premises. Promoting occasional special preaching events may be an exception. Disciples of ISKCON diksa and siksa gurus should not wear or publicly display guru t-shirts, posters, bead bag buttons, athletic caps etc. (other than Srila Prabhupada).

7.4.8.4 Seat in Temple Room

Sastra enjoins that the disciple may not sit on the seat of the guru. The seat for speaking Srimad-Bhagavatam, however, is not the property of any one guru, there is no harm in any Vaisnava sitting in that place while giving class. Thus, anyone giving sastra classes in ISKCON temple rooms shall use a single seat reserved for the purpose.

7.4.8.5 Guru Under Suspension

7.4.8.5.1 No Public Worship

There should be no public worship of a guru who is under suspension by the GBC.

7.4.8.5.2 Disciples Offering Arati

While performing *arati* to the Deities a disciple of a suspended guru should offer the various articles through Srila Prabhupada to the disciplic succession.

7.4.8.5.3 Disciples Offering Bhoga

When offering *bhoga* to the Deities in the temple or outside the temple in ISKCON establishments like restaurants, a disciple of a suspended guru must offer through Srila Prabhupada to the disciplic succession.

7.4.8.5.4 Disciples Offering Obeisances

While offering obeisances in a public place a disciple of a suspended guru should recite Srila Prabhupada's *pranama-mantra* aloud and should chant the mantras to the suspended guru silently or not at all.

7.4.8.6 Murtis of Gurus Inside the Temple Room

There shall be no establishment of *murtis* in any ISKCON temple room of ISKCON gurus subsequent to Srila Prabhupada in succession. (97-617)

7.5 Guidelines

7.5.1 Rejection of a Fallen "Guru"

Note: The following laws are based on Sri Krsna-bhajanamrta by Sri Narahari Sarkara (an associate of Sri Caitanya), Bhakti-sandarbha by Srila Jiva Gosvami, and Jaiva-dharma by Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura, in addition to the writings of Srila A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada.

7.5.1.1 When a Fallen Guru May Be Rejected

If it is ascertained either by the admission of the guru, or by the testimony of irrefutably reliable witness(es) that the guru was fallen at the time of initiation, then the disciple has a legitimate reason to reject him and take re-initiation from a bona fide spiritual master.

7.5.1.2 When a Fallen Guru Must Be Rejected

7.5.1.2.1 Hopelessly Entangled in Sense Gratification

If a guru has become hopelessly entangled in sense gratification, and it has been established by reliable testimony or by his own admissions that he has been regularly violating the regulative principles of Krsna consciousness, and if there is virtually no hope for his rectification, then the disciple should reject him and may accept re-initiation.

7.5.1.2.2 Takes on Demonic Qualities

If the spiritual master takes on demonic qualities and becomes inimical to ISKCON, he should be rejected and the disciple may take re-initiation.

7.5.1.3 When Not to Reject a Fallen Guru

If a guru is engaged in sense gratification, violating one or more of the regulative principles, but there is hope that he can be rectified, then his disciples should not reject him but should allow time for such rectification to take place, and they should take shelter of Srila Prabhupada and senior Vaisnavas as *siksa-gurus*.

7.5.1.4 When a Suspended Guru May Be Rejected

A disciple of a suspended guru who has severely lost faith in his or her spiritual master, and is unable to regain faith, even after hearing many instructions in the matter, may take permission from the spiritual master for release to accept a different initiating guru. If the suspended guru is not willing to give permission, then the disciple may approach their local GBC representative and the Guru Services Committee, and present this desire to them. If the GBC representative is either the guru under suspension, or the guru the disciple wishes to be reinitiated by, then the Guru Services Committee will request another GBC member they feel is suitable to take up the matter. If the GBC member and the Guru Services Committee give their permission, the disciple may accept a different initiating guru.

7.5.1.5 "Guru Asraya" for Guidance

Devotees whose initiating spiritual master has fallen down should take guidance from the GBC papers entitled "Guru Asraya" and "Questions and Answers About Reinitiation." These papers also present ISKCON's guidelines on the importance of taking shelter of a spiritual master and the role of *siksa-guru*.

7.6 The Siksa-Guru

7.6.1 Definition

In accordance with the instructions of Srila Prabhupada in the Caitanya-caritamrita, "A devotee must have only one initiating spiritual master because in the scriptures acceptance of more than one is always forbidden. There is no limit, however, to the number of instructing spiritual masters one may accept." (CC Adi 1.35 Purport)

"Srila Krsna dasa Kaviraja Gosvami states that the instructing spiritual master is a bona fide representative of Sri Krsna. The initiating spiritual master is a personal manifestation of Srila Madana-mohana vigraha, whereas the instructing spiritual master is a personal representative of Srila Govindadeva vigraha." (CC Adi 1.47 Purport),

Devotees may accept a devotee as his/her *siksa-guru* and serve him as a representative of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. If they are under shelter or initiated by a spiritual master in good standing, they are to first acquire the blessings of their *diksa-guru* in order to accept a *siksa-guru*.

7.7 Guru Services Committee

A Guru Services Committee is hereby established with the purpose to resolve present and prospective guru topics. This Committee is to:

A. Ascertain whether each guru is following the standard practice of Krsna Consciousness, including:

1. Chanting a minimum of sixteen rounds per day and having a visible sadhana;
2. Has proper relationships with others according to his asrama, especially with the opposite sex;
3. Is responsibly engaged in his service within the Society;
4. Has an appropriate understanding of the siddhanta of Krsna Consciousness as given by Srila Prabhupada;
5. Is cooperating with the other devotees within ISKCON and,
6. Is financially accountable.

- B. Establish committees to research and deal with the philosophy and practical issues concerning gurus within ISKCON.
- C. Review existing procedures and recommend modifications of the existing procedures by which devotees in ISKCON can commence the service of *diksa-guru*.
- D. Review prospective gurus when called upon to do so.
- E. This committee has the power to educate the guru or to recommend to the GBC Body Executive Committee to sanction him /her, according to ISKCON Law. Any sanctions must be reviewed by the GBC Body at the Annual General Meeting in Mayapur.

ADDED · 2019

701.2 · Conditions for Second-generation Diksa-gurus (2019)

[Governing Law]

Whereas at the 2019 AGM, it was resolved that, under certain conditions, disciples can give initiation in the physical presence of their spiritual masters;

Whereas this resolution called for the Guru Services Committee to develop a more detailed process of implementation;

Resolved:

That the responsibility of ensuring that all conditions for Second-generation Diksa-gurus as listed in resolution “701.2, Conditions for Second-generation Diksa-gurus — 2019” of the 2019 Annual General Meeting, rests with the respective Local Area Councils nominating such candidates.

GBC Resolution 701.2 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

701.6 · Vaisnavi Diksa-gurus (2019)

[Governing Law]

Whereas in 2009 the GBC Resolved:

1. The GBC accepts the philosophical conclusion presented in the SAC's Female Diksa Guru Paper that a mature, qualified, female devotee may accept the role of an initiating spiritual master.
2. The GBC Body authorizes local area committees to put forward for approval as initiating guru any devotee in their area, male or female, who is qualified according to existing GBC Law.

Whereas, since then, the GBC has worked to achieve consensus and implementation of this resolution;

Whereas after much study, dialogue, and research, the GBC has come to the following conclusion.

Resolved:

1. Vaisnavis are eligible to give diksa in ISKCON provided that they:
 - a. Meet all the qualifications listed for ISKCON diksa-guru applicants;
 - b. Are at least 55 years of age and in a stable family situation, living under the protection of a husband, elder son or son-in-law, qualified householder couple or senior Vaisnava or Vaisnavi sanga;
 - c. Receive written permission from the appropriate Regional Body or its equivalent, or National Council, to give diksa in that particular part of the world.
2. After five years the GBC shall review this resolution to determine if the number of Vaisnavis initiating in any region or as a total for the world is in keeping with Srila Prabhupada's indication of "...not so many".

This resolution lifts the abeyance on this matter stated in resolution 310 of 2015.

GBC Resolution 701.6 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

701.6 · Statement on the Resolution Allowing Vaisnavis to Serve as Diksa-gurus in ISKCON (2019)

[Statement]

“Just adhere yourself to the lotus feet of Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu. Then you become spiritual master. That's all. So I hope that all of you, men, women, boys and girls, become spiritual master and follow this principle. Spiritual master — simply, sincerely, follow the principles and speak to the general public. Then Krsna immediately becomes your favorite. Krsna does not become your favorite; you become Krsna's favorite. (...) So if you want to become recognized by Krsna very quickly, you take up this process of becoming spiritual master, present the Bhagavad-gita as it is, your life is perfect.” (Sri Vyasa-puja Lecture — August 22, 1973, London)

“... as far as Krsna consciousness is concerned, everyone is capable of becoming a spiritual master because knowledge in Krsna consciousness is on the platform of the spirit soul. (...) The word guru is equally applicable to the vartma-pradarsaka-guru, siksa-guru and diksa-guru. Unless we accept the principle enunciated by Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu, this Krsna consciousness movement cannot spread all over the world”. (Caitanya-caritamṛta, Madhya-lila 8.128 purport)

On October 15, 2019, the Governing Body Commission of the International Society for Kṛṣṇa Consciousness (GBC) at their Mid-term General Meeting passed a resolution allowing, under certain conditions, mature and qualified Vaisnavis to serve as diksa-gurus in ISKCON.

The primary bases for this decision are the expressed desires and instructions on guru qualifications of ISKCON's Founder-Acarya, His Divine Grace Srila A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada.

This resolution concludes over 15 years of the GBC's thorough research and in-depth discussions of:

The letter and spirit of Srila Prabhupada's numerous instructions on the subject of the importance and qualifications of various types of spiritual masters for ISKCON as a worldwide movement;

Srila Prabhupada's expressed desire that all his “sons and daughters” become spiritual masters;

Srila Prabhupada's well-documented personal dealings with and engagement of his female disciples in various roles of spiritual responsibility;

Srila Prabhupada's approach to the balance between spiritual and societal roles of Vaisnavas and Vaisnavis in the context of pure devotional service;

As appropriate, the broader historical and sastic evidence in regards to diksa in Lord Caitanya's Gaudiya-Vaisnava sampradaya

While Srila Prabhupada indicated that Vaisnavi spiritual masters had been historically “not so many”, he also taught that the service of diksa-guru required an equally advanced level of Krsna consciousness for both genders that is achievable by strictly following the authorized devotional practices he prescribed.

Srila Prabhupada also taught that the service of diksa-guru naturally stems from fidelity to one's spiritual master and guru-parampara, from one's mature preaching of Krsna consciousness (siksa) empowered by such fidelity, and from the sense of selfless responsibility for those souls who become inspired to serve Lord Krsna by such preaching.

At the same time, Srila Prabhupada severely criticized and warned against bodily and mundane considerations in regard to the role and eligibility of diksa-guru — whether in the form of casteism, selfish motives for profit, adoration or distinction, or as conformity to social, cultural or modern trends and artificial “equality”:

“...Generally a spiritual master who constantly instructs a disciple in spiritual science becomes his initiating spiritual master later on. (...) Sri Jiva Gosvami advises that one not accept a spiritual master in terms of hereditary or customary social and ecclesiastical conventions. One should simply try to find a genuinely qualified spiritual master for actual advancement in spiritual understanding”. (Caitanya-caritamṛta, Ādi-līla 1.35 purport)

We, the GBC, are convinced that Śrīla Prabhupada by his devotional potency and perfect guidance continues to empower many devotees, men and women alike, to properly follow and represent his teachings in the mission of spreading Kṛṣṇa Consciousness; and that some of them thus become competent to solidify their śikṣa by giving dikṣa as faithful representatives of Śrīla Prabhupada.

We recognize that some members and friends of ISKCON may object to this resolution based on their own reading of sastra, their own social experiences, or deeply held Vaisnava convictions. At the same time, and on the same basis, others will think this resolution does not go far enough or that the additional requirements are unfair. To assuage these concerns, we will further describe the milestones leading to this decision and the philosophical underpinnings of this resolution in an upcoming document.

In the meantime, we humbly request ISKCON devotees to see this resolution in the light of the inclusiveness of Lord Chaitanya and our previous acaryas, and as facilitating senior, mature and exemplary followers of Śrīla Prabhupada in their dedicated service to him and his ISKCON. Please bless them in this new important spiritual responsibility.

“So one who is spreading kṛṣṇa-upadeśa, simply repeat what is said by Kṛṣṇa, then you become acarya. (...) Suppose you have got now ten thousand. We shall expand to hundred thousand. That is required. Then hundred thousand to million, and million to ten million. So there will be no scarcity of acarya, and people will understand Kṛṣṇa consciousness very easily”. (Lecture on Sri Caitanya-caritamṛta, Ādi-līla 1.13 – April 6, 1975, Mayapur)

GBC Resolution 701.6 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

ADDED · 2020

701.06 · Plan for dialogue on GBC Resolution 701.6, “Vaisnava Dikṣa-gurus — 2019” (2020)

Statement

RESOLVED:

That a dialogue on this topic take place as per the request of the ISKCON India Bureau and a number of GBCs during the joint brainstorming session on February 4.

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The GBC shall make a final decision on any amendments to resolution 701.6, “ISKCON Spiritual Masters, Vaisnava Dikṣa-gurus--2019”, in Pune at the 2020 GBC Mid-term General Meeting.

GBC Resolution 701.06 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

701.06 • Vaisnavi diksa-gurus — 2019: Amendment (2021)

[Governing law]

Whereas the GBC put in abeyance the 2019 Vaishnavi Diksa Guru resolution so that the GBC and the Indian Bureau could discuss the topic in more detail,

Whereas representatives of the Bureau and representatives of the GBC met jointly more than two dozen times over the period of a year,

Whereas those meetings were facilitated by professional mediators, including a mediator chosen by the Bureau, and another mediator who is a senior member of ISKCONResolve,

Whereas the GBC representatives made a sincere effort to hear and understand the concerns and opinions of the Bureau representatives,

Whereas the GBC representatives noted that they valued the time spent with the Bureau members, and that they now better understand the views of the Bureau representatives after those meetings,

Whereas the GBC delegation concluded that further meetings, or additional study of the matter, would not provide new insights,

Whereas the GBC delegation reported that, based on these discussions, some clarifications of the 2019 Resolution on Vaishnavi Diksa Gurus are required, 701.6, "ISKCON Spiritual Masters, Vaisnavi Diksa-gurus—2019.

Whereas the GBC, in its November 17, 2021, meeting, determined that on rare occasions a GBC Resolution may be certified as a Culturally Sensitive Resolution, and thus, within specific GBC guidelines, that Resolution may be applied differently across ISKCON regions,

Whereas in 2009 the GBC Resolved (Female Diksa Gurus):

The GBC accepts the philosophical conclusion presented in the SAC's Female Diksa Guru Paper that a mature, qualified, female devotee may accept the role of an initiating spiritual master.

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The GBC Body authorizes local area committees to put forward for approval as initiating guru any devotee in their area, male or female, who is qualified according to existing GBC Law.

Whereas, the GBC has worked to achieve consensus and implementation of this resolution for many years, including the above mentioned extensive dialogues with representatives of the India Bureau;

Therefore, the Resolution regarding Vaisnavi Diksa Gurus of 2019, 701.6, "ISKCON Spiritual Masters, Vaisnavi Diksa-gurus—2019 is amended and replaced by the following:

1. Vaisnavis are eligible to give diksa within ISKCON provided that they:
 - a. Meet all the qualifications listed for ISKCON diksa-guru applicants;
 - b. Are at least 55 years of age.
 - c. Are in a stable family situation living under the protection of a husband, elder son or son-in-law, qualified householder couple or senior Vaisnava or Vaisnavi sanga;
2. After five years the GBC shall review this resolution to determine if the number of Vaisnavis initiating in any region, or as a total for the world, is in keeping with Srila Prabhupada's indication of "not so many."

Prof. O'Connell: Is it possible, Swamiji, for a woman to be a guru in the line of disciplic succession?
Prabhupada: Yes. Jahnavi devi was---Nityananda's wife. She became. If she is able to go to the highest perfection of life, why it is not possible to become guru? But, not so many. Actually one who has attained the perfection, she can become guru. But man or woman, unless one has attained the perfection... Yei kṛṣṇa-tattva-vettā sei guru haya [Cc. Madhya 8.128].

3. Furthermore, this resolution is designated as a “Culturally Sensitive Resolution.” Per GBC law:

A Regional Governing Body (RGB), or where there is no RGB, an authorized national council with the support of their GBC, or where a national council has more than one GBC, a majority of their GBCs, may apply to the GBC Body with a request to modify a culturally sensitive resolution for their area/yatra. Such a request must include the details of the specific adjustment/s they propose to make, as well as the reasons for requesting such an adjustment/s.

The GBC Body will give guidelines and set out the parameters regarding what may or may not be adjusted within a culturally sensitive resolution.... Any details, guidelines, parameters, timelines, etc., in regard to its exceptional status must be recorded within the resolution itself.

Thus, by designating this as a Culturally Sensitive Resolution, the GBC hereby establishes that an RGB or other authorized ISKCON leadership body as denoted in the above referenced law—may opt out of this mandate and choose to not allow any Vaisnavis to initiate within their jurisdiction. Any given RGB that does

not opt out and proceeds to fully implement this resolution, may, at their discretion, allow any given country

within their region to opt out of applying this resolution. Naturally that would only be done after very careful

consideration, as the default position is to always fully implement GBC resolutions.

In those regions or countries that choose to opt out, if a particular candidate for diksa guru is approved by a

special 2/3 vote of that RGB, or other authorized body, per above, then she shall be accepted as a diksa guru in that region or country.

A decision to opt out must be reaffirmed by that RGB, or authorized body per above, every five years. No other adjustments to this resolution are authorized or will be permitted.

This resolution lifts the abeyance on this matter stated in resolution 310 of 2015.

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GBC Resolution 701.06 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on December 22, 2021)

702.02 · Increasing the Number of Diksa-gurus (2021)

[Statement]

Whereas connection via diksa to the parampara is essential for anyone aspiring to advance in Krishna consciousness.

Whereas ISKCON needs a sufficient number of initiated devotees to perform many essential services, which can only be performed by properly initiated devotees

Whereas ISKCON still has a similar number of diksa-gurus as at the end of the 1980s (+/- 80), while the number of aspiring devotees in ISKCON has increased at least fiftyfold or more since then; thus an acute lack of diksa-gurus has become an ever growing problem to facilitate the increased number of persons now engaged in devotional service

Whereas the present generation of diksa-gurus will be drastically reduced within the next decade or so. Thus a new generation of diksa-gurus urgently needs to be established in ISKCON

Whereas ISKCON's demography has changed from ashrama living to largely being a movement of congregational devotees centred around communities; there is an increasing need of a more natural and organic diksa-guru culture in line with Srila Prabhupada's statement in CC. Adi 1.35 purport: "Generally a spiritual master who constantly instructs a disciple in spiritual science becomes his initiating spiritual master."

Whereas we can observe – for different reasons - a clear change in the social culture of the world and therefore cannot take it for granted that smooth travel all over the world will be possible in the future; thus an increasing number of more locally accessible diksa-gurus, each having a moderate number of disciples will be more sustainable and will strengthen our preaching movement as a whole, as well as local preaching projects.

Whereas a considerable number of the local "spiritual masters who constantly instruct their disciples in spiritual science" are often not disciples of diksa-gurus who have left this world.

RESOLVED:

The GBC hereby states their commitment to increase the number of diksa-gurus in ISKCON by systematically and promptly increasing the number of diksa-gurus before we lose the present gurus. The GBC also accepts the principle that the number of diksa-gurus must reflect, as closely as possible, the actual size of ISKCON, and that the future system leans to having many local diksa-gurus with fewer disciples, rather than having a limited number of international gurus with many disciples. Furthermore, the GBC members will support and promote prominent siksa-gurus initiating while their diksa-gurus are present.

The GBC will support programs that facilitate more diksa-gurus while the present diksa-gurus are with us.

GBC Resolution 702.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on July 29, 2021)

702.03 · Reviewing the principles of a diksa-guru system (2022)

[Statement]

Whereas in 2017, the GBC adopted the position paper 702.03 Principles for creating a diksa-guru system for ISKCON — 2017. As this paper itself describes, it “explains the authority of ISKCON’s Governing Body

Commission (GBC) to create a system for devotees to take up the service of diksa-guru within the society, focusing on the principles behind the system.”

However, the paper did not articulate the GBC’s key concerns behind the no-objection process (which would enable assessments of its effectiveness), and a revised paper could make clear what additional managerial safeguards the process could offer that are not already provided for in ISKCON’s managerial organization, educational standards, and training programs for gurus and disciples

Whereas the paper did not justify guru approvals as the only means to regulate the diksa process, and a revised paper could affirm that Srila Prabhupada expects the GBC to govern and lead according to the direction of sastra — which only calls for mutual testing in a diksa process and does not mention a GBC managerial system of oversight of the diksa process; it could explain why the GBC does not vet and approve siksa-gurus, even though sastra equates them with diksa-gurus

Whereas a revision of this paper is important because it is essential that the GBC offers clearer, more complete principles for its diksa-guru system.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

That the GBC Body hereby approves in principle a revision of its position paper “702.03 Principles for creating a diksa-guru system for ISKCON — 2017.” The GBC Body shall oversee the formation of a group

to revise the paper in order to provide clarity on this important topic and to enhance the GBC’s credibility and strengthen its authority. The final revision will be approved by the GBC Body.

Terms of reference for revisions

1. Clarify the basis of support for the current process. Articulate the problems and concerns that the GBC thinks the guru-approval system addresses, to enable assessments of the system’s effectiveness.
2. Explain why the GBC system has two mandatory interventions in guru-disciple relationships, when there is no direction in sastra to accept such third-party approvals. The natural system of siksa-gurus becoming diksa-gurus, mentioned by Srila Prabhupada, is supported by ISKCON’s system of assessing, training, and managing, so why employ another level of bureaucracy to approve diksa-gurus?
3. The list of approved gurus can result in disciples minimizing their own testing, and the current process clearly distinguishes between siksa- and diksa-gurus, effectively diminishing the status of siksa-gurus, who are at least as important as diksa-gurus. Consider how the more natural system of siksa-gurus becoming diksa-gurus is supported by the current system of assessing and training and explain why ISKCON does not institutionally test or approve siksa-gurus, but finds it necessary to approve diksa-gurus.

GBC Resolution 702.03 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed via GEM on April 25, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

702.04 · Implementation of a moratorium on all further appointments of, and (2022)

[Action order]

initiations by, Vaisnavi diksa-gurus (VDG) in ISKCON — 2022

Whereas the GBC Body has, pursuant to Resolution no. 701.06/2019 and a subsequent amendment to said resolution on 22 December 2021, approved Vaisnavi diksa-gurus (VDG) in ISKCON

Whereas the Indian Bureau (IB) contends that the GBC Body has erred by instituting VDG in ISKCON

Whereas the IB is of the view that further consultation on the VDG matter is needed

Whereas the IB feels that a deeper theological deliberation on guru-tattva is required

Whereas the IB has asked the GBC Body to put on hold its resolution permitting VDG

Whereas the IB has called for a serious dialogue by constituting a joint GBC-IB committee to examine the VDG issue during a period lasting no longer than three (3) years

Whereas the GBC Body is amenable to further consultation and deliberation with the IB.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. An immediate moratorium be placed on further appointments of, and initiations by Vaisnavi diksa-gurus (VDG) in ISKCON.
2. A GBC committee be established to formulate a written understanding to be approved by the GBC Body within 4 weeks, with the ISKCON Bureau mandating, among other things, the requirement for proper decorum, the withdrawal of ultimatums, and a solemn pledge to abide by Srila Prabhupada's request for cooperation.
3. The dialogue be concluded within three years from the date of this resolution.

GBC Resolution 702.04 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on November 2, 2022)

ADDED · 2025

702.03 · Diksa-guru projects position paper — 2024 (2025)

[Position paper]

Resolved that:

The GBC approves the “Principles and Practices/Diksa-guru projects” position paper.

GBC Resolution 702.03 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed August 21, 2024

ADDED · 2025

702.03 · Defining Guru responsibilities (2025)

[Guideline]

Whereas the primary role of a guru should be to provide spiritual guidance based on scripture.

Whereas current legislation on the role of the guru in ISKCON states:

"A guru is one who transmits spiritual knowledge on the basis of revealed scriptures." 404/1999

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC hereby reconfirms that the primary role of a siksa- or diksa-guru in ISKCON is to provide spiritual

guidance. In matters outside their expertise and responsibility, they are advised to direct devotees to seek advice from suitably qualified experts.

GBC Resolution 702.03 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2025

702.09 · New diksa gurus (2025)

[Statements]

service of initiating spiritual master

Whereas GBC Resolution 702.02 of 2024 modified the process for devotees to initiate in the presence of their own diksa-gurus;

Whereas the GBC has determined that the below six devotees have met these requirements

Therefore it is resolved that:

Vasu Srestha dasa (JPS), Dayavan Swami (RS), Manibandha dasa (NRS), Madana-mohana dasa (MG), Revati Raman dasa (JPS), and Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS) may commence the service of diksa-guru in ISKCON

[To view the full list of ISKCON diksa-gurus click [here](#)]

GBC Resolution 702.09 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed [various]

702.05 · GBC-IB Committee conclusions about Vaisnavi dikṣā-gurus (2026)

[Statement]

Whereas the GBC-ISKCON Bureau joint committee was given the responsibility of suggesting to the GBC a

way forward to resolve the issue of whether Vaisnavis can take up the service of being diksa-gurus in ISKCON.

Whereas this committee has since then discussed and deliberated Vaisnavi diksa-gurus (VDG) and various connected issues to arrive at a way forward.

Whereas many highly qualified ISKCON Vaisnavis have done and are doing commendable service under Srila Prabhupada's guidance and protection in the mission of Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu.

Whereas the GBC-IB committee concluded that the role of a guru in ISKCON needs to be further examined

and clarified in relationship to Srila Prabhupada's position, the managerial system that Srila Prabhupada established, the guru's disciples, and other devotees in ISKCON.

Whereas to conclusively determine who is qualified to take a service of leadership in ISKCON it is necessary to first determine what that service is and what qualifications are required to perform that service.

Whereas not only scriptural study is required for different parties to come to an agreement on such an important issue, but also continued discussion between concerned open-minded leaders who have mutual respect for each other. It will be helpful if underlying issues which are obstacles for the successful conclusion of the issue be recognized and attempts to resolve them made.

Whereas from the GBC-IB committee's discussions and deliberations the committee can now present a way forward to resolve this issue. The committee's proposal was arrived at after an examination of Srila Prabhupada's instructions and example as well as after consultation with various ISKCON's committees, leaders, and scholars.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

1. There should be an ongoing discussion on guru-tattva based on Srila Prabhupada's teachings and examples amongst qualified devotees in ISKCON. Details can be discussed further.
2. There should be a system to give more recognition and spiritual authority to certain qualified siksa-gurus within ISKCON.
3. Qualified Vaisnavis or Vaisnavas can be recognized as these special siksa-gurus.
4. Until the issue of is satisfactorily resolved concerning Vaisnavi diksa-gurus, qualified Vaisnavis should only be recognized as siksa-gurus.
5. The present committee remains open to assist in further research and discussions on the topic according to the GBC's desire.

GBC Resolution 702.05 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 10, 2026

8 ISKCON Members

8.1 Principles

8.1.1 Faith in ISKCON's GBC Body

Faith in the GBC as the ultimate managing authority in ISKCON, shall be preserved, protected and enhanced by all ISKCON members.

8.1.2 Regarding Local Laws

ISKCON members are law abiding citizens. However, where demonic laws interfere with the execution of bona fide preaching duties then one can resist such orders. In such cases Srila Prabhupada recommended to do the needful taking into consideration the circumstances of the laws of the country, the customs of the local people, the reputation of our society and the example which will be set for the future devotees to follow.

8.1.3 Preaching Krishna Consciousness As It Is

It is the duty of the Society's preachers to present the Krsna consciousness philosophy as it is presented in Srila Prabhupada's books. (76)

8.1.4 Standing of Members

8.1.4.1 Standards for Devotees In Good Standing

A devotee in good standing may enjoy all the privileges which are normally offered to all the members of the Society, in accordance to their situation, as per ISKCON Law, the ISKCON constitution and the GBC resolutions.

8.1.4.2 Principles for Determining Who Is "In Good Standing"

1. An ISKCON devotee (temple resident/ congregational) who follows the rules and regulations appropriate to his situation, who is not acting inimically to ISKCON or its interests, who is not put under any disciplinary mandate, and;
2. Anyone serving in ISKCON who is a disciple of a bona fide *guru*, who is faithfully following his vows and obligations to his *guru*, and;
3. A person who is appropriately adhering to the rules and regulations in his *asrama* and
4. A spiritual authority who is not on probation or suspension-is in good standing.

This list is not exhaustive, the GBC or its delegated authorities may add standards for determining devotees in good standing as required.

8.2 Duties

8.2.1 Loyalty to ISKCON and Srila Prabhupada

8.2.1.1 Seeking Instruction Outside ISKCON Improperly

Since all the spiritual knowledge and instruction required is available in Srila Prabhupada's books and from ISKCON, no ISKCON member shall be allowed to seek spiritual instruction from any other person or institution outside of ISKCON without approval of the GBC Body. Any member of ISKCON who willfully disobeys the above order will thereby sever his connection with ISKCON.(82)

1. Although all respects should be shown to senior Vaisnavas of the Gaudiya-math or other non-ISKCON Vaisnavas, no one should independently approach these respected personalities with the intention of begging advice or opinions regarding management or any controversial matters pertaining to ISKCON. The GBC is the ultimate authority for resolving such matters, and its decisions should be accepted.(79)

8.2.1.2 Prohibition to Lead Anyone Away from ISKCON

As ISKCON is spiritually non-different from His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, no one has the right to lead anyone away from ISKCON.(82)

8.2.1.3 Initiation Regulation

Devotees who live and work within ISKCON must be initiated in ISKCON, except one previously initiated by a recognized *sampradaya* who later wants to join and serve in ISKCON under the approval and direction of the local GBC.(82)

8.2.1.4 Initiated ISKCON Members Taking Further Initiation Outside of iskcon

1. Any ISKCON Leader, *sannyasi*, or senior devotee who was initiated in ISKCON from a bona fide spiritual master who has taken further initiation outside of it, without appropriate permission, must renounce their non-ISKCON initiation, receive a clearance and be re-assigned a preaching field in order to work again within ISKCON. (82)

2. Such reformed devotees shall be reassigned a preaching field by the GBC Executive Committee, or a Divisional Council and in cases not involving a very senior devotee the local GBC Zonal Secretary, for a one year probation.(82)

3. Such reformed devotees will be reassigned a preaching field by the GBC officers committee for a one year probation.(82)

4. To avoid offenses to Srila Prabhupada and to avoid offenses to his godbrothers, the GBC reminds all ISKCON devotees of Srila Prabhupada's instruction that in general we should avoid the association of His godbrothers and members of other spiritual groups unless one has permission from a GBC member for some specific purpose. Intimate *siksa* association is prohibited from non-ISKCON spiritual masters.(87)

8.2.1.5 Resident Devotees Normally Initiated in ISKCON

Devotees who live and work within ISKCON must be initiated in ISKCON except if someone was previously initiated by a recognized *sampradaya* who afterwards wants to join and serve in ISKCON under the approval and direction of the local GBC.(82)

8.2.1.6 Reasonable Warnings of a Spiritual Authority's Deviation

That, when reasonable warning is given by the GBC Body that a particular authority is deviating, followers who continue to accept instructions from such deviants cannot claim to be exonerated from personal responsibility by virtue of obediently or blindly following that authority.(93)

8.2.1.7 Association with Non-ISKCON Vaisnavas and Sadhus

1. In obedience to the instruction of His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, the GBC directs that the members of ISKCON should respect all senior Gaudiya Vaisnavas outside ISKCON, but should not intimately associate with them, personally or through printed or recorded media, for guidance, teaching, instruction, or initiation as their presentation of Krsna consciousness often differs from that of Srila Prabhupada in emphasis, balance and other aspects of both teaching and practice.

2. This resolution is intended to apply categorically to all ISKCON members. ISKCON Leaders' first responsibility is to give considerate direction, guidance, and counseling to any ISKCON devotees personally affected by this resolution so as to bring them back to the path set by Srila Prabhupada.

In any case, those who continue to act in violation of this resolution are subject to sanctions by Temple Presidents and GBC Zonal Secretaries, who may exercise their discretion to prohibit any such devotees from living on ISKCON properties or participating in ISKCON functions.

Those who persist in violating this resolution are cautioned they may be reported to the GBC Executive Committee for immediate action or action at the following year's annual GBC meeting. The Executive Committee is hereby given authority to undertake any action up to and including suspension from ISKCON of any violator at any time between the GBC annual general meetings at Mayapur.

3. ISKCON devotees should carefully avoid hearing or speaking personal criticism of the Godbrothers of Srila Prabhupada.(87)

8.2.1.8 Avoiding Rasika Literature

The members of ISKCON should regularly study *Bhagavad-gita As It Is*, *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, *Caitanya-carit-amrta*, and the other books given by His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada. The recent proliferation in ISKCON of literature focusing on "*rasika-bhakti*," intimate Radha-Krsna *lila*, and other subject matters suitable only for highly advanced souls, represents a departure from Srila Prabhupada's orders and obstructs the smooth spiritual progress of ISKCON devotees. ISKCON members should therefore avoid collecting, reading, discussing, or distributing such literature.(95)

8.2.2 Support and Adjust to GBC Decisions

The authorized forum for GBC policy is the annual GBC meeting, annual ISKCON Leaders meeting, annual *sannyasis* assembly, and similar official meetings held after the Gaura-purnima festival at Sri Mayapur. Outside of these meetings it is the duty of all ISKCON members and leaders to support and adjust to GBC decisions. Srila Prabhupada's principle was to meet once a year, make decisions, and follow them during the year. Activities contrary to this, shall be considered as a serious breach of etiquette and discipline.(86)

When there are significant difficulties with a GBC member one should state his problem in writing and forward to the GBC Executive Committee for necessary consideration.(82)

8.3 Categories of ISKCON Members

8.3.1 Temple-dependent Resident Members

8.3.1.1 Definition

A Temple-dependent Resident Member is defined as a devotee who is dependent upon ISKCON for residential facilities, food, clothing, and basic health care.

Temple-dependent Resident Members have voluntarily taken a more renounced, less materialistic, plainer form of life for the purpose of dedicating maximum energy toward spiritual advancement and devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa.

Such devotees are free to leave the *asrama* at any time and continue their residence on their own free will for the purpose of engaging in Kṛṣṇa consciousness.

8.3.1.2 Duties

Temple-dependent Resident Members shall have the following obligations and responsibilities

1. To maintain the Kṛṣṇa conscious standards of behavior, including following the four regulative principles and chanting a minimum of sixteen rounds of *japa* per day.
2. To attend the spiritual programs in the temple regularly.
3. To adhere to ISKCON Law and the regulations of the temple or *asrama*.
4. To be honest and straightforward in all dealings.
5. To be loyal to ISKCON and report any deviations from ISKCON standards to higher authorities.
6. To make no claim of ownership over ISKCON property which has been allocated for use in one's service, and to return such property when requested or when one has decided to leave the *asrama* or community of residence.
7. To agree to be transferred from one temple to another as may be needed from time to time. Such circumstances require mutual consideration. (Special consideration and sensitivity should be given when asking families with children to transfer to another temple.)
8. To take any regular health test according to local temple policy.
9. To settle disputes through the ISKCON Judicial System or through ISKCON approved arbitration, and not to take recourse in a court of law against ISKCON except where expressly allowed under ISKCON Law.

8.3.1.3 Regulations

8.3.1.3.1 Standards of Service

1. *Sannyasis*, *brahmacaris*, *vanaprasthas*, and brahminical *grhasthas* (living in facilities provided by ISKCON) are to be fully engaged in devotional service with all their time and energy.(92)
2. There are *grhasthas* who dedicate the major part of their time and energies to render devotional service in ISKCON. They need, however, to earn a minimum amount of income for family obligations that are not borne by ISKCON. They are exempted from the fifty percent(50%) donation rule. (92)

Temple-dependent Resident Members shall engage in devotional service as instructed by the local authority with a minimum of 48 hours of practical service a week.

8.3.1.3.2 Change of Temples for Temple Resident Devotees

8.3.1.3.2.1 Both Temple Presidents Should Agree

If a devotee wants to change temples, his present Temple President should agree as well as the new Temple President. The GBC member may be consulted if there is disagreement.

8.3.1.3.2.2 *Permission is Necessary To Serve in India*

Any temple devotee seriously desiring to go and serve ISKCON in India must obtain the permission of his GBC Zonal Secretary and Temple President. The GBC Zonal Secretary should not discourage serious devotees in their zone from serving ISKCON in India if they are having a serious and appropriate service to do in India. However, they shall still require the permission of GBC Zonal Secretary and Temple President.(77)

8.3.1.3.2.3 *Devotees should not be encouraged to Abandon Prescribed Temple Duties*

Even if there is any alleged deficiency in a temple program, that is not sufficient grounds in itself for a *sannyasi*, party leader or anyone else to encourage a devotee to abandon his prescribed duty in the temple. If the Temple President and GBC representative do not correct a deficiency in a period of time agreed upon by the Temple President, the GBC representative and the devotee making a complaint, the GBC, Divisional Council or appropriate authority may transfer the devotee to other duties.(77)

8.3.1.3.3 *Child Protection Concerns*

Persons who after an ISKCON investigation are confirmed to be guilty of child abuse must report their status to the local Temple President upon their arrival in an ISKCON community. Also, it is the obligation of a Temple President to determine, for every member joining his community, if the newcomer is a confirmed child abuser. The Temple President is then obliged to notify the local householders and GBC of the offender's presence.(94)

8.3.1.3.4 *Written Agreement Between the Temple and the Resident*

A simple written agreement should exist between the temple and dependent resident members stating conditions under which the residential dependent members will be maintained by the temple.

8.3.1.4 *Facilities*

The facilities ISKCON temples should provide for Temple-dependent Resident Devotees will vary according to local conditions. Generally, though, the minimum should include:

8.3.1.4.1 *For All Members*

1. Modest but adequate dormitory facility.
2. Adequate *Krsna-prasadam*.
3. Suitable clothing for protection of body.
4. Basic medical care or health insurance as affordable by the temple. (Strong encouragement is given that temple managers see this as a basic requirement and not a luxury.)
5. To not have their privilege of residence revoked without adequate cause.
6. Reasonable allowance for study time.
7. Sufficient time for health programs if required.
8. Regular program for attending India pilgrimage.
9. Reasonable time for cultivation of family members.

8.3.1.4.2 *For Married Families, Additionally*

1. Adequate residence for family and children.
2. Education for children
3. Life insurance for parents to maintain dependents in case of unexpected death, as affordable by temple.
4. Reasonable arrangements for family needs to be met with dignity.

8.3.1.5 Financial Standards

1. That, since preaching Kṛṣṇa consciousness is the principle business of ISKCON, the GBC recommends that, as far as possible, devotees living in the *asramas* of ISKCON temples should collect money through preaching activities such as book distribution, membership, cultivation of the congregation, restaurants, temple stores, etc. Since Srila Prabhupada stated that "business means to help the preaching", it may also be necessary for ISKCON Leaders to organize businesses which utilize devotee resources in generating income for the support of the temple. However, ISKCON Leaders involved in such activities should insure that the main focus of the temple remains on preaching and not on business.

Business activities other than as described above are permissible, provided they are not in contradiction to the regulative principles. As far as possible, ISKCON Leaders should encourage devotees for preaching work, while also engaging devotees according to their nature and *asrama*, and the temple needs.

Recognizing that there are varied economic and social conditions in different parts of the world, as well as the fact that sometimes special collection drives have to be organized for particular projects, the GBC accepts that the sale of paraphernalia may be necessary as a means of generating income. These programs of paraphernalia sales, however, fall within the realm of "business", or "collection" activities and should therefore not be termed as "*sankirtana*".

2. That transactions between ISKCON entities and devotees involving the transfer of funds over US \$1,000 or equivalent, should be substantiated by written contracts, purchase orders, invoices and/or other appropriate documentation. This principle should also be followed in dealings between devotees and non-devotees.(92)

8.3.2 Non-dependent Temple Resident Members

Those *grhasthas* who choose to engage in full-time occupation outside of ISKCON must follow the fifty percent(50%) donation rule, and all of their non-occupational time should also be engaged in devotional service, sacrificing a major portion given in voluntary service to ISKCON.(92)

8.4 Disciplinary Remedial Measures

Reasons for Discipline

Persons participating in ISKCON's activities, regardless of ashram, occupation, initiation status or previous history, may have their participation restricted when their continued association is likely to disturb the peaceful conduct of the affairs of ISKCON. Activities creating such a disturbance are to be defined and determined at the ecclesiastical discretion of the GBC, and may include, but are not limited to:

Misconduct and Failure to Follow Authority

Wilful violation of GBC resolutions.

Vilification of ISKCON, the GBC Body, or other ISKCON authorities.

Misconduct (breaking of service agreements, physical assault except in self-defense, improper relationships with the opposite sex, improper sexual behavior, abusive behavior and quarrelling with devotees, improper dealings with the external society, and so on.)

Habitually or knowingly making false charges and accusations or other vaisnava-aparadhas.

Serious interference in the guru and disciple relationship.

Duplicious or untruthful dealings (giving false promises to devotees, lying to spiritual authorities, and other serious prevarications).

Acts that endanger ISKCON assets and the preaching mission.

Depending on the severity of any improper activity, corrective steps may consist of informal discussions, written warnings or censures, disciplinary measures such as placing the offending participant on probation or suspension, or permanent prohibitions against future participation, or any other measures deemed appropriate to the situation by the GBC.

Disciplining Authority

The GBC Body, the GBC Executive Committee, any Regional Governing Body, Divisional Council, National Council, Zonal Secretary, or local affiliate authority which includes the local temple executive or board or other authorized persons may decide to restrict anyone from participating in ISKCON activities under their jurisdiction.

8.4.1 Censure

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

Censure is a reprimand aimed at reformation of a person participating in ISKCON's activities and prevention of further offending acts. It is a preliminary step that may lead to probation or suspension. Censure may serve as a condition precedent to other forms of religious discipline.

When ordering the censure, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person the specific actions that were irresponsible, inappropriate, or in violation of ISKCON Law and why they were judged so.

8.4.2 Probation

Heading text located by title match; the book's own Detailed Contents numbers this section but the body text carries no visible number here.

Probation applies when the disciplining authority has determined there have been serious or repetitive breaches. It is an opportunity for a person facing disciplinary action to rectify his or her situation and regain their status as a participant in good standing. When ordering the probation, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person:

the specific breaches and why they were judged so.

the specific program of rectification.

the specific prerequisites for restoration, if any.

the time period of the probation, which shall be no longer than one year.

At the end of the period of probation, the disciplining authority must decide one of the following:

The participant is rectified and is no longer on probation.

A determination of further probation under the same or modified conditions is required to complete the rectification process.

The person cannot be rectified within a reasonable period of time and must be suspended from participating in or permanently disassociated from the society's activities under the jurisdiction of the disciplining authority, as per the terms given below.

Suspension Pending Investigation

When there is substantial reason to believe that a person participating in ISKCON's activities has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON Law and the person's continued participation will be injurious to the properties, good name, physical assets, or other resources of the society, or if there are serious allegations of impropriety requiring investigation, then a participant shall be suspended pending investigation.

Suspension pending investigation is to separate a person from ISKCON activities so that a thorough investigation of allegations may be conducted and the suitability of the person to participate is determined. The disciplining body must conduct an immediate investigation so as to minimize disruption. After completion of the investigation, the body shall make a determination as to the truth of the allegations and the future course of action as per one of the following:

The suspension shall be revoked with no further restriction on participation.

There shall be a probationary period with a program of rectification as described under probation above.

He or she shall be suspended from participating in or permanently banished from the society's activities under the jurisdiction of the disciplining authority as per the terms given below.

Suspension

When there has been a determination that a person has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON Law such that the person's continued participation in the activities of ISKCON is likely to damage the good name, reputation, or other resources of the society, or significantly violates the teachings and precepts of Srila Prabhupada and Krishna consciousness, as determined by the GBC, but there is the possibility that the person may eventually be rectified, then the person may be suspended from participating in all activities of the society under the jurisdiction of the disciplining authority.

When ordering the suspension, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person:

the specific breaches and the grounds or bases thereof

the specific prerequisites for restoration

Suspension of the right to participate is not limited by time, but shall remain in effect until specifically withdrawn by the disciplining or any higher authority.

Excommunication

When there has been a determination that a person has acted irresponsibly, inappropriately, or in violation of ISKCON Law such that the person's continued participation in the activities of ISKCON is likely to damage the good name, reputation, or other resources of the society, or significantly violates the teachings of Srila Prabhupada and Krishna consciousness, as determined by the GBC, and there is little possibility that the person may eventually be rectified, then the person may be permanently prohibited from participating in the activities of the society under the jurisdiction of the disciplining authority. When ordering the excommunication, the disciplining authority must clearly set forth in writing to the disciplined person the specific breaches and the grounds or reasons thereof.

If the GBC Body determines that a person shall be excommunicated from the activities of the entire society then the GBC Secretary shall issue a "Notice of Non-participation" barring the former participant from participation in all ISKCON activities.

Appeals

If an ISKCON participant has his/her participation restricted by the action of a local affiliate's executive or board then he/she may appeal to the local Divisional or National Council, or, if one does not exist, to the local Zonal Secretary.

If an ISKCON participant has his/her participation restricted by the action of a Zonal Secretary or Divisional or National Council, he/she shall have the right of appeal to the Regional Governing Body (if one exists in the area) or the GBC Body (if there is no Regional Governing Body in the area).

If he or she has his/her participation restricted by the action of a Regional Governing Body, he/she shall have the right of appeal to the GBC Body.

If he or she has his/her participation restricted by the action of the GBC Executive Committee, he/she shall

have the right of appeal to the GBC Body.

Any disciplinary action taken against an ISKCON participant by any of the above-mentioned entities shall stand unless and until it is overruled by a higher body.

8.4.5 Expulsion (Excommunication)

1. Some members of the Society who have previously been in good standing have subsequently deviated from the ISKCON standard and whereas such members by their bad conduct and character may damage the good name of the Society. In such cases, the GBC Body may, by a two third(2/3) vote of the members present expel any member of the ISKCON provided that:

- a. The member is openly deviating from the fundamental tenants of the Society's teaching.
- b. The member is openly and flagrantly antagonistic to the GBC or other ISKCON authority.
- c. The member is engaged in illegal activities.

8.4.7.1 Conditions of Reinstatement

Devotees who have left ISKCON are welcome back into ISKCON at any time, provided they agree that:

1. The GBC is the ultimate managerial authority for ISKCON
2. They accept His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, Founder-Acarya of ISKCON, as the preeminent siksa guru for ISKCON.

However, if there are any special circumstances surrounding that devotee's departure then a procedure of reinstatement may be required.

8.4.7.2 Procedure of Reinstatement

The procedure for formal reinstatement shall be that:

1. the devotee desiring to return shall send a signed letter to GBC Corresponding Secretary stating his agreement to the above-listed provisions (8.4.7.1).
2. The GBC Corresponding Secretary shall send the letter to all GBC members. If no objections are received by the Corresponding Secretary within 90 days of the date of distribution to all members, then the Corresponding Secretary shall send a notice of reinstatement to the devotee in question along with all GBC members.

Notwithstanding the above, in the following cases reinstatement may only be granted by simple majority vote of the full GBC Body:

1. Devotees who were ISKCON initiating gurus at the time of their original departure from ISKCON, or devotees who accepted disciples since leaving ISKCON;
2. Devotees who have been found guilty of any serious offence.
3. Devotees who are currently in the sannyasa asrama.
4. Devotees who were removed from ISKCON by GBC Resolution
5. Devotees for whom a written objection from a GBC member has been submitted to the Corresponding Secretary within 90 days of notification, as per above.

8.4.9 Grievances Regarding Management

If a *sannyasi* or party leader has a grievance regarding the management of a temple, particularly in regard to the *brahmacari* program, his complaint should be properly aired to the Temple President and the local GBC representative. The matter should not be brought before the devotees in general.

When a person becomes a member of ISKCON or assumes an office within ISKCON, he does so on the condition of submission to the ecclesiastical jurisdiction of ISKCON, and however much he may be dissatisfied with the exercise of that jurisdiction, he shall refrain from invoking the supervisory power of the civil court, but shall seek redress of any grievance(s) through the ISKCON judicial process. Otherwise, he may be removed from office and/or his membership in ISKCON terminated.(88)

8.5 General Guidelines

8.5.1 Prohibition of Chocolate

As it contains various stimulants like caffeine (contained in coffee), theine (contained in black tea) and theobromine (contained in cocoa), chocolate should not be eaten by ISKCON devotees.(93)

8.5.2 AIDS Test

1. The GBC Body requires that all devotees living and/or serving in our temples should take an AIDS test, local laws permitting. All new devotees, as they join, should also take an AIDS test.
2. The GBC Health and Welfare Committee advises that temples should not allow persons who are HIV positive to engage in services within our temples which involve the preparation or serving of bhoga or *prasadam*.

8.5.3 Holding ISKCON Assets In One's Private Name

Anyone holding ISKCON assets in his private name, in the name of another, or in the name of a corporate entity and controlled by himself or another, shall provide an annual detailed confidential declaration of such assets and the reasons for the holding arrangements to his GBC representative. When the GBC representative holds such assets, he shall disclose the same information to the GBC Body in the manner provided by it.(88)

9 Asramas (Spiritual Orders) in ISKCON

9.1 Sannyasa-Asrama

9.1.1 Principles

ISKCON *sannyasis* are individually and collectively responsible for maintaining the purity and high spiritual standard of ISKCON by their personal example and in their preaching according to the instructions of Srila Prabhupada.

9.1.2 Regulations

9.1.2.1 Application for Sannyasa Initiation

1. Any GBC member can nominate a man from his zone for *sannyasa* each year at the GBC annual meeting. The man must be a preacher and not sexually inclined. He must be an initiated *brahmana*. A GBC should avoid recommending a *sannyasi* whimsically.(75)
2. Any GBC member can place a devotee on a two-year trial period for *sannyasa*. After one year, the GBC Body will discuss the qualifications of the candidate and pending their approval, the candidate will enter into the final one-year trial period. At the end of the final year, the GBC will vote for the appointment of the *sannyasi*.
3. *Sannyasa* candidates must meet personally with the *Sannyasa* Committee in Mayapur before receiving final approval for taking *sannyasa*, unless exempted by the *Sannyasa* Minister.(95)
4. Candidates for *Sannyasa* must submit their applications in accordance with the Society's Rules of Order and include a statement by a GBC member listing the candidate's qualifications to take *sannyasa* and a letter written by the candidate explaining his reasons for wanting to accept *sannyasa*.
5. When the GBC Body approves a candidate for *sannyasa*, they reserve the right to assign the candidate a mission of their choice which may take him far from his previous area of service. Before making such an assignment, the GBC Body shall discuss the suitability of the candidate for the assigned mission with the local GBC, the *Sannyasa* Committee, the candidate's *sannyasa-guru* and the candidate.(97-102)
6. A devotee must pass the *Bhakti-sastri* test before being placed on the *sannyasa* waiting list. Those who are currently on the list must pass the *Bhakti-sastri* test before taking *sannyasa*. Exceptions to this require a two thirds(2/3) vote of the GBC Body.(97-301)

9.1.2.2 Sannyasa Recommendations

1. If a GBC member or initiating *guru* who has recommended someone for *sannyasa* withdraws his recommendation, the candidacy is canceled.
2. The GBC Body can waive the preliminary one year of the two years suggested in the previous proposal by its own decision at the time of discussion of the candidates. (At this time the *sannyasa-guru* of the candidates should be specified).
3. All *sannyasa* candidates are to be examined on the basis of the following qualifications before their names are accepted on the list of candidates for *sannyasa*:
 - a. How free is he from sex desire?
 - i. How long has he been a *brahmacari*?
 - ii. How long has he been living away from his wife?

- b. What is his preaching record? Is it demonstrated by his ability to preach strongly? Is he a preaching leader? Has he been doing this for a good amount of time?
 - c. Is he strict in his personal conduct? Is he beyond suspicion?
 - d. Is he philosophically strong? Is this demonstrated through his lectures?
 - e. Is he willing to accept fully the authority of the GBC and work under the auspices of the GBC?
 - f. Does he have the proper quality of leadership to train and lead *brahmacaris* who are under his direction?
 - g. Is he self-reliant?. Does he have the ability to keep himself continuously engaged in some way which contributes positively to our preaching work?
 - h. Is the field of his preaching after taking *sannyasa* clear and acceptable to the GBC or other authorities?
4. Applications for *sannyasa* candidacy should include written endorsements from the local GBC(s) and the local managerial body or bodies where the candidate serves. In addition, it should include a resume detailing the candidate's devotional career.(96)

The sponsor of a proposal for a candidate for *sannyasa* should each year give a report of the candidate's qualifications according to the GBC Rules of Order, "The Qualification for *Sannyasa*." To be put on the list, an initial report is required. Thereafter an annual report is also necessary.(93)

Complaints about Sannyasis (1999)

The GBC Sannyasa Sub-committee shall deal with any complaints against sannyasis. An investigation will be initiated if a majority of members judges a complaint to merit investigation. Decisions will be made by majority vote. The GBC Executive Committee shall present the decision to the GBC Body either by correspondence or at the next Annual General Meeting. A decision of the Sannyasa Sub-committee will be overturned by a majority vote of the GBC Body, otherwise the sub-committee's decision remains in effect. A sannyasi who does not abide by the decision shall be subjected to penalties according to ISKCON Law; If there are complaints against sannyasis who are also GBC members or gurus, the GBC Executive Committee may decide to deal with them itself; however, in that case, the Sannyasa Minister should also participate in the decision making process.

Amendment (2018)

ISKCON sannyasis shall be subject to the same basic disciplinary rules as other ISKCON members regarding the conduct of their services within ISKCON. A sannyasi's behavior that is subject to disciplinary action is specified in the approved ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services' Policy Manual. However, if any complaint concerning a sannyasi is received by any ISKCON authority then the ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services shall be promptly informed of the complaint as well as of any and all subsequent actions taken either by the ISKCON authority receiving the complaint or any other ISKCON authority that becomes involved in the matter.

Upon being informed in this regard, the ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services shall consider whether the matter is in any way relevant to its mandate to uphold the prestige of the sannyasa asrama. If so, then it may choose to advise the ISKCON authority(ies) that are dealing with the matter locally and/or undertake its own proceedings.

However, if a complaint is received directly by the ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services and it contains primarily general concerns about the behavior and activities of a particular sannyasi then it can be dealt with directly by the ISKCON Ministry of Sannyasa Services according to the following procedures:

An investigation will be initiated if a majority of the Sannyasa Standing Committee members determines a complaint to merit investigation. Disciplinary decisions will also be made by a majority vote. The GBC Executive Committee shall present the decision to the GBC Body either by correspondence or at the next Annual General Meeting. A decision of the Sannyasa Standing Committee may be overturned by a majority vote of the GBC Body; otherwise the Standing Committee's decision remains in effect. A sannyasi who does not abide by the decision shall be subjected to penalties according to ISKCON Law. The appeals process is explained in the Policy Manual.

9.1.2.3 Reinstatement Procedures for a Devotee Who Has Fallen From His Sannyasa Vows

Update 2009:

If an ISKCON sannyasi is unable to maintain his lifelong commitment to renunciation he should communicate, in writing, his decision to leave the sannyasa-asrama to the Sannyasa Minister or to the GBC Executive Committee.

Anyone who has abandoned the vows of the sannyasa-asrama, whether as per the procedure described above or otherwise, is required to also immediately relinquish the sannyasa dress and sannyasa name and title and resume the name accepted at first initiation. He should not again accept sannyasa dress or refer to himself by his sannyasa name and title without following the proper procedures for approval of sannyasa.

9.1.3 Duties

1. Each ISKCON *sannyasi* should allocate some time for traveling and preaching in various ISKCON temples in addition to his existing administrative and other responsibilities.

ISKCON *sannyasis* shall always endeavor to increase their active assistance to the GBC in maintaining the spiritual standard of ISKCON, expanding the dynamic preaching of ISKCON, and preserving Srila Prabhupada's mood and instructions.

Sannyasi Annual Commitment (1999)

That all sannyasis shall annually submit in writing, to the GBC Body, a "service program" report they are committing themselves to, for the following year. This report shall include the following:

- a) What devotional services they intend to do.
- b) Where they intend to perform their services.
- c) When they intend to be in different places, if not always in the same zone, and
- d) Anything else they would like the GBC Body to know.

9.1.4 Guidelines

9.1.4.1 Sannyasa Reinitiation

- 1. Those who have taken *sannyasa* from a *sannyasi* in ISKCON who was in good standing but later fell from *sannyasa* are recommended to take *sannyasa* re-initiation by an authorized ISKCON *sannyasi*.
- 2. Anyone who took *sannyasa* outside of ISKCON and whose *sannyasa-guru* has fallen, but wants to serve as an ISKCON *sannyasi* must take *sannyasa* re-initiation from an ISKCON *sannyasi*.

From 2013:

All ISKCON sannyasis are strongly advised to attend the Spiritual Leadership Seminar, "Being a Guru in ISKCON", given under the auspices of the GBC Guru Services Committee

All sannyasa candidates must attend the Spiritual Leadership Seminar, "Being a Guru in ISKCON", provided it is available in a language appropriate for them.

9.2 Vanaprastha-Asrama

9.2.1 Eligibility

Vanaprastha is generally recommended for 50 years of age and has to be taken with the permission of the local GBC after the recommendation of the local Temple President. *vanaprastha* cloths are received from the Spiritual Master whose blessing is also required. There should be no whimsical taking of *vanaprastha*.(76)

9.3 Grhastha-Asrama (Householder)

9.3.1 Giving Fifty Percent (50%) of One's Income to ISKCON

9.3.1.1 Definition

1. The following is established as the official definition of "giving fifty percent (50%) of one's income to ISKCON", according to the scriptural reference cited. For the present, this definition shall only be applied in the statement of the qualification of a [*grhastha*] GBC member given in the following resolution:
2. "A *grhastha* should calculate his donation of fifty percent (50%) of income to ISKCON as follows: calculate gross personal income, deduct the required income tax remittance, then deduct fifty percent (50%) of the remaining net personal income and donate it to ISKCON. Supporting evidences: *Bg.*16.1-3, *SB.*1.5.36; 1.17.24; 1.17.38; 3.21.31; 5.19.7; 8.19.37.
3. *Grhasthas* should not be discouraged to work at jobs or develop their own business with their own means. (77)

9.3.2 Polygamy

No polygamy is allowed in ISKCON

9.3.3 Grhastha Coordinator

9.3.3.1 Duties

To function under the auspices of the Ministry of Health and Welfare.

1. To report to the Health and Welfare Committee Chairman, who will report on the Coordinator's progress to the GBC Body.
2. To assemble materials for a *grhastha-asrama* handbook.
3. To gather information on how marriage matches occur in different parts of the world.
4. To work out guidelines in consultation with senior *grhasthas* in good standing about child raising, economic security, etc. (theoretical and practical).
5. To correspond with *grhasthas* and managers worldwide about householder questions.
6. To tabulate the successes and failures of grassroots efforts to deal with *grhastha* problems now underway in different regions of the ISKCON world and make the information available to all ISKCON devotees.
7. To insure adequate information is available on *grhastha* life.
8. To establish a system to counsel *grhastha* couples according to Srila Prabhupada's instructions.
9. To establish and support continental representatives.

10. To work out guidelines, in consultation with senior *grhasthas* in good standing about child raising, economic security, etc.
11. To organize seminars, presentations and/or conferences on *grhastha* life.(96)

9.4 Brahmacari-Asrama

Brahmacari life in a temple is a bona-fide process for cultivating the highest grade of Krsna consciousness and that it is not intrinsically inferior to *brahmacari* life in a traveling context.

9.5 Asrama Considerations For Vaisnavis

1. The devotional service of the women is considered equal by Lord Krsna and the spiritual master.
2. ISKCON does not support an independent all-women's *asrama*, because in every case a woman should be protected by a man.(76)
5. It is against Vedic and Vaisnava principles for women to take *sannyasa*, and whereas it is not authorized by Srila Prabhupada, it is resolved that those women rejoining ISKCON after taking *sannyasa* are free to rejoin their families. If any woman devotee is internally committed to celibacy they are welcome to follow that decision in ISKCON in white cloth and to render devotional service up to their full capacity and dedicate themselves to the *sankirtana* movement of Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu. They are to be encouraged and respected as preachers. (94)

10 ISKCON Temples and Affiliates

10.1 Standards for ISKCON Temples

1. At least one day a week there must be public chanting and food distribution in public performed by each temple, wherever possible.(77)
2. Each temple should observe one major festival a year.
3. All ISKCON centers should have extra classes for new devotees in addition to the regular morning and evening classes.(84)
4. All ISKCON centers shall always offer hospitality of at least prasadam to any Life Patron Members who visit. Life Patron Members should be offered to stay overnight regardless of how meager the facilities are and of it is not possible to afford accommodations then it is the responsibility of the temple to give assistance in finding accommodations.(82)

10.2 Regulations for ISKCON Temples

10.2.1 Unrelated Businesses

When an ISKCON entity is registered as a religious, charitable, or non-profit organization under the laws of its particular state or country, if those laws prohibit such an entity from engaging in activities of a commercial nature, then, of course, the ISKCON entity must comply. Such businesses, though, cannot be contained as part of the ISKCON entity's activities when the ISKCON entity is constituted as a non-profit corporation. The managers of such businesses may decide to donate funds from their business activities to ISKCON. Such donations cannot encumber ISKCON with any obligations toward the donor or the business.

10.2.2 Priority in Preaching

It may be seen that certain activities like *prasadam* distribution, restaurants, temple stores, book distribution, Life Patron Membership, or soliciting of donations with devotional paraphernalia, are carried out by ISKCON non-profit organizations as part of their missionary activities. As long as these activities are not of a primarily commercial nature, are not for the benefit of individuals, are not in violation of local law, and do not endanger the ISKCON entity with unnecessary liability, they may be conducted by the ISKCON entity directly. If the activities develop such that the primary focus is profit rather than preaching, such that local laws would be violated by the non-profit ISKCON entity, or such that unnecessary liability is risked, then they must be legally separated.(93)

10.2.3 Financial Contract Parameters

Transactions between ISKCON entities and devotees involving the transfer of funds over US \$1,000 or the equivalent should be substantiated by written contracts, purchase orders, invoices and/or other appropriate documentation. This principle should also be followed in dealings between devotees and non-devotees.(93)

10.2.4 Bank Account Signers

There be at least two joint signers on all temple bank accounts.(77)

10.2.5 Temple Residents' Cultivation of Parents

To insure that every temple resident with living parents maintains a program of sending a monthly letter to the parents, if the parents are at least approachable.(77)

10.2.6 Sastra Degrees

The ISKCON Board of Examinations shall have power to review and approve proposed examinations for the awarding of the degrees *bhakti-sastri*, *bhakti-vaibhava*, *bhakti-vedanta*, and *bhakti-sarvabhauma*. The basis for review and approval shall be the guidelines given by Srila Prabhupada for the awarding of these degrees. No ISKCON center may award these degrees without seeking the approval of the ISKCON Board of Examinations.

10.2.7 Firearms

No firearms which are in violation of local laws shall be kept in any temple.(76)

10.2.8 Debts to the BBT

Whenever there is a change of management in a temple (or zone), the new management shall accept all existing debts to the BBT.(79)

10.2.9 Calender

The calendar generated by the program written by the Calendar Research Committee shall be the standard calendar to be followed by all ISKCON centers.(90)

10.3 Guidelines for ISKCON Temples

10.3.1 Foreign Visa Sponsorship

10.3.1.1 Explanation

This is a guideline to be followed in regard to those devotees who live in a less developed country and desire to perform devotional service in a more developed country.

10.3.1.2 General Guidelines

That permanent residency visas (called "green cards" in USA) for a developed country should not be given quickly or indiscriminately to nationals coming to serve from a less developed country.

No developed country (includes North America) temple shall sponsor a foreign devotee for a visa to render service in their temple unless the devotee has:

1. written permission from the GBC representative in his country of origin, and
2. a character reference as a devotee in good standing and written permission from his spiritual master and local temple authority.(93)

10.3.1.3 Guideline in Relation to Going to the USA

Devotees coming from a less developed nation should be first given only temporary religious worker or temporary religious minister visas. Three to five year visas should be given prior to green card issue.

10.3.2 Orienting Income-Generating Activities towards Preaching

The GBC recommends that all ISKCON Leaders endeavor to gradually orient the income-generating activities of the temple devotees in the *asramas* primarily towards preaching-related sources. The pace of such a shift is to be determined by the local leadership. ISKCON Leaders and traveling preachers should respect and cooperate with the policies being instituted in the various zones. This guideline is not in any way intended to contradict or create an exception to any ISKCON Law restricting the commercial activities of legal entities which are ISKCON Affiliates. ISKCON Leaders and/or members encouraging the conduct of or engaging in activities prohibited for ISKCON affiliates under such laws should take care to see that such activities are conducted by other entities.(93)

10.4 ISKCON Affiliated Organizations

[Please note that the ISKCON Law Book has a slightly different name for this Section, and that the numbering given here is not consistent with the numbering therein. Either the remaining subsections of Section 10.4 will need to be renumbered to accommodate this revision, or (preferred) the balance of the section should be revised as well. However, only the existing 10.4.1 is being specifically repealed at this point.]

10.4.1 Definition

The GBC Body shall recognize certain associations of devotees located anywhere in the world, which may be registered or unregistered, incorporated or unincorporated, as being affiliated with ISKCON, provided they meet the requirements spelled out in this law section. Such affiliated organizations may be known as "Centers" (or "Independent Centers" if they are also financially autonomous). Types of Centers are "Temples," "Rural Communities," "Preaching Centers," "Institutes," "Congregational Preaching Directorates" and "Special Projects," as defined below.

10.4.2 Purpose

For an association of devotees to be considered in any way affiliated with ISKCON and to receive the benefits of such affiliation, it must meet the following requirements:

1. It must be organized on not-for-profit basis.
2. It must be managed by ISKCON devotees in good standing.
3. It must be conducting its affairs according to the policies, guidelines and standards as set down by the GBC Body.
4. It must be recognized as affiliated with ISKCON as per Subsection 10.4.4 below.

10.4.3 Recommendations for Opening ISKCON Affiliated Centers

10.4.3.1 ISKCON Affiliate Using Property as Public Place of Worship Regulation

"Temples" are Centers characterized by having one primary location which is either stable or semi-stable, and at which daily functions of community or public worship are performed, plus financial autonomy (not being financially controlled by any other affiliate), plus at least one of the following four additional characteristics:

1. There are Deities installed as the presiding Deities of that location for which the worship is being conducted by ISKCON;
2. There is real property at the primary location which is either owned by the association directly, or owned by another not-for-profit entity controlled by ISKCON devotees in good standing, or in any other way the ownership of the property fits the definition of an ISKCON Property as described under ISKCON Law;

3. There is a separate legal registration for the local association; or,
4. There is a congregation of at least 75 members who regularly attend the center's functions.

10.4.3.2 Rural Communities

"Rural Communities" are Centers that fit the same characterization as do Temples, but in addition they are situated in a rural area.

10.4.3.3 Institutes

"Institutes" are characterized by having at least one primary location, which is either owned by the association directly, or owned by another not-for-profit entity controlled by ISKCON devotees in good standing, plus financial autonomy (not being financially controlled by any other affiliate), plus by having activities centered around education, research and/or publication. There may or may not be regular activities of public worship.

10.4.3.4 Congregational Preaching Directorates (Amendment 2004)

"Congregational Preaching Directorates" are characterized by having at least one primary location that is either stable or semi-stable, by having financial autonomy (not being financially controlled by any other affiliate), and by having activities centered on development of congregational preaching over a significantly large area. There may or may not be regular activities of public worship.

10.4.3.5 Special Projects

"Special Projects" are characterized by having functions and activities as needed for special circumstances to fulfill the overall purposes of ISKCON, plus financial autonomy (not being financially controlled by any other affiliate). They may or may not have primary locations or activities of public worship, but they must meet the General Requirements of Affiliation as described in Section 10.4.2 above.

10.4.3.6 Preaching Centers

"Preaching Centers" are characterized by having at least one primary location which may not be permanent but at which regular functions of community or public worship are performed. A Preaching Center may be financially controlled by another ISKCON center; or it may not have a sufficiently permanent location or sufficiently mature management structure to be recognized as a full Temple; or it may have neither installed Deities, nor owned property, nor a separate legal registration, nor a sufficiently large congregation, as described to be qualified as a Temple under Section 10.4.3.1 above.

10.4.3.7 Subsidiaries and Branches of Affiliated Organizations

Any of the above-defined affiliated centers which are financially autonomous may have subsidiaries or branches in additional locations, provided they are authorized to have them by the local Zonal Secretaries or Divisional Council. These subsidiaries or branches may be known as "Extension Centers," "Nama Hatta Centers," etc.

A Preaching Center may also be a subsidiary or branch of a large independent Temple, or it may be semi-autonomous and report directly to a Zonal Secretary or Divisional Council.

Subsidiaries and branches of affiliated centers shall be considered as constituent parts of those centers for all purposes of ISKCON Law except where specifically noted.

ISKCON Centers may encourage and endorse the preaching activities of independent ventures, such as privately owned devotee restaurants and independent householders who regularly preach from their homes, and the Centers may advertise such preaching activities as ISKCON activities to the extent that such advertising does not compromise its non-profit status. While such independent activities are not to be

considered as subsidiary or branch activities of the Center for the purpose of this Law, the Center is responsible for any use of ISKCON's good name in such activities. Care must be taken not to place the name of ISKCON at risk. The Center must be prepared to withdraw its endorsement of these activities whenever the need arises.

10.4.4 Procedure and System of Affiliation

The Zonal Secretaries are normally the competent ISKCON authorities to certify to the GBC Body that an organization functioning in a particular zone is to be recognized or de-recognized as an official ISKCON Center, and to determine the corresponding type of affiliation as per Subsection 10.4.3 above. However, this function may have been delegated to a constituted local Divisional Council. Whichever the case in a particular zone, the competent authority is obliged to report annually to the GBC Secretariat prior to the conclusion of the Annual General Meeting of the GBC as to the existence and status of all ISKCON Centers functioning in the zone. They are also obliged to report promptly during the year if any new Center has been opened in the zone or if there has been any change in the official status of any center.

11 ISKCON Immovable Properties

11.1 General Provisions

That all existing GBC resolutions concerning property management and Deity relocation matters are hereby superseded by the following section:

11.1.1 Definition of an ISKCON Property

An ISKCON Real Property is a real property owned by an ISKCON affiliate, or held for the exclusive and perpetual benefit of one or more ISKCON affiliates; or buildings owned on land which is contractually under the exclusive control of an ISKCON affiliate for a total period of minimum fifty (50) years.

11.1.2 Definition of an ISKCON Property with Deities

For the purpose of property related laws, an ISKCON property with Deities is a property on which there is a Deity which has been either formally installed, or publicly worshipped according to the ISKCON standard for formally installed Deities.

11.1.3 Property Trustees Definition

A Property Trustee is an ISKCON official with certain duties for the protection of ISKCON's interests for properties assigned to him.

11.1.4 Executors Committee Definition

The Executors Committee is a permanent GBC Committee assigned to assist the GBC for executing the details of Srila Prabhupada's will, overseeing and coordinating the activities of Property Trustees, and additional duties relating to ISKCON Properties.

11.1.5 Definition of "Property Trustee Principle"

(The following section is from Srila Prabhupada's will, consisting of part of paragraph 4 and all of Paragraph 5.)

None of the immovable properties standing in the name of ISKCON in India shall ever be mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, transferred, or in any way encumbered, disposed of, or alienated. This direction is irrevocable. Properties outside of India in principle should never be mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, transferred, or in any way encumbered, disposed of, or alienated, but if the need arises, they may be mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, etc. with the unanimous consent of the Property Trustees.

ISKCON Property Office (2001)

An ISKCON property office be established under the GBC Executive Committee Governing Body. The ISKCON property office shall consist of the GBC Executive Committee (Ex-Officio) plus Nareshwara Dasa and Bhaktarupa Dasa. All the functions assigned to the Executors' Committee in the GBC Laws related to ISKCON properties are hereby transferred to this office and are no longer under the Executors' Committee. The Executors committee shall now exclusively concern itself with the various terms of Srila Prabhupada's Will which do not deal with the protection of ISKCON Properties.

11.2 Regulations

11.2.1 Registering Real Properties

1. No funds of an ISKCON affiliate or of the BBT may be used for or pledged against the purchase or major development of any real property that is not held or will not be held as an ISKCON property.
2. All ISKCON properties shall be registered in such a way that the Property Trustees shall have, to the maximum degree possible under local law, the actual authority to perform the functions required of them under ISKCON Law.
3. The copies of the registration deed and corporate papers shall be submitted to the Secretary of the GBC Executors Committee, who shall hold them.

11.2.2 Encumbering or Alienating ISKCON Properties

1. No ISKCON property outside of India shall be sold, mortgaged, borrowed against, transferred or in any way encumbered, disposed of, or alienated without the prior unanimous written permission of the Property Trustees assigned to that property. Property Trustees, in granting permission, should consider that, in principle, Srila Prabhupada did not want ISKCON Properties to be sold, mortgaged, etc., except "when the need arises". (see Property Trustee Principle definition)
2. It is not allowed for any private individual or non-ISKCON entity to hold equity in any structure built on ISKCON property if that equity constitutes a legal encumbrance on that property.
3. No ISKCON property in India shall ever be mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, transferred, or in any way encumbered, disposed of or alienated. This direction is irrevocable.

11.2.3 Mortgaging Properties with Installed Deities

An initial purchase mortgage may be taken against a real property in which a Deity will be installed, but no additional mortgages shall be permitted without the permission of the GBC Body.

11.2.4 Regulations for Alienating Properties with Deities

1. No property in which the Deity of the Lord is installed can be sold without approval of the GBC Body.
2. A proposal to the GBC for sale of an ISKCON Property and relocation of installed Deities must be accompanied by:
 - a. a written recommendation with explanation by the local Temple President and management council,
 - b. The written request of the local GBC Zonal Secretaries,
 - c. the written approval of the Property Trustees, and
 - d. a report by the Trustees giving their reasons for the approval.
3. In the event the local GBC, temple management and Property Trustees are not all unanimous in recommending that an ISKCON property with installed Deities be sold, and/or the Deities be moved, and a majority wants to sell or relocate, or if there is an imminent risk of losing the property, the GBC Executive Committee shall appoint an impartial three-man committee to investigate the situation and prepare a comprehensive report with their recommendation for or against the proposal. If the three-man committee finds that the proposal is acceptable, then the entire GBC body may be approached either at its annual meeting or by correspondence proposal, for approval of the plan.

4. If a local GBC Zonal Secretary finds himself unable to maintain an ISKCON property in which installed Deities reside, and also is unable to obtain the consent of the Property Trustees to sell the property, then he may approach the Executive Committee, which is empowered to take whatever steps are necessary in collaboration with the Property Trustees to save the property, including the appointing of an ad-hoc co-GBC.

5. If installed ISKCON Deities are being relocated to a new property, the trustees of the Deities' original property are responsible to oversee the relocation, according to GBC directives, to ensure that:

- a. any funds realized from the sale of ISKCON property are not mismanaged or in anyway diverted so as to decrease the Deity's equity, and
- b. the new property is adequate to the needs of the Deities and the community.

11.2.5 Regulations for Maintaining Records of Real Properties

1. The copies of the registration deed and corporate papers shall be held by the Secretary of the Executors Committee. The ISKCON affiliate having purchased or acquired a real property shall be responsible to submit these documents within six months from the date of purchase.

2. A record of all ISKCON properties shall be maintained by the Secretary of the Executors Committee, including current value, purchase price, address of property, owner's name, and other information as specified by the Executors Committee. The Secretary of the Executors Committee shall provide the above information to the GBC Executive Officers and members as required.

11.2.6 Non-Adherence to Property Registration Regulations

That unless the Executors Committee grants a special temporary exemption, those temples who do not adhere to the Property Trustee Principle may not be considered as authorized ISKCON affiliates.

11.2.7 Registering Properties in a Non-ISKCON Affiliate's Name

If an ISKCON Property cannot be registered according to these regulations, the property registration must have the prior consent of the GBC Executors Committee.

11.2.8 Exemptions and Additions to ISKCON Property Law

1. Before making any improvements on an ISKCON property, the local management shall comply (where applicable) with building, health and fire codes. Building permits shall be obtained as required by local law before commencing the work. The local GBC Zonal Secretary shall oversee that this guideline is being adhered to. (95)

2. To have a "private" residence on an ISKCON property, someone must have a written legal agreement signed with the proprietary ISKCON entity.

The agreement shall include the following:

- a. The property shall remain legally unencumbered.
- b. In case any improvements are ever to be made on the residence, they shall comply with these guidelines:
 - i. That they comply with the ISKCON Law on making "property improvements".
 - ii. That it shall state whether the improvement is a donation, or a claimed asset of the resident. In the case of a claimed asset, the limit and nature of any compensation shall be detailed so as to avoid any legal complication in the future.
 - iii. That the written permission of the competent local authorities shall be taken prior to making any improvements.

- c. The resident shall maintain the spiritual standards of ISKCON.
 - d. Reasonable clauses for vacating the resident if required.
 - e. Any other clauses needed for maintaining good relations and avoiding legal or practical problems between the occupant and ISKCON.
3. If needed or desired, an ISKCON rural community outside India may be permitted to alienate or encumber a portion of its properties subject to one or more of the following conditions:
- a. The temple project has excess land which ISKCON cannot fully develop in the foreseeable future.
 - b. ISKCON property is endangered by a large mortgage, inability to conform to government regulations, or any other cause.
 - c. The community needs to facilitate householders in order to build up the project in a manner which will not be detrimental to the Deity's interests.
4. If any of the above conditions exists, approval to alienate or encumber may be sought as follows:
- a. The local administration and GBC Zonal Secretary must explain to the property trustees how the rural community's property fits under one or more of the above mentioned conditions.
 - b. In their application, the local administration and GBC Zonal Secretary must also explain how they plan to protect the Deity's and ISKCON's interests providing the following information:
 - i. Which properties will remain ISKCON's and the Deities' possessions, including lands for temple, Deity gardens, *asrama*, brahminical and other temple devotees' lodging, non-encumbered rental or income-earning assigned homesteads, temple's cows, temple's agricultural lands, temple-owned *Gurukula*, temple administration, preaching facilities, utilities, roads, and any other similar areas.

These lands and properties will be designated "Deity property".

 - ii. Which properties are to be alienated from ISKCON and how they will be used. Such uses could include sale, rental or any encumbered allotment of land for homesteads, privately owned cottage industries, private agriculture and dairy, community government, and any other use not against Krsna conscious principles. These lands and properties will be designated "Non-Deity property".
 - iii. How income earned from the alienation shall only be utilized for removing danger to the property by paying off pending mortgages or BBT capital loans, fulfilling government regulations, constructing temple buildings, etc., to ISKCON's and the Deities' capital benefit.
 - iv. Evidence that there are devotees ready and able to invest in buying or renting alienated land.
 - v. A proposed scheme or covenant on land sale to prohibit use of land for purposes against the principles of Krsna consciousness (as legally as possible).
 - vi. Statement that the land price is equal to or greater than the local fair market value for such property.
 - vii. A land use sketch showing where the lands designated in (1) and (2) above will be situated.
 - viii. Any other supporting information.
- c. If the Property Trustees unanimously approve of the proposal and the Deity is situated anywhere on the ISKCON property, the proposal in the above format must be forwarded with the trustees' recommendation to the Executors Committee. The Executors Committee may then approve the proposal demarcating "Deity property" [non-alienable], and "Non-Deity property" [alienable], by two third (2/3) majority. If a simple majority approves, but less than two thirds (2/3), the Executors Committee may forward the proposal to the GBC Body for resolution.

d. After the proposal is approved, the project may be designated as an ISKCON Village Community and the Property Trustees alone can approve proposals from the local management to alienate or encumber land not designated as the Deity's. The Property Trustees shall insure that proceeds from the alienation are invested according to the approved plan.

e. In their order, the Executors Committee shall give specific instructions to insure proper execution and provide safeguards to protect the capital assets as per the approved scheme.

5. In the case of donations of real property or other donations specifically for real estate purchases or improvements, any conditions relating to the property imposed by a donor must be clearly spelled out in writing. The Property Trustees associated with the property must consider the conditions in light of the ISKCON Guidelines for Donations With Conditions, and if they agree in writing that the conditions are within the specified guidelines, then the donation may be accepted.(93)

11.3 Property Trustees

11.3.1 Duties

1. To have their names included on ISKCON property titles or on holding corporations for properties assigned to them.
2. To see that assigned properties are properly registered according to ISKCON Law and to advise local managers in this regard.
3. To report transgressions of ISKCON property law in assigned properties.
4. To consider proposals of local managers for acquiring new properties in areas under their jurisdiction, and to grant or withhold approval of the proposals.
5. To oversee the tax and legal status of entities owning assigned properties in order to certify that the properties are adequately safeguarded.
6. To give or withhold permission on merit to allow any ISKCON property without an installed Deity to be mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, transferred, or in any way encumbered, disposed of, or alienated.
7. To give or withhold recommendation on merit to allow any ISKCON property with an installed Deity to be mortgaged, borrowed against, sold, transferred, or in any way encumbered, disposed of or alienated.
8. To give written reports to the GBC Body, or the Executors Committee, regarding proposals to move an installed Deity or alienate the property of the Deity.
9. To assist the GBC Executive Committee in saving an endangered property on which installed Deities reside.
10. To be responsible to oversee the relocation of installed ISKCON Deities to a new property ensuring that property sale proceeds are not mismanaged or in anyway diverted so as to decrease the Deity's equity, and that the new property is adequate for the Deities.
11. When assigned by the GBC, to approve purchase of property or perform special assignments regarding property safeguards.
12. Whereas the position of property trustee is of grave importance within ISKCON because the trustee is entrusted with the responsibility of preserving Srila Prabhupada's will, every devotee holding the position of property trustee must therefore:

- a. routinely participate in ISKCON activities (temple programs, festival gathering, etc.) or, in the event that trustee doesn't reside within close proximity to an ISKCON temple, maintain a standard ISKCON *sadhana* program at home and regularly attend major temple festivals such as Janmastami, Vyasa-puja, Gaura-purnima, etc.,
- b. regularly associate with ISKCON devotees.,
- c. visibly adhere to the spiritual standards expected of any full-time member of ISKCON, and
- d. sign the Oath of Allegiance.(96)

11.3.2 Powers

- 1. To grant or withhold approval to sell, mortgage, borrow against, transfer, or in any way encumber, dispose of, or alienate an ISKCON property under their jurisdiction that does not have an installed Deity.
- 2. To grant or withhold recommendation to sell, mortgage, borrow against, transfer, or in any way encumber, dispose of, or alienate an ISKCON property under their jurisdiction that does have an installed Deity.
- 3. To inspect and review on demand an ISKCON affiliate's institutional or corporate records, financial accounts, tax records, or property records in order to safeguard assigned real properties held in the name of the affiliate from being alienated or encumbered due to negligence, error, mismanagement, or other improper acts, or in order to determine if all ISKCON property laws are being followed by the affiliate.
- 4. To act as required signatories on all real estate transactions involving assigned properties.
- 5. To act as trustees for any funds held in trust from sale proceeds of the Deity's property until new property is purchased and the Deity permanently and properly settled.

11.3.3 Procedures of Appointment

- 1. The Property Trustees who have been designated in Srila Prabhupada's will have been appointed for life, except as mentioned below.
- 2. In the event of the death, or failure to act for any reason, of any of the Property Trustees, there shall be a successor initiated disciple of ISKCON who is following strictly all the rules and regulations of ISKCON as detailed in Srila Prabhupada's books provided that there are never less than three or more than five trustees acting at one time. "No objections" to the appointment must be obtained in writing from the local GBC's, and the Monitoring Executor for the property in question must certify in writing that the change is in accordance with ISKCON Law and Executors Committee policies. The trustees shall be responsible to notify the Executor Committee of any changes so effected by sending copies of all relevant documents to the Secretary of the Executor Committee.

Any changes, filling of vacancies, or additional appointments of Property Trustees that cannot practically be done by the Property Trustees as above shall be done by GBC Body, or on behalf of the GBC Body by the Executors Committee, which shall take into consideration the local GBC Zonal Secretary's recommendations. Property Trustees shall be selected primarily from among the GBC members, or alternatively from among senior responsible devotees. At least one Property Trustee shall not be involved in the local management.

In general, property trustees are appointed for life. However, the property trustee appointment may be terminated under the following conditions: (2000)

On the submission of a letter of resignation to the GBC Body via the ISKCON property office. For the resignation to take effect, it must be either unanimously accepted by the remaining trustees (if 2 or more exist), or, by a decision of the ISKCON property office.

Upon the death of the trustee or upon the trustee becoming permanently disabled so as not be able to carry out the duties of trusteeship.

Update 2014: If the property trustee is seen to be failing to properly execute his duties under ISKCON property law or is seen to be acting beyond the scope of his authority, then the local management or the co-trustees may submit a request for removal of the trustee to the ISKCON Property Office, which, after hearing the response of the trustee and considering the matter carefully, may grant the request. In the case of a property trustee that is simply not responding promptly to specific requests for trustee action, the local management responsible for the property in question or the local Zonal Secretary(ies) may, alternatively, approach the ISKCON Property Office for permission to bypass such a non-functioning trustee without removing him.

Temple management can approach the property office to bypass a non-functioning trustee without replacing him.

11.3.4 Regulations

Wherever legally possible, the names of the Property Trustees shall be included on all new and existing titles to ISKCON properties or where applicable as directors or trustees of the controlling Board of Directors or Trustees of the "holding trust" of the property.

11.4 The Executors Committee

11.4.1 Duties

1. To implement the specific legal and familial provisions of Srila Prabhupada's will; and to take appropriate steps to insure that ISKCON members duly fulfill their specific responsibilities in relation to Srila Prabhupada's will.
2. To oversee the performance of all Property Trustees in seeing that all ISKCON properties are properly registered according to ISKCON Law.
3. To delegate authority to its individual members for implementing the Property Trustee Principle.
4. To submit an annual report to the GBC.

11.4.2 Powers

1. To delegate authority to individual members to guide and monitor the Property Trustees.
2. To make rules for ISKCON regarding property related standards and execution of legislation and Srila Prabhupada's will. These rulings may be amended or rescinded by the GBC Body at their discretion.
3. To nominate and appoint Property Trustees where none exist or to replace vacancies according to approved procedures.
4. To make recommendations and to propose legislation to the GBC in regards to property matters and Srila Prabhupada's will.
5. To grant special temporary exemptions from placing their properties in the name of ISKCON or having Property Trustees as trustees of the property.

11.4.3 Agenda of Annual Meeting of the Executors Committee

1. To elect Officers of the committee.
2. To review old business and to review the activities of its members and of the Property Trustees.

3. To deal with matters referred by the GBC Body.
4. To deal with other agenda topics as may be proposed by the members.

11.5 Guidelines

11.5.1 Debts

1. Since temples are places of worship and ISKCON's funds and assets are considered to be the personal property of the Supreme Lord, it was Srila Prabhupada's desire that as a general principle of management that Temple Presidents and temple administrations shall keep ISKCON temples free from debts. No external debts should be created by any temple administration. The approved guideline for implementing this is:
 - a. Except for BBT book consignment purchases and deferred payment short-term purchases which can be timely met by the temple from its normal cash flow, all other purchases and expenses should be made on cash basis. Temple Presidents should involve their Temple Board if this is deemed not possible before incurring a significant debt and the advice of the local GBC Zonal Secretary should be sought.
 - b. Immovable property purchases on mortgage or time payment done with concerned property as only collateral and after taking requisite permission as per ISKCON Laws on property are exempt.
 - c. Purchases of vehicles or other movable assets such as equipment of machinery should only be done with the concerned vehicle or other movable assets as collateral and not endangering other assets of default. If purchasing a vehicle or other movable assets will compromise a major portion of the temple cash flow, or there is danger of defaulting, then this should be avoided.
 - d. Any debt which could endanger the immovable properties in case of default shall require the permission of the Property Trustees in writing prior to creating the debt, and if the property has installed Deities, then the permission of the GBC Body shall be required.
2. GBC Zonal Secretaries shall insure that their Temple Presidents and administrations learn to follow the principle of keeping the temple free of debts, and are following this principle.
3. The GBC Zonal Secretary to the GBC Body shall include in his annual report:
 - a. Any deviation from following this principle and what steps have been taken to correct it.
 - b. Any debts which with just cause could not be avoided and the current status of the debt.
4. In urgent cases during the year, the GBC Zonal Secretary shall inform the GBC Executive Committee of any blatant disregard of this principle or action which is placing the temple entity into significant debt risk, for which the GBC Zonal Secretary is not able to prevent or correct.
5. Temple Presidents and administrations which chronically endanger the Lord's properties by deviating from this principle shall be liable for remedial or disciplinary action including:
 - a. Attendance of an approved course on proper financial management procedures.
 - b. Censure.
 - c. Probation and/or reducing to an acting status.
 - d. Removal, in extreme or chronic cases.

New material since 2018 — placement to be confirmed

ADDED · 2020

901 · GBC Budget (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

The GBC Budget for 2020-21 is (in INR):

Annual General Meetings 595,000

Cow Protection & Agriculture 350,000

Child Protection Office 700,000

Dandavats 427,800

Deputies –Travel for Assistant 70,000

Deity Worship Ministry 980,000

Emergency Fund 280,000

Legal & related expenses 700,000

Executive Committee Travel 210,000

Finance & Bank Charges 35,000

GBC Strategic Planning Team 770,000

GBC Corresponding Secretary 462,000

GBC EC Secretary 462,000

GBC Executive Secretariat 350,000

GBC 50th Anniversary Films 210,000

ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 210,000

ISKCON Temple Database 98,000

ISKCON Mayapur's Ethics, Standards & Compliance Office (ESCO) 175,000

ISKCON Law Book 175,000

ISKCON News 308,000

ISKCON Resolve 560,000

ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry 210,000

ISKCON Connection 140,000

Prevention of Leader Misconduct Office 350,000

Legal Committee 140,000

Mayapur GBC Office 434,000

Ministry of Education 441,000

SABHA (Spiritual Advisors Bhagavata Assembly) 560,000

Sastric Advisory Council (SAC) 280,000

Swami Productions (Bhaktimarga Swami) 140,000

Vaisnava Calendar Website 35,000

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Vaishnavi Ministry 105,000

Youth Ministry 105,000

TOTAL 11,067,000

GBC Resolution 901 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2021

901 · GBC Budget (2021)

[Action order]

RESOLVED:

That the Covid-reduced GBC Budget for 2021-22 is (in INR):

Annual General Meetings 420,000
Cow Protection & Agriculture 175,000
Child Protection Office 350,000
Dandavats 224,800
Deputies –Travel for Assistant 35,000
ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry 490,000
Emergency Fund 140,000
Legal & related expenses 350,000
Executive Committee Travel 105,000
Finance & Bank Charges 17,500
GBC Strategic Planning Team 385,000
GBC Corresponding Secretary 462,000
GBC EC Secretary 462,000
GBC Executive Secretariat 22,470
GBC 50th Anniversary Films 140,000
ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 105,000
ISKCON Dispute Resolution Committee 70,000
ISKCON Temple Database 49,000
ISKCON Mayapur's Ethics, Standards & Compliance Office (ESCO) 87,500
ISKCON Law Book 70,000
ISKCON News 154,000

ISKCON Resolve 262,500
ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry 105,000

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ISKCON Connection 70,000
Prevention of Leader Misconduct Office 175,000
Mayapur GBC Office 280,000
Ministry of Education 220,500
Sastric Advisory Council (SAC) 280,000
Vaisnava Calendar Website 17,500
Vaishnavi Ministry 52,500
Youth Ministry 52,500
TOTAL 5,688,970

34

GBC Resolution 901 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 5, 2021)

ADDED · 2022

901 · GC Budget (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The GBC Budget for 2022-23 is (in INR):

Annual General Meetings 629,000

Cow Protection & Agriculture 555,000

Child Protection Office 555,000

GBC Org Dev Committee — Constitution Work 222,000

Dandavats 473,600

Deputies — Travel for Assistant 74,000

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry 1,036,000

Emergency Fund 296,000

Legal & related expenses 370,000

Executive Committee Travel 222,000

Finance & Bank Charges 37,000

GBC Strategic Planning Team 814,000

GBC Corresponding Secretary 488,400

GBC EC Secretary 488,400

ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 296,000

ISKCON Temple Database 55,500

ISKCON Mayapur's Ethics, Standards & Compliance Office (ESCO) 46,250

ISKCON News 296,000

ISKCON Resolve 222,500

ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry 111,000

Mayapur GBC Office 296,000

Ministry of Education 407,000

SABHA 222,000

Vaishnavi Ministry 111,000

TOTAL 8,323,150

GBC Resolution 901 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on April 4, 2022)

ADDED · 2023

901 · GBC Annual Budget (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The GBC Budget for 2023-24 is (in INR):

Annual General Meetings 520,000
Cow Protection & Agriculture 555,000
Child Protection Office 1,600,000
GBC Org Dev Committee — Constitution Work 240,000
Dandavats 560,000
Deputies — Travel for Assistant 80,000
ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry 800,000
Emergency Fund 320,000
Legal & related expenses 800,000
Executive Committee Travel 240,000
Finance & Bank Charges 40,000
GBC Strategic Planning Team 400,000
GBC Corresponding Secretary 528,000
GBC EC Secretary 528,000
GBC Organizational Development Committee 240,000
ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 480,000
ISKCON Connection 240,000
ISKCON Global Property Office 800,000
ISKCON News 400,000
ISKCON Resolve 400,000
ISKCON Sannyasa Ministry 200,000
Mayapur GBC Office & Accounts 400,000
Ministry of Education 640,000
Ministry of Justice 400,000
Prevention of Leadership Misconduct Office 400,000
SABHA 200,000
Vaishnavi Ministry 160,000
Srila Prabhupada Vyasa-puja Book 400,000
TOTAL 13,176,000

GBC Resolution 901 · 2023 · GBC Annual General Meeting, passed February 7, 2023

ADDED • 2024

901 • GBC Annual Budget (2024)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The GBC Budget for 2024-25 is (in INR):

Dandavats 574,000

Deputies — Travel for Assistant 82,000

Emergency Fund 410,000

Executive Committee Travel 328,000

Finance & Bank Charges 41,000

GBC Annual General Meeting 533,000

GBC Corresponding Secretary 541,200

GBC EC Secretary 541,200

GBC Strategic Planning Team 410,000

ISKCON Child Protection Office 4428,000

ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 492,000

ISKCON Connection 246,000

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry 1660,500

ISKCON Global Property Office 410,000

ISKCON Kirtan Ministry 205,000

ISKCON Law Department 820,000

ISKCON News 410,000

ISKCON Resolve 656,000

ISKCON Youth Ministry 164,000

Leadership Conduct Office 410,000

Legal & related expenses 800,000

Mayapur GBC Office & Accounts 492,000

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture 615,000

Ministry of Education 658,000

Ministry of Justice 410,000

Ministry of Padayatra 164,000

Ministry of Sannyasa Services 205,000

SABHA 205,000

Srila Prabhupada Vyasa-puja Book 205,000

Vaisnava Calendar – Android Version 164,000

Vaishnavi Ministry 164,000

TOTAL 16,641,900

ADDED · 2025

901 · GBC Annual Budget (2025)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The GBC Budget for 2025-26 is (in INR):

Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC) 38,28,000

Dandavats 609,000

Deputies — Travel for Assistant 87,000

Emergency Fund 435,000

Executive Committee Travel 348,000

Finance & Bank Charges 52,200

GBC Annual General Meeting 582,900

GBC Corresponding Secretary 574,200

GBC EC Secretary 574,200

GBC Strategic Planning Team 200,100

ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 522,000

ISKCON Connection 165,300

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry 891,750

ISKCON Global Property Office 522,000

ISKCON Kirtana Ministry 174,000

ISKCON Law Department 870,000

ISKCON News 435,000

ISKCON Resolve 696,000

ISKCON Youth Ministry 174,000

Leadership Conduct Office 435,000

Mayapur GBC Office & Accounts 522,000

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture 652,500

Ministry of Education 696,000

Ministry of Justice 435,000

Ministry of Padayatra 174,000

Ministry of Sannyasa Services 261,000

SABHA 261,000

Srila Prabhupada Vyasa-puja Book 217,500

Vaishnavi Ministry 174,000

TOTAL 1,55,68,650

GBC Resolution 901 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 21, 2025

ADDED · 2026

901 · GBC Annual Budget (2026)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The GBC Budget for 2026-27 is (in INR):

Child Protection Oversight Committee (CPOC) 39,60,000

Dandavats 630,000

Deputies — Travel for Assistant 90,000

Emergency Fund 450,000

Executive Committee Travel 450,000

Finance & Bank Charges 67,500

GBC Annual General Meeting 540,000

GBC Corresponding Secretary 594,000

GBC EC Secretary 594,000

GBC Strategic Planning Team 225,500

Guru Services Committee 225,000

ISKCON Congregational Development Ministry 540,000

ISKCON Connection 180,000

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry 9,22,500

ISKCON Global Property Office 540,000

ISKCON Kirtana Ministry 180,000

ISKCON Law Department 9,00,000

ISKCON News 450,000

ISKCON Resolve 720,000

ISKCON Youth Ministry 174,000

Leadership Conduct Office 450,000

Mayapur GBC Office & Accounts 540,000

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture 675,000

Ministry of Education 720,000

Ministry of Justice 450,000

Ministry of Padayatra 180,000

Ministry of Sannyasa Services 270,000

SABHA 270,000

Srila Prabhupada Vyasa-puja Book 270,000

Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee 180,000

Vaishnavi Ministry 225,000

TOTAL 16,488,000

GBC Resolution 901 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

12 Temple Worship and Deity Worship

12.1 Deity Worship and Altar Regulations

12.1.1 Standards of Deity Worship

1. The book, "The Method of Deity Worship for the International Society for Krishna Consciousness," is approved by the GBC Body. All devotees engaged in Deity worship in ISKCON temples with installed Deities should study and take guidance from this book.
2. There should be no change in the system of Deity worship as established by Srila Prabhupada. In all matters of new Deity worship which Srila Prabhupada has not established or about which he has not given specific instructions, the GBC must be consulted.(83)

12.1.2 Protection of Deities

All temples must make arrangements for the protection of installed Deities immediately. This is to include adequate protection during *darsana* times when the curtain and doors are open. Locking iron gates are recommended. All GBC members must include details on how the Deities in each temple in their zone are being protected in their annual report.

12.1.3 Pictures of the Spiritual Master and Parampara Acaryas'

2. The pictures of His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada, His Divine Grace Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Prabhupada, Srila Gaurakisora dasa Babaji, Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura, and preferably Jagannatha dasa Babaji should always remain on all ISKCON temple altars.
3. A *pujari* who is not initiated by Srila Prabhupada shall keep the picture of his *guru* on the altar while offering *arati*. The picture must be substantially smaller than those of the predecessor *acaryas* in disciplic succession, or, if not substantially smaller, be placed on a lower level. After the *arati*, the picture should be removed from the altar.(87)
4. Disciples of a suspended *guru* when offering *bhoga* to the Deities in the temple or in any ISKCON establishment, (like restaurants, etc.) outside the temple must offer through Srila Prabhupada to the disciplic succession. (87)

12.1.4 Vaisnava Marriage Ceremonies Before the Deities

Only initiated devotees of Krsna who are strictly maintaining their vows of initiation may be married before the Deities in a *vaisnava* ceremony. An ISKCON devotee priest can perform a ceremony for uninitiated devotees that may include the lighting of the sacred fire, but not before Deities, if he is reasonably certain that the devotees to be married are not engaged in regular and/or serious deviation from the four regulative principles. It is preferred that this ceremony not be held in the temple room if other facilities are available. An ISKCON devotee who is qualified under local law to perform religious ceremonies may marry other uninitiated devotees at his own risk. (93)

12.1.5 Prema-dhvani Prayers

1. The proposal 4 of "rules of conduct" of the laws of ISKCON regarding the specific method of chanting the *prema-dhvani* prayers shall be deleted, except the "ISKCON Founder-Acarya A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada *ki jaya*" that shall be retained, chanted before chanting "*Namacarya Srila Haridasa Thakura ki jaya*".(81)

2. That in the temple room *kirtana*, only the name of Prabhupada and his predecessors can be chanted. The words ISKCON *guru vrnda ki jaya* is to be used in the *prema-dhvani* prayers in place of the existing prayers.

12.1.6 Regulations for Worship of Srila Prabhupada

1. There shall be a separate daily *guru-puja* for Srila Prabhupada in the temple.
2. The only *guru-puja* inside the temple room will be for Srila Prabhupada.(81)

12.1.6 Regulation of Deity Installations in ISKCON (Amendment 2017)

(duplicate number in the 2018 source)

Any ISKCON center wishing to install any deities for public temple worship or commence the worship of any deity in an ISKCON center must first receive a “Certificate of Readiness for Worship” for the said deities.

Centers may procure Deities and begin promoting planned temple openings or additions to existing worship once they have successfully completed the first stage of the approval process. Centers shall not commit to and/or publicly advertise final dates for commencement of worship until they receive a “Certificate of Readiness for Worship.”

This “Certificate of Readiness for Worship” applies only to the deities for which it is granted and is not a generic permanent approval.

The initial contact: The center wishing to commence the worship of deities makes an application via the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry’s website, deityworship.com. After receiving this application, the IDWM contacts the local GBC and regional authorities to assess the viability of the application. If this consultation shows the center has made a proper analysis of the requirements to worship deities and are moving in the right direction regarding allocation resources, etc. to the worship of the deities then the first stage approval is granted. This then enables the temple to make arrangements to acquire deities and commence fund-raising, etc.

The second and final stage will be assessed based on the findings of a site visit by a IDWM representative, or comprehensive consultation with concerned devotees.

The readiness for worship will be assessed by a local representative (from the temple concerned); the local GBC, regional leadership (which may include a representative from the National Council or RGB, etc.); and an ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry representative. The GBC Executive Committee will be informed of the assessment outcome.

For any applications for deities apart from those given by Srila Prabhupada, i.e. Radha-Krsna; Jagannatha, Baladeva, Subhadra; and Gaura-Nitai (or Panca-tattva) and salagram silas; the IDWM requires executive input.

Therefore, for any application that includes Krsna-Balarama or Sita Rama Lakshman Hanuman, the IDWM will consult with the GBC Executive Committee for approval.

Any deities apart from the aforementioned must be approved by the GBC Body before the IDWM can issue a Certificate of Readiness for installing deities. This Certificate of Readiness is valid for up to 180 days beyond the initial scheduled installation date. If the 180 day period has elapsed without the installation being completed, the temple will be reassessed by the ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry for a new Certificate of Readiness to be issued.

12.2 Guidelines

12.2.1 Worship of Demigods as Vaisnavas

1. Worship of demigods as independent gods is not permitted in Krsna consciousness. However, the Nectar of Devotion says that demigods should be respected. Worshipping demigods as Vaisnavas is authorized for preaching, in order to teach people the right position of the demigods as great Vaisnavas.

a. The worship is only as a *vaisnava* (This means that the *deva/devi* shall be offered: the *prasadam arati* items immediately after they are offered to Lord Krsna, *krsna-prasadam* flower garlands, and *krsna-prasadam* food-stuffs. No independent worship is offered. Only the chanting of Hare Krsna and VisAu's names is done, as Lord Caitanya did in South India.)

b. Their status as servants of Krsna is made as clear as possible through signs, symbols, and iconography, and

c. Offerings are of *krsna-prasadam*.

2. Deities of demigods (incl. Laksmi where no VisAu is established), shall not be established without permission of the GBC. Where they are permitted or where ISKCON acquires a temple with already established murtis of demigods, they may remain, provided they are worshipped as *vaisnavas*, as provided above.

3. ISKCON temples may hold, on special occasions, ceremonies or *pujas* respecting and worshipping demigods as great *vaisnavas*, provided they shall be designed as an introduction, precisely to draw people into that culture, and not as a substitute for it, thereby not falling under Srila Prabhupada's structure. Properly conducted, they are favorable to Krsna consciousness and should not be rejected.

12.2.2 Renting Space for other Groups' Religious Functions

It is permitted for other groups, at the discretion of the local ISKCON authorities, to rent space in ISKCON premises, outside the temple room, for their own ceremonies and functions, even for functions listed below (a-e), provided that the public understand clearly that the function is not being sponsored or conducted by ISKCON. However, no function on ISKCON property shall include any activity contrary to the four regulative principles. The GBC recommends that temples provide outside groups rental contracts clearly stipulating the above restrictions.(96)

The following activities are not allowed as part of ISKCON functions, whether conducted on ISKCON property or elsewhere:

a. Satya Narayana *katha*. (This is a concocted form of worship).

b. *Garbha* dance, when it is conducted in association with the worship of Durga. (*Garbha* dance is usually performed as part of *Nava-ratri*, a Durga festival. However, there are also *Garbha* dances in glorification of Krsna. Temple authorities permitting a *Garbha* dance must be confident that the performance is entirely Krsna-centered.)

c. The reading of Tulasidasa's *Rama-carita-manasa*. (*Ramayana* readings should be from Valmiki *Ramayana*, as Tulasidasa's work is tinged with impersonalism.)

d. Lectures advocating *Mayavada* or other offensive philosophies.

e. The singing of the Hindi *arati* song "*om jaya jagadisa hare*". (This is a prayer for material benedictions).

12.2.3 Sponsoring Professional Bhagavata-katha Reciters

The following guidelines should be followed:

- i. If the speaker is not an ISKCON devotee, he should be a practicing *vaisnava* who can speak in public with enthusiasm about Lord Caitanya, ISKCON, and Srila Prabhupada.
- ii. ISKCON should systematically cultivate such speakers as potential initiated devotees, so that at least their own standard of *sadhana* is enhanced. ISKCON will try to engage a few favorable outside reciters, rather than many, so that those few may become more immersed in ISKCON's mood.
- iii. All *kathas* should showcase devotees in *kirtana*, *prasadam* distribution, as well as photos, paintings, and Deities from ISKCON temples or homes.
- iv. The temples sponsoring such *kathas* shall be pledged to pursue vigorous follow-up programs among those who attended the *kathas* in order to cultivate them as temple members and practitioners of Krsna consciousness.
- v. Distribution of full sets of Srila Prabhupada's *Bhagavatam*, in both Indian languages and in English, should be the main feature of these *kathas*.
- vi. We should be confident that the speaker will not express any *mayavada* or *sahajiya* philosophy or sentiments.
- vii. The speakers should represent the full *Bhagavatam*, and not just the Tenth Canto.
- viii. The speakers should speak as a benefit for ISKCON, receiving only minimal compensation.
- ix. The ISKCON speakers should always speak last in order to correct any errors in the other presentations.
- x. If the speaker is not an ISKCON devotee, the event should be held in another name.

12.2.4 Sthapaka-sastra

It is advised as a guideline that all ISKCON temples with installed Deities may immediately begin and maintain a *sthapaka-sastra* using a long-lasting hard-bound book suitable for establishing a legacy. Each temple's historical events should be recorded in the *sthapaka-sastra* by the Temple President and Head *pujari* after due consideration and mutual agreement. The *sthapaka-sastra* should be maintained on the altar as the Deities' personal paraphernalia. Suggestions for entries are:

1. Formation of the temple.
2. Special *lilas* and instructions given by the Founder-Acarya, Srila Prabhupada.
3. Special history of the Deities e.g.: how They were named, how They came, Their standard of service, Their extraordinary *lilas*, etc.
4. Accomplishments of the devotees and temple e.g.: winners of Christmas marathons.
5. Temple's annual history.
6. The last words of retiring Temple Presidents.(95)

12.2.5 Regulations Regarding Vaisnava Calendar

1. ISKCON temples throughout the world shall follow the official calendar calculated according to the conclusions of this report, which are:
 - a. The calculations should be made based upon the local time of sunrise.
 - b. A computerized method of calculations is acceptable.
 - c. The length of a *muhurta* shall be calculated as a 15th part of the daytime and a 15th part of the nighttime.

- d. Sunrise shall be defined as the time of calculated visibility of the upper limb of the sun at the horizon, and the time of sunset as the time of calculated disappearance of the upper limb of the sun at the horizon.
 - e. The calculations shall be based upon the positions of the heavenly bodies as determined according to modern scientific astronomical observations.(90)
2. The calendar generated by the program written by the Calendar Research Committee shall be the standard calendar to be followed by all ISKCON centers.(90)
 3. Srila Prabhupada's Appearance Day be fixed as the calendar day after the observance of Janmastami, and the calendar program changed accordingly.
 4. The official ISKCON calendar should include the significant dates in Srila Prabhupada's life, such as the day he took *sannyasa*, departed for America, arrived in America, founded ISKCON, etc.(92)
 5. The disappearance day of H.H. Gaura Govinda Maharaja be observed on the ISKCON GBC and BBT calendar every year.(96)

13 Education

13.1 Board Of Education

13.1.1 Definition

The ISKCON Board of Education is a GBC standing committee dealing with primary and secondary education in ISKCON, composed of GBC and non-GBC members. The Board will formulate and execute concrete plans which shall enable it to effectively insure the quality of Krsna conscious primary and secondary education throughout ISKCON. Each member of the ISKCON Board of Education shall have responsibility for specific duties and shall make specific commitments for which he shall be held accountable.

13.1.2 Powers

1. That all Board of Education resolutions are binding on ISKCON Educational Institutions, subject to review each year in Mayapur by the GBC.(89)

13.1.3 Duties

The ISKCON Board of Education shall continue to maintain the activities of the former Ministry of Education.

1. To establish and maintain a central administrative office.
2. To meet annually in Mayapur.
3. To plan international policies and strategies.
4. To interface with the GBC Body.
5. To resolve problems brought to it.(94)
6. To give Gurukula schools permission and guidance.(81)
7. To formulate and execute concrete plans which shall enable it to effectively improve and insure the quality of Krsna Conscious primary and secondary education throughout ISKCON.
8. To develop and print curriculums.
9. To establish standards for voluntary accreditation of *gurukulas* worldwide and manage the accreditation process.
10. To act as an advisory service for ISKCON leaders and devotees worldwide in all matters concerning elementary and secondary education and child protection. It is reaffirmed herein that the ultimate responsibility for education and child protection rests with the local GBC and temple authorities.
11. To maintain official ISKCON child abuse records.
12. To report to the ISKCON Education Office Liaison (described below) of any known discrepancies in local follow up of reports.
13. To maintain other records, files, mailing lists as appropriate.
14. To organize the Education Conference on COM.

13.1.4 Regulations

13.1.4.1 Membership

Its membership, to be appointed by the GBC Body upon the Board's recommendation, shall be:

1. A Chairman / Secretary.
2. GBC members as Regional Representatives.
3. At-Large members who, while not representing a particular area, are experienced in education or have a specific contribution which enhances the composition of the Board.

The yearly GBC Chairman shall also serve as a member of the ISKCON Board of Education.

Duties of the different categories of members shall be initially as per the document entitled "Proposal to the GBC for Reorganizing the International Board of Education", dated February 14, 1991 and filed with the Corresponding Secretary, or as they may be modified by the Board of Education in the future and reported in writing to the GBC Body.

13.1.4.2 Duties of the Chairman of the Board

1. To supervise and review the activities of the Office.
2. To be referred any matters which come to the Education Office which are beyond its scope.
3. To refer them further to the Board of Education or to the GBC Body.

13.1.4.3 Gurukula Education

That within ISKCON, *gurukula* schools shall open only with the permission of the Board of Education, and operate under the guidance of the Board of Education and the local GBC.(81)

13.1.4.4 Children's Books

All children's books, including coloring books, for use by Krsna conscious schools should have approval of the Board of Education.(79)

Social Development Information (1998)

The purpose of this Ministry is to :

Help with the development of other ministries in the social circle (cow protection and agriculture, grhastha and community development, and health and welfare.);

Actively pursue improved communications between ISKCON and its members;

Facilitate communications among ministries on matters of social development;

Propagate understanding of social principles among devotees by publications, seminars and visiting devotee communities;

Identify competent devotees to head various projects for social development;

Engage in fund raising for it and the ministries it represents, in addition to any funds that the individual ministries are able to generate for themselves. (Funds are to be allocated by a committee representative of the four ministries.)

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture (1998)

“Minimum Cow Protection Standards” prepared by the Ministry of Cow Protection and Agriculture is hereby ratified by the GBC Body and it thereby becomes part of ISKCON Law. (1999)

Note : Details of Standards required to be mentioned to become part of Law.

14 Sankirtana - Book Distribution

14.1 Significance

That the leaders of ISKCON, as followers of Srila Prabhupada, ought to see book distribution as our most effective means of preaching. "Know it for certain that there is no better way to preach Krsna consciousness than through the distribution of my books." We can make a worldwide revolution in the hearts of the people of this world and save these people from material existence through the distribution of Srila Prabhupada's books. But book distribution strongly increases only when we have a constant influx of new ISKCON devotees. So to increase book distribution, we must make new devotees. Therefore, wherever we have powerful leaders—whether GBC members, *gurus*, *sannyasis*, or Temple Presidents—they ought to impress upon their followers that book distribution and making new devotees to go out on book distribution are ISKCON's main work. The *guru*, whether *siksa* or *diksa*, has great power to increase ISKCON's preaching. Therefore, in cooperation with the GBC Body and the individual GBC members, the *guru* should use that power to encourage and inspire his disciples to make new devotees and increase the distribution of books. *gurus* can impress upon their disciples the importance of the Mayapur Project, remind them of its dependence on the BBT's income from book distribution, and encourage them to dedicate themselves to the mission of distributing books and building the Mayapur City. Srila Prabhupada himself did this, and so can the leaders who follow him. We all understand that we must build the temple and city in Mayapur. And the way to do this is through book distribution. Therefore the leaders of ISKCON—GBC members, *gurus*, *sannyasis*, Temple Presidents, and senior devotees should bring the Mayapur City, and the book distribution that supports it, to the forefront of ISKCON's consciousness. All ISKCON leaders are urged to strive vigorously to instill within their followers a consciousness of the crucial importance of the Mayapur City and book distribution to the success of ISKCON's mission.

14.2 Regulations

1. GBC Zonal Secretaries and Temple Presidents shall be responsible to ensure that Srila Prabhupada's books are distributed on *sankirtana* on a regular basis.(81)
2. Regarding temple's BBT debts, Srila Prabhupada said a temple can order with thirty days credit, and after that time they must pay in full for the books received, even if they were not all sold.(75)
3. If the establishment of a project within a particular zone will cause that zone or the temples within that zone to stop or greatly diminish their BBT remittances (i.e. the GBC mandate of 25%-50%), the GBC Zonal Secretary must receive approval from the GBC Body at the annual GBC meeting.(86)

14.2.1 Regarding Awards and Recognition

1. A monthly newsletter shall be sent out to all temples listing all zones and temples in order, giving details of all book sales and including interesting articles concerning developments of preaching fields in various zones.
2. Annual awards shall be presented during Mayapur *Gaura-purnima* annual festival for outstanding services in the field of *sankirtana* in the following areas:
 - a. Most successful country
 - b. Most improved country
 - c. Most successful temples (*maha*-large, large, medium, and small)
 - d. Most improved temples (*maha*-large, large, medium, small and *maha*-small)

e. Top individual *sankirtana* devotees.

3. Award winners shall be determined each year by the *Sankirtana Newsletter* staff.

4. A BBT Newsletter may provide financial information.(80)

5. The scoring system for the *Sankirtana Newsletter* is changed to include the following:

a. For the "Regular" category:

i. To count only literature which is actually sold and given into the hands of the receivers personally, and

ii. Literature distributed by accepting post dated checks shall only be counted when the minimum BBT price has been received.

b. A new category named "Subsidized" for the following methods of distribution:

i. Devotees working in teams of two or more and recording their total group effort as one score,

ii. Subsidized books which are sold at BBT price or less, and

iii. Sponsored books given to people who can value them (i.e.: VIPs, libraries, schools, prisons, etc.).

The above methods of book distribution must be specified when reporting scores to the newsletter.

c. Distribution by individuals and temples who give out literature free of cost shall not be counted in the newsletter.(97-103)

14.2.2 Regarding Book Distribution Techniques

1. Illegal techniques shall not be used on book distribution. Such illegal methods include: misrepresenting one's physical health, claiming falsely that contributions go for welfare projects and claiming falsely to be affiliated with a charity.(77)

2. "If costumes are used on *sankirtana* it must be done legally with permits from local authority".(77)

3. Each GBC Zonal Secretary man will go out in the field in each of his temples during the year to observe the same [to know how his devotees are implementing the resolution, "no illegal techniques".](77)

14.2.3 Regarding Traveling Sankirtana

No GBC member shall allow the *sankirtana* parties of his zone to carry out *sankirtana* activities outside of his zone without having received the express written permission of the host GBC Zonal Secretary or the Temple President concerned.(80)

14.2.4 Regarding Srila Prabhupada Marathon

1. The Christmas marathon shall be officially titled the "Srila Prabhupada Marathon".

2. Only legal and ethical techniques shall be used on book distribution and other techniques are not to be used. The standard of approved *sankirtana* techniques can be obtained from the GBC Minister for book distribution. (77)

14.2.5 Seminars Conducted by the Ministry for Book Distribution

1. The five-day seminar course established by the Global Book Distribution Minister is accepted as the official training course for all ISKCON book distributors. This course is to be taken by all:

a. New regular book distributors within the first twelve months of their book distributing career, and

b. Regular book distributors by Gaura-purnima 1998, and

- c. Part time book distributors are encouraged to take this course.
2. The Global Book Distribution Minister is responsible to supervise the standard and content of the Book Distribution Graduate Course, promote it, and ensure that the requirements of this resolution are met.

14.3 Guidelines

1. The Temple Presidents should give an absolute minimum of twenty five percent(25%) of the Temples income for book distribution.(81)
2. Each temple may give books to ISKCON centers in third-world countries like India, Bangladesh, Sri Lanka, Nepal, Africa and Latin America for establishing Krsna conscious reading rooms. The temple contributing should receive *sankirtana* points for those books according to the Book Distribution Ministry approved system. In such a case the recipients will not receive points.(79)

15 Congregational Development

15.1 Significance

That the leaders of ISKCON, as followers of Srila Prabhupada, ought to see the duty of training and facilitating congregational members as their primary function, in order to fulfill the order of Lord Caitanya: "Therefore I order every man within this universe to accept this Krsna consciousness movement and distribute it everywhere." and the numerous instructions that Srila Prabhupada has given in his books, lectures, letters and conversations on how people can practice Krsna consciousness in their home, be initiated, establish a center in their home, preach *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from their home. Wherever we have powerful leaders-whether GBC members, *gurus*, *sannyasis*, or Temple Presidents-they ought to impress upon their followers that everyone must be brought into the congregation and empowered to preach Krsna consciousness purely. This will directly please Lord Caitanya and Srila Prabhupada. Congregational preaching should be understood to be one of the most essential works of ISKCON (books are the basis; preaching is the essence) following the footsteps of Lord Nityananda and the previous *acaryas*.

15.2 Guidelines

15.2.1 Encouraging the Congregation: The Siksa Ceremony

1. ISKCON Leaders and GBC Members (with the exception of ISKCON initiating spiritual masters who cannot perform this ceremony except when it is for an approved *guru-asraya* (sheltered) or approved aspirant disciple) shall, within their area of authority, be permitted to publicly bestow acceptance and recognition to members of its congregation for devotional achievements and progress in devotional service.
2. Local temples and congregational preaching units should implement programs for aiding the congregational members to enhance their standing, and for training them to qualify for the higher levels. This should include following a recommended study course for the different levels (Adult Education and Congregational Preaching Monitors shall recommend.)
3. Standard certificates shall be issued worldwide. (The proforma certificates shall be created and circulated by the Corresponding Secretary in consultation with the Congregational Preaching Monitor.)
4. The recognition shall be granted in any of the following categories (giving these is optional, as also the bestowal ceremony according to local time, place and circumstance):

15.2.1.1 Accepting the Sacred Order of Lord Caitanya (*Sat-sangi*, or *Sraddhavan*)

Qualifications: Accepting the instructions or sacred order of Lord Caitanya to chant Hare Krsna (minimum one round per day), to worship Lord Krsna (to visit the temple or otherwise cultivate devotional service as far as possible), and to read the teachings of Lord Krsna (*Bhagavad-gita*, *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and other books of Srila Prabhupada). [Note: Since this broadly correlates with *sraddha* or *sat-sanga* stages of devotion, they can generally be called as "*Sat-sangi*" or "*Sraddhavan*".]

15.2.1.2 Krsna (or Gauranga) Sevaka

Qualifications: Chanting a minimum of four rounds of Hare Krsna *japa* per day, refraining from meat-eating, believing in Lord Krsna as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, possessing a devotional attitude, and avoiding of grossly immoral acts (drugs, prostitution, etc.)

15.2.1.3 Krsna (or Gauranga) Sadhaka

Qualifications: Chanting a minimum of eight rounds of Hare Krsna *japa* per day, refraining from intoxication, meat-eating, gambling, and extra-marital sex, offering of *bhoga* to pictures, establishing an altar at home, and generally accepting the process of *sadhana-bhakti*.

15.2.1.4 Srila Prabhupada Asraya

Qualifications: Practicing the minimum standard of Krsna consciousness for ISKCON members as given by Srila Prabhupada, namely chanting of minimum sixteen rounds of Hare Krsna *japa* per day, refraining from intoxication, meat-eating, gambling, and illicit sex, and generally showing a strong conviction in Krsna consciousness.

15.2.1.5 Sri Guru Carana Asraya

Qualifications: Same as Srila Prabhupada Asraya, with additional faith and surrender in an authorized spiritual master coming in the disciplic succession. Must have been practicing Srila Prabhupada Asraya standard for a minimum of six months. They should pass the exam provided for in ISKCON Law.

Women's Participation: (2000)

All ISKCON temples are to allow all qualified devotees, regardless of gender, to speak on Srimad Bhagavatam, Bhagavad-gita etc. during the regular temple class.

All ISKCON temples designate half of the temple room area divided in the center from the altar for the ladies.

If the management in a particular temple feels it is unable to implement these proposals, the Executive Committee will appoint a small team of senior devotees, including women, to sensitively review the particular local situation.

15.2.2 Annual Doubling of the Congregation

ISKCON temples should try to annually double their congregation by training and empowering the congregation through small local *nama-hatta Bhakti-vrksa* Branch Groups (known also as Krsna conscious "cell" groups, *bhakti-sangas*, etc.)

15.3 ISKCON Leaders' Duties In Regard to Congregational Preaching

15.3.1 GBC Zonal Secretary

1. Each GBC Zonal Secretary shall allocate the responsibility for preaching to the congregation in the different geographic areas of his zone to temples or Congregational Preaching Directorates to insure maximum effectiveness in congregational preaching and development.

2. If a *nama-hatta* center upgrades to become an ISKCON temple or otherwise a temple is established in a Congregational Preaching Directorate area, then naturally the GBC Zonal Secretary will make new arrangements to re-allocate the respective geographic responsibilities for preaching to the congregation in the affected areas.(93)

For those geographic areas which fall beyond the capacity or desire of ISKCON temples to supervise, promote, and expand the congregational preaching, the local GBC Zonal Secretary(s) and the Zonal Council (if any) can appoint a responsible devotee in good standing to be a "Director" of a "Congregational Preaching Directorate" or "Branch" of ISKCON who can lead a team of preachers to systematically cultivate, preach to, and expand the congregational preaching in a specified area.

3. To oversee that every temple maintains a program of sending a monthly letter from a devotee to his parents, if his parents are at least approachable.(77)

15.3.2 Responsibility of ISKCON Leaders to Conduct Congregational Preaching

Local spiritual authorities shall be responsible to establish programs for effectively involving, training and otherwise helping and encouraging congregational devotees to gradually become qualified for initiation.

1. An ISKCON temple shall be responsible for preaching to the congregation in the city, adjacent areas nearby, and any other extended area as may be designated by the local GBC Zonal Secretary(s) and Zonal Council (if any).
2. The congregational preaching program in such cases shall operate as a department of or part of the ISKCON temple, who shall bear the expense and shall provide the other requirements needed for this preaching. (see p. 129)

15.4 Regulations

15.4.1 Initiation of Congregational Devotees

Congregational members shall be subject to the same standards for initiation as stated in ISKCON Law on initiation and for acceptance of Guru. ISKCON Law states that the local Temple or Regional Authorities must recommend the congregational candidate. However this shall be done in the same manner as any other qualified devotee. If a local authority considers a candidate for initiation not qualified, then the candidate should be informed what needs to be done in order to become qualified according to ISKCON Law. It shall be prohibited to require a minimum donation or financial commitment or other requirements not mentioned by Srila Prabhupada or ISKCON Law. As already mentioned in ISKCON Law, an individual *guru* is under no obligation to initiate a devotee because a proper recommendation has been given.(96)

15.4.2 The Congregational Preaching Directorate

For those geographic areas which fall beyond the capacity or desire of ISKCON temples to supervise, promote, and expand the congregational preaching, the local GBC Zonal Secretary(s) and the Zonal Council (if any) can appoint a responsible devotee in good standing to be a "Director" of a "Congregational Preaching Directorate" or "Branch" of ISKCON who can lead a team of preachers to systematically cultivate, preach to, and expand the congregational preaching in a specified area. For all practical administrative purposes, the Director of such a unit is considered a Temple President.

15.4.2.1 Duties of a Congregational Preaching Branch Director

A Director of a Congregational Preaching Branch for purposes of ISKCON Law shall have for all effective purposes the position and responsibilities of a Temple President over his team of preachers and establishment.

In addition the Director shall have the following specific duties:

1. To provide leadership and spiritual guidance for the devotees under him.
2. To manage the finances of his program.
3. To recommend qualified candidates for initiation.
4. To encourage persons ready for joining a temple to do so.
5. To concentrate on congregational preaching.
6. To be accountable to the GBC Zonal Secretary.
7. To perform additional duties as assigned by the GBC Zonal Secretary and Zonal Council.

15.4.2.2 Location

The central office of the "branch" may be based in a temple premises with the permission of the Temple President, or they may have a separate place.

15.4.2.3 Cooperation with the Temple President

If any ISKCON temples exist nearby or do preaching in the area, then their no-objection shall be required to establish such a branch. Arrangements for *sankirtana* rights and other aspects needed to maintain good relations and cooperation shall be made with the concerned Temple President.

16 Prasadam Distribution

16.1 Hare Krsna Food For Life

16.1.1 GBC Recognition of Hare Krsna Food For Life Program

The GBC Body officially recognizes "Hare Krsna Food For Life" as ISKCON's program for widespread distribution of *Krsna -prasadam* and gives the program its blessings.

"Hare Krsna Food for Life" and "ISKCON Food Relief" are officially part of the Ministry of Communications.

16.1.2 Duties

1. To promote, coordinate and organize *Krsna-prasadam* distribution programs all over the world under appropriate titles.
2. To promote and supervise the ISKCON third world (i.e. India, Asia, Africa, etc.) *prasad* distribution program known as ISKCON Food for Life or ISKCON Food Relief as established by ISKCON's Founder-Acarya.

16.1.3 Regulations

That all temples are encouraged to take up the Hare Krsna "Food For Life" program as outlined by the Communications Ministry and Food for Life Ministry. The GBC Body recommends this program as a highly effective means to increase *prasadam* distribution and ultimately book distribution as well and as a way for ISKCON to gain acceptance by the public and government agencies.

1. No person can collect funds using the name Food for Life without the written permission of their local ISKCON authority and the Ministry of Communication.
2. The above parties (the applicant, local ISKCON authorities and Ministry of Communication) are to mutually agree upon a percentage of funds to be collected using the name Food for Life. This must comply with local laws and must be used for the stated purpose either by:
 - a. conducting *prasadam* distribution, or
 - b. sponsoring *prasadam* distribution projects somewhere in the world.(97-106.1, 106.22)

17 Justice

17.1 Appealing a Decision

17.1.1 The Principle

In personal dealings between individual devotees and their authorities, appealing the decision of a lower authority to a higher authority for reaching a final solution is a standard principle in ISKCON.(93)

17.1.2 Procedure

1. If a devotee feels aggrieved by a decision, or the lack of a decision, of his Temple President for something which affects him in his personal spiritual life (initiation, marriage, transfer, removal, permissions, etc.), the devotee may appeal the matter to the local GBC Zonal Secretary or to an assistant of the GBC approved for this purpose.
2. While the appeal is being considered, the concerned devotee must follow the decision of the Temple President unless the GBC has given a stay order for the duration of the appeal.
3. During an appeal, all concerned parties should be heard and the decision in the appeal shall be considered as final.
4. If requested, decisions should be given in writing.
5. If the Temple President wants to appeal a matter relating to a decision of his GBC Zonal Secretary he can do so to the GBC Body, or in emergencies to the GBC Executive Committee, but while the appeal is going on he should follow the decision of the GBC Zonal Secretary unless the GBC Executive Committee gives a stay order from following it.
6. When the matter being appealed is related with something which will produce an irrevocable consequence or contravene ISKCON Law, the status quo should be maintained until the appeal is decided.(93) See also Ministry of Justice.

18 Fund Development and Life Patron Membership

18.1 General Regulations

ISKCON centers shall always offer reasonable hospitality to any life members in good standing who visit the center. The minimum hospitality is to offer at least *prasadam*. Life members should be offered to stay overnight regardless of how meager the facilities are and if it is not possible to offer accommodations, then it is the responsibility of the temple to give reasonable assistance in finding member's accommodations.(82)

Collection of funds in the name of the homeless, the handicapped and the under-privileged is not acceptable method of fund raising, unless the collections are used for genuine purposes.(97-106.3)

18.2 General Guidelines

According to Srila Prabhupada's expressed desire, whenever possible all temples should offer at least a one-year Back to Godhead subscription to every newly enrolled life member. New members who are not residing in primarily English-speaking areas shall have the option to be provided the magazines in another language if available.(90)

See also Ministry of Fund Development and Life Patron Membership (page 37.)

19 Devotee Health and Welfare

19.1 The Principle of Welfare of Each ISKCON Member

The welfare of individual ISKCON members is always of concern to the Society and its leadership. Specifically, devotees who have dedicated themselves to the work of the Society according to their ability and then later come to face some hardship due to old age, illness, lack of a means of livelihood, etc. should be provided the necessities of life. It is the duty of every ISKCON devotee to make whatever arrangements are within their power to provide these necessities wherever there is a need, without seeking compensation.

Trust funds, welfare organizations, and other such entities may be established by individual ISKCON members, temples, the GBC Body, etc. for carrying out these responsibilities, but the overriding principle of such endeavors must always be voluntary charity to the *vaisnavas*. Taxes, assessments, and fees must never be used for such purposes, as such would serve only to decrease the feelings of love and trust upon which our Society is based.(91)

19.2 Protection of Women

19.2.1 Principles

The GBC hereby requests all temple and congregational leaders to practically engage female devotees in areas of temple *sadhana* and preaching, giving careful and mature consideration to devotee ability, local culture, devotee seniority, dedication, service, need for encouragement, and temple environment. ISKCON is a family where everyone should feel welcome. Although temple environments may differ, the underlying principle of facilitating ladies' *sadhana* must remain, based on an attitude of encouragement and respect.

19.2.2 Sannyasa Widows

For those widows in ISKCON whose husbands took *sannyasa* prior to March 1988, any needs that they may have for financial support shall be taken up on a case-by-case basis by the Health and Welfare committee. The Committee should act as a "placement agency" attempting to match widows with temples and service opportunities. The goal should be to find a temple which will provide shelter in exchange for reasonable service. ISKCON's obligation is to offer the same modest standard we offer to all devotees. If the widow is infirm and unable to be "placed", as above, the Health and Welfare Committee shall attempt to arrange general welfare support.

See also Women's Ministry (page 39.)

19.3 Child Protection

1. The local governing authority of each ISKCON school or community is responsible to appoint two or three devotees to investigate and follow-up on all suspected or confirmed cases of child abuse.
2. Suspected or confirmed cases of child abuse must be reported to local government authorities for investigation and/or prosecution. In India, the ISKCON Board of Education may authorize a waiver of this requirement if the perpetrator is willing to sign a statement authorizing the Board of Education to publicize the incident to all ISKCON-related educational projects and other concerned parties.

3. All suspected or confirmed incidents of child abuse must be reported immediately to the local GBC Zonal Secretary, and within thirty days, to the ISKCON Board of Education. The ISKCON Board of Education shall review the investigation and give a finding as to the status of the alleged perpetrator as confirmed, suspect, or innocent/not-suspected.

4. The perpetrator or alleged perpetrator must be immediately segregated so that he has no possible contact with the victim or other children. This segregation may take the form of relocating the perpetrator to another part of the project, away from children; banishment from the project (and possibly from other ISKCON projects with children); or in severe cases, banishment from all ISKCON projects. The degree of segregation will be determined by the nature and severity of the offense, the attitude of the perpetrator, the feasibility of protecting the children from further abuse or intimidation, and the sentiments of the local devotees, especially the parents. In no case should a confirmed or suspected perpetrator remain in the local community unless the local ISKCON authorities obtain the written authorization of no less than three fourths (3/4) of the parents of children at the project or in the community. The local government authorities and/or the ISKCON Board of Education will make the final determination of the appropriate degree of segregation.

5. Any confirmed child abuser may never again serve in association with children in any ISKCON project. The Board will also make available to all ISKCON educational projects and temples the names of all accused, admitted, confirmed or convicted child abusers.

6. Abused children must get appropriate professional counseling so that the serious ill-effects of the abuse can be minimized.

7. All ISKCON educational projects must have preventative programs which train children how to avoid and report child abuse incidents.

8. The local GBC members are directly responsible to implement the measures outlined above. Should the GBC Body find a GBC member or other ISKCON Leader's responsible for suppressing or covering-up complaints of child abuse, or supporting intimidation of those who might complain, the GBC member shall be open to censure or probation, and the ISKCON Leader shall be open to appropriate disciplinary action.(90)

9. Incidents of child molestation within ISKCON or ISKCON related organizations must be reported by the ISKCON authority to the local governmental agency or agencies for civil or criminal action, as appropriate. (89)

10. In countries such as India, where it is not practical to report child abusers to the police, the local GBC or Continental Committee must establish a mechanism whereby all child molestation incidents are thoroughly investigated, and confirmed abusers are banned from residing in or working in all ISKCON communities. Local resolutions confirming these actions must be forwarded in writing to the ISKCON GBC Board of Education, and all temples where the abusers may be likely to travel. The policy should be regularly explained to the devotees in these countries.(92)

See also Ministry of Health and Welfare (page 38.)

20 Farm Communities

20.1 Regulations

1. Farms can not be opened without prior approval of GBC. It can be done during the year by correspondence and through the GBC Property Committee.
2. No farm community shall be supported by a temple, but should be self sufficient from the beginning. Those farms opening can take a loan but must pay it back.

21 International Projects

21.1 Regulations

21.1.1 Board of Directors

For all international projects, (i.e. built with international funds) there shall be a Board Of Directors of not less than five or more than seven of which the local GBC shall act as the Managing Director. The Board Of Directors shall establish goals and strategies which they will be responsible to follow up on.(86)

21.2 Obligation of GBC Members In Relation to International Projects

The GBC members are obliged to support Srila Prabhupada's international priority projects such as Sridhama Mayapur, etc.(80)

21.3 Special Projects in India

1. Srila Prabhupada's desires and goals for expanding ISKCON activities through special projects in India (construction, development, maintenance, food distribution, etc.) is known to all GBC members. It is resolved that the GBC accepts the final responsibility for these.(79)

2. Regarding all construction projects in India, along with commissioning money for new projects, we must finish and maintain/repair all old projects, especially the international projects like Bombay, Vrndavana, Mayapur and New Delhi Glory of India. We should also seriously consider improving already established projects before constructing new ones.(81)

3. The Mayapur, Vrndavana, Bombay, and New Delhi Glory of India temples be accorded special status as the direct responsibility of the GBC Body as a whole, in addition to being the zonal assignment of individual GBC members. The entire GBC Body must discuss each of them at every annual meeting, must receive three reports per year from the management of each of these projects, and must be consulted on major decisions.(90)

21.3.1 Sri Mayapur Project

21.3.1.1 Construction of the Temple of Vedic Planetarium

21.3.1.1.1 Significance

From the completion of the Srila Prabhupada Centennial year (1997) ISKCON shall make the achievement of Srila Prabhupada's and the previous *acaryas'* dream to build the Mayapur Temple of Vedic Planetarium as the focus of all its activities until its completion (the twenty-year anniversary of Srila Prabhupada's foundation stone laying).

21.3.1.1.2 Guidelines

1. Maximum total cost for all things necessary to build the temple should be approved by the full GBC Body.
2. Total planning and construction time as approved by the GBC Body.
3. The temple must include:
 - a. As main deities, *Pañca-tattva*, *Radha-Madhava* and the eight *gopis*, and the *guru-parampara*.
 - b. Vedic planetarium.

c. Four *dhamas* exhibits.

d. *Kirtana* hall.

4. The temple shall be constructed for maximum longevity and minimum maintenance and upkeep.

5. Funding for this construction shall come from worldwide book distribution and worldwide fundraising efforts.(89)

6. The SMPDC (Sri Mayapur Project Development Committee) shall make a presentation at each year's festival to the general devotees regarding the Mayapur development plans.(90)

7. Formation of an institute to research the *Vedic* understanding of universal order, under the Bhaktivedanta Institute. The SMPDC will review their work.(78)

8. The entire GBC Body shall be the standing committee for insuring the development of Sri Mayapur Mandir and City, and they shall make an annual presentation to the GBC Body.

21.3.1.2 Sri Mayapur Project Development Committee

21.3.1.2.1 Definition

For implementing the desires of Srila Prabhupada and the previous *acaryas*, the GBC and ISKCON shall begin work on Sri Mayapur Project. To this effect, a development committee called "Sri Mayapur Project Development Committee,"(SMPDC) shall be responsible for planning and constructing the Mayapur project.

21.3.1.2.2 Duties

1. To plan for the Mayapur Project.

2. To construct the Mayapur Project.

3. To delegate responsibilities in order to realize the Mayapur Project.

4. To allocate funds for this project, once they have been contributed by the BBT and other sources.

5. To give an annual report to the GBC Body.

21.3.1.2.3 Powers

1. To expend funds without further sanction for the implementation, planning, etc. of the Sri Mayapur Development Project from any funds received.

2. To decide on proposals regarding the Sri Mayapur project and to sanction the plans, designs, programs and questions which arise.

3. To meet as required for the successful completion of the Temple of Vedic Planetarium construction and implementation, especially during the following stages:

a. Project formulation: estimates and cost flow evaluations, planning procedures, appointing engineer architects, etc.

b. Approval of preliminary drawings: modifications approximate cost, preliminary selection of materials, etc.

c. Approval of final design: last revisions, revision of approximative cost, etc.

d. Approval of interior plan: final modification of interior, etc.

e. Approval of estimates: hiring contractors, and on any other occasion as may be necessary.

4. To sanction the procurement of necessary and qualified devotees to work under the project, this sanction with the permission of local GBC and Temple President, provided the individual is agreeable.

5. To review the reports made by the various research groups and approve on the recommendation and implementation.
6. To be always in the awareness of the progress of the project, and to stimulate the ideals of the project of ISKCON at large.
7. To do all other things on behalf of the GBC which are required to further the Mayapur Development Project, and to give reports to the GBC at the annual meeting.
8. To appoint personnel on any committee formed for planning, research, etc. of the project.
9. This committee will elect a Chairman, a Vice-Chairman, a Secretary and a Project Director to co-ordinate the working of the committee, and their term shall be one year.
10. On the order of the Chairman (or in his absence, or non-availability, the Vice-Chairman) the Secretary will notify the committee members fifteen days in advance of the venue and of the next meeting, and that the quorum of the meeting thereby officially called shall be a majority of the members in person or by proxy.
11. The Chief Architect and the Head Supervisor shall be entitled to attend the meetings relating to their work, and that the SMPDC shall be entitled to call any one to sit in the meeting, or render a report before the committee, but that such ex-officio invitees, or others present shall have no voting power in the committee.
12. All other conditions in the "standing orders" regarding committee shall be followed.

21.3.1.2.4 Regulations

1. The SMPDC shall appoint a "working sub-committee or team" from any of its members for being immediately available to the planning department and other research groups and for dispensing funds sanctioned and made available by the previous decision of the SMPDC, and for doing all other things related as may be resolved by the committee as its representative.
2. The committee shall appoint a "Mayapur Planning Department," being a team of devotee architects, engineers, draftsmen, construction supervisors, etc., which shall be responsible to make plans, co-ordinate research groups, supervise construction, take quotations and tenders, work with professional architects, engineers and experts, and give regular reports to SMPDC and its working subcommittee.

21.3.1.2.5 Mayapur Project Fund Raising Committee

21.3.1.2.5.1 Definition

A committee is formed under the direction of the SMPDC for the specific purpose of fund raising all over the world for the Sri Mayapur project.(82)

21.3.1.2.5.2 Duties

1. To raise funds and co-ordinate the fund-raising for the Sri Mayapur Development Project including forming new parties, donations, and other means. It shall enjoy the co-operation of the rest of the Society in the implementation of their program.
2. The above fund raising committee shall elect its office bearers for one year and meet during the Mayapur festival and subsequently during the year, at least once, and may form sub-committee's reports which shall be submitted by the Fund Raising Committee to the SMDPC for their advice.

21.3.1.2.6 Research institute

1. A research institute styled as "Bhaktivedanta Universal Order Research Institute" (or "Bhaktivedanta Astronomical Research Institute", or BI) shall be established and research the Vedic understanding of the Universal order on a full-time basis for the purpose of erecting an exhibit at Sri Mayapur, and thereafter in other places, for giving public and scientific circles the real picture of the universe.

2. The above mentioned B.I. shall be financed under the auspices of the Sri Mayapur Development Project Committee's Fund.(78)

21.3.2 Vrndavana International Project

21.3.2.1 Focus of the Vrndavana Project

The Vrndavana ISKCON project shall be organized with the focus on education, i.e. that all aspects of the project will be seen as parts of a campus that exists to further the educational aims. All persons who come to the campus, for an hour, a week, a year, or any length of time, should find opportunities to be educated in Krsna consciousness.(90)

21.3.2.2 Save Vrndavana Campaign

ISKCON shall spearhead an international "Save Vrndavana" campaign, which could have tremendous preaching potential, both in India and abroad. A committee, the Save Vrndavana Campaign Committee, is hereby formed to take up the work. (90)

21.3.3 Jagannatha Puri Bhaktivedanta Asrama

1. That the Bhaktivedanta *asrama* in Jagannatha Puri shall be known as an international project. Funding for this project from the India Fund will await the completion of the Mayapur Temple and Planetarium.
2. That the development oversight of the thirty (30) acre land now in ISKCON's name in Jagannatha Puri will be under a Standing Committee known as the ISKCON Puri Development Committee. (IPDC).(91)

22 Sri Mayapur-Vrndavana Gaura-purnima Festival

22.1 Mayapur-Vrndavana Festival Committee

22.1.1 Definition

Srila Prabhupada instructed the worldwide devotees of ISKCON to annually gather together and observe a pilgrimage, *dhama-parikrama* and festival at the ISKCON center in Mayapur-*dhama* on the occasion of Gaura-purnima (the Appearance Day of Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu) and around that occasion to also observe a *parikrama* and festival at the ISKCON Temple in Vrndavana-*dhama*. This is known as the Sri Mayapur-Vrndavana Festival.

The Mayapur-Vrndavana Festival Committee shall discuss improvements in the Mayapur- Vrndavana Festival, and set programs.(77)

22.1.2 Membership of the Festival Committee

1. The GBCs of Sri Mayapur and Vrndavana are ex-officio permanent members of the committee.
2. The Regional Secretaries and Temple Presidents/Co-Directors/CEO of Sri Mayapur and Vrndavana or their assignees are permanent invitees to the committee.
3. Other committee members shall be elected every three years by the existing committee members by taking a representative from each continent from those volunteers who commit themselves to come and serve during the festival for a fixed period of time. Unexcused or repeated absence from the festival shall terminate committee membership.(83)

22.1.3 Duties

22.1.3.1 General Duties

1. To schedule the annual ISKCON Sri Mayapur-Vrndavana Festival.
2. To establish detailed programs, including seminars, processions, award ceremonies, classes, etc., during festivals. The purpose shall be to bring the ISKCON world community closer together and to increase the communication of Krsna conscious ideas and understanding among the participants as far as possible.
3. To develop new facilities for the festivals as required.
4. To establish journals, periodicals, pamphlets, manuals, etc., as required to further the objectives of the committee.
5. To confer awards, prizes, certificates, etc., upon deserving parties.
6. To take steps to insure that there are adequate festival facilities i.e., *prasadam*, rooms, *parikramas* in Vrndavana and Mayapur.(82)

22.1.3.2 Regarding Finances

1. The Secretary of the Sri Mayapur-Vrndavana Festival Committee will make available to the GBC, on request, a financial report of the income and expenditure of the Mayapur-Vrndavana Festival (shortly after the festival is finished).(82)
2. If there is any balance of funds it shall be invested to improving the festival facilities.(82)

3. To arrange to finance the festival through fixing and collecting individual festival fees, collecting donations, and other methods.
4. To manage the finances making allotments according to budget.
5. The festival income from fees shall not be considered as temple income, but kept in a separate fund. The Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival Committee is authorized to pay/contribute to the local Temple for room rent and facilities or services utilized.

22.1.3.3 Regarding Management

1. To directly, or through a delegated authority, manage, coordinate, and organize the annual ISKCON Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival and all *pandals*, *parikramas*, pilgrimages, and programs related thereto.
2. To appoint subcommittees, secretaries, cultural secretaries, coordinating secretaries, and all other officers.
3. To have the local (Mayapur and Vrindavana) temples participating in the festival program act as agents of the committee and follow the directives and standards of the committee during the period of the annual festival.
4. The Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival Committee is authorized to appoint any qualified devotee situated in a foreign country to assist in facilitating, promoting and coordinating the annual Gaura-purnima Festival by interfacing with the devotees and temples outside India in their assigned area. Such a devotee should have adequate time to devote to the annual festival service.(80)

22.1.4 Guidelines

The Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival Committee may, at their discretion, organize booths during the Annual festival for temples, regions, zones, countries or continents at Sri Mayapur, in which annually each temple, country or zone should exhibit their Krsna conscious achievements of the year. This will increase the enthusiasm of the devotees in general and inform the public of ISKCON's preaching achievements.(81)

22.2 General Regulations

1. The approved schedule for the annual Mayapur-Vrindavana festival shall be that the Vrindavana-*dhama* festival immediately follows the Mayapur-*dhama* festival, and any other festivals may be scheduled thereafter.(83)
2. An annual traveling *padayatra parikrama* of Navadvipa-*dhama*, following the example of Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura and Lord Nityananda, be organized with tents, and a full program be held as a part of the annual Gaura-purnima festival. To make this a success a maximum number of senior *Vaisnavas'* presence is requested.(81)
3. That all Regional Secretaries and Temple Presidents will be responsible for setting up their zonal exhibition booths at the annual Mayapur festival. This will be followed up by the Secretary of the Sri Mayapur-Vrindavana Festival Committee.(82)

22.3 General Guidelines

1. Zones may provide an audio-visual or video presentation for the festival and time shall be provided for exhibiting that to the GBC's and the devotees in general.(81)
2. All temples should try to at least send one representative along with as many men as possible to the Mayapur festival to resist weakening of ISKCON.(80)

23 ISKCON Related Organizations

23.1 General Regulations

1. Any ISKCON Ministry, organization, individual, or project (including those legally independent from ISKCON) receiving funding from ISKCON or the BBT, including mandatory assessments, taxes, and so forth, from temples and/or zones, be required to provide financial reports clearly delineating assets, liabilities, expenditures, and income. Such reports are to be submitted to the GBC Corresponding Secretary at least forty-five days prior to the beginning of the annual meeting, and shall be distributed to all GBC members and made available to other concerned ISKCON officials upon request.
2. The Corresponding Secretary shall compile a list of ISKCON Ministries, organizations, individuals, or projects to whom this resolution applies, and annually notify them of their report deadline at least sixty days in advance.
3. Anyone who is submitting a request for GBC/ISKCON funding should, along with their appeal, include their budget and previous financial reports for information. This resolution will not take effect until after the 1990 annual meeting.
4. All fund-raising activities performed by an ISKCON non-profit entity that are considered as un-related businesses which could endanger ISKCON should be separately incorporated and should comply with guidelines given by GBC legal advisors.(80)

23.2 The Bhaktivedanta Book Trust

23.2.1 General Regulations

1. Only the BBT has the right to publish any of Srila Prabhupada's books. All books published by the BBT shall be copyrighted by BBT International.
2. The BBT Trustees' eligibility to serve shall be approved by the GBC Body if the GBC Body finds a trustee unacceptable.
3. Only BBT books may be sold on *sankirtana* by ISKCON temples. Anyone who wishes to write a book for mass distribution shall present that book to the BBT trustees for approval.
4. BBT publications shall only be sold to customers (for their book distribution) who are not attacking ISKCON institutions or what ISKCON stands for.
5. Every publication from the BBT shall invite readers to correspond with either the secretary of the BBT or the temple of their choice. If possible, a list of temples shall appear in each publication. All names received requesting free books shall be immediately sent to appropriate temples, provided the temples pay the costs involved.(84)
6. If the establishment of a project within a particular zone will cause that zone or the temples within that zone to stop or greatly diminish their BBT remittance (i.e. the GBC mandate of 25-50%) the GBC Zonal Secretary must receive approval before the GBC Body at the annual Mayapur meeting.(86)
7. There shall be a GBC subcommittee known as the Supervisory Committee for India BBT Funds. This committee shall recommend to the GBC Body how to allocate funds given to ISKCON for India Projects by the BBT. The committee shall also audit and supervise the spending of those funds and make regular reports to the GBC Body and the trustees of the BBT.(89)

8. The GBC accepts the authenticity of the unabridged complete edition of the *Bhagavad-gita As It Is* published by North America BBT.
9. After the BBT Trustees have determined the amount of funds available for ISKCON projects, the GBC shall decide how to divide it.
10. All ISKCON literature published [in quantities over 5000 intended] for the public in mass distribution on *sankirtana*, must be published exclusively by the BBT or a center or publisher specifically authorized by the BBT.(75)
11. No ISKCON temple or other entity shall sell, give away, or otherwise permanently dispose of any original works of art which were created to illustrate Srila Prabhupada's (or other BBT) books. If temples wish to transfer ownership of these artworks, they must do so to another ISKCON temple or to the BBT.(89)
12. When a temple continues illegal means of *sankirtana*, the BBT trustees are authorized to do the needful to rectify.(77)
13. The GBC will decide how the BBT contributions for temple building in India, etc. shall be spent.(75)
14. BBT publications shall only be sold to customers (for their book distribution) who are not attacking ISKCON. Any former member of ISKCON who preaches against ISKCON shall be excommunicated or appropriately disciplined. It shall be prohibited to sell BBT publications to them by ISKCON members. If they are claiming to be officially members of ISKCON, they should be legally disenfranchised.(83)

23.2.2 Srila Prabhupada's Vyasa-puja Book

1. An annual *vyasa-puja* book for Srila Prabhupada shall be published by the BBT for the next ten thousand years.
2. A high-quality, hardbound Srila Prabhupada *vyasa-puja* book for the whole Society shall be published annually. It shall include offerings from all GBC members, ISKCON centers, and *sannyasis* worldwide. Continental *vyasa-puja* books are welcome additions.
3. The author of each temple's offering in the annual world *vyasa-puja* book shall be stated in the book.

23.2.3 Back to Godhead Magazine

There may be various co-editors of non-English BTG magazines but the English edition editor will be responsible to keep the standard. In this he will work in cooperation with the co-editors and BBT trustees of the various foreign language BTGs. As for the editorial policies he should follow, he shall take consultation from the GBC.(77)

23.3 Bhaktivedanta Institute

1. The Bhaktivedanta Institute (BI) is authorized to delegate someone in any zone or country to deal with the scientists more effectively.
2. BI goals shall annually be presented at the GBC meeting with a review report on the progress on the following year to the GBC in Mayapur. Also the BBT trustees are authorized to review and approve the annual budget for the BI each year. (80)
3. The BI will establish centers only after obtaining permission of the local GBC zonal Secretaries.(86)

23.4 Mayapur-Vrndavana Trust (MVT)

The MVT Committee, which controls the funds of the Mayapur-Vrndavana fund, shall submit yearly reports to the GBC on the expenditure from this fund.(77)

23.5 ISKCON Television, Inc.

That the GBC establishes a policy prohibiting "pirating", i.e., unauthorized duplicating of any ISKCON Television (ITV) videotapes, from now in perpetuity as the official policy of ISKCON for the benefit of the preaching effort. This includes any unauthorized duplication of any division of ISKCON engaged in producing video cassette.(81)

Annual Personal Financial Reporting (2000)

All GBC Body Members, gurus, sannyasis, and international project directors are required to file annual personal financial reports to the Executive Committee of the GBC Body and where requested, their National Executive Body. These reports shall contain a standard income statement and balance-sheet (to be reported in quick books or other standard software format). The report should also include a list of all ISKCON-related bank accounts (including Account Name, Signers, and Balance) for which these individuals are a signer or have some control. All guru-daksina must be included in this report.

Note: THE ABOVE IS AMENDED VIA RESOLUTION 322 OF 2008 TO BE APPLICABLE TO:

“All GBC Body members, gurus, and sannyasis, as well as GBC-appointed Ministers, International Project Directors, and anyone else who receives funds for activities that are directly authorized by the GBC Body, regardless of the source of those funds.”

Within the definition of the previous resolution regarding reportable income, all income and non-monetary gifts over US \$ 500/- must be itemized according to source.

(Note: US based preachers are reminded that all gifts over US \$ 10,000/- and income from inheritance or family trusts must be reported to the IRS).

All annual reports must be submitted by January 31st of each year and be signed with the following statement:

I solemnly swear that this report represents a true and accurate statement of my financial activities and status for the previous year.

Name_____ Date_____

The Executive Committee shall provide an annual report for the GBC Body prior to the annual meetings containing information on the number of GBC Body members filing, names of those not filing, and a summary report of the financial data including high, low and median numbers for income, assets and expenses.

24. ISKCON Global Excellence Awards

“Global Excellence Awards” be established to recognize outstanding contributions with ISKCON. The purpose of the awards is to recognize excellence in the field of devotional service and to encourage devotion in the various aspects and fields of Krsna conscious activities.

25. Miscellaneous / Appendices

1 Miscellaneous

All ISKCON official mouthpiece publications shall not be permitted to carry advertising for astrological services.

That in all ISKCON kirtans, the Hare Krsna maha-mantra should be the primary mantra.

Note: This is for kirtans, but does not apply to bhajans such as Jaya Radha Madhava, Nrsimha prayers, etc.

2.3 ISKCON's Position Statement on the Environment

Fostering a more simple and natural way of life is one of the founding principles of ISKCON. The members of the Society are therefore committed to helping solve the planet's environmental problems. These include water pollution, air pollution, toxic waste, nuclear and chemical accidents, destruction of wildlife, and desertification.

The environmental crisis is a product of a society that has become overly dependent upon destructive industrial technology. This dependency is rooted in reductionist science, which has removed God and the soul from the forefront of human concern. When people forget that nature is the property of God, they are driven to exploit it unlimitedly for their own material gratification.

2.4 Official Position Statement on ISKCON's Relationship with Hinduism

"The International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON), also known as the Hare Krsna movement, was founded by His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada. ISKCON follows the teachings of the Vedas and the Vedic scriptures, including *Bhagavad-gita* and the *Bhagavata Purana*; it teaches and practices Vaisnavism, or devotion to God in the supreme personal aspect of Radha-Krsna. ISKCON receives these teachings through the preceptorial line known as the *Brahma-Madhva-Gaudiya sampradaya*. This well-established traditional line descends through the respected teacher Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu (AD 1486-1534), the full incarnation of Sri Krsna, whose philosophy and practices unify the teachings of all four major Vaisnava Acaryas: Sri Madhvacarya, Sri Ramanujacarya, Sri Visnusvami, and Sri Nimbarkacarya.

"ISKCON embraces the chanting of the holy name of Krsna as a primary practice and accepts the concepts of transmigration, *karma*, vegetarianism (*ahimsa*), worship of the Deity (*sri vigraha*), and the preceptor-disciple (*guru- sisya*) relationship. Initiated members vow to refrain from gambling, illicit sex, intoxicants (including coffee, tea, and cigarettes), and non-vegetarian food.

"In this way ISKCON faithfully continues the core traditions of the Hindu faith. ISKCON's teachings are non-sectarian and non-denominational, for they are not limited to any particular historical religion. Vaisnavism inculcates the essential and universal principle of all religion. That principle, called *sanatana-dharma* in Sanskrit, denotes the natural and eternal activity of all living beings-loving devotional service to the one Supreme Personality of Godhead."(91)

3 Sample Recommendation Forms for Initiations

3.1 First Initiation

INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY FOR KRISHNA CONSCIOUSNESS

Founder-acarya: His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada

Center:

Date:

Official Recommendation for First Initiation

To (Name of guru):

Please accept my humble obeisances. All glories to Srila Prabhupada.

It is my pleasure to recommend (name of candidate)

for first initiation by you. I find that he/she has fulfilled the necessary qualifications for initiation to the best of my understanding. Specifically, for the last twelve months he/she has been engaged in favorable devotional service, has chanted sixteen rounds of *japa* daily, and has adhered to the four regulative principles. He/she is sufficiently knowledgeable in the philosophy of Krsna consciousness and the structure and purpose of ISKCON for initiation, as evidenced by passing an examination as prescribed under ISKCON Law. The candidate has accepted your shelter for at least six months. These qualifications have either been observed by me personally or I have heard of them from sources I know to be reliable.

Your servant,

Name / Title

3.2 Second Initiation

INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY FOR KRISHNA CONSCIOUSNESS

Founder-acarya: His Divine Grace A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupada

Center:

Date:

Official Recommendation for Second Initiation

To (Name of guru):

Please accept my humble obeisances. All glories to Srila Prabhupada.

It is my pleasure to recommend (name of candidate)

for second initiation by you. I find that he/she has fulfilled the necessary qualifications for this initiation to the best of my understanding. Specifically, for the last twelve months he/she has been engaged in favorable devotional service, has chanted sixteen rounds of *japa* daily, and has adhered to the four regulative principles. It has been more than one year since he/she received first initiation. These qualifications have either been observed by me personally or I have heard of them from sources I know to be reliable.

Your servant,

Name / Title

4 Sample Letter of Censure

A letter of Censure may be worded as follows:

"Dear _____ Maharaja/Prabhu,

Please understand that an ISKCON devotee is a member of Srila Prabhupada's family and as such has the duty to act in a befitting Krsna conscious manner demonstrating concern for your own and others spiritual welfare and for the well-being of ISKCON. Due to the reasons stated below you have been censured. A censure expresses disapproval of your conduct. A censure is an official note of caution. Please take due notice thereof and rectify the situation.

[insert reasons for censure]

[name and signature(s) of censoring authority]"

Other important resolutions:

2008/307. Jurisdiction of ISKCON Centers

[Statement] Whereas ISKCON has grown into an organization with multi-faceted preaching programs;

Whereas it may not be possible for a single temple or project to cover all such preaching programs;

Whereas the GBC would like to encourage ISKCON members' individual initiatives to preach;

RESOLVED: That multiple ISKCON entities can be accommodated in a particular city or geographical area. Such entities should work cooperatively with existing ISKCON temples and projects. Any concerns that arise in the course of expanding ISKCON's preaching in this fashion should be worked out amongst the leaders of those projects, and/or by the Zonal Secretary(s) for that area.

2014/305: Establishing the Division of Legal, Accounting and Regulatory Compliance

Whereas Srila Prabhupada wanted a high standard of legal, regulatory and accounting compliance in ISKCON with the aim of protecting the properties, preventing lawsuits, maintaining standards, etc.;

RESOLVED: The GBC Division of Legal, Accounting, and Regulatory Compliance is hereby established; the Division shall report to the Executive Secretariat.

The Compliance Division is authorized to request and receive legal and financial documentation from all over the world and all managers must make every effort to provide any information the Division may request in regard to the National Councils, projects, centers, etc. under their management—subject to the discretion of the GBC Zonal Secretary/ies.

Twice a year, before the AGM and midterm meetings, the Compliance Division Director shall submit to the GBC reports on national and local performance in regard to:

- Corporate-bylaws
- BoD succession provisions
- Oaths of Allegiance for all project leaders
- Property Trustee System (PTS) and other forms of property protection systems
- Intellectual Property such as trademarks, etc
- Other relevant information

Such reports will be provided also to each GBC zonal secretary for their confirmation of the reports' accuracy.

2015/305: Appointing Zonal Supervisors

Whereas the GBC has established the position of Zonal Supervisor, who assists the GBC Zonal Secretary/ies in managing a zone, and their process of appointment needs to be clarified

RESOLVED:

After successfully graduating from the GBC College of Leadership Development with the appropriate degree, a person can be appointed as Zonal Supervisor by the GBC Zonal Secretary/ies responsible for that zone.

The GBC Zonal Secretary/ies shall consult relevant leaders connected with the zone (including national or continental councils, etc. where present) before appointing the Zonal Supervisor.

The appointment shall be ratified by the GBC Body through a simple majority vote. The GBC's ratification is only required at the first appointment, not for every subsequent zonal appointment, even if in different places.

In rare cases, the GBC Body may ratify as Zonal Supervisors devotees who have not completed the standard course, but who are otherwise qualified for the service, by a two-thirds majority.

The appointment shall be on a probation basis for a year. After the probation period the GBC Zonal Secretary/ies shall retain the option of suspension or removal in case of non-performance or malfeasance. In case the Zonal Supervisor believes that there are grounds for appeal, he or she can approach the GBC EC for consideration.

2016/309: **Zonal Supervisors**

Whereas the process of zonal configuration has created the need for clarifying the exact title and service description for those who will supervise the new zones; Whereas the term "Regional Secretary" is not considered ideal for universal application;

Whereas the service of zonal supervision needs an internationally uniform process of appraisal and development of the candidate;

Whereas the newly ratified zones need zonal supervision:

RESOLVED:

1. The position of Zonal Supervisor is hereby established.
2. The Zonal Supervisor's primary duty and responsibility is to assist the GBC Zonal Secretary in the administration according to the service description delineated below.
3. Before formal appointment the candidate Zonal Supervisors shall undergo a standard process of assessment, induction, training and development administered under the supervision of the GBC Succession Committee.
4. By the 2014 GBC midterm meeting the SOA team (Succession, Organizational Development and Appointment Committees) shall produce and submit a comprehensive program that would constitute the above-mentioned standard process.
5. By 16 March 2014 GBC Zonal Secretaries shall submit nominations for potential Zonal Supervisor candidates to the GBC Succession Committee.
6. All other devotees who are presently conducting valuable service within ISKCON aside from this particular function of Zonal Supervisor (Regional Secretaries, non-GBC Zonal Secretaries, etc.) are encouraged to continue enthusiastically in their activities, with the same titles and present service descriptions.

Zonal Supervisor Service Description

(i) Preamble

This document outlines the skill sets and primary focus areas of a Zonal Supervisor, the ISKCON officer assisting a GBC zonal secretary in overseeing a particular territory defined "zone" (at the moment a zone could be constituted by: 1. a group of countries; 2. a single country; 3. more states/provinces within the same country; 4. a single state; 5. a part of a state). The "zone" shall preferably consist of the entire area within one of the above five zones, or possibly it may cover a portion. The essential feature is that a Zonal Supervisor **must** fulfill and perform **all** of the functions found within the service description below.

Primary responsibility: Assisting the GBC Zonal Secretary

Srila Prabhupada: “Divide the whole world into twelve parts. That is first . . . Gradually this GBC, they can take assistants to help them.” (Conversation with the GBC, 25 May 1972, Los Angeles)

From GBC Resolution (1979): “That the GBC recognizes that as per Srila Prabhupada's instructions that GBC men may have thousands of secretaries, individual GBC men may see the need for appointing assistants who will have greater responsibility than temple presidents.”

The GBC Zonal Secretary is the immediate authority of the Zonal Supervisor; the overall responsibility for the management and administration of the zone remains with the GBC Zonal Secretary.

1. Service Objective	To assist the GBC Zonal Secretary in fulfilling all his responsibilities as delineated in Srila Prabhupada’s instructions: “GBC means to be occupied with everything in the zone. It is not that now we are preachers we can neglect all other points. No, the GBC member is supposed to know everything and anything about the condition and situation of all matters within his jurisdiction. That is the meaning of secretary.” (Letter to Satsvarupa, 1 July 1972)
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2. Key Responsibilities (to be fulfilled directly or through delegation)	3.1 Demonstrates organizational and managerial capabilities; 3.2 Ensures the implementation of GBC resolutions, strategic initiatives and ISKCON Laws; ensures that GBC resolutions and position papers are appropriately circulated – in the necessary languages – throughout the zone. 3.3 Visits and provides guidance and inspiration to centers, projects and communities in the zone to ensure that spiritual standards are maintained and sustainable expansion is encouraged; promotes systematic qualitative and quantitative congregational development. 3.4 Establishes an annual schedule of time to be spent within zone, in collaboration with the respective local leadership; 3.5 Fosters trust and team spirit within the principles of unity in diversity; 3.6 Ensures that a Devotee Care plan is developed and implemented; which includes endeavoring to establish systematic training and education; 3.7 Develops and encourages practical plans to encourage book distribution; 3.8 Ensures that the appropriate standards of Deity worship are maintained; 3.9 Focuses on identifying potential ISKCON officers; 3.10 Actively encourages a system of succession; 3.11 Oversees the rectification of underperforming Temple Presidents and other officers and, if and when needed, takes steps to suspend or remove them, according to the procedures delineated in ISKCON Law, in consultation with the relevant GBC Zonal Secretary/ies and other administrative entities; 3.12 Facilitates and/or participates in the creation and implementation of systematic strategic planning; promotes and encourages communication strategies to strengthen ISKCON. 3.13 Endeavors to ensure financial solvency, protection of property, trademarks and compliance to other internal and external legal regulations 3.14 Attends national and regional meetings as required; 3.15 Submit and receives reports as required; 3.16 Ensures personal skills assessment and development where required; 3.17 Ensures that dispute resolution mechanisms are in place, and that constituents know how to access and utilize them; 3.18 Encourages devotees through guidance and friendship to sustain their commitment to the principles of Krishna consciousness; 3.19 Handles management questions, philosophical queries and personal problems of management; 3.20 Builds organizational capabilities by evaluating likely future scenarios (through environmental scanning) and ensuring that individuals pursue the best possible development opportunities in line with these; 3.21 Assists the GBC Zonal Secretary’s global mandate by contributing relevant suggestions for new or modified GBC legislation and other observations. 3.22 Remains a servant of the GBC Zonal Secretary and of the GBC body for any other service that maybe required from time to time, including emergency assignments.
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4. Core Competence 4.1 Personal			
4.2 Knowledge	4.2 Knowledge	A Zonal Supervisor should be knowledgeable in Srila Prabhupada’s books, Srila Prabhupada’s instructions about management, and should be familiar with ISKCON Law.	

4.3 Experience	A Zonal Supervisor should, ideally, have successfully performed in other leadership positions within ISKCON.
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4.4 Technical competencies	At the very least technical skills include computer literacy, basic negotiation skills, competence to read financial statements, basic budgeting skills and risk management ability or should ensure that such skills be available within the local community.
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4.5 Problem solving, planning and decision making	The Zonal Supervisor must have the capacity to respond to or to seek third party assistance (e.g.: ISKCONResolve) in matters of interpersonal conflicts, socio-economic challenges and matters of regulatory compliance. He/she must be able to make decisions autonomously and to set short, medium and long term goals.
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2 Position Papers

2.1 "On My Order" Understood

ISKCON devotees and leaders have repeatedly requested a clear vision from the GBC on Srila Prabhupada's order in 1977 regarding continuing the disciplic succession, but as yet it has not been presented. Many interpretations of the "appointment tapes" have been published by the GBC and outside parties, many inimical to ISKCON, and a clear GBC stand would help ISKCON devotees in their preaching and search for unity in diversity. A clearer concept and a general consensus on many things have been achieved after discussions and philosophical research. The *siddhanta* in regard to *guru-tattva* in ISKCON has been unclear, and there is a need for a statement from the GBC to give direction. Therefore it is resolved that the following conclusions are accepted as the official GBC position in regard to Srila Prabhupada's instructions regarding continuing the disciplic succession:

1. Srila Prabhupada's explicit and consistent desire and program had always been that eventually His Divine Grace's disciples and followers would take up the service of initiating new disciples into the disciplic succession as initiating *gurus* 1. This procedure is supported by all evidence from *sadhu*, *sastra* and *guru* as the bona fide method of continuing the disciplic succession. In fact, this is the only concept of continuing the disciplic succession ever mentioned by Srila Prabhupada.

2. In 1977, Srila Prabhupada repeatedly said he would "select," "choose," "appoint," or "designate" some disciples to take up the service of initiating new disciples. When Srila Prabhupada was asked who would initiate after his physical departure he stated he would "recommend" and give his "order" to some of his disciples who would initiate on his behalf during his lifetime and afterwards as "regular *gurus*," whose disciples would be Srila Prabhupada's grand-disciples. Srila Prabhupada repeatedly cited Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu's statement "*amara ajñaya guru hoiya*" and stated that one would be eligible to act as an initiating *guru* based "on my order", i.e. on the "order" of Srila Prabhupada as the representative of Lord Caitanya.² Subsequently, Srila Prabhupada named some disciples to initiate on his behalf, as he had previously stated.³ Although Srila Prabhupada did not repeat his earlier statements, it was understood that he expected these disciples to initiate in the future. Srila Prabhupada stated that being a spiritual master is "not difficult," that the primary qualification for is to "strictly follow" the previous spiritual masters.⁴ Srila Prabhupada's repeated use of the phrase "on my order" makes it abundantly clear that those who would be "selected" were simply to strictly carry out His Divine Grace's "order", and as long as they did so they would be bona fide spiritual masters. It is up to Srila Prabhupada's followers to be and remain qualified by strictly following his instructions.

3. In ISKCON, the basis of anyone's acting as an ISKCON spiritual master is the transcendental "order" of Srila Prabhupada, which conveys in succession the divine order of Lord Caitanya Mahaprabhu. It is therefore clear that Srila Prabhupada's use of words like "appoint," "recommend" or "select" was not in the mundane sense of appointing someone to a post or position, and certainly not to some state of "realization," nor as a full endorsement of qualification, as has been commonly misunderstood, but is rather a conditional mandate dependent on the follower's "strictly following" the "order" of the spiritual master. In fact, the Sanskrit word "*ajña*" means to be the order-carrier or to represent a higher authority. Failing to "follow strictly" the "order" of the previous *acaryas* would disenfranchise the putative *guru*.⁵ Although Srila Prabhupada was a pure devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa and a liberated soul, he humbly presented as his only qualification that he was a humble

"servant of the servant," that he was simply carrying out the "order" and strictly following the instructions of his spiritual master, Om VisAupada Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura, who was a liberated soul. Srila Prabhupada taught by example. Therefore, His Divine Grace's "selecting" someone would be to do what Srila Prabhupada stated he was doing, i.e. simply to "carry out the order" of the previous *acaryas*.⁶ Reinforcing that truth is Srila Prabhupada's well-known instruction that a spiritual master must always consider himself a disciple and servitor of his own *guru*.

4. After Srila Prabhupada named some disciples to initiate, his personal secretary suggested some others for also starting to initiate, but Srila Prabhupada, after considering the matter, said they were not yet ready. His Divine Grace said the GBC could consider and later add others when needed. Thus, by delegating that duty to the GBC, Srila Prabhupada personally detailed the procedure for increasing the number of initiating *gurus*. Earlier, His Divine Grace had taught Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura's instruction that his GBC would be responsible to "elect" qualified devotees to be initiating *gurus*. When asked who would succeed him, His Divine Grace said that he "gave the legacy" to all his disciples and whoever strictly follows him is qualified to succeed him.⁷

5. When a devotee is allowed to carry out the "order" of Srila Prabhupada to expand the disciplic succession by initiating new disciples, it is not to be taken as a certification or endorsement of his being an "*uttama-adhikari*," "pure devotee," or to having achieved any specific state of realization. It is simply a statement that the devotee has been given permission to execute the "order" to serve as a *guru* because it was considered that he was "strictly following" Srila Prabhupada's instructions and had maintained an adequately exemplary *sadhana* and behavior up to the standard approved for serving as a *guru*. Moreover, Srila Prabhupada never stated that he was appointing an "*acarya*" or an independent or "absolute authority" for the *sampradaya*. To the contrary, His Divine Grace established the GBC and said that the GBC would be the "ultimate managing authority" for all affairs (material and spiritual) of the society in accordance to *sadhu*, *sastra* and *guru*.⁸ *Gurus* and disciples are expected to cooperate and follow the decisions of the GBC as desired of Srila Prabhupada.

6. It may be that in the future a devotee may achieve great realization and advancement in Krsna consciousness and become a "self-effulgent *acarya*," a renowned "*acarya*" for the *sampradaya*, but Srila Prabhupada stated such things are not to be confirmed by administrative decrees or actions. If an advanced devotee's spiritual qualities are "self-effulgent," devotees may naturally accept him as an "*acarya*" or advanced or realized spiritual master and his association and guidance will be sought, but the GBC cannot "rubber stamp" him nor change ISKCON's system of management consequently. ISKCON will continue to be managed as Srila Prabhupada provided without "change" by the GBC. That is Srila Prabhupada's instruction.⁹

7. Uninitiated ISKCON devotees should seek out a spiritual master who is strictly following Srila Prabhupada's instructions and representing Srila Prabhupada, with full faith that by following such a spiritual master who is strictly following a liberated soul; they will achieve the same results obtainable by serving Srila Prabhupada directly. (Other instructions in this regard may be separately published.)

8. Disciples are to respect their spiritual masters as direct representatives of Krsna, i.e. as "*saksad dharitvena*," in accordance with *sastras*. Disciples should worship their spiritual master according to their faith and according to the standard *Vaisnava* etiquette approved by ISKCON. All ISKCON devotees should encourage disciples in developing faith in their spiritual masters.

2.1.1 Notes

1. As early as 1967 Srila Prabhupada wrote:

"Anyone following the order of Lord Caitanya under the guidance of His bonafide representative, can become a spiritual master and I wish that in my absence all my disciples become bonafide spiritual masters to spread Krsna Consciousness throughout the whole world." (Letter to Madhusudana 02-11-1967)

and in 1968 he wrote to Hamsaduta:

"Maybe by 1975 all of my disciples will be allowed to initiate and increase the number of the generations. That is my program." (Letter to Hamsaduta Swami)

Also,

"Therefore if anyone is anxious to be initiated, he should first of all hear our philosophy and join chanting at least for three months, and then if required, I shall send chanted beads for him if you recommend. As we are doing here. Don't be allured by such *maya*. I am training you all to become future spiritual masters, but do not be in a hurry. (08-21-1968, Letter to Acyutananda and Jaya Govinda)

"I am just trying to disseminate this message of my spiritual master and if there's any credit for this service, everything goes to Him. This message of Kṛṣṇa Consciousness is coming down from Kṛṣṇa Himself, and we are all servants of the Supreme Lord working under the consecutive disciplic succession. Please try to understand our philosophy through various books that I have already published and sometimes after you will have to carry out this order of disciplic succession." (03-14-1969, Letter to Prahlaṇanda)

"Some time ago you asked my permission for accepting some disciples, now the time is approaching very soon when you will have many disciples by your strong preaching work. Stick to the line of our strong preaching method and many misguided persons will be blessed by your proper guiding." (05-16-1972, Letter to Acyutananda)

"I have heard that there is some worship of yourself by the other devotees. Of course it is proper to offer obeisances to a Vaiṣṇava, but not in the presence of the spiritual master. After the departure of the spiritual master, it will come to that stage, but now wait. Otherwise it will create factions." (10-01-1974, Letter to Hamsaduta Dasa)

"Now has the GBC become more than *guru* Maharaja? As if simply GBC is meant for looking after pounds, shilling, pence. The GBC does not look after spiritual life. That is a defect. All of our students will have to become *guru*, but they are not qualified. This is the difficulty." (11-10-1975, Letter to Alalanatha Dasa)

"Keep trained up very rigidly and then you are bonafide *guru*, and you can accept disciples on the same principle. But as a matter of etiquette it is the custom that during the lifetime of your spiritual master you bring the prospective disciples to him, and in his absence or disappearance you can accept disciples without any limitation. This is the law of disciplic succession. I want to see my disciples become bonafide spiritual master and spread Kṛṣṇa consciousness very widely, that will make me and Kṛṣṇa very happy." (12-02-1975, Letter to Tusta Kṛṣṇa Swami)

2. Vr̥ndavana, May 28, 1977

Satsvarupa: By the votes of the present GBC. Then our next question concerns initiations in the future, particularly at that time when you're no longer with us. We want to know how first and second initiation would be conducted.

Prabhupada: Yes. I shall recommend some of you. After this is settled up, I shall recommend some of you to act as officiating *acaryas*.

Tamala Kṛṣṇa: Is that called *rtvik-acarya*?

Prabhupada: *rtvik*, yes.

Satsvarupa: Then what is the relationship of that person who gives the initiation and the...

Prabhupada: He's *guru*. He's *guru*.

Satsvarupa: But he does it on your behalf.

Prabhupada: Yes. That is formality. Because in my presence one should not become *guru*, so on my behalf, on my order... *Amara ajñāya guru hañā*. Be actually *guru*, but by my order.

Satsvarupa: So they may also be considered your disciples.

Prabhupada: Yes, they are disciples. Why consider? Who?

Tamala Krsna: No, he's asking that these *rtvik-acaryas*, they're officiating, giving *diksa*. Their... The people who they give *diksa* to, whose disciples are they?

Prabhupada: They're his disciples.

Tamala Krsna: They're his disciples.

Prabhupada: Who is initiating. He is granddisciple.

Satsvarupa: Yes.

Tamala Krsna: That's clear.

Satsvarupa: Then we have a question concer...

Prabhupada: When I order, "You become *guru*," he becomes regular *guru*. That's all. He becomes disciple of my disciple. That's it...

Prabhupada: And Caitanya Mahaprabhu says, *amara ajñaya guru hañā*. One can understand the order of Caitanya Mahaprabhu, he can become *guru*. Or one who understands his *guru's* order, the same *parampara*, he can become *guru*. And therefore I shall select some of you. (hums)

It should also be noted that in most cases when Srila Prabhupada spoke about his disciples becoming *gurus* he cited the *amara ajñaya* verse.

3. July 7, 1977, Vrindavana

Tamala Krsna: Those are their favorite words. Srila Prabhupada? We're receiving a number of letters now, and these are people who want to get initiated. So up until now, since your becoming ill, we asked them to wait.

Prabhupada: The local, mean, senior *sannyasis* can do that.

Tamala Krsna: That's what we were doing... I mean, formerly we were... The local GBC, *sannyasis*, were chanting on their beads, and they were writing to Your Divine Grace, and you were giving a spiritual name. So should that process be resumed, or should we...? I mean one thing is that it's said that the spiritual master takes on the... You know, he takes on the... He has to cleanse the disciple by... So we don't want that you should have to... Your health is not so good, so that should not be... That's why we've been asking everybody to wait. I just want to know if we should continue to wait some more time.

Prabhupada: No, the senior *sannyasis*...

Tamala Krsna: So they should continue to...

Prabhupada: You can give me a list of *sannyasis*. I will mark who will...

Tamala Krsna: Okay.

Prabhupada: You can do. Kirtanananda can do. And our Satsvarupa can do. So these three, you can give, begin.

Tamala Krsna: So supposing someone is in America, should they simply write directly to Kirtanananda or Satsvarupa?

Prabhupada: Nearby. Jayatirtha can give.

Tamala Krsna: Jayatirtha.

Prabhupada: Bhavanan..., er, Bhagavan. And he can do also. Harikesa.

Tamala Krsna: Harikesa Maharaja.

Prabhupada: And... Five, six men, you divide who is nearest.

Tamala Krsna: Who is nearest. So persons wouldn't have to write to Your Divine Grace. They could write directly to that person?

Prabhupada: Hm.

Tamala Krsna: Actually they are initiating the person on Your Divine Grace's behalf. Those persons who are initiated are still your...

Prabhupada: Second initiation we shall think over, second initiation.

Tamala Krsna: This is for first initiation, okay. And for second initiation, for the time being they should...

Prabhupada: No, they have to wait. Second initiation, that should be given...

Tamala Krsna: Should... Some devotees are writing you now for second initiation, and I'm writing them to wait a while because you're not well. So can I continue to tell them that?

Prabhupada: They can do second initiation.

Tamala Krsna: By writing you.

Prabhupada: No. These men.

Tamala Krsna: These men, they can also do second initiation. So there's no need for devotees to write to you for first and second initiation. They can write to the man nearest them. But all these persons are still your disciples. Anybody who gives initiation is doing so on your behalf.

Prabhupada: Yes.

Tamala Krsna: You know that book I'm maintaining of all of your disciples' names? Should I continue that?

Prabhupada: Hm.

Tamala Krsna: So if someone gives initiation, like Harikesa Maharaja, he should send the person's name to us here and I'll enter it in the book. Okay. Is there someone else in India that you want to do this?

Prabhupada: India, I am here. We shall see. In India, Jayapataka.

Tamala Krsna: Jayapataka Maharaja.

Prabhupada: You are also in India.

Tamala Krsna: Yes.

Prabhupada: You can note down these names.

Tamala Krsna: Yes, I have them.

Prabhupada: Who are they?

Tamala Krsna: Kirtanananda Maharaja, Satsvarupa Maharaja, Jayatirtha Prabhu, Bhagavan Prabhu, Harikesa Maharaja, Jayapataka Maharaja and Tamala Krsna Maharaja.

Prabhupada: That's nice. Now you distribute.

Tamala Krsna: Seven. There's seven names.

Prabhupada: For the time being, seven names, sufficient. You can make Ramesvara.

Tamala Krsna: Ramesvara Maharaja.

Prabhupada: And Hrdayananda.

Tamala Krsna: Oh, yeah. South America.

Prabhupada: So without waiting for me, wherever you consider it is right... That will depend on discretion.

Tamala Krsna: On discretion.

Prabhupada: Yes.

Tamala Krsna: That's for first and second initiations.

Prabhupada: Hm.

4. Make sure that they are well aware of the four rules and regulations and that they are fixed in chanting the prescribed number of sixteen rounds daily on the beads. Without these two principles no one can make advancement on the path of regulated *bhakti*. Teach them the science of the *Bhagavad-gita* and train them to be first class representatives of Krsna. It is not very difficult, simply one has to hear from the perfect authority who is in disciplic succession from Krsna Himself, and then repeat the same message without any change. If one does this then he is qualified to become *guru*. (Letter to Jayadharma 08-20-1976)

Guru is only one. *guru* means, as you explained, *ajñāna-timirandhasya jñānāñjana-salakaya, caksur unmilitam yena tasmai sri-gurave namaḥ*. One who eradicates the *ajñāna*, *andhakara*, darkness. In the darkness, if somebody brings lamp, *ajñāna-timirandhasya jñānāñjana-salakaya*... The *jñāna-rupa*, torchlight, he's *guru*. So maybe of different degrees, but anyone who opens the spiritual eyes, he's *guru*.

But it doesn't matter that degree. Actually, if the *guru* teaches Krsna consciousness, then he may be in lesser degree, but he's accepted as *guru*. There is no question of rejection. Because Krsna is actually *jñāna*. One who teaches Krsna as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, "One has to know Krsna, one has to surrender to Krsna," this kind of teaching is required.

So the real test is whether the *guru* is a Vaisnava, whether he knows the science of Krsna. That is also confirmed by Caitanya Mahaprabhu: *kiba vipra kiba sudra nyasi kene naya, yei krsna-tattva vetta sei guru haya*. A... It doesn't matter what he is, whether he's a *sannyasi* or a *grhastha* or a *brahmana* or a *su...*, born in *brahmana* family or... It doesn't matter. *Yei krsna-tattva*. Anyone who knows Krsna, he can become *guru*, not others. So that is the statement of the *sastras*. Avaisnava cannot become *guru*. (Lecture, Ahmedabad 12-13-1972)

Just like post peon give you five thousand rupees, delivers. He does not deliver. Somebody else is delivering. He's simply carrying. That's all. Similarly, if we simply carry the message of Krsna as it is, we become perfect. It is not very difficult. If I simply carry the message of Krsna, where is the difficulty? Everything is there. Krsna has said everything. Krsna says, *man-mana bhava mad-bhakto mad-yaji mam namaskuru*. We carry this message. Just always think of Krsna, always offer obeisances to Krsna, become a devotee of Krsna. *Man-man-af*, think of Krsna always. We have to carry this message. Where is the difficulty? So to become a bona fide spiritual master, there is no difficulty. If you, simply, if we carry the message of Krsna as it is without any adulteration. So we must find out a person who is actually bona fide spiritual master by this test: that he's not-I mean to say-adulterating Krsna's message. He's not playing havoc with the message of Krsna in order to introduce himself, his person. He's simply presenting the message of Krsna as it is. Then he's spiritual master. Nobody else. Thank you very much. (NOD Lecture, Vrndavana 10-31-1972)

So Caitanya Mahaprabhu says *amara ajñāya guru hañā tara ei desa yare dekha tare kaha krsna-upadesa*.

He says, *amara ajñāya*. by My order, you become a spiritual master.

So one may be very illiterate, no education, (and) or no scholarship, may not be born in *brahmana* family, or may not be a *sannyasi*. There are so many qualifications. But one may not have all these qualifications. He may be rascal number one, but still, he can become spiritual master. How? *Amara ajñāya*. As Krsna says, as

Caitanya Mahaprabhu says, if you follow, then you become spiritual master. One may be rascal number one from material estimation, but if he simply strictly follows whatever is said by Caitanya Mahaprabhu or His representative spiritual master, then he becomes a *guru*. (Vyasa-puja address, London 08-21-1973)

It is Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu's wish that everyone should become a Vaisnava and *guru*. Following the instructions of Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu and His disciplic succession, one can become a spiritual master, for the process is very easy. One can go everywhere and anywhere to preach the instructions of Krsna.

... the duty of every Vaisnava is to travel and preach *Bhagavad-gita*, either in his country or a foreign country. (Cc.M. 24.277)

" We do not have to manufacture anything new. We are getting perfect knowledge from Krsna through the disciplic succession, so our position is very firm. Whatever we hear from the bonafide spiritual master should be practiced in life and the same message delivered to whomever we meet. In this way you become spiritual master. (Letter to Kirtiraja 12-31-1975)

5. This time I have requested all Nairobi important friends that: "Now you take *sannyasa* and become *guru*. Krsna Caitanya Mahaprabhu asked everyone to become *guru*. *Amara ajñaya guru haña tara ei desa*. You have come to Africa. Now become their *guru* and deliver them." "Now, how shall I do it?" *Yare dekha tare kaha krsna-upadesa*: "Simply speak. Don't become very big upstart. Simply speak what Krsna has done. That's all. You become *guru*." (Conversation, Bombay 03-11-1975)

Bambarambhe laghu-kriya, in the Sanskrit word, that you can make a very high-grade arrangement, but the result is zero. So that hierarchical arrangement is exactly not in Krsna consciousness. But our method is very simple. If one is fortunate enough to meet a bona fide spiritual master and if he acts strictly under his discipline, he also becomes within a very short time another spiritual master. (Interview, Seattle 09-24-1976)

Because people are in darkness, we require many millions of *gurus* to enlighten them. Therefore Caitanya Mahaprabhu's mission is, He said, that "Everyone of you become *guru*." *Amara ajñaya guru haña tara ei desa*. You haven't got to go foreign countries. Wherever you are, you teach; become *guru*. It doesn't matter. *Ei desa*. He says, *ei desa*. If you have got power, you can go other country but it doesn't require. In whichever village, whichever country or town you are, you become a *guru*. This is Caitanya Mahaprabhu's mission. *Amara ajñaya guru haña tara ei desa*. "This country, this place." So "But I have no qualification. How can I become *guru*?" There is no need of qualification. "Still, I can become *guru*?" Yes. "How?" *Yare dekha tare kaha krsna-upadesa*: "Whomever you meet, you simply instruct what Krsna has said." That's all. You become *guru*. Everyone is very anxious to become *guru*, but rascal does not know how to become *guru*, a simple thing.

So that is our mission. All of you who have come to Krsna consciousness movement, that is our request, that you, all of you, become *guru* but don't speak nonsense. That is request. Simply speak what Krsna has said. Then you become *brahmana*. You'll be *guru*, and everything. Thank you very much. (Lecture, Honolulu 05-21-1976)

Caitanya Mahaprabhu said that "You become a *guru*." *Amara ajñaya guru haña tara ei desa*. "You become a *guru* and deliver them." So "I am a fool. I have no education. How can I become a *guru*?" So answer is "No, no. *Yare dekha tare kaha krsna-upadesa*." If you simply advise people what Krsna has said, then you become *guru*. But if you manufacture your ideas, then you are not a *guru*. (Conversation Bombay 01-07-1977)

Amara ajñaya guru haña tara ei desa. Suppose you are living in that village. Caitanya Mahaprabhu says, "You become a *guru* here." Here. You haven't got to go out. *Ei desa*, "where you are living." Just see how nice it is. *Amara ajñaya*: "By My order, you become a *guru* and deliver the people of this place." This is Caitanya Mahaprabhu's... So "I am not educated, I do not know. How I shall become?" No, you haven't got to bother. *Yare dekha tare kaha krsna-upadesa*: "Simply you repeat what Krsna has said. You become *guru*." That's all. Everyone can do that. *Gita* is there. You sit down in your place and preach *Bhagavad-gita* and try to induce them to take it. You become *guru*. (Conversation, Bombay 04-23-1977)

Our Caitanya Mahaprabhu's mission is that "You become *guru*," as I was telling, "and teach, deliver persons where you are." If you say, "How can I become *guru*?" there is no difficulty. Simply repeat the words of *Bhagavad-gita*. That's all. You become *guru*. So our mission is to create real *guru*, not these jugglers. And real *guru* is he who speaks on behalf of Kṛṣṇa. And that is wan... It is very simple.

This is our mission. Everything is there. Caitanya Mahaprabhu says, *yare dekha tare kaha kṛṣṇa-upade...* "You simply make your life successful by understanding *Bhagavad-gita* and preach this. You become *guru*." So where is the difficulty? Why don't you do that? (Conversation, Bombay 04-24-1977)

This is very easy. So I am not a scholar. I am simply... Whatever is said there, I am trying to distribute in a palatable way. That's all. It is not my manufacture. And that is Caitanya Mahaprabhu's... *Amara ajñaya guru hañā tara ei desa*. You all become *guru*. "How can I become *guru*? I have no education. I have no knowledge." No, you haven't got to acquire all these things. That is already... *Yare dekha tare kaha*. Finished. So I never tried to become a scholar. But I tried, whatever is spoken by Kṛṣṇa, deliver. That's all. And that is *guru*. (Conversation, Vrndavana 06-26-1977)

6. "Personally I am humble servant of Kṛṣṇa as you are also, but I am deputed to accept your service just to transfer it to Kṛṣṇa as via media. I shall try to do this service to you and Kṛṣṇa throughout my life, and I am so proud to have such assistants as you are to help me in my mission to push on the Kṛṣṇa Consciousness Movement." (Letter to Dayananda, 05-01-1969)

"You are all my children and I love my American boys and girls who are sent to me by my spiritual master and I have accepted them as my disciples." (Letter to Satsvarupa and Uddhava, 07-27-1970)

"Practically, I do not have any disciples; I select so many masters to train them in the service of the Lord." (Letter to Jai Mazo, 01-18-1968)

"I have not done anything personally, very wonderful. I am simply serving my spiritual master, Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Gosvami Maharaja and all the *acaryas* in the disciplic succession." (Letter to Bhima Dasa et al, 05-16-1974)

6. November 2, 1977

Prabhupada: ...after you, who will take the leadership?" And "Everyone will take, all my disciples. If you want, you can take also. (laughter) But if you follow. They are prepared to sacrifice everything, so they'll take the leadership. I may, one, go away, but there will be hundreds, and they'll preach. If you want, you can also become a leader. We have no such thing, that 'Here is leader.' Anyone who follows the previous leadership, he's a leader. 'Indian,' we have no such distinction, 'Indian,' 'European.'"

Brahmananda: They wanted an Indian to be the leader?

Prabhupada: Yes. (laughs) "Everyone, all my disciples, they are leaders. As purely as they follow, they become leader. If you want to follow, you can become a leader. You are Indian. But you don't want." I told them that.

Tamala Kṛṣṇa: Yes, they probably wanted to propose somebody who would take over our movement.

Prabhupada: Yes. Leaders. All nonsense. Leader means one who has become first-class disciple. He is leader. *Evam parampara-prapta...* One who is perfectly following... Our instruction is *ara na kariha mane asa*. You know this? What is that? *Guru-mukha-padma-vakya, cittete kariya aikya, ara na kariha mane asa*. Who is leader? A leader, to become leader, is not very difficult, provided one is prepared to follow the instructions of a bona fide *guru*.

7. See Prabhupada's will.

8. "He [Srila Bhaktisiddhanta] never asked anybody to become *acarya*. He asked that 'You form a governing body of twelve men and go on preaching. . . .' None, none of them were advised by guru Maharaja to become *acarya*. His idea was 'Let them manage; then whoever will be actually qualified for becoming *acarya*, they will elect. Why I should enforce upon them?' That was his plan. 'Let them manage by strong governing body, as it is going on. Then *acarya* will come by his qualifications.'" (Conversation, Bombay 09-21-1973)

"His [Srila Bhaktisiddhanta's] idea was *acarya* was not to be nominated amongst the governing body... a self-effulgent *acarya* would be automatically selected." (Letter to Rupanuga, 04-28-1974)

"A *vaisnava acarya* is self-effulgent, and there is no need for any court judgment." (Cc. M 1.220)

"A powerful Vaisnava who has converted others into Vaisnavas is to be worshipped, but because of material contamination, sometimes such an exalted Vaisnava is disrespected by other, minor Vaisnavas."

"... It has actually been seen that even an authorized devotee who is engaged in the service of the Lord by preaching the mission of Krsna consciousness is sometimes criticized by neophyte devotees."

" ... Neophytes, unable to appreciate the exalted service of the advanced devotee, try to bring the *maha-bhagavata* to their platform. We experience such difficulty in propagating this Krsna consciousness all over the world. Unfortunately we are surrounded by neophyte Godbrothers who do not appreciate the extraordinary activities of spreading Krsna consciousness all over the world. They simply try to bring us to their platform, and they try to criticize us in every respect. We very much regret their naïve activities and poor fund of knowledge. An empowered person who is actually engaged in the confidential service of the Lord should not be treated as an ordinary human being, for it is stated that unless one is empowered by Krsna, one cannot spread the Krsna consciousness movement all over the world." (NOI, Text 6, pp.64)

2.2 Devotees Initiating Before Their Guru's Physical Departure

2.2.1 Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura's View

Some of Srila Prabhupada's godbrothers were approached to find out what Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura's view was on this issue. All of them informed [us] that none of his disciples gave initiation when he was present. His Divine Grace did not instruct anyone to give initiation during his presence nor for that matter did he give any specific instructions about them initiating after his disappearance.

In the Gaudiya Matha, after Srila Om VisAupada Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura's disappearance, the etiquette of not initiating in the presence of the spiritual master has continued. In fact, if anyone breaks from this tradition, he is excommunicated from their mission.

2.2.1.1 Srila Bhaktisiddhanta's Instructions

Although apparently Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura did not specifically, in black and white, instruct anything about a disciple not giving initiation when the *guru* is present, it is quite clearly implied in the instructions below. The question of initiating in the presence of one's *guru* is inappropriate for a disciple who naturally is cultivating his service attitude to the *guru*. Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura was very emphatic about the disciple's sincere dedication to his *guru*. The following quotes are from a Bengali book called Sri Srila Prabhupader Upadesamrta:

Q: Will I be able to accept disciples?

A: "Give up envy and show mercy to living entities-living entities who become averse to Krsna, make them Krsna conscious. Do not become a *guru* to become envious. Do not become a *guru* in order to drown yourself in sense gratification-do not become a *guru* just for show off. But if you can become a sincere servant of your *guru* and Krsna, if you can receive their mercy-potency, then there is nothing to fear. Otherwise there will be disaster." (p. 235)

"If one is not dedicated to his *guru* he can not be qualified to be a *guru*." (p. 337)

Q: What is the difference between *guru* and me?

A: I am lighter than the lightest; even lighter than that. But one who is serving the greatest constantly, that spiritual master is greater than the greatest; even greater than that. (p. 235)

Q: Is it true that without the mercy of the spiritual master nothing can be achieved?

A: Yes. I am blind, who will show me the way other than the *guru*? Everything is achieved by the mercy of the *guru*. We are *laghu* (light), our only shelter is the *guru*. He who serves the Lord all the time in all respects, he is the *guru*.

Q: Does one invite misfortune when he does not follow the orders of his spiritual master properly?

A: Of course! If one does not follow the orders of his spiritual master who is the personification of all auspiciousness, he will suffer misfortune-his material desires will increase, and after death he will go to hell. He who does not follow the order of his spiritual master, is a resident of hell. He is a materialist or a big sense enjoyer. One who disobeys the order of his spiritual master enters in the womb of a pig. Those who have strong desire for sense enjoyment, even after getting a bona fide spiritual master due to their good fortune, due to the inability to serve the spiritual master with heart and soul, do not derive any spiritual benefit. Due to their inability to appreciate the value of this priceless object, they consider this material nature to be real, and suffer life after life. (p. 506)

From these statements of Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura, it is clear that only a qualified disciple can become a bona fide spiritual master, and a true disciple simply depends upon the mercy of his spiritual master in order to do anything. The disciple's only desire is to satisfy the spiritual master. Whatever the *guru* orders, the disciple must carry out, including the order to give initiation and accept disciples, with a sense of duty as a service to his spiritual master. But he himself always feels unqualified to execute such a serious responsibility. The more one feels unqualified the more he receives the mercy of the *guru*; and that enables him to become qualified.

2.2.2 Vedic View

In the Vedic society a disciple does not usually give initiation when his spiritual master is present. A disciple naturally feels unqualified to take up such a serious responsibility, especially when his *guru* is present; and his natural tendency is to bring the fruits of his preaching to his *guru*. (Since one is not supposed to canvas for his *guru* in ISKCON, it is expected that one should direct the candidates for initiation to Srila Prabhupada and all those who are initiating now.)

There are instances when disciples gave initiation before their *guru*'s physical departure:

1. Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura mentioned in *Jaiva-dharma* how Paramahansa Premadasa Babaji took his disciple Vaisnava Dasa to his spiritual master, Pradyumna Brahmachari.
2. Ramacandra Kaviraja, a disciple of Srinivasa Acarya, gave initiation when Srinivasa Acarya was present on the planet.

There are many such instances in the scriptures about disciples giving initiation in the presence of *guru*, but that was done only when the disciples were extremely qualified and spiritual masters ordered them to do so. *Hari-bhakti-vilasa* states:

gurorgurau sannihite guruvad vittimacaret

"If the spiritual master of the spiritual master is present, then he should be treated as the *guru*." (Hbv. 1.59)

This statement proves that acceptance of disciples in the presence of one's spiritual master has been approved by the scriptures.

In the scriptures there is no specific instruction about a disciple not giving initiation when his *guru* is present. About transgression of etiquette, we found only one verse in the *Hari-bhakti-vilasa*:

varAottame 'tha ca gurau sati ya visruto 'pa ca

svadesato 'tha vanyatra nedam karyam subharthina

"When a superior *guru* (with aforementioned qualities) is present at home or abroad, a person born in a lower caste should not try to bestow his mercy in the form of giving *mantra* if he desires his own good." (Hbv. 1.37)

But this initiation is based on the consideration of *varna*. Regarding this statement, Srila Bhaktivinoda Thakura mentioned in his *Amṛta-pravaha-bhāṣya* of *Caitanya-caritamṛta*:

"Knowledge about Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate objective of all living entities. Regarding how one can become qualified to give that knowledge it has been concluded that irrespective of one's position as a *brahmana* or *sudra*, householder or *sannyasi*, one can become a *guru* as long as he is well conversant with the knowledge of Kṛṣṇa. The consideration of *Hari-bhakti-vilasa* is for those Vaisnavas who are concerned about social customs; i.e. for those who want to make a little spiritual progress by following customary social regulations. But those who want to acquire pure devotion after understanding the significance of *vaidhi* and *raganuga-bhakti*, should accept a qualified spiritual master without considering his *varna* and *asrama*." (Cc. Madhya 8.127)

In Srila Prabhupada's teachings also it is clear that the main qualification of a *guru* is his Kṛṣṇa consciousness. All Vaisnava *acaryas* have been very emphatic about this point.

Although not much has been said about this etiquette, yet it is known to everyone that transgression of etiquette, i.e. to disregard the position of a senior, is deemed to be a great offense. In Vedic culture the position of the spiritual master is considered to be the highest and transgression of etiquette in this relation was always considered to be extremely dangerous.

There are some unusual instances where disciples gave initiation in the presence of *guru* under some special circumstances. We did not research on what those special circumstances were.

2.2.3 Srila Prabhupada's Views

Srila Prabhupada was very emphatic that a disciple should not initiate in the presence of his *guru*. He told many of his disciples that even though they may be qualified, they should not give initiation as long as the spiritual master is present, because that is the etiquette. He emphatically told that to HH.Jayapataka Maharaja. The day Srila Prabhupada gave *sannyasa* to HH.Bhakti Caru Swami, he told him, "Now that you are a *sannyasi*, you can give initiation. But as long as the spiritual master is alive one doesn't give initiation. That is the etiquette."

He wrote to Tusta Kṛṣṇa Swami,

"Keep trained up very rigidly and then you are bona fide *guru*, and you can accept disciples on the same principle. But as a matter of etiquette it is the custom that during the lifetime of your spiritual master you bring the prospective disciples to him, and in his absence or disappearance you can accept disciples without any limitation. This is the law of disciplic succession. I want to see my disciples become bona fide Spiritual Master and spread Kṛṣṇa consciousness very widely, that will make me and Kṛṣṇa very happy."

In other letters, Srila Prabhupada wrote:

The first thing, I warn Acyutananda, do not try to initiate. You are not in a proper position now to initiate anyone. Besides that, the etiquette is that so long the Spiritual Master is present, all prospective disciples should be brought to him. (Letter to Acyutananda and Jayagovinda, 08-21-1968)

Anyone following the order of Lord Caitanya under the guidance of His bonafide representative, can become a spiritual master and I wish that in my absence all my disciples become the bona fide spiritual master to spread Krsna Consciousness throughout the whole world. (Letter to Madhusudana, 11-02-1967)

So far as your taking initiation from Brahmananda Maharaja, I have no objection, but it is the etiquette that in the presence of one's Spiritual Master, one does not accept disciples. In this connection, Swami Brahmananda may write me and I will instruct him. (Letter to John Milner, 03-24-1971)

Siddhasvarupa does not want to take disciples, neither he should have disciples while I am alive. That is the process. (Letter to Sudevi, 09-15-1972)

From Madhavananda I have heard that there is some worship of yourself by the other devotees. Of course it is proper to offer obeisances to a Vaisnava, but not in the presence of the spiritual master. After the departure of the spiritual master, it will come to that stage, but now wait. Otherwise it will create factions. (Letter to Hamsaduta, 10-01-1974)

Don't become premature *acarya*. First of all follow the orders of *acarya*, and you become mature. Then it is better to become *acarya*. Because we are interested in preparing *acarya*, but the etiquette is, at least for the period the *guru* is present, one should not become *acarya*. Even if he is complete he should not, because the etiquette is, if somebody comes for becoming initiated, it is the duty of such person to bring that prospective candidate to his *acarya*. Not that "Now people are coming to me, so I can become *acarya*." That is *avamanya*. *Navamanyeta karhicit*. Don't transgress this etiquette. *Navamanyeta*. That will be falldown. Just like during the lifetime of our guru Maharaja, all our Godbrothers now who are acting as *acarya*, they did not do so. That is not etiquette. *Acaryam mam vijaniyat na avaman...* That is insult. So if you insult your *acarya*, then you are finished. *Yasya prasada bhagavat-prasado yasya aprasadat na gatir kuto 'pi*-finished. If you displease your *acarya*, then you are finished. (Cc. 1.13 Lecture, Mayapur, 04-06-1975)

From these quotations it is clear that Srila Prabhupada did not want his disciples to initiate, no matter how qualified they may be, as long as their spiritual master was present. One may question, however, whether these instructions are applicable only to founder-*acaryas* like Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Thakura and Srila Prabhupada. It is a fact that the founder-*acarya* is the *guru* of all members of his institution, and no one gives initiation when he is present, and even after his disappearance the members of the institution become connected to him through *siksa* relationship. But here there is no reason to believe that these instructions of Srila Prabhupada were meant only for a founder-*acarya*. The etiquette he mentioned here is a common Vaisnava etiquette. It is prudent to assume that Srila Prabhupada was speaking as the Founder-*acarya* of ISKCON, and that he is restricting all disciples of all *gurus* in ISKCON from initiating in the presence of their spiritual masters.

Even though in the past spiritual masters have given disciples permission to initiate in their presence, Srila Prabhupada emphatically forbids it as a manner of general etiquette. We see only two places where Srila Prabhupada may have indicated otherwise.¹

ISKCON is a unique institution in the history of Vaisnavism. We must assume that as Founder-*acarya*, Srila Prabhupada had the vision to set down a law-a law suitable for that unique institution, a law we would transgress at our peril.

A disciple's only duty is to worship and serve his spiritual master. His mind should not be agitated over how he may become a *guru*. A devotee who sincerely wants to make spiritual advancement should try to become a disciple, not a spiritual master.

2.2.4 Notes

By 1975, all of those who have passed all of the above examinations will be specifically empowered to initiate and increase the number of the Krsna Consciousness population. (Letter to Kirtanananda, 01-12-1969)

I want that all of my spiritual sons and daughters will inherit this title of Bhaktivedanta, so that the family transcendental diploma will continue through the generations. Those possessing the title of Bhaktivedanta will be allowed to initiate disciples. Maybe by 1975, all of my disciples will be allowed to initiate and increase the numbers of the generations. That is my program. (Letter to Hamsaduta, 3rd December, 1968)

These quotes raise further questions: In 1968, did Srila Prabhupada expect to leave the planet before 1975? Or was he thinking of creating *rtvik-gurus* who would initiate on his behalf by 1975? Whatever the answer may be, when 1975 arrived, Srila Prabhupada took no steps to give his disciples the responsibility of accepting their own disciples. Indeed, his statements on this issue in 1975 (Letter to Tusta Krsna and lecture in Mayapur) leave no doubt that His Divine Grace gave no authorization for disciples to initiate as long as he remained on the planet. In logic, later statements supersede earlier ones in importance.

New Subject Areas Since 2018

The 85 resolutions below have no confident chapter home in the 2018 book (mostly Section 800 Appointments, cross-cutting in both numbering schemes, plus a few genuinely new subject areas). Grouped by the GBC's own modern Section.

Section 800: Appointments (85)

ADDED · 2019

802.1 · GBC Officers and Members (2019)

[Action order]

1. HH Bhaktivaibhava Swami is elected GBC Chairman.
2. HH Ramai Swami is elected First Vice-Chairman.
3. HH Bhakti Caitanya Swami is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. HH Gopal Krsna Goswami is elected GBC Secretary.
5. The resignation of HG Tamohara Das is accepted, and he is awarded the title of GBC Emeritus
6. The resignation of HH Sivarama Swami is accepted
7. HG Guru Gauranga Das is awarded the title of GBC Emeritus.

GBC Resolution 802.1 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

802.2 · Resignation of Hridayananda Das Goswami (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

That the resignation of Hridayananda Das Goswami is accepted.

GBC Resolution 802.2 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

802.2 · Romapada Swami's Leave of Absence Extended (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

That the Leave of Absence of Romapada Swami is extended for a further year.

GBC Resolution 802.2 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

803.4 · Area GBC appointments (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

That the following GBC Members are elected as Area GBCs:

Kavicandra Swami, Area GBC for Western Africa: Benin, Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Cape Verde, Chad, Equatorial Guinea, Gambia, Ghana, Guinea, Guinea Bissau, Ivory Coast, Liberia, Mali, Niger, Nigeria, Sao Tome & Principe, Senegal, Sierra Leone, Togo.

Gopal Krishna Goswami, Area GBC for Central & Eastern Africa: Burundi, Central Africa Republic, Democratic Republic of Congo, Djibouti, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Kenya, Republic of Congo, Rwanda, South Sudan, Tanzania, Uganda.

Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Area GBC for Southern Africa: Angola, Botswana, Comoros, Lesotho, Madagascar, Malawi, Mauritius, Mozambique, Namibia, Seychelles, South Africa, Swaziland, Zambia, Zimbabwe.

Guru Prasad Swami, Area GBC for Mexico, Central America & the Caribbean: Belize, Cuba, Trinidad & Tobago (and all other Caribbean countries & territories), Costa Rica, El Salvador, French Guyana, Guyana, Guatemala, Honduras, Mexico, Nicaragua, Panama, Suriname.

Giridhari Swami, Area GBC for China (including Hong Kong, Macau & Taiwan) and Philippines

Virabahu Das, Area GBC for Southern Latin America: Argentina, Chile, Paraguay, Uruguay

Ramai Swami, Area GBC for Oceania: (Australia, New Zealand, Papua New Guinea, Fiji and the rest of Oceania), Indonesia and East Timor.

GBC Resolution 803.4 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

804.1 · Sannyasa Waiting List (2019)

[Action order]

(Proposed and Sponsored by the Ministry for Sannyasa Services)

The following are the candidates for sannyasa along with their respective waiting periods:

Navadvip Dwija Gauranga Das (Bangladesh) This year

Priti Vardhana Das (Mayapur) This year

Pushpashila Shyam Das (Bangladesh) This year

Vrindavan Chandra Das (Vrindavan) This year

Asim Krishna Das (India) One year

Bhaktipada Das (Hungary) One year

Ekalavya Das (India, Middle East, North America) One year

Sundarlal Das (Mauritius) One year

Venudhari Das (Mayapur) One year

Raghava Pandit Das (Delhi/India) One year

Kamalalochan Das (Mumbai) Two years

Radha Shyamsundar Das (Vrindavan) Two years

Vanamali Das (Mumbai) Two years

Adhoksaja Das (Russia) Three years

Gopendra Das (Vrindavan) Three years

Sankarshan Nitai Das (Mayapur) Three years

Vishvasvasu Das (Germany/Baltics/Russia) Three years

Trailokyanatha Das Three years

Savyasachi Das (JPS) Three years

Valmiki Das Three years

Atmaram Das Three years

Sutapa Das (UK) Three years

Govindananda Das (West Bengal) Four years

Savyasachi Das (BCS) Six years

GBC Resolution 804.1 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

805.1 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2019)

[Action order]

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2019-20:

Congregational Development Ministry Co-Ministers – Jayapataka Swami, Kaunteya Das

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca Das

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama Das

Ministry of Book Distribution Minister – Vijaya Das

Ministry of Communications Minister – Anuttama Das

Ministry of Cow Protection and
Agriculture

Minister – Kalakantha Das

Ministry of Education Minister – Sesa Das

Ministry of Fund Development Minister – Devakinandan Das

Ministry of Health and Welfare

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Other member – Bir Krishna Das Goswami

Ministry of Justice Minister – Sesa Das

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Dispute

Resolution Committee (IDRC)

Minister of Justice, a representative of ISKCON Resolve,
the second Vice-Chairman of the GBC, and the Director
of the ISKCON Dispute Resolution Office

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Dispute
Resolution Office

Director – GBC EC, pending nomination

Ministry of Padayatra Minister – Lokanath Swami

Ministry of Sannyasa Services

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Other members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami,
Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Hrdaya
Caitanya Das

Vaishnavi Ministry Minister – Radha Dasi (California)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan Das (MVG)

GBC Nominations Committee

Members – Bhakti Caitanya Swami (Chairman),
Praghosa Das, Gopal Bhatta Das (Convenor), Anuttama
Das, Tamohara Das, Revati Raman Das, Radha Krsna
Das, Gauranga Das, Aniruddha Das, Devakinandan Das
(MVG), Kaunteya Das, Tapan Misra Das

GBC Organizational Development
Committee

Gopal Bhatta Das & Kaunteya Das (Co-chairs) –
Anuttama Das, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Badrinarayan
Swami, Hrdaya Caitanya Das, Jayapataka Swami,
Praghosa Das, Revati Raman Das, Sivarama Swami,
Aniruddha Das, Caitanya Avatari Das, Devakinandan

Das (Juhu), Devakinandan Das (MVG), Gaura Krishna Das, Gauranga Das, Praharana Dasi, Rasa Krida Parayana Das, Rupanuga Das, Subhananda Das, Tapana Misra Das, Tirtharaja Das, Vraja Vihari Das
GBC-BBT Team

Members – Badrinarayan Swami (Coordinator), Gopal Krishna Goswami, Sivarama Swami, Madhu Sevita Das, Hrdaya Caitanya Das, Praghosa Das

GBC Vaisnava Calendar Committee

Members – Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya Das, Sadasivananda Das, Bhaktarupa Das (Convener)

Guru Services Committee

Members – Anuttama Das, Prahladananda Swami (Chairman), Virabahu Das, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Bhaktimarga Swami, Ramai Swami, Atul Krishna Das (Mayapur)

ISKCON Central Office of Child Protection

Director – Kamlesh Krishna Das

ISKCON Property Office

Members – Current GBC Executive Committee, Bhaktarupa Das, Devakinandan Das (MVG), Govardhan Das, Tapana Misra Das

Sastric Advisory Council

Core Members: Urmila Dasi (Chair), Hari Parsad Das, Narayani Dasi, Adi-purusa Das, Sarvajna Das, Brijabasi Das,

Associate Members: Giriraja Swami, Krishna Kshetra Swami, Radhika Raman Das, Drutakarma Das, Gauranga Das, Gopinatha-acarya Das, Harideva Das, Caitanya-caran Das, Bhakti-Vijnana Goswami, Gopal Hari Das, Kanai Krishna Das, Krishna Abhishek Das

World Holy Name Festival Committee

Global Coordination Team – Lokanath Swami, Janananda Goswami, Ekalavya Das

810 Appointment of Global Duty Officers

Appointment of Global Duty Officers — 2019

[Action order]

(Proposed and Sponsored by the GBC Nominations Committee)

The following devotees are appointed as GDOs:

1. Vaisesika Das (reconfirmed) One World Book Distribution Team
2. Radheshyam Das Training and making devotees from/in the West
3. Bhakti Vinoda Swami International outreach development
4. Caitanya Avatari Das ISKCON Initiated-disciples' database
5. Devakinandan Das International Projects' masterplan development:

Puri/Mayapur

GBC Resolution 805.1 · 2019 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, March 3-12, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

810.1 · Global Duty Officer Reappointments (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

That the following Global Duty Officers are hereby reappointed for a further one-year term:

1. Devakinandan Das (MVG)
2. Dhanvantari Swami (ACBSP)
3. Gauranga Das (RNS)
4. Govardhana Das (BCAIS)
5. Hanuman Das (SDG)
6. Kaunteya Das (JPS)
7. Mathuresh Das (JPS)
8. Mukunda Madhava Das (BSDS)
9. Praharana dd (ACBSP)
10. Radha Krsna Das (BBGS)
11. Srivas Das (BTS)
12. Srivas Pandit Das (GGS)
13. Tirtharaj Das (TKG)
14. Tapan Misra Das (BVKS)

GBC Resolution 810.1 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

ADDED · 2019

810.1 · Global Duty Officer Appointment (2019)

[Action order]

Resolved:

That Krsnapremarupa Das (BSDS) is appointed as a Global Duty Officer with the following areas of service:

1. Education: developing long-term guru preparation
2. Education: facilitating establishing the GBC College for Leadership Development in Europe
3. Communication: Charter Model-related

GBC Resolution 810.1 · 2019 · Midterm General Meeting (Tirupati, AP, October 11-17, 2019)

ADDED · 2020

802.01 · GBC officers (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

1. HH Ramai Swami is elected GBC Chairman
2. HH Bhakti Caitanya Swami is elected First Vice-Chairman
3. HH Bhanu Swami is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. HH Gopal Krsna Goswami is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

802.02 · Govardhana dasa appointed as a GBC Member (2020)

Action order

Whereas the GBC Body authorized the GBC Nominations Committee to vet candidates for GBC Secretary positions

Whereas the referrals and the authorities fully support HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari to fulfill the GBC Secretary role

Whereas HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari fulfilled all requirements of the Nomination Process, including essays, questionnaires, zonal analysis and was fully cooperative during the process

Whereas HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari has a service and occupational track record that proves his eligibility to be an international leader

Whereas HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari's wife agreed that the applicant can accept the GBC Secretary position if the GBC Body accepts the applicant

Whereas there are no financial conditions that would restrict HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari to become a GBC Secretary

Whereas HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari's skills and competencies are developed enough to serve in the capacity of a GBC Secretary

Whereas the areas of improvement are not contradictory to the GBC Secretary service

Whereas the Zonal Analysis and Strategy submitted by HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari are fully in compliant with the GBC Body's strategic plan

Whereas the Nominations Committee voting resulted in a unanimous 11 yeses

<http://gbc.iskcon.org/members-profile/>

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Whereas the GBC Nominations Committee proposes that HG Govardhana dasa Adhikari becomes the GBC Secretary for the Southern Africa GBC Area

RESOLVED:

1. HG Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) is appointed as a GBC member with zonal responsibilities for the Southern Africa GBC Area.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED • 2020

803.04 • New Area GBCs (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

Acyutatma dasa, Area GBC for Russian Sphere Area One:

Belarus

Russia:

Arkhangelsk Region

Belgorod Region

Bryansk Region

Chuvash Republic

Ivanovo Region

Kaliningrad Region

Kaluga Region

Karelia, Republic of

Komi Republic

Kostroma Region

Kursk Region

Leningrad Region

Lipetsk Region

Mari El Republic

Moscow

Moscow Region

Murmansk Region

Nenets Autonomous District

Nizhny Novgorod Region

Novgorod Region

Oryol Region

Pskov Region

Ryazan Region

Saint Petersburg

Smolensk Region

Tambov Region

Tatarstan, Republic of

Tula Region

Tver Region

Vladimir Region

Vologda Region

Voronezh Region

Yaroslavl Region

Chaitanya Chandra Charan dasa, Area GBC for Russian Sphere GBC Area Three:

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Russia:

Altai Territory

Altai Republic

Bashkortostan, Republic of (North)

Chelyabinsk Region

Kemerovo Region

Khanty–Mansi Autonomous District – Yugra

Kirov Region

Kurgan Region

Novosibirsk Region

Omsk Region

Perm Territory

Sverdlovsk Region

Tomsk Region

Tyumen Region

Udmurt Republic

Yamalo-Nenets Autonomous District

Madhu Sevita dasa, Area GBC for Western Europe:

France

Belgium

Netherlands

Luxembourg

Spain

Andorra

Gibraltar

Portugal

Italy

Malta

Badrinarayan Swami, Area GBC for Western North America:

Arizona

California (except Berkeley)

Colorado

Hawaii

Idaho

Nevada

New Mexico

Oregon

Utah

Washington (except Seattle)

Bhaktimarga Swami, Area GBC for Northern North America:

Canada

Alaska

Minnesota

Montana

North Dakota

South Dakota

Wyoming

GBC Resolution 803.04 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

804.01 · Sannyasa waiting list (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

The following are the candidates for sannyasa along with their respective waiting periods:

Asim Krishna dasa (RGS) (India) This year
Sundarlal dasa (LOK) (Mauritius) This year
Venudhari dasa (JPS) (Mayapur) This year
Raghava Pandit dasa (GKG) (Delhi/India) This year
Bhaktipada dasa (SRS) (Hungary) One year
Ekalavya dasa (LOK) (India, Middle East, North America) One year
Kamalalochan dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) One year
Radha Shyamsunder dasa (LOK) (Vrindavan) One year
Vanamali dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) One year
Adhoksaja dasa (NRS) (Russia) Two years
Gopendra dasa (BCS) (Vrindavan) Two years
Sankarshan Nitai dasa (JPS) Two years
Vishvavasudasa (NRS) (Germany/Baltics/Russia) Two years
Savyasachi dasa (JPS) Two years
Valmiki dasa (CCCD) Two years
Atmaram dasa (GGS) Two years
Sutapa dasa (KKS) (UK) Two years
Trailokyanatha dasa (GGS) Three years
Govindanandana dasa (BCS) Three years
Savyasachi dasa (BCS) Five years

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2020-21:

Congregational Development Ministry Co-Ministers – Jayapataka Swami, Kaunteya dasa (JPS)

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama dasa (SNS)

Ministry of Book Distribution Minister – Vijaya dasa (HDG)

Ministry of Communications Minister – Anuttama dasa

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture Minister – Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Ministry of Education Minister – Sesa dasa

Ministry of Fund Development Minister – Devakinandan dasa (Juhu)

Ministry of Health and Welfare

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Other member – Bir Krishna dasa Goswami

Ministry of Justice Minister – Sesa dasa

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Dispute

Resolution Committee (IDRC)

Minister of Justice, a representative of ISKCON

Resolve, the second Vice-Chairman of the GBC, and

the Director of the ISKCON Dispute Resolution Office

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Dispute

Resolution Office

Director – GBC EC, pending nomination

Ministry of Padayatra Minister – Lokanath Swami

Ministry of Sannyasa Services

Minister – Prahladananda Swami Other members: Bhakti

Gauravani Goswami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti

Caitanya Swami, Hridaya Caitanya dasa (SDG)

Vaishnavi Ministry Minister – Radha dasi (MG) (California)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

GBC Nominations Committee

Members – Bhakti Caitanya Swami (Chairman),

Praghosa dasa (SDG), Gopal Bhatta dasa (Convener),

Anuttama dasa, Badrinarayan Swami, Revati Raman

dasa (JPS), Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS), Gauranga dasa

(RNS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Devakinandan dasa

(MVG), Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Tapana Misra dasa

(BVKS)

<http://gbc.iskcon.org/ministries/>

<https://iskconcongregation.com/>

<http://deityworship.com/>

<https://www.facebook.com/iskconyouthministry/>

<http://www.iskconbookdistribution.com/>

<https://iskconcommunications.org/>

<https://mcpa.iskcon.org/>

<https://iskconeducation.org/>

<http://www.iskconresolve.org/>
<http://www.iskconresolve.org/>
<http://www.padayatra.com/>
<http://iskconsannyasa.com/>
<http://vaishnaviministry.org/>

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GBC Organizational Development

Committee

Gopal Bhatta dasa & Kaunteya dasa (JPS) (Co-chairs) –
Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Badrinarayan
Swami, Jayapataka Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG),
Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD),
Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu),
Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa (HDG),
Gauranga dasa (RNS), Praharana dasi, Subhananda
das (PSDG), Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS), Tirtharaja
das (TKG), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD)

GBC Strategic Planning Team

Gopal Bhatta dasa (chair), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD),
Subhananda dasa (PSDG), Deva Madhava dasa (JPS),
Adi Kurma dasa (HKS), Kaunteya dasa (JPS)

GBC-BBT Team

Members – Badrinarayan Swami (Coordinator), Gopal
Krishna Goswami, Madhu Sevita dasa, Praghosa dasa
(SDG), Devamrita Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami

GBC Vaisnava Calendar Committee

Members – Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya dasa (BVS),
Sadasivananda dasa (JPD), Bhaktarupa dasa
(Convener)

Guru Daksina Committee

Badrinarayan Swami (coordinator), Bhakti-bhusana
Swami, Bhanu Swami, Guru Prasad Swami, Niranjana
Swami, Praghosa dasa (JPS), Prahladananda Swami,
Rama Swami

Guru Services Committee

Members – Anuttama dasa, Prahladananda Swami
(Chairman), Virabahu dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami,
Bhaktimarga Swami, Rama Swami, Atul Krishna dasa
(PVS) (Mayapur)

ISKCON Central Office of Child

Protection

Director – Kamalesh Krishna dasa (BCS)

ISKCON Harinama Sankirtana Ministry

Minister: Lokanath Swami

Members: Janananda Goswami, Ekalavya dasa (LOK)

Global Property Office

Members – Current GBC Executive Committee,
Bhaktarupa Das, Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Govardhan

dasa (BCAIS), Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)
Justice Development Committee
Prahlaṇanda Swami (Chair), Champakalata dasi (IDS)
(Vice-chairman), Devakinandana dasa (MVG),
Hansarupa dasa, Kamalesh Kṛṣṇa dasa (BCS), Radha
dasi (MG), Sesa dasa, Praharana dasi, Vraja Vihari dasa
(BJD)
Sastric Advisory Council
Members: Urmila dasi (Chairperson), Hari Parsad dasa
(RGS), Narayani dasi, Adi-purusa dasa (GKG),
Sarvajna dasa (NRS), Brijabasi dasa (IDS)
Associate Members: Giriraja Swami, Kṛṣṇa Kṣetra
Swami, Drutakarma dasa, Radhika Raman dasa (HPS),
Caitanya-carana dasa (RNS), Gaurāṅga dasa (RNS),
Gopinātha-acārya dasa (KKS), Harideva dasa (SRS),
<http://gbcstrategicplanningteam.com/>
<https://www.iskconchildprotection.org/>
<https://www.iskconchildprotection.org/>
<http://worldholynama.org/>
<https://globalpropertyoffice.com/>
<http://gbc.iskcon.org/ministries/>

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Bhakti-Vijñāna Goswami, Gopal Hari dasa (GKG), Kanai
Kṛṣṇa dasa (RNS), Kṛṣṇa Abhishek dasa (TKG)
Prevention of Leadership
Misconduct Office
Director: Champakalata dasi (IDS)
GBC Executive Secretariat
Praharana dasi, Srivasa dasa (BTS), Tirtharaj dasa
(TKG), Mathuresa dasa (JPS)

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel, Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2020-21.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

808.02 · Reappointment of Director for Prevention of Leader Misconduct Office (2020)

— 2020

Action order

Whereas Champakalata devi dasi (IDS) was appointed as the Director of the ISKCON International Office for the Prevention of Leader Misconduct (PLM Office) for a period of two years from March 2018 to February

2020

Whereas her term of office has thus ended

RESOLVED:

Champakalata devi dasi's term of office is extended for two years.

GBC Resolution 808.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

809.01 · Appointment of Zonal Supervisors (2020)

Action order

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RESOLVED:

The following devotees are appointed as Zonal Supervisors:

Tarakanatha dasa (SRS): Wales & SW England

Vrinda dd (GKG): Canada, Alaska, North & South Dakota, Minnesota, Montana, Wyoming

Syamananda Krsna dasa (GKG): Pakistan

Vraja Pran dasa (JPS): Mathuradesh

Jaya Krsna dasa (SNS): Delaware, Maryland, Washington DC, Eastern Pennsylvania, Illinois and Missouri

Aniruddha Gopal dasa (JPS): Krsnakatha Desh

GBC Resolution 809.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

810.01 · Appointment of Global Duty Officers (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

That the following devotees are appointed as Global Duty Officers:

Asitaradhya dasa (VVPS), Financial Analysis

Shyamananda Krishna dasa (GKG), Environment

GBC Resolution 810.01 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2020

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2020)

Action order

RESOLVED:

That the following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

Chaitanya Avatari dasa (JPS): ISKCON Initiated disciple's database/CD

Devakinandan dasa (Juhu): International Projects masterplan development — Sridham

Mayapur and Jagannath Puri

Radheshyam dasa (RNS): Training and making devotees from/in the West

Vaisesika dasa: One World Book Distribution Team/Books are the Basis Training

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2020 · Annual General Meeting (Sri Mayapur Dham, February 11-22, 2020)

ADDED · 2021

802.01 · GBC officers (2021)

[Action order]

1. HH Bhakti Caitanya Swami Swami is elected GBC Chairman

2. HH Bhanu Swami is elected First Vice-Chairman

3. HG Revati Raman dasa (JPS) is elected Second Vice-Chairman

4. HH Gopal Krsna Goswami is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 17, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

802.02 · Gauranga dasa (RNS) appointed as a GBC Member (2021)

[Action order]

Whereas the GBC Body authorized the GBC Nominations Committee to vet candidates for GBC Secretary positions;

Whereas the referrals and the authorities fully support Gauranga dasa to fulfil the GBC Secretary role;

Whereas Gauranga dasa fulfilled all requirements of the Nomination Process, including essays, questionnaires, zonal analysis, GDO service and was fully cooperative during the process;

Whereas Gauranga dasa has a service track record that proves his eligibility to be an international leader;

Whereas there are no financial conditions that would restrict Gauranga dasa to become a GBC Secretary;

Whereas Gauranga dasa's skills and competencies are developed enough to serve in the capacity of a GBC Secretary;

Whereas the areas of improvement are not contradictory to the GBC Secretary service;

Whereas the Zonal Analysis and Strategy submitted by Gauranga dasa are fully in compliance with the GBC Body's strategic plan;

Whereas the Nominations Committee voting resulted in 9 yeses and 1 abstention.

RESOLVED:

HG Gauranga dasa is appointed the GBC Secretary for Human Resource Development & Capacity Building, GBC Global Duty position.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 5, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

802.02 · Devakinandana dasa (MVG) appointed as a GBC Member (2021)

[Action order]

Whereas the GBC Body authorized the GBC Nominations Committee to vet candidates for GBC Secretary positions;

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Whereas the referrals and the authorities fully support Devakinandana dasa to fulfill the GBC Secretary role;

Whereas Devakinandana dasa fulfilled all requirements of the Nomination Process, including essays, questionnaires, zonal analysis and was fully cooperative during the process;

Whereas Devakinandana dasa has a service and occupational track record that proves his eligibility to be an international leader;

Whereas Devakinandana dasa's spouse agreed that the applicant can accept the GBC Secretary position if the GBC Body accepts the applicant;

Whereas there are no financial conditions that would restrict Devakinandana dasa to become a GBC Secretary;

Whereas Devakinandana dasa's skills and competencies are developed enough to serve in the capacity of a GBC Secretary;

Whereas the areas of improvement are not contradictory to the GBC Secretary service;

Whereas the Zonal Analysis and Strategy submitted by Devakinandana dasa Adhikari are fully in compliant with the GBC Body's strategic plan;

RESOLVED:

HG Devakinandana dasa (MVG) becomes the GBC Secretary for the Global Legal GBC Secretary role.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 3, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

802.04 · GBC officers and members: Individual members leave of (2021)

[Action order]

absence

1. HG Sesa dasa is granted a leave of absence for health reasons
2. HH Bhakti-bhusana Swami is granted a leave of absence for health reasons

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on May 19, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

802.06 · Dina Sharana dd appointed as Area GBC (2021)

[Action order]

RESOLVED:

Dina Sharana dd is appointed as Area GBC for Germanic Europe (Germany, Austria, Liechtenstein, and Switzerland).

GBC Resolution 802.06 · 2021 · Correspondence Vote (passed on January 3, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

804.01 · Sannyasa appointments: Sannyasa waiting list (2021)

[Action order]

The following are the candidates for sannyasa along with their respective waiting periods:

Ekalavya dasa (LOK) (India, Middle East, North America) This year

Bhaktipada dasa (SRS) (Hungary) This year

Vanamali dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) One year

Radha Shyamsunder dasa (LOK) (Vrindavan) One year

Adhoksaja dasa (NRS) (Russia) One year

Sutapa dasa (KKS) (UK) One year

Kamalalochan dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) One year

Sankarshan Nitai dasa (JPS) One year

Prana Govinda dasa (USA) One year

Gopendra dasa (BCS) (Vrindavan) Two years

Valmiki dasa (CCCD) Two years

Atmaram dasa (GGS) Two years

Vishvasu dasa (NRS) (Germany/Baltics/Russia) Two years

Trailokyanatha dasa (GGS) Two years

Savyasachi dasa (JPS) Two years

Govindanandana dasa (BCS) Three years

Savyasachi dasa (BCS) (Swaziland) Four years

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 10 & 24, 2021)

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2021)

[Action order]

Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2020-21:

Co-Ministers – Jayapataka Swami, Kaunteya

Congregational Development Ministry

dasa (JPS)

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama dasa (SNS)

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Ministry of Book Distribution Minister – Vijaya dasa (HDG)

Ministry of Communications Minister – Anuttama dasa

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture Minister – Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Co-Ministers – Sesa dasa, Tapana Misra dasa

Ministry of Education

(BVKS)

Ministry of Fund Development Minister – Devakinandan dasa (Juhu)

Ministry of Justice Minister – pending nomination

Co-Directors: Brahmatirtha Das, Vraj Vihari Das

Ministry of Justice: ISKCONResolve

(BJD)

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Dispute

Director – GBC EC, pending nomination

Resolution Office

Prahladananda Swami (Chair), Champakalata

Dasi (Vice-chair) (IDS), Devakinandana Das

(MVG), Hansarupa Das, Kamalesh Krsna Das

ISKCON Dispute Resolution Department

(BCS), Radha Dasi (MG), Sesa Das, Praharana

Dasi, Vraja Vihari Das (BJD), Navina-shyam

Das (BCS)

Ministry of Padayatra

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Other members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami,

Ministry of Sannyasa Services

Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti Caitanya Swami,

Hrdaya Caitanya dasa (SDG)

Vaishnavi Ministry Minister – Radha dasi (MG) (California)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Members – Bhakti Caitanya Swami (Chairman),

Praghosa dasa (SDG), Gopal Bhatta dasa

(Convener), Anuttama dasa, Badrinarayan

Swami, Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Radha Krsna

GBC Nominations Committee

dasa (BBGS), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Aniruddha

dasa (BJD), Devakinandan dasa (MVG),

Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS)
 Gopal Bhatta dasa & Kaunteya dasa (JPS) (Co-chairs) – Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Badrinarayan Swami, Jayapataka Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG), Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Caitanya GBC Organizational Development
 Avatari dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu), Committee
 Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa (HDG), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Praharana dasi, Subhananda dasa (PSDG), Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS), Tirtharaja dasa (TKG), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD)
 Gopal Bhatta dasa (chair), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD), Subhananda dasa (PSDG), Deva Madhava dasa (JPS), Adi Kurma dasa (HKS), Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Pancharatna dasa, GBC Strategic Planning Team
 Vrsabhanu dasa (PSDG), Govinda Priya Devi Dasi (RNS), Parijata Dasi (RNS), Aradhya Bhagavan Das (BCS), Shyama Sakhi Devi Dasi (BCS)
 Members – Badrinarayan Swami (Coordinator), Gopal Krishna Goswami, Madhu Sevita dasa, BBT-GBC Team Praghosa dasa (SDG), Devamrita Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, BBT Trustees and BBTI
 Directors
 Members – Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya dasa
 GBC Vaisnava Calendar Committee (BVS), Sadasivananda dasa (JPD), Bhaktarupa
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 dasa (Convener)
 Badrinarayan Swami (coordinator), Bhakti-bhusana Swami, Bhanu Swami, Guru Prasad
 Guru Daksina Committee
 Swami, Niranjana Swami, Praghosa dasa (JPS), Prahladananda Swami, Ramai Swami
 Members – Anuttama dasa, Prahladananda Swami (Chairman), Virabahu dasa, Bhakti
 Guru Services Committee
 Caitanya Swami, Bhaktimarga Swami, Ramai Swami, Atul Krishna dasa (PVD) (Mayapur)
 ISKCON Central Office of Child Protection Director – Kamalesh Krishna dasa (BCS)
 Members: Janananda Goswami, Ekalavya dasa
 ISKCON Harinama Sankirtana Ministry (LOK)

Members – Current GBC Executive Committee,
Bhaktarupa Das, Devakinandan dasa (MVG),
Global Property Office
Govardhan dasa (BCAIS), Tapana Misra dasa
(BVKS)

Members: Urmila dasi (Chair), Bhakti Prabhava
Swami, Hari Parsad dasa (RGS), Narayani dasi,
Adi-purusa dasa (GKG), Sarvajna dasa (NRS),
Kartika Chandra dasa (RNS)

Sastric Advisory Council Associate Members: Giriraja Swami, Krishna
Ksetra Swami, Drutakarma dasa, Radhika
Ramana dasa (HPS), Caitanya-caran dasa
(RNS), Gopinatha-acarya dasa (KKS), Bhakti-
Vijnana Goswami, Gopal Hari dasa (GKG),
Kanai Krishna dasa (RNS)

Prevention of Leadership Misconduct

Director: Champakalata dasi (IDS)

Office

Bhanu Swami, Giriraja Swami, Malati DD,
Hrdaya Caitanya dasa (convenor) (SDG),
Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee
Gauranga dasa (RNS), Nrsimha Kavaca dasa
(IDS)

Praharana dasi, Srivasa dasa (BTS), Tirtharaj
GBC Executive Secretariat
dasa (TKG), Mathuresa dasa (JPS)

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 3, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

805.03 · Tapana Misra dasa appointed as co-minister of education (2021)

[Action order]

ministers

Whereas, the Ministry of Education mandate requires more administrative leadership to sufficiently execute

its GBC assigned mandate;

Whereas the educational services provided to the ISKCON mission are dramatically increasing;

Whereas His Grace Tapan Mishra dasa (BVKS) in his role of Executive Director for the Ministry of Education has demonstrated the necessary managerial and creative abilities to execute the duties of a Co-Minister;

Whereas the current Ministry EC Team has voted unanimously in favor of this appointment;

30

RESOLVED:

Tapana Misra dasa is appointed as Co-Minister with Sesa dasa for the Ministry of Education

GBC Resolution 805.03 · 2021 · Correspondence Vote (passed on February 8, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2021)

[Action order]

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel aka Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2021-22.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 3, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

809.01 · Appointment of Zonal Supervisors (2021)

[Action order]

RESOLVED:

That the following devotees are appointed as Zonal Supervisors:

Govinda Vallabha dasa (IDS): Guangdong, Hunan & Hainan

Sandhini devi dasi (UD): Liaoning, Jilin & Harbin

Gaudiya dasa (TKG): Fujian & Jiangxi

Gaurananda dasa (CCCD): Latvia

Harideva dasa (BCAIS): Mauritius

Dayavan dasa (RSD): Central Asia (Kazakhstan, Uzbekistan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan)

GBC Resolution 809.01 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on February 10, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

810.01 · Samba dasa appointed as Global Duty Officer for ISKCON property (2021)

[Action order]

records and GBC funding — 2021

Whereas the GBC Nominations Committee has approved that Samba dasa (JPS) become a Global Duty Officer with the service of updating the ISKCON properties database and raising funds for the GBC Body;

Whereas the GBC Nominations Committee has recommended to the GBC Body that Samba dasa therefore become a Global Duty Officer with that service.

RESOLVED:

31

That Samba dasa is appointed as a Global Duty Officer with the service of verifying the ISKCON properties database and raising funds for the GBC Body.

GBC Resolution 810.01 · 2021 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on November 24, 2021)

ADDED · 2021

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2021)

[Action order]

RESOLVED:

That the following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

ISKCON Initiated-

Caitanya Avatari dasa

India disciples' database, CDM

(JPS)

support

Devakinandan dasa (MVG) Singapore GBC Legal Office

International Projects'

Devakinandan dasa India masterplan development,

Mayapur, Puri

Everything Website,

Gauranga dasa (RNS) India

ISKCON Administration

Org Dev Co-chair,

Congregation

Kaunteya dasa (JPS) Mayapur

Development Co-minister,

SPT

Krishna Premarupa dasa Long Term Guru Training

Switzerland

(BSDS) Development

Latin America GBC

Mathuresa dasa (JPS) Bolivia College; GBC Executive

secretariat Office (ESO)

Mukunda Madhava dasa

India GBC Finance

(BSDS)

GBC Executive

Praharana dasi Canada

secretariat Office (ESO)

Training and making

Radheshyam dasa (RNS) India

devotees from/in the West

Shyamananda Krishna

Australia Environment

dasa (GKG)

ISKCON Global Support

Srivasa Pandit dasa (GGS) Myanmar for upcoming centres;

Sannyasa Ministry

GDO Office, Education

Tapana Mishra dasa

Kuwait Ministry, ISKCON

(BVKS)

Property Office, GBC NC

Global Leaders Database,
Tirtharaja dasa (TKG) Hong Kong
ESO

32

One World Book
Vaisesika dasa USA
Distribution Team

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2021 · Online AGM (passed on March 5, 2021)

ADDED · 2022

802.01 · GBC officers (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

1. Bhanu Swami is elected GBC Chairman
2. Revati Raman dasa (JPS) is elected First Vice-Chairman
3. Guru Prasad Swami is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. Gopal Krishna Goswami is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed in February 2022)

ADDED · 2022

802.02 · Tapana Misra dasa appointed as a GBC member (2022)

[Statement]

appointments

Whereas the referrals and the authorities fully support Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS) to fulfill the GBC Secretary role

Whereas Tapana Misra dasa fulfilled all requirements of the Nomination Process, including essays, questionnaires, zonal analysis and was fully cooperative during the process

Whereas Tapana Misra dasa has a service and occupational track record that proves their eligibility to be an international leader

Whereas Tapana Misra dasa's spouse agreed that the applicant can accept the GBC Secretary position if the GBC Body accepts the applicant

Whereas the Applicant's financial conditions are in category 5, so he is fully independent, and self-maintained

Whereas Tapana Misra dasa's skills and competencies are developed enough to serve in the capacity of a GBC Secretary

Whereas the areas of improvement are not contradictory to the GBC Secretary service

Whereas the Zonal Analysis and Strategy submitted by Tapana Mishra Das are fully in compliance with the

GBC Body's strategic plan.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Tapana Misra dasa is appointed as the GBC Zonal Secretary for the Arab League Countries.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on March 23, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

802.03 · Sesa dasa's resignation (2022)

[Statement]

Resolved that:

The resignation of Sesa dasa is accepted.

GBC Resolution 802.03 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on September 1, 2021)

ADDED · 2022

802.03 · BB Govinda Swami's resignation (2022)

[Statement]

Resolved that:

The resignation of BB Govinda Swami is accepted.

GBC Resolution 802.03 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on March 23, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

802.03 · Praghosa dasa's resignation (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The resignation of Praghosa dasa is accepted.

GBC Resolution 802.03 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on July 27, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

802.04 · Romapada Swami's leave of absence extension (2022)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

The Leave of Absence of Romapada Swami is extended by a further one year, to March 2023.

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on February 18, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

802.05 · Praghosa dasa as GBC Emeritus (2022)

[Statement]

emeritus

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Praghosa dasa is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

GBC Resolution 802.05 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on July 27, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

802.05 · Sesa dasa as GBC Emeritus (2022)

[Statement]

emeritus

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Sesa dasa is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

GBC Resolution 802.05 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on February 18, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

804.01 · Sannyasa waiting list (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The following are the candidates for sannyasa along with their respective waiting periods:

Vanamali dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) this year

Sankarshan Nitai dasa (JPS) (India) this year

Prana Govinda dasa (USA) this year

Sutapa dasa (KKS) (UK) this year

Adhoksaja dasa (NRS) (Russia) One year

Gopendra dasa (BCS) (Vrndavana) One year

Kamalalochan dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) One year

Radha Shyamsunder dasa (LOK) (Vrndavana) One year

Valmiki dasa (CCCD) One year

Savyasachi dasa (JPS) One year

Trailokyanatha dasa (GGS) One year

Atmaram dasa (GGS) Two years

Vishvavasudasa (NRS) (Germany/Baltics/Russia) Two years

Govindanandana dasa (BCS) Two years

Savyasachi dasa (BCS) (Swaziland) Three years

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on June 8, 2022)

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2022)

[Action order]

Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2022-23:

Congregational Development Ministry Co-Ministers – Jayapataka Swami, Kaunteya dasa (JPS)

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama dasa (SNS)

Ministry of Book Distribution Minister – Vijaya dasa (HDG)

Ministry of Communications Minister – Anuttama dasa

Ministry of Cow Protection & Agriculture Minister – Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Ministry of Education Minister – Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)

Minister – Devakinandan dasa (Juhu)

Ministry of Fund Development Other member: Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS)

Ministry of Justice Minister – Champakalata DD (IDS)

Co-Directors: Brahmatirtha Das, Vraj Vihari Das

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Resolve (BJD)

Ministry of Justice: ISKCON Dispute

Director – GBC EC, pending nomination

Resolution Office

Prahladananda Swami (Chair), Champakalata

Dasi (Vice-chair) (IDS), Devakinandana Das

ISKCON Dispute Resolution Department (MVG), Hansarupa Das, Kamalesh Krsna Das (BCS), Radha Dasi (MG), Vraja Vihari Das (BJD), Navina-shyam Das (BCS)

Ministry of Padayatra Minister – Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Ministry of Sannyasa Services Other members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Hrdaya Caitanya dasa (SDG)

Vaishnavi Ministry Minister – Radha dasi (MG) (California)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Members – Bhakti Caitanya Swami (Chairman),

Praghosa dasa (SDG), Anuttama dasa,

Badrinarayan Swami, Revati Raman dasa

GBC Nominations Committee (JPS), Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD),

Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)

Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Gauranga dasa (RNS),
Govardhana dasa (BCAIS), (Co-Chairs),
Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami,
Badrinarayan Swami, Jayapataka Swami,
Praghosa dasa (SDG), Revati Raman dasa
GBC Organizational Development
(JPS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Caitanya Avatari
Committee
dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu),
Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa
(HDG), Praharana dasi, Tapana Misra dasa
(BVKS), Tirtharaja dasa (TKG), Vraja Vihari
dasa (BJD)

Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD) (Chair), Ananta Sesa
GBC Strategic Planning Team Das (IDS), Deva Madhava dasa (JPS),
Kaunteya dasa (JPS), Pancharatna dasa,
Vrsabhanu dasa (PSDG), Govinda Priya Devi
Dasi (RNS), Parijata Dasi (RNS), Aradhya
Bhagavan Das (BCS), Shyama Sakhi Devi Dasi
(RNS), Tosan Nimai Das (RNS)

Members – Badrinarayan Swami (Coordinator),
Gopal Krishna Goswami, Madhu Sevita dasa,
BBT-GBC Relations Committee Praghosa dasa (SDG) (Coordinator), Devamrita
Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, BBT Trustees
and BBTI Directors

Members – Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya dasa
GBC Vaisnava Calendar Committee (BVS), Sadasivananda dasa (JPD), Bhaktarupa
dasa (Convener)

Badrinarayan Swami (coordinator), Bhakti-
bhusana Swami, Bhanu Swami, Guru Prasad
Guru Daksina Committee
Swami, Niranjana Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG)
Prahlanananda Swami, Ramai Swami

Members – Anuttama dasa, Prahlanananda
Swami (Chairman), Virabahu dasa, Bhakti
Guru Services Committee
Caitanya Swami, Bhaktimarga Swami, Ramai
Swami, Atul Krishna dasa (PVS) (Mayapur)

ISKCON Central Office of Child Protection Director – Kamalesh Krishna dasa (BCS)

Minister: Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami
ISKCON Harinama Sankirtana Ministry
Janananda Goswami

Jayapataka Swami, Gopal Krsna Goswami,
GBC Executors Property Oversight Guru Gauranga dasa, Nrsimhananda dasa,
Committee (GEPOC) Ramesvara dasa, Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS),
Govardhana dasa (BCAIS)

Members: Urmila dasi (Chair), Bhakti Prabhava
Swami, Hari Parsad dasa (RGS), Narayani dasi,
Adi-purusa dasa (GKG), Sarvajna dasa (NRS),
Kartika Chandra dasa (RNS)

Sastric Advisory Council Associate Members: Giriraja Swami, Krishna
Ksetra Swami, Drutakarma dasa, Radhika
Ramana dasa (HPS), Caitanya-caran dasa
(RNS), Gopinatha-acarya dasa (KKS), Bhakti-
Vijnana Goswami, Gopal Hari dasa (GKG),
Kanai Krishna dasa (RNS)
Prevention of Leadership Misconduct
Office Mahavisnupriya DD

Bhanu Swami, Giriraja Swami, Malati DD,
Vaisnava Memorial Standing Committee Hridaya Caitanya dasa (convenor) (SDG),
Gauranga dasa (RNS), Nrsimha Kavaca dasa
(IDS)

Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS) Corresponding
Secretary

GBC Secretariat Staff Radha Sundari DD (RNS) EC Secretary

Mahamani Govinda dasa (JPS) Treasurer

Subha Krsna dasa (RNS) GBC Office Manager

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on January 18, 2023)

ADDED · 2022

805.03 · Champakalata dasi (IDS) appointed as Minister of Justice — 2021 (2022)

[Action order]

Ministers

Whereas Sesa dasa has retired from the service of Minister of Justice leaving this portfolio vacant

Whereas Champakalata dasi (IDS) has served in various capacities both in South Africa and internationally

over the past 33 years, which services have included being Director of the ISKCON's International Child Protection Office (CPO), communications and public relations, legal advisor, Vice President and Chairperson of ISKCON KwaZulu-Natal management board, and currently as the Vice-Chairperson of ISKCON's Dispute Resolution Department, Director of ISKCON's Prevention of Leader Misconduct Office

and General Counsel for ISKCON South Africa National Council

Whereas as well as being professionally qualified and admitted as a practicing Attorney, Conveyancer and Notary Public, and an Acting Magistrate in South Africa, she possesses the relevant experience, knowledge,

skills and attributes to be appointed as the Minister of Justice.

Therefore, it is resolved that:

Champakalata dasi (IDS) is appointed as the ISKCON Minister of Justice with immediate effect.

GBC Resolution 805.03 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on December 1, 2021)

ADDED · 2022

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel aka Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2022–23.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on March 28, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

808.02 · Appointment of Director of the Prevention of Leader Misconduct (2022)

[Action order]

Office — 2022

Whereas the ISKCON Prevention of Leader Misconduct Office (PLMO) requires a skilled and experienced

Director to replace Champakalata dasi, who has been appointed as the Minister of Justice

Whereas Mahavisnupriya devi dasi (ACBSP) has volunteered to take up this service

Whereas Mahavisnupriya devi dasi has years of experience in this field, working with trauma and victimization of children, teens, and young adults. She possesses the necessary qualifications, qualities and the leadership maturity as required by page 29 of the PLMO Guidelines to head this Office

Whereas the guidelines and policy manual for this Office have been completed by Champakalata dasi and adopted by the GBC body; thereby providing the framework for the functioning of the PLMO and the investigation as well as adjudication of complaints.

Resolved that:

Mahavisnupriya devi dasi (ACBSP), who has been serving as the Acting Director of the International Office

for the Prevention of Leader Misconduct (PLMO) since Oct. 16, 2022, be appointed as the Director of the PLMO until the 2025 AGM, with an option to renew subject GBC approval and to terms and conditions to be decided when the option is being exercised.

The mandate, deliverables, and performance of the Director and the PLMO will be subject to review by the

GBC Body (as with other Offices and Ministries). The PLMO Director will report to the GBC EC.

GBC Resolution 808.02 · 2022 · GBC Virtual Meeting (passed on December 21, 2022)

ADDED · 2022

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2022)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

That the following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS) India ISKCON initiated disciples' database, CDM support

Devakinandan dasa (MVG) Singapore General Counsel for ISKCON Law Department

International Projects' masterplan development,

Devakinandan dasa India

Mayapur, Puri

Gauranga dasa (RNS) India Devotee Care, BRC, GEV 2.0

Kaunteya dasa (JPS) Mayapur Org Dev, Congregation Development Co-minister, SPT

Krishna Premarupa dasa

Switzerland Long Term Guru Training, Ministry of Education
(BSDS)

Latin America GBC College; GBC Executive secretariat

Mathuresa dasa (JPS) Bolivia

Office (ESO)

Mukunda Madhava dasa

India GBC Finance

(BSDS)

Praharana dasi Canada GBC Executive Secretariat Office (ESO)

Radheshyam dasa (RNS) India Recruiting Full Time Youth Devotees

Shyamananda Krishna dasa

Australia Environment—Green Temple Initiative
(GKG)

Tapana Mishra dasa (BVKS) Mayapur GDO Office, Education Ministry, ISKCON Property Office

Tirtharaja dasa (TKG) Hong Kong Global Leaders Database, ESO

Vaisesika dasa USA One World Book Distribution Team

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2022 · Online AGM (passed on March 4, 2022)

ADDED · 2023

802.01 · GBC officers (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

1. Revati Raman dasa (JPS) is elected GBC Chairman
2. Guru Prasad Swami is elected First Vice-Chairman
3. Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS) is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. Gopal Krishna Goswami is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2023 · GBC Annual General Meeting, passed February 7, 2023

ADDED · 2023

802.04 · Bhakti-Bhusana Swami's leave of absence extension (2023)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

The Leave of Absence of Bhakti-bhusana Swami is extended by a further one year.

Resolved that:

Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS) is granted a Leave of Absence for health reasons.

Resolved that:

Giridhari Swami is granted a Leave of Absence for health reasons.

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed January 4, 2023

ADDED · 2023

804.01 · Sannyasa waiting list (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The following are the candidates for sannyasa along with their respective waiting periods:

Adhoksaja dasa (NRS) (Russia) this year

Gopendra dasa (BCS) (Vrndavana) this year

Radha Shyamsunder dasa (LOK) (Vrndavana) this year

Trailokyanatha dasa (GGS) this year

Valmiki dasa (CCCD) One year

Kamalalochan dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) One year

Savyasachi dasa (JPS) One year

Vishvavasu dasa (NRS) (Germany/Baltics/Russia) One year

Atmaram dasa (GGS) Two years

Savyasachi dasa (BCS) (Swaziland) Two years

Govindanandana dasa (BCS) Two years

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed May 15, 2023

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2023)

[Action order]

Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees

Resolved that: The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2023-24:

Congregational

Minister – Jayapataka Swami

Development Ministry

ISKCON Deity Worship

Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

Ministry

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama dasa (SNS)

Ministry of Book

Minister – Vijaya dasa (HDG)

Distribution

Ministry of

Minister – Anuttama dasa

Communications

Ministry of Cow Protection

Minister – Kalakantha dasa (IS)

& Agriculture

Ministry of Education Minister – Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)

Ministry of Fund Minister – Devakinandan dasa (Juhu),

Development Members: Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS), Madan Gopal dasa (SDG)

Ministry of Justice Minister – Champakalata DD (IDS)

ISKCON Resolve Co-Directors: Brahmatirtha dasa, Vraj Vihari dasa (BJD)

Prahladananda Swami (Chair), Champakalata dasi (Vice-chair) (IDS),

ISKCON Dispute Devakinandana dasa (MVG), Hansarupa dasa, Kamalesh Krsna dasa

Resolution Department (BCS), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD), Navina-shyam dasa (BCS),

Candrasekhara Swami

Ministry of Padayatra Minister – Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami (LOK)

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Ministry of Sannyasa Other members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami,

Services Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Hrdaya Caitanya dasa (SDG), Devakinandan

dasa (Juhu)

Vaishnavi Ministry Minister – Radha dasi (MG)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Members – Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS) (Chair), Bhakti Caitanya

GBC Nominations Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG), Anuttama dasa, Revati Raman dasa

Committee (JPS), Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Aniruddha

dasa (BJD), Devakinandan dasa (MVG),

Gauranga dasa (RNS), Govardhana dasa (BCAIS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), (Co-Chairs); Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Badrinarayan Swami, Jayapataka Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG), GBC Organizational

Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS), Devakinandan Development Committee

dasa (Juhu), Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa (HDG), Praharana dasi, Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS), Tirtharaj dasa (TKG), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD)

Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD) Ananta Sesa dasa (IDS), Pancharatna dasa, GBC Strategic Planning Vrsabhanu dasa (PSDG), Govinda Priya devi dasi (RNS), Parijata dasi Team (RNS), Aradhya Bhagavan dasa (BCS), Shyama Sakhi devi dasi (RNS), Tosan Nimai dasa (RNS)

Members – Badrinarayan Swami, Gopal Krishna Goswami, Madhu Sevita dasa, Praghosa dasa (SDG) (Coordinator), Devamrita Swami, BBT-GBC Relations

Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Tapana Misra dasa Committee

(BVKS), Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) Mathura Manohara dasa, BBT Trustees and BBTI Directors

GBC Vaisnava Calendar Members – Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya dasa (BVS), Sadasivananda Committee dasa (JPD), Bhaktarupa dasa (Convener)

Badrinarayan Swami (coordinator), Bhanu Swami, Guru Prasad Swami, Guru Daksina Committee Niranjana Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG) Prahladananda Swami, Ramai Swami

Members – Anuttama dasa, Prahladananda Swami (Chairman), Bhakti Guru Services Committee Caitanya Swami, Ramai Swami, Bhakti Vijnana Goswami (RNS), Mahatma dasa, Gopika Radhika DD (JPS)

ISKCON Central Office of

Director – Kamalesh Krishna dasa (BCS)

Child Protection

Minister: Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami (LOK)

ISKCON Kirtan Ministry

Jagannatha Kirtanananda dasa, Dinanukampa devi dasi

GBC Executors Property

Jayapataka Swami, Gopal Krsna Goswami, Guru Gauranga dasa, Oversight Committee

Nrsimhananda dasa, Ramesvara dasa, Loka dd (BTS)

(GEPOC)

Members: Urmila dasi (Chair), Bhakti Prabhava Swami (BCS), Hari Parsad dasa (RGS), Narayani dasi, Adi-purusa dasa (GKG), Sarvajna dasa (NRS), Kartika Chandra dasa (RNS)

Sastric Advisory Council

Associate Members: Giriraja Swami, Krishna Ksetra Swami,
Drutakarma dasa, Radhika Ramana dasa (HPS), Caitanya-caran dasa
(RNS), Gopinatha-acarya dasa (KKS), Bhakti-Vijnana Goswami (RNS),
Gopal Hari dasa (GKG), Kanai Krishna dasa (RNS)

Prevention of Leadership

Mahavisnupriya dd

Misconduct Office

Vaisnava Memorial Bhanu Swami, Giriraja Swami, Malati DD, Hrdaya Caitanya dasa
Standing Committee (convenor) (SDG), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

Executive Director: Nanda Kishor dasa (GRS)

GBC Executive Support Corporate Services: Krishnanam dasa (RNS)

Office GBC Communications: Parijata dd (RNS)

Ministry and Committee Support: Jayalalita dd (KKS)

Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS) Corresponding Secretary

Radha Sundari dd (RNS) EC Secretary

GBC Secretariat Staff Mahamani Govinda dasa (JPS) Treasurer

Subha Krsna dasa (RNS) GBC Office Manager

Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS) Parliamentarian

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed August 23, 2023

ADDED · 2023

806.01 · Confirmation of GBC Deputy Membership (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that: The following devotees are confirmed as GBC Deputies for the next three years:

1. Krsnadasa Kaviraja dasa (Chair)
2. Sri Krsna Caitanya Swami (LOK) (Vice Chair)
3. Aniruddha dasa (BJD) (Secretary)
4. Acintya Rupa dasi (BJD)
5. Acyuta Priya dasa (RNS)
6. Akrura dasa (GKG)
7. Aravindaksa Govinda dasa (JPS)
8. Bhaktarupa dasa
9. Bharata Candra dasa (BDDS)
10. Brajsundar dasa (RDGS)
11. Devakinandana dasa (KDS) (Botswana)
12. Jagarini dasi
13. Jaya Gaura dasa
14. Kalasamvara dasa
15. Madana-mohana dasa (MG)
16. Nagapatni devi dasi
17. Namacarya dasa (BCAIS)
18. Prasanta dasi (LOK)
19. Rasaraja dasa (BSDS)
20. Srivasa dasa (BTS)
21. Vedavyasapriya Swami

GBC Resolution 806.01 · 2023 · GBC Midterm General Meeting, passed October 25, 2023

ADDED · 2023

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel aka Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2023-24.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2023 · GBC Annual General Meeting, passed February 7, 2023

ADDED · 2023

809.01 · Appointment of Zonal Supervisors (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that: The following devotees are appointed as Zonal Supervisors:

Indresa Gaura dasa (BBGS) Eastern Canada including Nova Scotia, Newfoundland, Prince Edward Island, New Brunswick, Ontario, and Quebec

Madhupati dasa (JAS) New Jersey (except Central NJ and Parsippany Temple)

Yugal Kishore dasa (RNS) New York City

Ramiya dasa Northern Florida, including Tallahassee, Orlando, Tampa, Deland, (not Alachua or Gainesville)

Prabhupada Priya dd (HDG) Texas

Vaisesika dasa Northern California

Tukarama dasa, (LOK) Southern California and Nevada, particularly Long Beach, Escondido Farm, San Diego, Riverside, and Las Vegas

Radha Govinda dasa (SRS) Romania

GBC Resolution 809.01 · 2023 · GBC Midterm General Meeting, passed October 28, 2023

ADDED · 2023

810.01 · Pundarikaksa Govinda dasa appointed as Global Duty Officer for (2023)

[Action order]

Temple Construction advice — 2023

Resolved that:

Pundarikaksa Govinda dasa (JPS) is appointed as a Global Duty Officer for Temple construction advice.

GBC Resolution 810.01 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed February 1, 2023

ADDED · 2023

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2023)

[Action order]

Resolved that: The following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

ISKCON initiated disciples' database, CDM

Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS) India
support

Devakinandan dasa (MVG) Singapore GBC Legal Office

International Projects' development,
Devakinandan dasa (Juhu) India
Mayapur, Puri

Devotee Care, Bhaktivedanta Research
Gauranga dasa (RNS) India
Centre, GEV 2.0

Krishna Premarupa dasa Long Term Guru Training, Ministry of
Switzerland
(BSDS) Education

Mukunda Madhava dasa
India GBC Finance
(BSDS)

Radheshyam dasa (RNS) India Recruiting Full Time Youth Devotees

Samba dasa (JPS) India GBC Funding and Property Office

Shyamananda Krishna dasa
Australia Environment—Green Temple Initiative
(GKG)

Global Leaders Database, ORGDEV,
Tirtharaj dasa (TKG) Australia
Endowment Fund

Vaisesika dasa USA One World Book Distribution Team

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2023 · GBC Virtual Meetings, passed February 1, 2023

ADDED · 2024

802.01 · GBC officers (2024)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

1. Guru Prasad Swami is elected GBC Chairman
2. Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS) is elected First Vice-Chairman
3. Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. Gopal Krishna Goswami is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 28, 2024

ADDED · 2024

802.02 · Acyuta Priya dasa appointed as a GBC member (2024)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Acyuta Priya Das (RNS) is appointed as a full GBC member.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 8, 2024

ADDED · 2024

802.03 · Resignation of Bhakti-bhusana Swami (2024)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Bhakti-bhusana Swami. His resignation is effective at the conclusion of the 2024 AGM.

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Bhaktimarga Swami. His resignation is effective at the conclusion of the 2024 AGM.

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Niranjana Swami. His resignation is effective at the conclusion of the 2024 AGM.

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Malati devi dasi. Her resignation is effective on December 31, 2024.

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Radhanath Swami. His resignation is effective at the conclusion of the 2024 AGM.

GBC Resolution 802.03 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 8, 2024

ADDED · 2024

802.04 · Romapada Swami's leave of absence (2024)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

The Leave of Absence of Romapada Swami is extended by a further one year to March 2, 2025.

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 2, 2024

ADDED · 2024

804.01 · Sannyasa waiting list (2024)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The following are the candidates for sannyasa along with their respective waiting periods:

Valmiki dasa (CCCD) This year

Vishvavasu dasa (NRS) (Germany/Baltics/Russia) One year

Atmaram dasa (GGS) One year

Savyasachi dasa (BCS) (Swaziland) One year

Govindanandana dasa (BCS) One year

Rukmini Krsna dasa (GKG) North India Sannyasa candidate*

Nanda Kumar dasa (BVG) Russia Sannyasa candidate*

Shanta Narsimha dasa (JPS) Jaipur Sannyasa candidate*

Kamalalochan dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) TBD

*Note: The sannyasa waiting period system is changing and thus new candidates will not have a stipulated annual waiting period any more.

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2024)

[Action Order]

Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2024-25:

Congregational Development

Minister – Jayapataka Swami

Ministry

Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

ISKCON Deity Worship

Members: Devadeva dasa (BCAIS) (Executive Director), Murli

Ministry

Manohara dasa (SRS), Manohara dasa (SDG), Radha Thakurani dd

(BCAIS), Mahat Sevaka dasa (DAS), Nara-Narayana dasa (KDS)

Shyamapriya dd (SDA), Yogendra dasa (BCAIS)

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama dasa (SNS)

Ministry of Book Distribution Minister – Vaisesika dasa

Ministry of Communications Minister – Anuttama dasa

Minister – Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Ministry of Cow Protection &

Agriculture IMCPA Board of Directors (USA): Niranjana Swami, Sesa dasa,

Vaikuntha dasa, Krishna Kishore dasa (BCS), Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Ministry of Education Minister – Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)

Minister – Devakinandan dasa (Juhu),

Ministry of Fund Members: Govind Prema dasa (GKG), Mukunda Madhava dasa

Development (BSDS), Madan Gopal dasa (SDG), Nila Madhava dasa (BCS), Vijaya

Gopikesa dasa (JPS)

Ministry of Justice Minister – Champakalata dd (IDS)

ISKCON Resolve Co-Directors: Brahmatirtha dasa, Vraj Vihari dasa (BJD)

Prahladananda Swami (Chair), Champakalata dasi (IDS) (Vice-chair),

ISKCON Dispute Resolution Devakinandana dasa (MVG), Hansarupa dasa, Kamalesh Krsna dasa

Department (BCS), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD), Navina-shyam dasa (BCS),

Candrasekhara Swami

Ministry of Padayatras Minister – Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami (LOK)

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Ministry of Sannyasa Members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti

Services Caitanya Swami, Hrdaya Caitanya dasa (SDG), Devakinandan dasa

(Juhu)

Vaishnavi Ministry Minister – Radha dasi (MG)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Members – Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS) (Chair), Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG), Anuttama dasa, Revati Raman dasa
GBC Nominations Committee
(JPS), Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Gauranga dasa (RNS), Govardhana dasa (BCAIS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), (Co-Chairs); Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Badrinarayan Swami, Jayapataka Swami, GBC Organizational
Praghosa dasa (SDG), Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Caitanya Avatari Development Committee
dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu), Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa (HDG), Praharana dasi, Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS), Tirtharaj dasa (TKG), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD)

Ananta Sesa dasa (IDS), Pancharatna dasa, Govinda Priya devi dasi
GBC Strategic Planning
(RNS), Parijata dasi (RNS), Aradhya Bhagavan dasa (BCS), Tosan Team
Nimai dasa (RNS)

BBT-GBC Relations Members – Badrinarayan Swami, Gopal Krishna Goswami, Madhu Committee Sevita dasa, Praghosa dasa (SDG) (Coordinator), Devamrita Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS), Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) Mathura Manohara dasa (JPS), BBT Trustees and BBTI Directors

GBC Vaisnava Calendar Members — Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya dasa (BVS), Sadasivananda Committee dasa (JPD), Bhaktarupa dasa (Convener)

Badrinarayan Swami (coordinator), Bhanu Swami, Guru Prasad Guru Daksina Committee Swami, Niranjana Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG) Prahladananda Swami, Ramai Swami

Members – Anuttama dasa, Prahladananda Swami (Chairman), Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Ramai Swami, Bhakti Vijnana Goswami
Guru Services Committee
(RNS), Mahatma dasa, Gopika Radhika dd (JPS), Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS)

ISKCON Child Protection

Director – Kamalesh Krishna dasa (BCS)
Office

Minister: Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami (LOK)

ISKCON Kirtan Ministry

Jagannatha Kirtanananda dasa (JPS), Dinanukampa devi dasi (LOK)

GBC Executors Property

Jayapataka Swami, Guru Gauranga dasa, Nrsimhananda dasa, Oversight Committee

Ramesvara dasa, Loka dd (BTS), Akshay Ramacandra dasa (JPS) (GEPOC)

Members: Urmila dasi (Chair), Bhakti Prabhava Swami, Hari Parsad dasa (RGS), Narayani dasi, Adi-purusa dasa (GKG), Sarvajna dasa (NRS), Kartika Chandra dasa (RNS), Mahendra dasa (SS)

Sastric Advisory Council Associate Members: Giriraja Swami, Krishna Kshetra Swami, Drutakarma dasa, Radhika Ramana dasa (HPS), Chaitanya Charan dasa (RNS), Gopinatha-acarya dasa (KKS), Bhakti-Vijnana Goswami (RNS), Gopal Hari dasa (GKG), Kanai Krishna dasa (RNS)

Leadership Conduct Office Mahavisnupriya dd

Bhanu Swami, Giriraja Swami, Malati dd, Hrdaya Caitanya dasa

Vaisnava Memorial Standing

(SDG) (convenor), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Nrsimha Kavaca dasa

Committee

(IDS)

Executive Director: Nanda Kishor dasa (GRS)

GBC Executive Support Corporate Services: Krishnanam dasa (RNS)

Office GBC Communications: Parijata dd (RNS)

Ministry and Committee Support: Jayalalita dd (KKS)

Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS) Corresponding Secretary

Radha Sundari dd (RNS) EC Secretary

GBC Secretariat Staff Mahamani Govinda dasa (JPS) Treasurer

Subha Krsna dasa (RNS) GBC Office Manager

Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS) Parliamentarian

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

ADDED · 2024

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2024)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel aka Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2024-25.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 4, 2024

ADDED · 2024

810.01 · New Global Duty Officers (2024)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

1. Asitaradhya dasa (VVPS) is appointed as Global Duty Officer for Global Duties Office.
2. Indresa Gaura dasa (BBGS) is appointed as Global Duty Officer for Govinda's Model.
3. Acyuta Priya dasa (RNS) is appointed as Global Duty Officer for Devotee Care.
4. Trilokatma dasa (BVS) is appointed as Global Duty Officer for Karma Free Club.

GBC Resolution 810.01 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

ADDED · 2024

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2024)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS) India ISKCON initiated disciples' database, CDM support

Devakinandan dasa (MVG) Singapore GBC Legal Office

Devakinandan dasa (Juhu) India International Projects' development, Mayapur, Puri

Devotee Care, Bhaktivedanta Research Centre,

Gauranga dasa (RNS) India GEV 2.0

Krishna Premarupa dasa (BSDS) Switzerland Long Term Guru Training, Ministry of Education

Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS) India GBC Finance

Radheshyam dasa (RNS) India Recruiting Full Time Youth Devotees

Samba dasa (JPS) India GBC Funding and Property Office

Shyamananda Krishna dasa (GKG) Australia Environment—Green Temple Initiative

Global Leaders Database, ORGDEV, Endowment

Tirtharaj dasa (TKG) Australia Fund

Vaisesika dasa USA One World Book Distribution Team

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2024 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 9, 2024

ADDED · 2025

802.01 · GBC officers (2025)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

1. Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) is elected GBC Chairman
2. Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS) is elected First Vice-Chairman
3. Madhu Sevita dasa is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. Revati Raman dasa (JPS) is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 14, 2025

ADDED · 2025

802.02 · Krishna Premarupa dasa appointed as an Assistant GBC member (2025)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Krishna Premarupa dasa (BSDS) is appointed as an Assistant GBC member for Germanic Europe.

Resolved that:

Mathuresh dasa (JPS) is appointed as an Assistant GBC member for the Andean countries.

Whereas the GBC Executive Committee has received sincere and robust requests from devotees in Ireland, Scandinavia, and the UK for Praghosa dasa to resume his duties as a full GBC member;

Whereas Praghosa Das has therefore, in a mood of service and cooperation, agreed to once again commit to the service of GBC Zonal Secretary for Ireland, Scandinavia, and the UK, while simultaneously committing himself to developing a succession plan for these zones;

Whereas while the GBC Body is aware of Praghosa Prabhu's grounds for resignation, it is to be noted that GBC decisions are collective and once resolved after due consideration, stand upon the adherence of every GBC member

Therefore, it is resolved that:

The GBC Body hereby reinstates Praghosa Prabhu as GBC Zonal Secretary for Ireland, Scandinavia, and the United Kingdom.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 15, 2025

ADDED · 2025

802.03 · Resignation of Dina Sharana devi dasi (2025)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Dina Sharana devi dasi. Her resignation is effective at the conclusion of the 2025 AGM.

Resolved that:

The GBC accepts the resignation of Giridhari Swami.

GBC Resolution 802.03 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed March 8, 2024

ADDED · 2025

802.04 · Romapada Swami's leave of absence (2025)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

The Leave of Absence of Romapada Swami is extended by a further one year to February 14, 2026.

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 14, 2025

ADDED · 2025

802.04 · Virabahu dasa's leave of absence— 2024 (2025)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

Virabahu dasa is hereby granted a leave of absence for one year. Within this time period, Virabahu dasa will nominate a successor for his GBC zone.

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed November 13, 2024

ADDED · 2025

802.05 · Bhakti-bhusana Swami as GBC Emeritus (2025)

[Statement]

emeritus

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Bhakti-bhusana Swami is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Bhaktimarga Swami is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Giridhari Swami is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Niranjana Swami is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

Resolved that:

In recognition of his long-standing service to the GBC Body, Radhanath Swami is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

Resolved that:

In recognition of her long-standing service to the GBC Body, Malati devi dasi is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

Resolved that:

In recognition of her long-standing service to the GBC Body, Dina Sharana devi dasi is hereby awarded the status of GBC Emeritus.

GBC Resolution 802.05 · 2025 · Online General Meeting, passed September 4, 2024

ADDED · 2025

804.01 · Sannyasa waiting list (2025)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The following are the candidates for sannyasa:

Valmiki dasa (CCCD) This year

Vishvavasu dasa (NRS) (Germany/Baltics/Russia) This year

Atmaram dasa (GGS) This year

Savyasachi dasa (BCS) (Swaziland) This year

Govindanandana dasa (BCS) This year

Kamalalochan dasa (GKG) (Mumbai) This year

Rukmini Krsna dasa (GKG) North India Sannyasa candidate

Nanda Kumar dasa (BVG) Russia Sannyasa candidate

Shanta Narsimha dasa (JPS) Jaipur Sannyasa candidate

Madana-mohana dasa (MG) Russia Sannyasa candidate

Charu Chandra dasa (JPS) Bangladesh Sannyasa candidate

Padmanayana dasa (RGS) Mayapur Sannyasa candidate

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 16, 2025

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2025)

[Action Order]

Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees

Resolved that:

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2025-26:

Congregational Development

Minister – Jayapataka Swami

Ministry

Minister – Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

Members: Devadeva dasa (BCAIS), Executive Director, Murli

ISKCON Deity Worship Ministry Manohara dasa (SRS), Manohara dasa (SDG), Radha Thakurani dd (BCAIS), Nara-Narayana dasa (KDS), Shyamapriya dd (SDA),
Yogendra dasa (BCAIS)

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister – Manorama dasa (SNS)

Ministry of Book Distribution Minister – Vaisesika dasa

Ministry of Communications Minister – Anuttama dasa

Minister – Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Ministry of Cow Protection &

Agriculture IMCPA Board of Directors (USA): Niranjana Swami, Sesa dasa,

Vaikuntha dasa, Krishna Kishore dasa, Kalakantha das

Ministry of Education Minister – Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)

Minister – Devakinandan dasa (Juhu)

Ministry of Fund Development Members: Govind Prema Das (GKG), Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS), Madan Gopal Das (SDG), Nila Madhava Das (BCS), Vijaya
Gopikesa Das (JPS)

Ministry of Justice Minister – Champakalata DD (IDS)

ISKCON Resolve Co-Directors: Brahmatirtha Das, Vraj Vihari Das (BJD)

Prahladananda Swami (Chair), Champakalata Dasi (Vice-chair) (IDS),

ISKCON Dispute Resolution Devakinandana Das (MVG), Hansarupa Das, Nanda Kishor Das
Department (GRS), Vraja Vihari Das (BJD), Navina-shyam Das (BCS),
Candrasekhara Swami

Ministry of Padayatra Minister – Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami

Minister – Prahladananda Swami

Ministry of Sannyasa Services Members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti
Caitanya Swami, Hridaya Caitanya dasa (SDG), Devakinandan dasa
(Juhu)

Vaishnavi Ministry Co-Ministers – Radha dasi (MG), Sati DD (BTS)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Members – Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS) (Chair), Tapan Misra dasa
(BVKS), Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG), Anuttama

GBC Nominations Committee

dasa, Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Aniruddha
dasa (BJD), Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

Aniruddha dasa (BJD), (Chair), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Govardhana
dasa (BCAIS), Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami,
Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Badrinarayan Swami, Jayapataka Swami,

GBC Organizational

Praghosa dasa (SDG), Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Caitanya Avatari Development Committee

dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu), Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa (HDG), Praharana dasi, Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS), Tirtharaja dasa (TKG), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD)

Pancharatna dasa (Chair), Ananta Sesa Das (IDS), Govinda Priya

GBC Strategic Planning Team Devi Dasi (RNS), Parijata Dasi (RNS), Aradhya Bhagavan Das (BCS), Toshani Nimai Das (RNS)

Members – Praghosa dasa (SDG) (Coordinator), Badrinarayan

Swami, Madhu Sevita dasa, Devamrita Swami, Bhaktivaibhava

BBT-GBC Relations Committee Swami, Devakinandan Das (MVG), Tapan Misra Das (BVKS),

Govardhana Das (BCAIS) Mathura Manohara Das, BBT Trustees and BBTI Directors

GBC Vaisnava Calendar Members – Bhaktarupa dasa (Convener), Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya Committee dasa (BVS), Sadasivananda dasa (JPD),

Members – Anuttama dasa, Prahladananda Swami (Chairman), Bhakti

Guru Services Committee Caitanya Swami, Ramai Swami, Bhakti Vijnana Goswami, Mahatma Das, Gopika Radhika DD (JPS), Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS)

CPOC (Child Protection Govinda Lilamrita DD (BHVS), Atmarama Das (BTS), Rasesvari Oversight Committee) Radhika DD (LOK)

ICPO Interim Director: Champakalata DD (IDS)

Minister: Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami

ISKCON Kirtana Ministry Members: Jagannatha Kirtanananda Das (JPS), Dinanukampa Devi Dasi LOK

Jayapataka Swami, Nrsimhananda dasa, Ramesvara dasa, Loka DD

GBC Executors Property

(BTS), Akshay Ramacandra dasa (JPS), Satyamedha Gauranga dasa Oversight Committee (GEPOC)

(JPS)

Members: Urmila dasi (Chair), Bhakti Prabhava Swami, Hari Parsad dasa (RGS), Narayani dasi, Adi-purusa dasa (GKG), Sarvajna dasa (NRS), Kartika Chandra dasa (RNS), Mahendra Das (SS)

Sastric Advisory Council Associate Members: Krishna Ksetra Swami, Drutakarma dasa, Radhika Ramana dasa (HPS), Chaitanya Charan dasa (RNS),

Gopinatha-acarya dasa (KKS), Bhakti-Vijnana Goswami, Gopal Hari dasa (GKG), Kanai Krishna dasa (RNS)

Leadership Conduct Office Mahavisnupriya DD

Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS) Gauranga dasa (RNS), Bhaktivaibhava

Succession Committee Swami, Rasa Krida Parayana dasa (JPS), Dina Sharana DD, Devakinandan dasa (Juhu), Aniruddha dasa (BJD)

Vaisnava Memorial Standing Hridaya Caitanya dasa (convenor), Bhanu Swami, Malati DD, (SDG), Committee Gauranga dasa (RNS), Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

Executive Director: Nanda Kishor Das (GRS)

Corporate Services: Krishnanam Das (RNS)

GBC Executive Support Office GBC Communications: Parijata DD (RNS)

Ministry and Committee Support: Jayalalita DD (KKS)

GBC Parliamentary Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS), Corresponding Secretary
Radha Sundari DD (RNS), EC Secretary
GBC Secretariat Staff Mahamani Govinda dasa (JPS), Treasurer
Subha Krsna dasa (RNS), GBC Office Manager

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 23, 2025

ADDED · 2025

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2025)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel aka Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2025-26.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 22, 2025

ADDED · 2025

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2025)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

Acyuta Priya dasa (RNS) Ukraine Devotee Care
Asitaradhya dasa (VVPS) India Global Duties Office
Devotee Care, Bhaktivedanta Research Centre, GEV
Gauranga dasa (RNS) India
2.0
Indresa Gaura dasa (BBGS) Canada Govinda's Model
Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS) India GBC Finance
Radheshyam dasa (RNS) India Recruiting Full Time Youth Devotees
Shyamananda Krishna dasa (GKG) Australia Environment—Green Temple Initiative
Trilokatma dasa (BVS) Czechia Karma Free Club
Vaisesika dasa USA One World Book Distribution Team

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2025 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 15, 2025

ADDED · 2026

802.01 · GBC officers (2026)

[Action order]

Resolved that:

1. Madhu Sevita dasa is elected GBC Chairman
2. Govardhana dasa (BCAIS) is elected First Vice-Chairman
3. Devakinandan dasa (MVG) is elected Second Vice-Chairman
4. Revati Raman dasa (JPS) is elected GBC Secretary

GBC Resolution 802.01 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.02 · Krishna Premarupa dasa appointed as an Acting GBC member (2026)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Krishna Premarupa dasa (BSDS) is appointed as an Assistant GBC member for Germanic Europe.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 5, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.02 · Mathuresh dasa appointed as an Acting GBC member (2026)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Mathuresh dasa (JPS) is appointed as an Acting GBC member for the Andean countries.

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.02 · BB Keshava Swami appointed as an Assistant GBC member (2026)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Bhakti Bhagavatamrita Kesava Swami (PVS) is appointed as an Assistant GBC member for for the South of

Russia: Sphere 4

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 5, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.02 · Umapati dasa appointed as an Assistant GBC member (2026)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Umapati dasa (GKG) is appointed as an Assistant GBC member for Central and East Africa (Burundi, Central Africa Republic, Democratic Republic of Congo, Djibouti, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Gabon, Kenya, Republic of Congo, Rwanda, South Sudan, Tanzania and Uganda)

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 5, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.02 · Indresh Gaura dasa appointed as an Assistant GBC member (2026)

[Statement]

appointments

Resolved that:

Indresh Gaura dasa (BBGS) is appointed as an Assistant GBC member for North America: Zone 1 (Canada, Alaska, Minnesota, Montana, North & South Dakota and Wyoming).

GBC Resolution 802.02 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 5, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.04 · Romapada Swami's leave of absence (2026)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

Romapada Swami's leave of absence is extended for a further one year, until February 2027

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.04 · Virabahu dasa's leave of absence (2026)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

Virabahu dasa's leave of absence is extended until February 2027

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

802.04 · Chaitanya Chandra Charan dasa's leave of absence (2026)

[Action order]

absence

Resolved that:

Chaitanya Chandra Charan dasa (JPS) is granted a Leave of Absence until February 2027.

GBC Resolution 802.04 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

804.01 · Sannyasa waiting list — 2025 (2026)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The following are the candidates for sannyasa:

Shanta Narsimha dasa (JPS) Jaipur This year

Rukmini Krsna dasa (GKG) North India This year

Charu Chandra dasa (JPS) Bangladesh This year*

*Passed by Correspondence vote on March 19, 2026

GBC Resolution 804.01 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 16, 2025

805.01 • Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees (2026)

[Action Order]

Reaffirmation of Ministries and Standing Committees

Resolved that:

The following are the Ministry and Standing Committees and their membership assignments for 2026-27:

Congregational Development

Minister: Jayapataka Swami

Ministry

ISKCON Deity Worship Minister: Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)

Ministry Executive director: Devadeva dasa (BCAIS)

Members: Murli Manohara dasa (SRS), Manohara dasa (SDG), Radha Thakurani devi dasi (BCAIS), Nara-Narayana dasa (KDS), Yogendra dasa (BCAIS)

ISKCON Youth Ministry Minister: Manorama dasa (SNS)

Ministry of Book Distribution Minister: Vaisesika dasa

Ministry of Communications Minister: Anuttama dasa

Ministry of Cow Protection & Minister: Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Agriculture IMCPA Board of Directors (USA): Niranjana Swami, Sesa dasa, Vaikuntha dasa (RS), Krishna Kishore dasa (BCS), Kalakantha dasa (IS)

Ministry of Education Minister: Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS)

Ministry of Fund Minister: Devakinandan dasa (Juhu)

Development Members: Govind Prema dasa (GKG), Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS), Madan Gopal dasa (SDG), Nila Madhava dasa (BCS), Vijaya Gopikesa dasa (JPS)

Ministry of Justice Minister: Champakalata devi dasi (IDS)

ISKCON Resolve Co-Directors: Brahmatirtha dasa, Vraj Vihari dasa (BJD)

ISKCON Dispute Resolution Chair: Prahladananda Swami (Chair)

Department Vice-chair: Champakalata dasi (IDS)

Members: Devakinandana dasa (MVG), Hansarupa dasa, Nanda Kishor dasa (GRS), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD), Navina-shyam dasa (BCS), Candrasekhara Swami

Ministry of Padayatra Minister: Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami (LOK)

Ministry of Sannyasa Minister: Prahladananda Swami Members: Bhakti Gauravani Goswami, Services Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Hridaya Caitanya dasa (SDG), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu)

Vaishnavi Ministry Co-Ministers: Radha dasi (MG), Sati devi dasi (BTS)

ISKCON General Counsel Devakinandan dasa (MVG) (Leave of Absence)

GBC Nominations Committee Chair: Radha Krsna dasa (BBGS)

Members: Tapan Misra dasa (BVKS), Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Praghosa dasa (SDG), Anuttama dasa, Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Devakinandan dasa (MVG)

GBC Organizational Co-chairs: Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Gauranga dasa (RNS), Govardhana Development Committee dasa (BCAIS)

Members: Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Badrinarayan Swami, Jayapataka Swami, Pancaratna dasa,

Praghosa dasa (SDG), Revati Raman dasa (JPS), Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (Juhu), Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Gaura Krishna dasa (HDG), Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS), Tirtharaja dasa (TKG), Vraja Vihari dasa (BJD)

GBC Strategic Planning Chair: Pancharatna dasa

Team Members: Ananta Sesa dasa (IDS), Govinda Priya devi dasi (RNS), Parijata dasi (RNS), Aradhya Bhagavan dasa (BCS), Toshani Nimai dasa (RNS)

BBT-GBC Relations Coordinator: Praghosa dasa (SDG)

Committee Members: Badrinarayan Swami, Madhu Sevita dasa, Devamrita Swami, Bhaktivaibhava Swami, Devakinandan dasa (MVG), Tapana Misra dasa (BVKS), Govardhana dasa (BCAIS), Mathura Manohara dasa (JPS), BBT Trustees and BBTI Directors

GBC Vaisnava Calendar Convener: Bhaktarupa dasa

Committee Members: Bhanu Swami, Gopalapriya dasa (BVS), Sadasivananda dasa (JPS)

Guru Services Committee Chair: Prahladananda Swami

Members: Anuttama dasa, Bhakti Caitanya Swami, Ramai Swami, Bhakti Vijnana Goswami (RNS), Mahatma dasa, Arcita dasa, Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS)

CPOC (Child Protection Govinda Lilamrita devi dasi (BHVS), Atmarama dasa (BTS), Nityananda Oversight Committee) Kari devi dasi (SNS)

ICPO Interim Director: Champakalata devi dasi (IDS)

ISKCON Kirtana Ministry Minister: Sri Krishna Chaitanya Swami (LOK)

Members: Jagannatha Kirtanananda dasa (JPS), Dinanukampa devi dasi (LOK)

GBC Executors Property Jayapataka Swami, Nrsimhananda dasa, Ramesvara dasa, Loka devi Oversight Committee dasi (BTS), Akshay Ramacandra dasa (JPS), Satyamedha Gauranga (GEPOC) dasa (JPS)*

Sastric Advisory Council Chair: Urmila dasi

Members: Bhakti Prabhava Swami (BCS), Hari Parsad dasa (RGS), Narayani dasi, Sarvajna dasa (NRS), Kartika Chandra dasa (RNS), Mahendra dasa (SS)

Associate Members: Krishna Ksetra Swami, Drutakarma dasa, Radhika Ramana dasa (HPS), Chaitanya Charan dasa (RNS), Gopinatha-acarya dasa (KKS), Bhakti-Vijnana Goswami (RNS), Gopal Hari dasa (GKG), Kanai Krishna dasa (RNS)

Leadership Conduct Office Mahavisnupriya devi dasi

Succession Committee Co-convenors: Caitanya Avatari dasa (JPS), Gauranga dasa (RNS)

Members:

Africa: Umapati dasa (GKG), Harideva dasa (BCAIS)

Middle East: Srivallabha dasa (JPS), Aniruddha Gopal dasa (JPS), Vrajaprana dasa (JPS)

Latin America: Paramatma dasa (SDG), Prema Rupa Madhava dasa (JPS), Devakinandan dasa (HPS)

Europe: Krishna Premarupa dasa (BSDS), Parabhakti dasa (RNS)

Russia & Central Asia: Aprameyatma dasa (SRS), Adi Gopinath

dasa (GKG),
 Southeast Asia: Sri Narayan dasa (GKG), Raghunandana dasa (MVG)
 Oceania & Indonesia: Aniruddha dasa (BJD), Krishna Chandra dasa (BKG)
 North America: Jaya Krsna dasa (SNS), Govind Priya devi dasi (RNS)
 North India: Rishikumar dasa (GKG), Sundar Gopal dasa (GKG)
 West India: Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS)
 East India: Bhakti Vijaya Bhagavata Swami (JPS)
 South India: Narayana Chaitanya dasa (JPS)
 Vaisnava Memorial Standing Convener: Hrdaya Caitanya dasa (SDG)
 Committee Members: Bhanu Swami, Malati devi dasi, Gauranga dasa (RNS),
 Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS), Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS)
 GBC Executive Support Executive Director: Nanda Kishor dasa (GRS)
 Office Corporate Services: Krishnanam dasa (RNS)
 GBC Communications: Parijata devi dasi (RNS)
 Ministry and Committee Support: Jayalalita devi dasi (KKS)
 GBC Parliamentary Nrsimha Kavaca dasa (IDS)
 GBC Secretariat Staff Corresponding Secretary: Ananda Tirtha dasa (PVS)
 EC Secretary: Radha Sundari devi dasi (RNS)
 Treasurer: Mahamani Govinda dasa (JPS)
 GBC Office Manager: Subha Krsna dasa (RNS)

*GEPOC membership was not voted on

GBC Resolution 805.01 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 5, 2026

ADDED · 2026

807.01 · Appointment of auditor (2026)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

Sri Ratnesh Singh Chandel aka Rasa Parayana dasa (GKG), Partner, Kothari Chandel & Co Chartered Accountants 219/220 Office No. 2, Murlidhar Apartment, Kelkar Road, Narayan Peth, Pune 411030, is appointed as statutory auditor for the year 2026-27.

GBC Resolution 807.01 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

ADDED · 2026

810.02 · Reappointment of Global Duty Officers (2026)

[Action Order]

Resolved that:

The following Global Duty Officers are reappointed for a further one-year term:

Asitaradhya dasa (VVPS) India Global Duties Office

Indresa Gaura dasa (BBGS) Canada Govinda's Model

Mukunda Madhava dasa (BSDS) India GBC Finance

Radheshyam dasa (RNS) India Recruiting Full Time Youth Devotees

Shyamananda Krishna dasa (GKG) Australia Environment—Green Temple Initiative

Vaisesika dasa USA One World Book Distribution Team

GBC Resolution 810.02 · 2026 · Annual General Meeting, passed February 4, 2026

Appendix — Modern Section/code ↔ Book Chapter/Section Crosswalk

Modern Section	Book chapter(s)	Confidence	Basis
100 Srila Prabhupada	Ch.2	high	Modern Section 100 (Srila Prabhupada) corresponds directly to Chapter 2.
200 Governing Body Commission	Ch.3	high	Modern Section 200 (Governing Body Commission) corresponds directly to Chapter 3 for GBC structure/procedure.
300 International Society for Krishna Consciousness (ISKCON)	Ch.1	medium	Modern Section 300 (ISKCON) is the book's broad umbrella Chapter 1; most Section 300 resolutions on a specific subject fit better under that subject's own chapter instead.
400 ISKCON Ministries, Committees, and Offices	Ch.4	high	Modern Section 400 (ISKCON Ministries, Committees, and Offices) corresponds to Chapter 4 for the ministry system itself.
500 Deputies, Global Duty Officers, Special Duty Officers and Zonal Supervisors	Ch.3	medium	Modern Section 500 (Deputies, GDOs, SDOs, Zonal Supervisors) corresponds to the “Categories of GBC Members” subsection of Chapter 3 (§3.5.5), not a whole chapter of its own.
600 ISKCON Spiritual Leadership	Ch.5	high	Modern Section 600 (ISKCON Spiritual Leadership) corresponds directly to Chapter 5.
700 Gurus and Disciples	Ch.6, Ch.7	high	Modern Section 700 (Gurus and Disciples) corresponds to Chapter 6 (Discipleship in ISKCON) and Chapter 7 (ISKCON Spiritual Masters) together -- confirmed directly by three separate resolutions (2019 code 701.2, 2021 code 701.02, 2024 code 702.02) that each quote and amend the SAME book section, 7.3.2, by number.
800 Appointments	(none, cross-cutting)	none	Modern Section 800 (Appointments) is cross-cutting in both schemes -- appointments happen across many chapters (GBC members in Ch3, gurus in Ch7, temple presidents in Ch10...); there is no single chapter for “appointments” in general.
900 Financial and Legal	Ch.11, Ch.18, Ch.19, Ch.24	medium	Modern Section 900 (Financial and Legal) corresponds mainly to Chapter 11 (Immovable Properties) and Chapter 18 (Fund Development); some modern financial/legal material has no single-chapter counterpart at all.

Specific-section pairs with direct textual citation evidence:

Modern code (year)	Book section	Confidence
100.05 (2026)	2.3.2 Shrines and Memorials	explicit
203.02 (2020)	3.5.5.3 Emeritus GBC	explicit
701.02 (2021)	7.3.2 No One Can Give Diksa While Guru is Present	explicit
701.2 (2019)	7.3.2 No One Can Give Diksa While Guru is Present	explicit
702.02 (2022)	7.2.2 Discretionary Qualifications	explicit
702.02 (2024)	7.3.2 No One Can Give Diksa While Guru is Present	explicit
201.02 (2022)	3.1 GBC Body	high
201.03 (2026)	3 Governing Body Commission	high

201.04 (2026)	3 Governing Body Commission	high
202.3 (2019)	3.2 Executive Committee of the GBC Body	high
203.03 (2020)	3.5 GBC Members	high
307.04 (2021)	1.2 Principles: The Seven Purposes of ISKCON	high
307.4 (2019)	1.2 Principles: The Seven Purposes of ISKCON	high
410 (2021)	4.4.6 Ministry of Health and Welfare	high
605.1 (2019)	5 ISKCON Spiritual Leadership	high
701.06 (2020)	7 ISKCON Spiritual Masters (Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)	high
701.2 (2019)	7 ISKCON Spiritual Masters (Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)	high
701.6 (2019)	7 ISKCON Spiritual Masters (Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)	high
702.02 (2021)	7 ISKCON Spiritual Masters (Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)	high
702.03 (2022)	7 ISKCON Spiritual Masters (Diksa & Siksa-Gurus)	high

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